

THE
ENGLISH CHARLEMAGNE ROMANCES.

PART V.

The Romance of
The Sowdore of Babylone

and of

Herumbras his Sone who conquerede Rome.

RE-EDITED

FROM THE UNIQUE MS. OF THE LATE SIR THOMAS PHILLIPPS.

with Introduction, Notes, and Glossary,

BY

EMIL HAUSKNECHT, PH. D.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE ROMAUNCE OF THE SOWDONE OF BABYLONE AND OF
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INTRODUCTION. [◇](#)

THE exploits of Charles the Great, who by his achievements as conqueror and legislator, as reformer of learning and missionary, so deeply changed the face of Western Europe, who during a reign of nearly half a century maintained, by his armies, the authority of his powerful sceptre, from the southern countries of Spain and Italy to the more northern regions of Denmark, Poland, and Hungary, must have made a profound and unalterable impression in the minds of his contemporaries, so that for centuries afterwards they continued to live in the memory of the people. Evidence of this high pitch of popularity is given by the numerous *chansons de geste* or romances, which celebrate the deeds, or are connected with the name, of the great and valiant champion of Christendom.

It is true that the sublime figure of Charlemagne, who with his imaginary twelve peers perpetually warred against all heathenish or Saracen people, in the romances of a later period, has been considerably divested of that nimbus of majestic grandeur, which the composers of the earlier poems take pains to diffuse around him. Whereas, in the latter, the person of the Emperor appears adorned with high corporeal, intellectual, and warlike gifts, and possessed of all royal qualities; the former show us the splendour of Royalty tarnished and debased, and the power of the feudal vassals enlarged to the prejudice of the royal authority. Roland, in speaking of Charlemagne, says, in the *Chanson de Roland*, l. 376:—

“Jamais n’iert hum qui encuntre lui vaillet,”

and again the same Roland says of the Emperor, in *Guy de Bourgoyne*, l. 1061:—

“Laissomes ce viellart qui tous est assotez.”

[<vi>](#)

This glorification of the great Christian hero took its rise in France, but soon spread into the neighbouring countries, and before long Charlemagne

was celebrated in song by almost all European nations. Indeed, there are translations, reproductions, compilations of French Charlemagne romances to be met with in Italy, Spain, and Portugal, as well as in Scandinavia and Iceland. Even in Hungary and Russia these *chansons* of the Charlemagne cycle seem to have been known.¹

A full account of almost all Charlemagne romances will be found in Gaston Paris's exhaustive work of the *Histoire poétique de Charlemagne* (Paris, 1865), and in Léon Gautier's *Epopées françaises* (Paris, 1867).

Of all the Charlemagne romances, that of Fierabras or Ferumbras has certainly obtained the highest degree of popularity, as is shown by the numerous versions and reproductions of this romance, from the 13th century down to the present day.

When the art of printing first became general, the first romance that was printed was a prose version of *Fierabras*; and when the study of mediæval metrical romances was revived in this century, the *Fierabras* poem was the first to be re-edited.²

The balm of Fierabras especially seems to have been celebrated for its immediately curing any wound; we find it referred to and minutely described in Florian's *Don Quichotte*, I. chap. 10. The scene of Fierabras challenging to a combat the twelve peers of France, and of his vaunting offer to fight at once with six (or twelve) of them,³ must also have been pretty familiar to French readers, as the name of Fierabras is met with in the sense of a simple common noun, signifying "a bragging bully or swaggering hector."⁴

Rabelais⁵ also alludes to Fierabras, thinking him renowned enough as to figure in the pedigree of Pantagruel.

In 1833, on a tour made through the Pyrenees, M. Jomard witnessed <vii> a kind of historical drama, represented by villagers, in which Fierabras and Balan were the principal characters.⁶

That in our own days, the tradition of Fierabras continues to live, is evident from the fact, that copies of the Fierabras story, in the edition of the *Bibliothèque Bleue*, still circulate amongst the country people of France.⁷ There is even an illustrated edition, published in 1861, the pictures of which

have been executed by no less an artist than Gustave Doré. And like Oberon, that other mediæval hero of popular celebrity,⁸ Fierabras has become the subject of a musical composition. There is an Opera *Fierabras* composed by Franz Schubert (words by Joseph Kupelwieser) in 1823, the overture of which has been arranged for the piano in 1827, by Carl Czerny.⁹

The different versions and the popularity of the present romance in France, Italy, Spain, and Germany, having been treated in the Introduction to *Sir Ferumbras*, we need not repeat it again here.¹⁰ As to the popularity of the *Fierabras* romance in the Netherlands, the following passage from Hoffmann, *Horæ Belgicæ* (Vratislaviæ, 1830), I. 50, may be quoted here¹¹:—

“Quam notæ Belgis, sec. xiii. et xiv., variæ variarum nationum fabulæ fuerint, quæ ex Gallia septentrionali, ubi originem ceperunt, translatae sunt, pauca hæc testimonia demonstrabunt:— in exordio Sidraci:—¹²

‘Dickent hebbic de gone ghesconden,
die hem an boeken houden
daer si clene oerbare in leren,
also sijn jeesten van heeren,
van Paerthenopeuse, van Amidase,
van Troijen ende van *Fierabrase*,
ende van menighen boeken, die men mint
ende daer men litel oerbaren in vint,
<viii>
ende dat als leghene es ende mere,
ende anders en hebben ghene lere,
danne vechten ende vrouwen minnen
ende lant ende steden winnen’—

“Nec rarius tanguntur fabulæ de Carolo Magno, *Speculum Historiale*, IV. 1. xxix (cf. *Bilderdijk, Verscheidenh*, I. D. bl. 161–2):—

‘Carel es menichwaerf beloghen
in groten boerden ende in hoghen,
alse boerders doen ende oec dwase,
diene beloghen van *Fierabrase*,
dat nie gheschiede noch en was
die scone walsce valsce poeten,
die mer rimen dan si weten,
belieghen groten Caerle vele
in sconen worden ende bispele
van *Fierabrase van Alisandre*,
van *Pont Mautrible* ende andre,
dat algader niet en was’”

That the *Fierabras* romance must have been well known and highly popular in England and Scotland, may be gathered from the numerous references to this poem in various Middle English works.

Thus the whole subject of the *Fierabras* romance is found in the following passage, taken from *Barbour's Bruce*, ed. Skeat, 3, 435 ss., where the King is described as relating to his followers:—

“Romanys off worthi Ferambrace,
 That worthily our-commyn was
 Throw the rycht douchty Olywer;
 And how the duz Peris wer
 Assegyt intill Egrymor,
 Quhar King Lawyne lay thaim befor
 With may thowsandis then I can say,
 And bot elewyn within war thai,
 And a woman; and wa sa stad,
 That thai na mete thar within had,
 Bot as thai fra thair fayis wan.
 Y heyte, sua contenyt thai thaim than;
 That thai the tour held manlily,
 Till that Rychard off Normandy,
 Magre his fayis, warnyt the king,
 That wes joyfull off this tithing:
 For he wend, thai had all bene slayne,
 Tharfor he turnyt in hy agayne,
 And wan Mantrybill and passit Flagot;
 And syne Lawyne and all his flot
 Dispitusly discumfyt he:
 And deliueryt his men all fre,
 And wan the *naylis*, and the *sper*,
 And the croune that Ihesu couth ber; [<ix>](#)
 And off the *croice* a gret party
 He wan throw his chewalry.”¹³

In his poem of *Ware the Hawk*, Skelton (ed. Dyce, l. 162) cites *Syr Pherumbras* as a great tyrant. He also refers to him in one of his poems against Garnesche, whom he addresses with the following apostrophe:—

“Ye fowle, fers and felle, as Syr Ferumbras the ffreke.”

The story of the combat between Oliver and Ferumbras is alluded to by Lyndsay, in his *Historie of ane Nobil and Wailzeand Squyer, William Meldrum*, ed. Hall, ll. 1313–16:—

“Roland with Brandwell, his bricht brand,
 Faucht never better, hand for hand,
 Nor Gawin aganis Golibras,
 Nor Olyver with Pharambras.”

The tale of the fortified bridge of Mauntrible seems also to have been very well known in England and Scotland. In the *Complaint of Scotland*, ed. Murray, p. 63, we find the *Tail of the Brig of the Mantrible* mentioned

among other famous romances. In his lampoon on Garnesche, Skelton describes his adversary as being more deformed and uglier than

“Of Mantryble the bryge Malchus¹⁴ the murryon.”

As has already been mentioned, amongst all the Charlemagne romances the (originally French) romance of *Fierabras* is remarkable as being one of the first that was rescued from the dust of libraries; and it is worthy of note, in connection with it, that the first printed version was not a French, but a Provençal one, which was published not in France, the birth-place of the romance, but in Germany.

The manuscript of this Provençal version having been discovered by Lachmann in the Library of Prince Ludwig von Oettingen-Wallerstein,¹⁵ ~~cx~~ somewhere about the year 1820, the poem was published in 1829 by Immanuel Bekker.¹⁶

Raynouard, who drew attention to this edition of the poem in the *Journal des Savants*, March 1831, supposed this Provençal version to be the original.

Soon after Fauriel discovered at Paris two MSS. of the romance in French, and a third French MS. was found in London,¹⁷ by Fr. Michel, in 1838.

In 1852 Fauriel gave an account of the poem in the *Histoire Littéraire de la France, par les religieux bénédictins de congregation de Saint-Maur continuée par des membres de l’Institut*, vol. xxii. p. 196 *et seq.*, where he also investigated the question of the originality of the two versions, without arriving at a final solution; as from the comparison of the French and the Provençal version, no conclusion as to the original could be drawn in favour of either of the two poems.¹⁸

As early as 1829 Uhland and Diez had expressed their opinion, that in all probability the Provençal poem was to be looked upon as a reproduction of some French source,¹⁹ and in 1839 Edelestand du Méril, in France, had pointed out the French poem as the original of the Provençal version;²⁰ Guessard in his lectures at the Ecole des Chartes, at Paris, had also defended the same opinion; when in 1860, the editors of the French

*Fierabras*²¹ finally and irrefutably proved the impossibility of considering the Provençal poem as anything but a translation of a French original. <xi>

In 1865, Gaston Paris, in his *Poetical History of Charlemagne*, pointed out that what we have now of the *Fierabras* romance must be looked upon as a very different version from the old original *Fierabras* (or *Balan*) romance, the former being indeed only a portion, considerably amplified and in its arrangement modified, of the old poem, the first portion of which has been lost altogether. Gaston Paris had been led to this supposition by the rather abrupt opening of the *Fierabras*, which at once introduces the reader *in medias res*, and by the numerous passages of the *Fierabras*, which contain allusions and references to preceding events; several of which, being obscure and inexplicable from the context of the *Fierabras* itself, can only be explained by assuming the existence of an earlier poem.

The main subject of the old *Balan* or *Fierabras* romance may be given as follows:—"The Saracens having invaded Rome and killed the Pope, Charlemagne sends, from France, Guy of Burgundy and Richard of Normandy to the rescue of the city, and follows himself with his main army. After a fierce combat between Oliver and Ferumbras, the city is delivered from the Saracens, and a new Pope established."²² <xii>

Of all the events related in the old *Balan* romance, there is but one which is contained in the *Fierabras* poem, viz. the combat between Oliver and Ferumbras, and even this has been greatly modified in consequence of the composer's transferring the scene of action from Italy to Spain. All the other events related in the *Fierabras*, the love of Floripas and Guy, the capture of the twelve peers, their being besieged in the castle of Agremor, and their deliverance by Charlemagne, and the ultimate wedding of Floripas and Guy are altogether wanting in the original *Fierabras* [*Balan*] romance.

Therefore Gaston Paris was right in saying that the *Fierabras* poem contained only the second part of the earlier poem, the first part of which had not come down to us.

Now it seemed as though this view, which had been clearly <xiii> demonstrated and generally adopted, would have to undergo a thorough modification on the discovery of a new *Fierabras* Manuscript in Hanover.

Professor Græber, having been informed of the existence of that MS. by Professor Tobler, published from it, in 1873, the poem of the *Destruction de Rome*,²³ which in that MS. precedes the *Fierabras* romance.²⁴ In his Address to the Assembly of German Philologists at Leipzig,²⁵ the same scholar attempted to show that this poem represented the first part of the earlier *Balan* romance.

This supposition, however, can only be accepted with reserve, and needs a great modification, as by no means all the references to previous events contained in the *Fierabras* receive explanation in the *Destruction*, although all such previous events must have been narrated in the original *Balan*. Moreover, one of these allusions in the *Fierabras* is in direct contradiction to the contents of the *Destruction*.

Thus ll. 2237 *et seq.* of the *Fierabras*:²⁶—

“i. chevalier de France ai lontans enamé:
Guis a nom de Borgoigne, moult i a bel armé;
Parens est Karlemaine et Rollant l’aduré.
Dès que je fui à Romme, m’a tout mon cuer emblé,
Quant l’amirans mes peres fist gaster la cité,
Lucafer de Baudas abati ens ou pré,
Et lui et le ceval, d’un fort espiel quarré,”

where Floripas declares that she has seen Guy before Rome when defeating Lukafer, widely differ from the account given in ll. 1355 *et seq.* of the *Destruction*, where Guy does not arrive at Rome until *after* the departure of Laban’s army to Spain.

In the *Destruction* no clue is given which would enable us to explain why Charles should be constantly applying to Richard in the *Fierabras* (ll. 112 *et seq.*) for information about Fierabras, or why Richard, in particular, should know more about Fierabras than any one else. There is no mention in the *Destruction* of Richard chasing <xiv> the Emir before him in the plain of Rome, to which event ll. 3708–9 of the *Fierabras*²⁷ clearly refer.

“Richars de Normendie au courage aduré,
Qui cacha l’amirant devant Romme ens el pré.”

The allusion contained in l. 2614,²⁸

. . . . “Richart de Normendie,
Cil qui m’ocist Corsuble et mon oncle Mautrie,”

where Richard is said to have slain Corsuble and Mautrie, the uncle of Floripas, is not cleared up by the *Destruction*, as in the three passages, where Richard is mentioned there (ll. 246, 288, 541), he does not play an active part at all, whereas from Mousket's analysis of the original *Fierabras* [*Balan*] romance, we know how important a part Guy and Richard played in the old poem.²⁹ There Richard and Guy being sent off by Charlemagne as a first succour to the oppressed Romans, succeeded in delivering Château-Miroir, which had been seized by the Saracens. The story of the combat around Château-Miroir, as related in the *Destruction*, ll. 593 ss., is thoroughly different,³⁰ as besides other variations, there is neither Richard nor Guy concerned in it.

Therefore, as the contents of the *Destruction* are not identical with Mousket's analysis of the old *Balan* romance, and as several passages alluding to events previously described are left unexplained in the *Destruction*; and as there is even an instance of the *Destruction* being in contradiction to the *Fierabras*, the poem of the *Destruction de Rome* cannot be said to be identical with the first part of the *Balan* romance.³¹ <XV>

The Provençal version and the *Destruction* are each printed from unique MSS., the latter from the Hanover MS., the former from the Wallerstein MS. Of the French *Fierabras* there are seven MSS. known to exist.

a = the MS. of the Bibliothèque Nationale at Paris, Supplém. franç., No. 180, which has been followed throughout by the editors of the French *Fierabras*, who in cases of evident errors or lacunæ of this MS., consulted the three following MSS.:

b = the MS. of the Biblioth. Nationale, Lancelot, 7566^{3.3}.

c = the MS. of the British Museum, MS. Reg. 15. E. vi.³²

d = the MS. of the Vatican Library, Regina 1616.

D = the MS. in possession of M. Ambroise-Firmin Didot, a small fragment of which has been printed by Gautier, *Epopées* fr. ii. 307.

E = the Escorial MS., a description of which, together with the variations, has been given by Knust, in the *Jahrbuch für romanische und englische Sprache und Literatur*, vol. ix. p. 43 et seq.

H = the Hanover MS., which also contains the *Destruction de Rome*. It has been described by Professor Græber in the *Jahrbuch*, xiii. p. 111.

<xvi>

As to the English *Fierabras* romances, there are two versions known to exist:³³ the poem of *Sir Ferumbras* contained in the Ashmole MS. 33³⁴ and the present poem.

In the following we shall attempt to point out the differences of these two versions, and to examine whether there is any relationship between the English and the French poems, and if possible to identify the original of the former.

A superficial comparison of the English poem of *Sir Ferumbras* with the French romance *Fierabras* (edd. Kræber and Servois) will suffice at once to show the great resemblance between the two versions. In my *Dissertation* on the sources and language of the *Sowdan of Babylone* (Berlin, 1879) I have proved (pp. 30–40) that the Ashmolean *Ferumbras* must be considered as a running poetical translation of a French original. Since Mr. Herrtage, in the Introduction to his edition of the Ashmole MS. 33, has also pointed out the closeness with which the translator generally followed the original, which he believes to belong to the same type as the *Fierabras*, edited by MM. Kræber and Servois. “The author has followed his original closely, so far as relates to the course of events; but at the same time he has translated it freely, introducing several slight incidents and modifications, which help to enliven and improve the poem. That he has not translated his original literally, is shown by the fact that the French version consists of only 6219 lines, or allowing for the missing portion of the Ashmole MS., not much more than one-half the number of lines in the latter, and that too, although he has cut down the account of the duel between Oliver and Ferumbras from 1500 to 800 lines, by leaving out Oliver’s attempts at converting the Saracen, Charlemagne’s prayers, &c.”

Now, in my opinion, we ought not to lay too much stress on the fact that the number of lines in the two versions differs, as all translators of poetical works, who wish to follow their original as closely as possible, will easily

be able to render it 'literally' as long as they write in prose. But adopting a poetical form for their translation, and still pursuing their intention of a close rendering of their original, <xvii> they must needs be more diffuse, and the consideration of rhythm and rhyme will compel them sometimes to abandon a quite literal translation, and to be content with a free reproduction. This is also the case with the author of *Syr Ferumbras*, who, notwithstanding the many passages where the French text is not given 'literally,' must be considered as a close rhymed translation of the French poem. The only liberty which we see the English author take sometimes, consists in contracting or amalgamating together those *couplets similaires*,³⁵ or strophes which contain repetitions.

But not always did the author thus give up his plan of rendering his original closely: occasionally he has such repetitionary lines in the same place as the French poem, as, for instance, in ll. 130 *et seq.* corresponding to *Fierabras*, ll. 125 *et seq.*

The closeness and literalness of his translation is well exemplified by his introduction in an English dress of a great many French words which are unknown, or at least of a most rare occurrence, in English, and which in his translation are found in the same place and context, where the French text has them. This will be best illustrated by juxtaposing the corresponding phrases of the two versions.

Ashmole *Ferumbras*.

- 312 Hit ys rewarded ous two
betwyne þat Olyuer schal
wende and take þe batail
- 330 *Mercy*, quap he to kyng
Charles
- 369 þat *paynede* crist
- 388 Er y *remuvie* me of þis
place
- 399 y *challenge* wiþ þe to fízt
- 457 *Parfay*, ansuerde erld O.
- 533 þat he ne . . maden zelde
his body to him *creaunt*
- 537 wiþ my swerd *trenchaut*
- 538 *Sarsyns*, said erld O.
- 551 long man in *fourchure*
- 558 a ful *gret pite*, etc.
- 751 haue *mercy* of me, *iantail*
knyzt
- 781 to *remurie* þe of þis place
- 817 he was *encombred* with F.
- 922 þey went forth on a
pendant
- 947 wan hure spere gunne to
faile
- 984 At *avalynge* of an hulle
1008. to *rescourre* þe barons
- 1012
- 1016 wel longe hadde þis *chas*
ylest

French *Fierabras*.

- 301 ‘Nous jupon Olivier, si
l’avons *esgardé* Qu’il fera
la bataille au païen
deffaé.’
- 333 ‘As piés le roy se jete,
merchi li a priié.’
- 377 ‘— dont vos Diex fu
penès.’
- 392 ‘Ains que je m’en
remue ...’
- 402 ‘— je te voel *calengier*’
- 449 ‘*Par foi*, dist Oliviers ...’
- 548 ‘se Roland s’i combat, ne
faice *recréant*’
- 553 ‘... à m’espée *trencant*’
- 554 *Sarrazins*, dist li quans ...
- 579 Il ot l’*enfourcéure* grant
- 586 j’ai de toi *grand pité*, etc.
- ⋈xviii⋈
- 1494 — *merci* li a crié: *Gentix*
—5 hom . .
- 1515 ja par moi n’i seriés . .
remués
- 1552 Mais de F. est . . .
encombrés
- 1696 Cil s’entornent fuiant le
pendant d’un laris
- 1712 Quant les lances lor *falent*
- 1734 À l’*avaler* d’un tertre
- 1757 . . les barons *rescous* . .
- 1764 Moult fu grans cele *chace*

1058	and opre reliques riche ynow wherof y have <i>plentee</i>	1806	Et les dignes reliques dont il i ad <i>plenté</i>
1227	for to wyte wat þay <i>be</i> and hure covyne yknowe	2067	Lor <i>couvine</i> et lor <i>estre</i> enquerre et demander.
1316	By an old forsake ʒeate of þe <i>olde antiquyte</i>	2144	Par une gaste porte de <i>viel</i> <i>antequité</i>
1773	sittyng on a grene <i>erber</i>	2562	. . siét sous cel <i>arbre</i> ramé.
1974	Florippe his doztre þe <i>cortoyse</i> in <i>chambre</i> þar she was In þe <i>paleys</i> yhurde <i>noise</i> and þyder þan she gas	2712	Floripas la <i>courtoise</i> a le <i>nois</i> escoute Puis issi de la <i>cambre</i> , . . . Entresi c’au <i>palais</i> . .
2007	þow ert <i>asotid</i>	2733	. . vous voi <i>assoté</i> .
2538	a gret <i>repref</i> it were	3136	. . il nous est <i>reprouvé</i>
3665	brydel and <i>paytrel</i> and al þe gere wiþ fyn gold yharneyssed were	4117	Li estrier furent d’or, rices fu li <i>poitrés</i>
3672	and þe king him gan <i>ascrie</i>	4126	. . . si s’est haut <i>escriés</i> .
3791	a gret <i>dul</i> þay made þere	4236	. . demainent grant <i>dolour</i>
4541	with an hard <i>crestid</i> <i>serpentis fel</i>	4832	vestu ot la pel d’un dur <i>serpent cresté</i>
5753	on þan ston a <i>cracchede</i> and in a spatte in <i>dispit</i> of god, etc.	5910	en <i>despit</i> de Ihesu ens es fous <i>ecraca</i> .

Besides these undoubted examples of translation, we must bear in mind that there occur some variations of readings, where, indeed, the author of *Syr Ferumbras* seems to have introduced slight incidents and modifications. But examining them more closely, we shall soon become aware that many of them also point to a French original, which we may sometimes identify by comparing these variations with the readings of those French MSS. that are already printed. Thus, the words “þarto ys stede þan tyep he,” l. 91, render exactly a line of the Escorial MS.³⁶—“son cheval

aresna à l’abricel rose”—which is omitted in l. 93 of *F* (*i. e.* the French *Fierabras*, as edited by MM. Kræber and Servois).³⁷ [<xix>](#)

The following is another example of *A* (= the Ashmolean *Ferumbras*) differing from *F*, but agreeing with *E*:

A.	E.
175 Ne <i>lyre</i> he noȝt þys day til evene	175 ke il puisse tant <i>vivre</i> que cis jours soit passés
2131 Adoun þay gunne falle, <i>knellyng</i> on þe erthe stille ... & <i>kussedem</i> <i>everechone</i> , etc.	2833 Issi <i>agenoillierent</i> par bones volentez ... <i>Ils baissent</i> les reliques ...

Notwithstanding these resemblances of *A* to *E*, in passages where *A* differs from *F*, *E* cannot have been the source of *A*, as there are many instances where *E* and *F* show the same reading, whereas *A* differs from both versions.

Thus, *A*, l. 340 *et seq.*, it is Duke Reyner who blesses his son, and not Charles, as *E* and *F* (l. 357) have it.

The names of Arrenor, Gwychar, Gayot, and Angwyree, given in l. 814, differ from those which are mentioned in the corresponding passage of *E* and *F* (ll. 1548–49).

There is no mention of Kargys being slain by Oliver (*A* 880) to be found in *E* or *F* (l. 1670–76).

In *A* 1178, *Lamasour* advises the Soudan not to slay the prisoners; in *E* and *F* (l. 1948) the same advice is given by *Brulans*.

The names of *Lambrock* and *Colbrant* (*A* 1616, 1618) are not found in *E* and *F*, 2424.

A, ll. 1347–48, are wanting in *E* and *F* (2174). xxx

Instead of a giant (*A* 1700) we find a giantess mentioned in *E* and *F* (l. 2483).

Instead of Roland (*A* 1793) it is Naymes who speaks first in *E* and *F*, 2570.

These few instances, the number of which might easily be increased, will certainly suffice to show the impossibility of regarding *E* as the original of *A*.

Only a short passage of the Didot MS. has been hitherto printed;³⁸ therefore the arguments drawn from a comparison of *A* with that printed

passage cannot be considered as altogether irrefutable and final. But as the Didot MS. belongs to the same family of MSS. as *E*, we may at once presume, that as *E* cannot be taken for the original of *A*, the possibility of the Didot MS. being the source of *A*, is not very strong. Besides it may be stated, that no trace of the two additional lines (ll. 19 and 20³⁹) which the Didot MS. inserts after l. 63 of *a* (or *F*) is found in *A*, although this version gives, in ll. 52 ss., a pretty close translation of the corresponding passage in *F* (ll. 50 *et seq.*). This may lead us to conclude that the Didot MS. was not the source of *A*.

Comparing now *A* with what is known of the Hanover MS. of *Fierabras*,⁴⁰ we find *A* resembling to *H* in the following names: *Lucafer* (only once *Lukefer* in *A* 2204), *Maragounde* (once *Marigounde*, *A* 1364), *Maubyn* *A* = *Maupyn* *H*.—*A* 1700 and 2831, which differ from *F*, equally agree with *H*. In the last case *A* agrees also with *E* (although differing from *F*). Now as we know that *H* together with *D* and *E* are derived from the same group *z*,⁴¹ we may perhaps be justified in regarding a MS. of the latter group as the original of *A*. But a more detailed comparison of *A* with *H* being impossible at present, this argumentation wants confirmation.

The impossibility of regarding the Provençal version as the source *<xxi>* of the Ashmolean *Ferumbras*, is proved by the fact that the long additional account, the ‘episode’ as Professor Græber calls it,⁴² is wanting in *A*. Another proof is given by *A*, ll. 5763 *et seq.*, where *A* agrees with *F*, but widely differs from *P*.⁴³

It seems superfluous to point out the inadmissibility of regarding the French prose version as the original of *A*, the first edition of the prose version being of a much later date than the Ashmole *Ferumbras*. But also that version from which the prose romance has been copied or compiled, cannot have been the original of *A*. For although the phrase of *A*, 3888—“*A skuntede as a bore*”—seems to contain some resemblance of expression with the reading of the prose *Fierabras*—“*il commença à escumer come s’il fust ung senglier eschaufé,*” which Caxton translates—“*he began to scumme at the mouthe lyke a bore enchaffed*”—the reading of *A*, ll. 1307 ss., which greatly varies from Caxton’s version (a translation of the French

prose *Fierabras*), renders inadmissible the supposition that the original of the French prose version is the source of A.⁴⁴

Having thus compared the Ashmolean *Ferumbras*, as far as can be done at present, with all existing versions of this romance, we arrive at the following conclusions.

The Ashmole *Ferumbras* is a pretty close translation of some French version, which we are at present unable to identify. Its original was neither of the same family (w) as the *Fierabras*, edited by MM. Kræber and Servois, nor yet of that of the Escorial version. Nevertheless, the original of *Sir Ferumbras* cannot have differed much from the common original, from which these two groups of MSS. are derived. To this original, called y by Græber, the MS., from which A has been copied, appears to have been more closely related than to the Provençal version, from which it certainly is not derived. As the liberties which the author of *Sir Ferumbras* took in translating his original, consist only in very slight modifications, we may conclude <xxii> from his closeness of translation in general, that in those passages of A which exhibit significant deviations from the known French versions, these variations are not due to the composer of the Ashmolean poem, but were already to be found in its original. Therefore the Ashmole *Ferumbras* may be considered as representing by itself the translation of an independent French MS., which perhaps belonged, or at least was nearly related, to the type y.

I now come to the consideration of the *Sowdan of Babylone*, which the simple analysis given by Ellis,⁴⁵ shows to be an essentially different work from the Ashmolean *Ferumbras*. Indeed, whilst the *Syr Ferumbras* represents only a portion (viz. the second part) of the original *Fierabras* [or *Balan*, as Gaston Paris has styled it],⁴⁶ the *Sowdan* approaches the original more nearly in that it contains the long 'introductory account'.⁴⁷ For this first part of the *Sowdan* (as far as l. 970), although it cannot be considered as identical with the first portion of the old *Balan* romance, contains several facts, which, however abridged and modified, show a great resemblance with those which must have been the subject of the lost portion of the old original. Whereas the Ashmolean *Ferumbras* is, on the whole, a mere

translation of a French original, the *Sowdan* must be looked upon as a free reproduction of the English redactor, who, though following his original as far as regards the course of events, modelled the matter given there according to his own genius, and thus came to compose an independent work of his own.

This point being fully treated in my *Dissertation*,⁴⁸ I need not again enter into discussion of it here. I only mention that the composer of the *Sowdan* has much shortened his original, omitting all episodes and secondary circumstances not necessarily connected with the principal action, so that this poem does not contain half the number of lines which his original had,⁴⁹ and that the proportion of the diffuse Ashmolean *Ferumbras* and the *Sowdan* is over five to one.⁵⁰ <xxiii>

The subject of the ‘introductory account,’ or the first part of the *Sowdan*, is nearly the same as that of the *Destruction de Rome*, differing from this poem only in the omission of a few insignificant incidents or minor episodes, and in greater conciseness, which latter circumstances, however, enters into the general plan of the author.

Indeed, the author of the *Sowdan* seems to have known the *Destruction*, as we see from a comparison of the two poems. Thus the following instances show a great resemblance of expression of the two versions:

Sowdan.

- 37 'With kinges xii and
admyralles xiv'
- 77 'The Romaines robbed us
anone'
- 75 'to presente you'
- 76 'a drift of wedir us droffe
to Rome'
- 110 'An hundred thousande'
- 128 'To manace with the
Cristene lore'
- 175 'Oure sheldes be not broke
-76 nothings, Hawberkes,
spere, ner poleyne, ner
pole'

Destruction.

- 420 'Ensemble ou li issirent xv
roi corone Et xiv
amaceours'
- 1154 'Bien i a xxx roi et xiv
admiré'
- 689 'xxx roi sont ou li et xiv
amaceours'
- 163 'Et xiv amaceours'
- 115 'De cels de Romenie que
-16 m'ont fait desrobber. Tiel
avoir m'ont robbé'
- 119 'vous quidai presenter'
- 120 'Uns vens nous fist à Rome
parmi le far sigler'
- 217 'Par C fois M payen'
- 228 'pour François menacier'
- 332 'Et menace François pour
faire les loye'
- 546 'Quant encor nen est lance
-47 quassée ne brusie, Ne
halbers derompus, ne fors
targe percie'

224 'Lukafer, Kinge of
-27 Baldas, The countrey
hade serchid and sought,
Ten thousande maidyns
fayre of face Unto the
Sowdan hath he broghte'

228 ss. 'The Sowdane
commaunded hem anone
That thai shulde al be
slayne . . . He saide "My
peple nowe ne shalle With
hem noughte defouled
be"'

278 'He clepede his engynour
Sir Mavone'
289 'Mahoundis benysone thou
shalt haue'

286 'And fille the dikes faste
anoone'
293 'Men myght go even to the
walle'

307 'The hethen withdrowe
hem tho'
317 'His baner knowe I ful
welle'

613 'Lucafer de Baldas discent
-19 al mestre tre, Devant
l'amirail vint, forment l'a
encline: Voyant tot ses
barnages l'a l'eschec
presente, Moignes,
prestres et lais, que sont
enchenee, Hermites et
enfants, a tous lor poign
lié; As femmes et pucels
les os furent bende, Totes
vives presentent par
devant l'admiré.'

614 'Maintenant soient tot
occis et descoupé. Ne voil
que mi serjant en soient
encombré.'

908 'Sortibrans a mande
Mabon l'engineor'

627 'Mahon te benoie'

925 'Mahon te doint honor'

<xxiv>

934 'Si emplirons les fosses'

918 'K'om poet aler al mure'

952 'K'om pooit bien au mur et
venir et aler'

979 'Payen se sont retrait'

997 'Jeo ai bien ses armes conu
et avisee'

331 'He entred to the maistre
 toure'
 332 'The firste warde thus they
 wonne'
 346 'And Estragot with him he
 -50 mette With bores hede,
 blake and donne. For as a
 bore an hede hadde And a
 grete mace stronge as
 stele. He smote Savaryz
 as he were madde'
 587 'Therefore Gy of
 Bourgoyne! Myn owen
 nevewe so trewe'

 647 'He smote of the traytours
 hede'
 648 'And saide "Gode gife him
 care, Shal he never more
 ete brede, All traitours
 evel mot thai fare"'
 663 'Ferumbras to Seinte Petris
 wente'
 727 'Thre hundred thousande
 of sowdeours'

1011 'Tantost le mestre porte
 aurons moult bien ferme'
 1057 'Mais tot le premier bail
 ont Sarasin pople'
 1090 'Estragot le poursuit, uns
 -94 geans diffaes, Teste avoit
 com senglers, si fu rois
 coronés. El main tient une
 mace de fin ascier trempé,
 Un coup a Savariz desur
 le chef done'
 1179 'Et Guion de Bourgoyne a
 a lui apelle, Fils est de sa
 soror et de sa parente:
 Cosins, vous en irrés . . '
 1236 'Le chief al portier trenche'

 1244 "'Diex" fist il "te maldie et
 que t'ont engendré, Kar
 traitour au darain averont
 mal dehé."'
 1260 'Al moustier de saint Piere
 est Fierenbras ales'
 1403 'iii C mil chevaliers'

743 'Sir Gye aspied his
comynge,
He knewe the baner of
Fraunce,
He wente anoone ayen the
Kinge,
And tolde him of that
myschaunce,
Howe that the cursed
sowdone,
Hath brent Rome and
bore the relequis awaye'
771 'Wynde him blewe ful
fayre and gode'
778 'To londe thai wente iwis'
783 'Tithinggis were tolde to
Lavan'
787 'With three hundred
thousand of bachelers'

1409 'Guis parceut le baniere le
roi de saint Dine,
Encontre lui chevalche, la
novele ont conté Come la
fort cité li payen ont
gasté; La corone et les
clous d'iloec en sont
robbé Et les altres
reliques . . '

1425 'Li vens en fiert es voilles
que les a bien guies'
1427 'il sont en terre entré'
1436 'Les noveles en vindrent al
soldan diffaié'
1443 'iii C mile François'

Other instances of resemblance may be found in the following passages:

S 49–50 = *D* 94–99;⁵¹ *S* 103 = *D* 202, 209; *S* 119 = *D* 385; *S* 146 = *D* 445–46; *S* 150 = *D* 503–4; *S* 157 = *D* 509; *S* 300 = *D* 967; <xxv> *S* 303 = *D* 915; *S* 396 = *D* 977; *S* 312 = *D* 989; *S* 340 = *D* 1063; *S* 360 = *D* 1101; *S* 376 = *D* 1119, 1121; *S* 377 = *D* 1133; *S* 380 = *D* 1136; *S* 699 = *D* 1379; *S* 723 = *D* 1384, &c., &c.

Besides, there are some names which occurring in none of the French versions, but in the *Destruction*, point to this poem as to the original of the *Sowdan*. Thus *Savaris*⁵² (*S* 171) seems to be taken from *D* 540.

Astragot or *Estragot*, *S* 346, 2944, 3022, the name of the giant by whom *Savaris* is slain, and who is said to be the husband of *Barrock*, occurs in *D* 1090.

The *Ascopartes*, a people subjected to the *Soudan*, are mentioned in *D* 98, 426, but not in *F* or *P*.

King *Lowes*, in the context where it occurs (S 24) is clearly taken from *D* 9.

Iffrez, S 165, is perhaps the same as *Geffroi* in *D* 1139, 1367, 1122.

[*Mounpelers*, S 3228, occurs only in *D* 250, 286.]

Persagyn, S 1259, seems to be identical with *Persagon*, *D* 162.

The form *Laban* is only met with in the *Destruction*, the French and the Provençal versions, and the Ashmole *Ferumbras* reading *Balan*.⁵³

The name of the Soudan's son, *Ferumbras*, is explained by the form *Fierenbras*, which occurs in *D* 57, 66, 71, 91, 343, 1210, 1237, besides the spelling *Fierabras*, which is the only one used in the French, the Provençal and Caxton's versions.

Also the phrase 'sowdan' seems to have been derived from the *Destruction* (l. 1436, 'soldan'), as it does not occur in any other version.

The great number of these resemblances seem evidently to point out the *Destruction* as the original of the first portion of the *Sowdan*; the few points in which the two versions differ not being such as to offer convincing arguments against this supposition. <xxvi>

Indeed if, for instance, we find a lot of nations, the names of which are not in *D*, mentioned by the author of the poem as belonging to the Soudan's empire, this point can be considered as irrelevant, as from many other instances we know how fond many composers of mediæval romances were of citing geographical names, by the great number of which they believed to show their knowledge in that science.⁵⁴ Also the three names of Saints (*Qwyntyn*, *Symon*, *Fremond*⁵⁵), and the names of five Saracen gods and of a Saracen bishop,⁵⁶ many of which, moreover, seem to be inserted only for the sake of rhyme, cannot be regarded as being of great consequence in establishing the source of the *Sowdan*. Others also, as *Oliborn*, *Focard*, *Hubert*, *Gyndard*, *Tamper* (the last occurring twice as a rhyme-word), being the names of insignificant characters, may be looked upon as mere expletives. Another variation is *Isrez* (ll. 625, 641) for *Tabour* (*D* 1202).

Besides these variations in the names contained in the two poems, we find in the *Sowdan* some slight modifications as to the matter related; none of which, however, is of so significant a character, as necessarily to point to

some other original than the *Destruction*, which the very striking points of resemblance above cited show almost decisively to have been the original of the *Sowdan*. The differences in the subject-matter may be explained by the tendency of the poet to follow his original only as far as the principal events are concerned, but to have his own way in the arrangement of the subject-matter, and especially to deal freely with secondary incidents.

Thus he may have thought the combat round Château-Miroir—which, moreover, is related in the *Destruction* in a rather obscure and confused style—to be a rather episodic incident, which he had better leave out in his poem, as not advancing the principal course of events.

A similar explanation may be given of the fact, that the account of Lukafer's desiring the hand of Floripas is given on another occasion in the *Sowdan* than in the *Destruction*. In the *Destruction*, l. 241, Lucafer claims that maiden immediately on arriving in the [xxxvii](#) Soudan's camp, as a reward for his having travelled such a long way in Laban's service. The poet of the *Sowdan* thinking, perhaps, that this was not a sufficient reason to justify such a claim, mentions this incident at another time, which he may have considered as more properly chosen for demanding a reward. It is on returning from a victorious expedition undertaken by Lukafer that the latter in the *Sowdan*, ll. 224–242, asks for the hand of Floripas.

As to the following or second part of the *Sowdan*, on the whole the same subject is treated of as in the Ashmole *Ferumbras*. But there are many differences between the two poems.

In the *Sowdan*, l. 1411 *et seq.*, Roland is captured by the Saracens at the same time as Oliver, and both on being conducted before Laban at once avow their names. In the Ashmole MS., ll. 909, &c., Oliver is led away to the Soudan together with Gwylmer, Berard, Geoffrey, and Aubray, whereas Roland is among the French peers whom Charlemagne sends on a mission to Laban to demand the surrender of Oliver.^{[57](#)}

The names of the twelve peers do not agree in both poems. In the *Sowdan* we find the following list (cf. ll. 1653 *et seq.*, and ll. 1730, 880):—Roland, Oliver, Duk Neymes of Bavere, Oger Danoys, Tery Lardeneyes, Folk Baliane, Aleroyse of Loreyne, Miron of Braban, Bishop Turpyn,

Bernard of Spruwse, Bryer of Mountez,⁵⁸ Guy of Bourgoyne.⁵⁹—Richard of Normandy, although a most important personage, is not included amongst the *Douzeperes*. Nor is Guenelyn mentioned as a peer of France. Four of these names, Folk Balian, Turpyn, Bernard of Spruwse, Aleroyse of Loreyne, do not occur at all in the Ashmolean *Ferumbras*.⁶⁰

The new game which Lucafer wants to teach Neymes, is differently described in the two poems, there being no mention made in the Ashmol. MS. (ll. 2231 *et seq.*) of the thread, needle, and coal, as spoken of in ll. 1998–2000 of the *Sowdan*. <xxviii>

In the *Sowdan*, l. 2507, Laban, being engaged with his gods, seizes the image of Mahound and smashes it. This incident is omitted in *Syr Ferumbras* (ll. 3345).

In the Ashmole MS., ll. 5760 *et seq.*, Ferumbras tries to persuade his father to become a Christian, whilst Floripas urges Charles not to delay in putting him to death. In the *Sowdan*, l. 3156 *et seq.*, there is no mention of either of them interfering either for or against their father.

Ashm. MS., ll. 130 *et seq.*, differs greatly from the corresponding passage in the *Sowdan* (ll. 1647 *et seq.*). In the latter poem the knights are pulled up from their dungeon with a rope, whilst in the former they have their fetters taken off by means of a sledge-hammer, anvil, and tongs, &c.

In the *Sowdan*, l. 3044, Richard of Normandy is left back as a governor of Mantrible; in the Ashmole version, l. 4881 *et seq.*, Raoul and Howel are ordered to keep that place, whereas Richard accompanies Charlemagne (cf. l. 5499).

In the Ashm. MS., l. 5209, Neymes sees first Charles coming with his host; in the *Sowdan*, l. 3083, it is Floripas who first discovers the banner of France.

The prayer which Charlemagne, seeing Oliver in distress, addressed to Christ, in the *Sowdan*, l. 1304 *et seq.*, is not mentioned in the Ashm. version.

The account of the duel between Oliver and Ferumbras differs considerably in the two versions. In the Ashmolean MS., l. 580, the incident of Oliver assisting Ferumbras to arm (cf. *Sowdan*, 1158) is omitted, and it is

not Oliver (as in the *Sowdan*, l. 1270) who is disarmed, but Ferumbras, whom his adversary offers to accept his own sword back (Ashm. MS., l. 680).

In the Ashmolean version, l. 102, Ferumbras offers to fight at once with twelve of Charles's knights; in the corresponding passage of the *Sowdan*, l. 1067, he challenges only six.

In the *Sowdan*, l. 1512 *et seq.*, Floripas advises her father not to slay the captive peers, but to detain them as hostages that might be exchanged for Ferumbras. In the Ashm. MS., l. 1178, it is not Floripas, but Lamasour, who gives that advice to the amirant. <xxix>

As in many of the variations, mentioned just before, there are many omissions in the Ashmole MS., which are related in the *Sowdan*, it becomes evident that the Ashmolean version cannot have been the original from which the *Sowdan* was copied, which is also proved by several names occurring in the *Sowdan*, but which are not to be found in *Syr Ferumbras*. Thus, for instance, the names of *Espiard*, *Belmore*, *Fortibrance*, *Tamper*,⁶¹ do not occur at all in the Ashmolean version, whereas other names have quite a different form in the latter poem. For *Generyse*, S 1135, 1239, we find *Garin*, A 216, 443; *Barrock*, S 2939, 2943, 3022 = *Amyote*, A 4663; *Alagolofur*, S 2135, 2881 = *Agolafre*, A 3831, 4327; and *Laban* is always spelt *Balan* in the Ashmolean poem, &c.

Now as there are some passages where the *Sowdan*, while it differs from the Ashm. MS., corresponds with the French *Fierabras*, we might be inclined to think that poem to be the original of the *Sowdan*. Thus Charlemagne's prayer and the name of Bishop Turpin, which are omitted in the Ashm. MS., occur in the French *Fierabras*. But there are several differences between the *Sowdan* and the French poem.

In the *Fierabras*, l. 1933, the French prisoners, on being brought before the Soudan, do not avow their true names as they do in the *Sowdan*, l. 1498.

In the French poem, l. 704, Oliver tells his adversary his name before the fight begins; in the *Sowdan*, l. 1249, he does not confess his true name until they had fought for a considerable time.

In the *Fierabras*, l. 1043, Oliver drinks of the bottles of balm, which is not mentioned in the *Sowdan*, l. 1190.

Again, *Fierabras*, ll. 1329 ss., where Ferumbras having disarmed Oliver, tells him to take his sword back again, does not agree with ll. 1279–82 of the *Sowdan*.

Instead of Floripas (S 1515), *Brulans* advises the Soudan not to slay the prisoners in F 1949.

The French knight slain at the sally of the captives is called *Bryer* in S 2604, but *Basin* in F 3313. <xxx>

Concerning the sacred relics there is no mention made of the *cross* (S 3236) in the French poem, and the *signe*, i. e. ‘the shroud or winding-sheet of the Lord’⁶² (F 6094), is omitted in the *Sowdan*.

Besides these variations of the two versions there is an incident of Marsedag being killed by Guy, and buried by the Saracens (S 2247–2274), which being omitted in the *Fierabras* proves that the author of the *Sowdan* cannot have followed the French poem, or at least not that version which is edited by MM. Kræber and Servois.

Similarly there is no mention made in the French *Fierabras* of *Bryer* being charged to take care of the relics and of Charles’s treasure (S 3204).

The game of blowing burning coals is related in *Sowdan*, l. 1996 ss., with several details which are wanting in the French poem, l. 2907.

The names also do not always agree in both versions. Thus we find *Generyse*, S 1139, for *Garin*, F 438; *Mapyn*, S 2325, for *Maubrun*, F 3046; *Alagolofur*, S 2135, for *Agolafre*, F 4290 or *Golafre*, F 4267, 4383; *Bryer*, S 2604, for *Basin*, F 3313; *Maragounde*, S 1563, for *Marabunde*, F 2196; *Boloyne*, S 3238, for *St. Denis*, F 6199; *Barokke*, S 2939, and *Espiard*, S 2145, are not mentioned at all in the French *Fierabras*, nor does *Belmore*, S 3122, occur in the *Fierabras*, either in the corresponding passage, F 5867, or elsewhere.

On the fact that the names of the twelve peers (see above, p. xxvii) differ in the *Sowdan* from those mentioned in the *Fierabras*, too much stress need not, I think, be laid, as it might be explained by the simple inadvertence of the composer. The poet in freely reproducing his source, which he generally

followed pretty closely as far as relates the course of events, well remembered the names of the principal French knights; but having forgotten those of less important characters, some of whom do not appear again in the poem, and being obliged to fill up their number of twelve, might have placed any names which he remembered having met with somewhere [xxxix](#) as included in the list of the douzeperes. By an oversight he omitted to mention Richard, whom however we see appear afterwards.⁶³

Similarly the names of *Laban* and *Ferumbras* for *Balan* and *Fierabras* afford no convincing proof of the impossibility of the French *Fierabras* being the original of the second part of the *Sowdan*, as the poet, having found those spellings in the *Destruction*, the source of the first portion of his romance, might simply have retained them for the whole poem.

But reviewing all the facts of the case, and taking into account those passages which relate incidents omitted in the *Fierabras*, and which the author of the *Sowdan* therefore cannot have taken from that poem—and further taking into account the several differences between the two versions, which, it may be admitted, generally speaking, are only slight ones—the French *Fierabras*, *i. e.* the version edited by MM. Kræber and Servois, which represents the group *w* (see before, p. xix, footnote), cannot have been the original of the second part of the *Sowdan*.

Proceeding now to a comparison of the *Sowdan* with the Escorial MS.,⁶⁴ we have not found any passage where *S* differing from *F* agrees with *E*, as *E* and *F* generally have in those places the same reading. Therefore the Escorial MS. cannot be regarded as the original of the *Sowdan*.

Unfortunately the fragment printed from the Hanover MS. is too short to allow of an exact comparison with that version. We only know⁶⁵ that some names, the spelling of which in the *Sowdan* differs from that in the other versions, have the same form in the Hanover MS. as in the *Sowdan*. Thus we find the following names agreeing in both versions: *Lucafer*, *Maragonde*, *Maupyn*. Only instead of *Laban* which is used in the *Sowdan*, we read *Balan*. In the fragment printed by Græber,⁶⁶ we find the name of the Soudan's son [xxxii](#) with the same spelling as in the *Destruction*, *Fierenbras*, which is nearer to *Ferumbras* than *Fierabras*.⁶⁷

This resemblance of the names contained in the two versions might lead us to believe the Hanover MS. of *Fierabras* to be the original of the second part of the *Sowdan*, just as the *Destruction*, found in the same MS., is the original of the first part. But as, according to Gaston Paris, the Hanoverian version “is the same as the printed text, differing only in slight variations of readings,”⁶⁸ we may suppose it likely that in all passages where the *Sowdan* differs from the printed *Fierabras*, it also differs from the Hanover MS. Nevertheless, as the differences between the *Sowdan* and the printed *Fierabras* are, on the whole, not very significant; for the several instances of omission in the *Sowdan*, being easily accounted for by the general plan of the poet, cannot be regarded as real variations; and as some names, the spelling of which differs in *S* and *F*, are found to be identical in *S* and *H*, we might, perhaps, be entitled to think the second part of the *Sowdan* to be founded on a MS. similar to the Hanover one.

It still remains for us to compare the *Sowdan* with the Provençal version.

In most cases where *S* differs from *F*, it also differs from *P*, therefore *S* cannot have taken those variations of readings from the Provençal poem.

The account of the knights sent on a mission to Laban, in *S* 1663–1738, considerably differs from the corresponding passage in *P* 2211 ss.

In *P* the scene of the whole poem is placed in Spain, there is no mention of the combat before Rome,⁶⁹ as in the first part of the *Sowdan*.

The game of blowing a coal, *S* 1996 ss., is not mentioned in the Provençal version.

From these variations, taken at random out of a greater number, <xxxiii> it becomes evident that the Provençal poem has not been the original of the *Sowdan*.

If now we compare the *Sowdan* with Caxton’s version, which we know to be simply a translation of the French prose romance of *Fierabras*;⁷⁰ the few following instances of differences between *C* and *S* will show at once, that also that version from which the prose romance was copied or compiled⁷¹ cannot have been the original of the *Sowdan*.

There are several variations in the names contained in the two versions. Thus we find *Ballant* in *C* for *Laban* in *S*; *Fyerabras* in *C* for *Ferumbras*

in *S*; *Garin*, *C* 55/3 = *Generyse*, *S* 1135; *Amyotte*, *C* 176/26 = *Barrokk*, *S* 1135, &c. The game of blowing a coal is told with more details in *S* 1998, and somewhat differently from *C* 118/24; the incident of Laban's seizing the image of Mahound and smashing it, which is related in *S* 2507, is omitted in *C*, &c.

Looking back now to our investigation concerning the original of the *Sowdan*, we sum up what results from it, in the following *resumé*:

Most probably the *Destruction de Rome* is the original of the first part of the *Sowdan*. As to the second part, we are unable to identify it with any of the extant versions. The French *Fierabras*, as edited by MM. Kræber and Servois, is not the original, but the differences between the two poems are not significant; apparently a version similar to the Hanover MS. may be thought to be the original.

The *Sowdan* is no translation, but a free reproduction of its originals; the author of the *Sowdan* following his sources only as far as concerns the course of the principal events, but going his own independent way in arranging the subject-matter as well as in many minor points.

The *Sowdan* differs from the poem of *Syr Ferumbras* in two principal points:

(1) In being an original work, not in the conception, but in the treatment of the subject-matter, whereas the Ashmole *Ferumbras* is little more than a mere translation. <xxxiv>

(2) In representing, in its first portion, the first part of the old *Balan* romance, whereas *Syr Ferumbras* contains only the second. But as that second part of the old *Balan* romance appears to be considerably modified and greatly amplified in the Ashmole *Ferumbras*, so the first part of the *Sowdan* contains a likewise modified, but much shortened, narration of the first part of the old *Balan* poem, so that the *Sowdan* has arrived to become quite a different work from the original *Balan* or *Fierabras* romance, and that a reconstruction of the contents of that old poem would be impossible from the *Sowdan*.

LANGUAGE AND SUMMARY OF GRAMMATICAL FORMS. [◇](#)

As regards the language of the *Sowdan*, the first point is the dialect. Looking at the plurals of the present indicative in *-en* or *-n*, we at once detect the Midland peculiarities of the poem. Thus we find, l. 1331, *gone* rhyming with *one*, l. 1010, *goon* : *camalyon*, l. 506, *gone* : *than*, l. 1762, *lyven* : *gyfen*, l. 1816, *byleven* : *even*.

The verbal forms of the singular present indicative and of the second person sing. preterite of weak verbs lead us to assign this poem to an East-Midland writer. The 2nd and 3rd person singular present indicative end in *-est*, *-eth*; and the 2nd person sing. preterite of weak verbs exhibits the inflection *-est*: l. 1202, *goist* : *moost*; 1314, 1715, *knowest*; 1344, *trowest*; 1154, *blowest*; 1153, *saiest*; 2292, *forgetist*; 560, *doist*; 1193, *doistowe*;—1093, *goth* : *wroth*, 1609 : *loth*, 1620 : *doth*; 1728, *sleith* : *deth*; 561, *sholdest*; 1244, *shuldist*; 603, *madist*; 563, *hadist*; 2219, *askapedist*, &c.—Twice we find the 2nd person preterite without *-est* (*made*, *wrought*); but see the note to l. 2.

If, now, we examine the phonological and inflectional peculiarities of the *Sowdan*, we find them thoroughly agreeing with those of other East-Midland works,⁷² which still further confirms the supposition of the East-Midland origin of the poem. <xxxv>

I or *y*, the descendants of original *u* (which in Old English [Anglo-Saxon] had already become *y* or *i* in consequence of *i*-mutation or *umlaut*)—are found rhyming with original *i*:—ll. 449, 881, *kyn* : *him*, 2060 : *wynne*; 1657, *fille* : *stille*; 1973, *fire* : *desire*, &c. It must, however, be noted that the rhyme *king* : *inne* (l. 372) or *king* : *thing* (ll. 173, 236) cannot be regarded as an East-Midland peculiarity, because *king*, *drihten*, *chikken*, the *i* of which is a modification of original *u*, are to be met with in all Middle-English dialects, as has been shown by Professor Zupitza in the *Anzeiger für deutsches Altertum*, vol. vi. p. 6.

Old English short *a*, which is liable to change into *o*, appears in this poem—

(1) always as *o*, before *n*- combinations (*nd*, *nt*, *ng*):—531, *stronge* : *istonge*; 3166, *bronte* : *fonte*; 214, *amonge* : *longe*, &c.

(2) as *a*, before the single consonants *m* and *n*:—1120, *name* : *shame*, 935 : *same*, 1739 : *grame*; 785, 1773, *man* : *Lavan*; 3125, *came* : *Lavan* (cf. 2579, *Lavan* : *tane*); 2160, *came* : *dame*, &c.—The fact that *com* (ll. 547, 1395, 3095, &c.) is used as well as *cam* as sing. preterite indic. need occasion no difficulty if we remember that the original short *a* (or *o*) of *cam* (or *com*) had already been lengthened into *ô* in the O.E. period.⁷³ *Came* and *come* as pret. sing. are employed indifferently in *Chaucer* as well as in the *Celestin* (ed. Horstmann, *Anglia*, i. 56), which is known to have been composed in the East-Midland dialect.

O long, from O.E. *â*, in our poem has that broad sound which is peculiar to the East-Midland dialect. We find it rhyming with—

(1) original *ô*:—1025, *wrothe* : *sothe*; 801, *goo* : *doo*; 60, *inowe* : *blowe*; 325, *so* : *ido*, &c.

(2) unchangeable *a*:—257, *Aufricanes* : *stoones*; 506, *gon* : *than*; 2049, *agoon* : *Lavan*, &c.

As many East-Midland works⁷⁴ the *Sowdan* has three forms for O.E. *þâr*:—*thare*, *thore*, *there*, all of which are established by the rhyme:—1805, *thore* : *Egremoure* (cf. 2895, *Egremoure* : *tresoure*, 1003, *Agremore* : *more*); 126, *thore* : *lore*; 430, *thare* : *sware*; <xxxvi> 2245, *there* : *chere*, 2404 : *bere*; 2604, *there* : *were* (*wæron*), 208 : *were* (*werian*), &c.

We likewise find *sore* and *sare*⁷⁵ (O.E. *sâre*):—1196, *sore* : *more*; 166, *sare* : *care*; 1377, *sore* : *thore*.

The O.E. diphthongs *ea* and *eo* and the O.E. *ÿ* (mutated from *êa* or *êo*) appear as *e* in this poem:—1595, *me* : *see*, 632 : *fee*, 1339 : *free*, 405 : *be*; 1535, *depe* : *slepe*; 1011, 1523, *dere* : *here*; 963, *yere* : *vere*, 1257 : *Olyvere*; 996, *nerre* : *were*; 596, 1528, *nede* : *spede*; 1702, *eke* : *speke*; 1726, *leke* : *speke*; 184, 215, 1208, *shelde* : *felde*; 2530, *hevene* : *elevene*, &c.

A brief summary of the grammatical inflexions employed in the poem will also give evidence of a great similarity with the forms used by other East-Midland writers, and will serve to show that the language of the *Sowdan* agrees closely with that of *Chaucer*.

In the declension of substantives the only remnant of case-formation by means of inflexions is the ending used to form the Genitive Singular and the Plural.

The genitive singular of nouns ends in *es* (sometimes written *-is* or *ys*) for all genders:—356, *develes*; 1209, *stedes*; 849, *worldis*; 1804, *worldes*; 3035, *dammes*; 1641, *nedes*; 1770, *shippes*; 1072, *faderis*.

Substantives ending in *-s* in the nominative case, remain unchanged in the genitive case:—1214, 1287, *Ferumbras*; 2006, *Naymes*; 3207, *Charles*; 1639, 1350, *Floripas*.—*Florip*, l. 614, is the genitive case of *Floripe* or *Florip*, l. 2027, 1571.

The nominative plural of all genders is formed by *-es* (*-is*, *-ys*) or *-s*:—919, *knightes*, 1947, 2276, *knightis*; 1384, *horses*, 1401, *horsys*; 429, 2054, *gatis*; 192, *wordes*; 837, *swerdes*; 174, *hedes*; 2289, *ladies*; 3271, *soules*; 26, *bokes*; 606, *peres*; 297, *tours*, &c. Examples of a plural case without *s* are seen in *thinge*, l. 2, 1709:—O.E. *þing*; *honde*, 987, O.E. *handa*, as well as *hondes*, 1412, 2568; *frende*, 3212, O.E. *frýnd*, as well as *frendes*, 1011, O.E. *frêondas*. Other plurals which are equally easily explained by their O.E. forms are:—*eyen*, 825, O.E. *êagan*; *shoone*, 1381, O.E. *scêon*; *fete*, 1403, O.E. *fêt*, *fote*, 1427, O.E. *fôtum*, 2673, O.E. *fôta*.

[xxxviii](#)

To mark the difference between the definite and indefinite forms of adjectives is a difficult task; as the final *-e* had in most cases already become silent in the poet's dialect, it seems probable that he no longer observed the distinction.

The pronouns are the same as in *Chaucer* and in other East-Midland poems:—*I*, *me*, *thou*, *the*; *he*, *hym*; *sche*, *her* and *hir*; *it* and *hit* (cf. note to l. 41); *we*, *us*; *ye*, *you*. The plural of the personal pronoun of the 3rd person is *thai* and *he* (cf. note to l. 2698) for the nominative case; *hem*, and in some doubtful passages (see note to l. 88) *thaym* for the accusative case.

As in *Chaucer*, the pronoun of the 2nd person is often joined to the verb:—*hastow* 1680, *maistow* 1826, *shaltow* 1669, *woltow* 1727, *wiltow* 1151, *artow* 1967, *kanstow* 2335, &c.

Possessive pronouns:—*myn* and *thyn* are used before vowels and before *h*; *my*, *thy* before consonants. Only once, l. 90, *my* is placed before a vowel. *His*, *hire* and *here*; *our*, *your*; *here* and (twice, 623, 1244) *thair*.

The demonstrative pronouns are *this*, *these* or *thes*; *that*.

The definite article *the* or *þe*, is used for all cases singular and plural. But we find besides, the following examples of inflexion:—*tho*, 2063, O.E. *þā*, and the accusative sing. *þon*, 108. In l. 2052, *tho* means ‘them, those’ = Lat. eos. *Tha*, l. 2639, seems to be a mistake of the scribe, it is perhaps miswritten for *þat* (day), cf. l. 619.

Men, 115, 1351, and *me*, 287, are used as indefinite pronouns. *Everyche*, *every*, *everychone* occur frequently. Note also *ichoon* 2774, *ilka* 2016; *thilke* 2644, *eche* 1865.

That or *þat*, *who*, *whome* are used as relative pronouns. The interrogative pronouns are *who* and *what*.

Verbs. The plural imperative ends in *-eth* or *-th*, which, however, we find frequently omitted, as in l. 194, *prove you*, 2078 *proveth*; 2131 *sende*, 167 *sendith*; *telle* 1977, *tellyth* 1625, &c.

The *-n* of the infinitive mood is often dropped, as in *Chaucer*:—274, 1588, *sene* : *bene*; 1124, *see* : *tre*; 658 : *cite*; 600, *be* : *cite*; 1225 : *contre*; 1411, *flee* : *cite*; 3065, *fleen* : *men*; 1282, *sloo* : *mo*; 792, *sloone* : *one*, &c.

The final *-(e)n* of past participles of strong verbs is in most cases [<xxxviii>](#) dropped, as in *Chaucer*:—3176 *forlorne* : *borne*, 32 *born*, 3011 *wonne*, 21 *wonnen*, 2756 *comen* : *nomen*, 155 *come*, 2476 *holpe*, 1362 *bygote*, 1026 *blowe*, &c.

Weak verbs form their past participles in *-ed*, *-d*, *-et*, *-t*, much as in *Chaucer*:—*lerned* 3042, *eyde* 1648, *toolde* 670, *bogt* 111, *delte* 526, *displaied* 133.

The prefix *i-* or *y-* occurs sometimes, *icome* 784, *come* 155, *istonge* 533, *itake* 49, *taken* 1430, &c.

The present participles end in *-inge* and *ande*, as is often the case in East-Midland works:—2831 *prikande* : *comande*, 435 *cryande*, 924 *makande*, 3225 *mornynge* : *kynge*, 2399 *slepynge* : *honde*, where evidently *slepande* is the true reading.

As in *Chaucer* the 2nd person preterite of strong verbs is sometimes formed by *-est* or *-ist*, *letist* 2167; but we find also regular forms, as in *slough* 1259, where, however, the O.E. *e* (*slôge*) is already dropped.

The *-en* or *-n* of the preterite plural and of past participles is commonly dropped, *ronnen* 3007, *ronne* 2959, *took* 477, *tokene* 2621, *slough* 78, *sloughen* 401, *ido* 327: so, &c.

The *-d* in the past participles and in the preterite of weak verbs is sometimes omitted, as often happens in East-Midland works. Thus we find *comforte* 2242 and *comforted* 312, *commaunde* 57 and *commaunded* 228, *graunte* 607, *liste* 1132, *list* 1966, *discumfite* 1464, &c. On the same analogy we find *light* 1125, 1189, and *lighted* 3109, *worth* 1203, and *worthed* 1163.

As regards the final *-e*'s, it may be remarked that the scribe has added many final *-e*'s, where the rules would not lead us to suspect them, and has often given a final *-e* to words which in other passages of the poem, although similarly used, have no *e*:—*note* 245, 274, *not* 255, 313; *howe* 19, *how* 275; *undere* 61, *under* 713; *bute* 247, *but* 8; *cooste* 202, *coost* 3062; *crafte* 424, *craft* 2335; *ashamede* 1295, *ashamed* 558, &c.

This is due either to carelessness on the part of the scribe, or perhaps to the fact that in the speech of the copyist the final *e*'s had already become altogether silent, so that finding many words ending in *-e* and not knowing its meaning, he considered it as a mere xxxix “ornament in writing” (Ellis, *Pronunciation*, i. 338), and sometimes added, sometimes omitted it.

With respect to the composer of the *Sowdan* himself, there may be some doubt left whether in his speech the final *e* had become altogether silent, or was still pronounced occasionally. From the following instances it may be concluded with certainty that the poet very frequently did not sound the final *e*:—757 *boghte* : *noght*, 3154 *hat* : *fat*, 961 *wronge* : *distruccion*, 556 *onlace* : *was*; cf. also 1383, 1611, 2163; 2795 *spéke we of Ríchard*, 2999 *fought*, 2093, 859 *bringe*, 9, 2547 *kepte*, 834 *wente*, 142 *come*, 713 *wode*.

In other cases there is no certainty whether the final *e* is quite silent or must be slightly pronounced or slurred over, so as to form trisyllabic measures. It must be noted, however, that in supposing trisyllable measures

in all these doubtful cases, the number of this kind of measure will increase to a great amount in the *Sowdan*. Therefore I rather incline to think the final *e* silent also in the following instances:—2090 *défendē this place*, 1201 *brékē both báke*, 861 *cómē from ál*, 2119 *askē consaile*, 1597 *wólē these traítours*, 1783 *whéns comē yé*, 2317 *pássē that brígge*, 1100 *rónnē bytwéne*, 2997 *fóught so lónge*, 175 *brokē nothings*, 1658 *bédde with ríght*, 713 *gréne wodē síde*, 571 *hómē to Rómē that nýght*, 1610 *the fáls jailoúr fedde yoúr prisonére*, 2152 *fáls traitóurs of Fránce*, 921 *chárged the yónge with ál*, 380 *abouťe midnýghte*, 726 *sóne to hím*, 160 *únneth not óne* [Chaucer still pronounces *unnethē*].

Nevertheless there seems to be some instances where the final *e* is to be sounded, as in ll. 298, 2790, 1332, 1619, 2740, 592, 2166, 2463, 1405, 2386, 895, 332, 91.

Final *en* also seems sometimes not to constitute a separate syllable:—1365 *waít_{en} uppon mé*, 459 *brék_{en} our wállis*, 45 *slép_{en} with ópyne ýze*, 485 *cóm_{en} by the cóst*, 2313 *díd_{en} it about*, &c.

In all these cases *n* had very probably already fallen off in the speech of the poet, as the following examples lead us to suppose:—178 *wynne : him*, 1582 *dye : biwry*, 2309 *shewe : trewe*, 2107 *slépe to lónge*, 861 *cóme from ál*, &c.

As regards the final *es* of nouns, the poet seems to have observed the same rules as those followed by Chaucer; viz. *es* is sounded when *<xl>* joined to monosyllabic stems; it does not increase the number of syllables (and therefore is often spelt-*s* instead of-*es*), when the stem has two or more syllables:—197, 277 *goddēs*, 665 *nailēs*, 445 *tentēs*, 2068 *tentīs*, 174, 1799 *hedēs*, 2032, 2868 *swerdēs*, 2327 *wallēs*, 1209 *stedēs*, 1770 *shippēs*, 2702 *somers*, 2687, 2591 *felowes*, 2660 *felows*, 2412 *maydyns*, 647, 1597 *traytours*, 2036 *orders*, 45 *lovers*, 2612, 3098 *develes*, 1072 *faderis*, 203, 862 *sowdons*, 881 *sarsyns*.

The final *es* of adverbs seems no longer to constitute a separate syllable:—2213 *hónged' els bý*, 2786 *éls had' hé*, 2109 *éllis I may sínge*, 1525 *élles wol' hé*, 2061 *théns*, 1783 *whens*.

METRE AND VERSIFICATION. [◇](#)

THE poem is composed in four-line stanzas. The arrangement of the rhyme is such that the 1st and 3rd lines rhyme together, and the 2nd and 4th together, which gives the following rhyme-formula: *a b a b*. The rhyme-endings employed in one stanza do not occur again in the next following.

But it must be noticed that there seem to occur some instances of eight-line stanzas, one of which, beginning at l. 1587, is built on the model employed by *Chaucer*. Others are arranged differently. Those beginning at ll. 1059 and 1219 show the rhyme-formula *a b a b a c a c*, in that of l. 1411 the 2nd and 4th lines are rhymed together, and the 5th and 7th, whilst the 1st, 3rd, 6th, 8th, all end with the same rhyme. The formula for the stanzas beginning at ll. 807, 879, 1611 is *a b a b c b c b*. In the stanza of l. 939 all the pair lines are rhymed together, and the odd ones also, which is the only instance in the poem of eight consecutive lines having only two rhyme-endings, as generally eight lines show four different rhyme-endings, and three only in the passages cited above. But the whole stanza of l. 939 seems not to be due to the author; he has very probably borrowed it from some other poem.^{[76](#)}

Turning now our attention to the fact that the lines occurring between the Initials or Capital Letters, which are met with in some passages in the MS., are often divisible by eight, we might feel [xli](#) inclined to regard this as an additional reason for considering the stanza employed in the *Sowdan* as an eight-line one. Indeed, the portion from the Initial of l. 1679 to the next one of l. 1689 might be taken for one single stanza. The 24 lines from l. 575 (beginning with an Initial) to the next Initial in l. 598 might equally be considered as three stanzas, whilst there are 5 times 8 lines = 5 eight-line stanzas from the Initial of l. 2755 to the next Initial in l. 2795.

In all these instances the supposition of eight-line stanzas would suit the context, as is the case also with other passages. Thus in the following cases it might seem as though eight lines taken together were more closely connected and made better sense than four lines, *e. g.* ll. 583–598, 1703–1710, 1679–1686, 939–962, 1043–1050, 244 ss., 455 ss., 631 ss., 1059 ss.

But, on the other hand, it must be borne in mind that there are also a great many cases where, as regards the sense, four lines can be considered as an independent whole, when, *e. g.*, the speech spoken by a person is contained in four lines, and the words of another person replying to the first follow in the next four lines. Very often also these next four lines contain only a part of the second person's reply, so that the remainder of his reply falls into the following stanza. This 'enjambement' or continuation of the sense, and sometimes of the syntactical construction from one stanza to another, need not, of course, prevent us from admitting the supposition of eight-line stanzas; as, upon the whole, it is met with in all poems composed in stanzas, and as it is frequently used in *Le Morte Arthur* (Harleian MS. 2252, ed. Furnivall), which is written in eight-line stanzas; but as there is no instance known of an eight-line stanza containing four different rhyme-endings, which at this supposition it would be the case with the *Sowdan*, the eight-line stanzas containing either three rhyme-endings, as in *Chaucer*, or two, as in *Le Morte Arthur*, and as in some passages of the *Sowdan* (ll. 1691, 1695, 1699, 1711, 1715), we find Initials placed after four lines, I believe a stanza of four alternately rhyming lines to be the one intended by the composer—a metre which, according to Guest, *History of Eng. Rhythms*, ii. 317—'must have been well known and familiar during the fifteenth century.' The few eight-line stanzas quoted above, may [xlii](#) then be owing either to the inadvertence of the poet, who somewhat carelessly employed one of the two rhyme-endings of one stanza a third and fourth time in the following one, or, perhaps also, he intentionally retained that rhyme-ending, and he inserted eight-line stanzas amongst those of four verses as a mere matter of variation. It is perhaps not impossible that the retention of this rhyme-ending was not greatly felt.

As regards the rhymes themselves, they are both monosyllabic or masculine rhymes, and dissyllabic or feminine ones. Frequently they are used alternating with each other, as in the stanzas beginning with l. 2755.

Sometimes we find four feminine rhymes occurring in an unbroken succession, as in ll. 1263–66. But it must be noticed that the number of masculine rhymes is predominant. Thus the stanzas beginning with ll. 3047,

3063, 3123, 1123, 791, 1035, 1271, 1275, 2019, 1311, 1351, 1463, &c., contain only masculine rhyme-endings.

The rhymes are not always full and true; there occur many imperfect ones.

(1) A word in the singular number is often rhymed with a word in the plural number, which therefore has an additional *s* (or *es*):—797, *thinge* : *tidyngys*; 2647, *fyght* : *knyghtes*; 2087, *light* : *knightes*; 1455, *cosynes* : *kinge*; 2272, *laye* : *dayes*; 2395, 885, *Ogere* : *peres*; 2456, *alle* : *walles*; 2682, *nede* : *stedes*; 944, *mone* : *stoones*; cf. also 2376, *wile* : *beguiled*. In l. 68, *poundis* : *dromonde*; the rhyme becomes perfect in reading *pounde*, as in l. 2336, instead of *poundis*.

(2) Single *n* is found rhyming with *n*- combinations.

α. *n* : *nd*—cf. 814, *ychoon* : *Mahounde*; 912, *pavilone* : *Mahounde*; 1201, *crowne* : *Mahounde*. The rhyme, 162, *Rome* : *houne*, may be explained in the same manner, for *houne* stands for *hounde*, as it is spelt in ll. 237, 2377, 935, 1756.⁷⁷

β. *n* : *ng*—cf. 2349, *Mapyne* : *endinge*; 86, *Apolyne* : *tithinge*; 370, *inne* : *kinge*; 1455, *cosynes* : *kinge*; 3249, *Genelyne* : *kinge*; 3171, *serpentyne* : *endinge*; 959, *distruccion* : *wronge*. <xliii>

In 614, *love* : *vowe*, the second rhyme *vowe* does not contain the consonant *v*.

(3) Rhymes imperfect as concerns the consonants.

m : *n*—cf. 76, *Rome* : *one*; 1672, 364 : *done*; 2443, 366, *come* : *done*; 747, *some* : *soudone*; 1323, *came* : *than*; 1488, *came* : *ranne*; 2128, *tyme* : *pyne*; 177, *him* : *wynne*; 2375, *him* : *tene*; 447, 859, *him* : *kyn*; 2004, *hyme* : *skyne*; 2353, *him* : *inne*.

f : *v*—cf. 341, *twelve* : *selve*; 415, *wife* : *alive*; 1762, *gyfene* : *lyvene*; 1912, *gife* : *lyve*. But in all these cases the rhymes are really perfect, they seem only imperfect in consequence of the copyist writing indiscriminately *f* and *v*. Thus the rhyme of l. 341 reappears in l. 1867, *self* : *twelf*. In l. 2336 we find *ge fe*, which is written *ge ve* in l. 198; *lefe*, l. 764; *safe*, l. 864, are spelt with *v* in ll. 1340, 1529, 2808.

l : *n*—cf. l. 363, *consaile* : *slayne*. Quite similar is l. 1251, *felde* : *sende*.

p : k—l. 820, *stoupe : stroke*. A similar rhyme occurs in *Guy*, l. 10903, *scapid : nakid*.

d : t—l. 2868, *gyrde : sterte*; 1151, *plete : dede*.

d : p—l. 283, *tyde : depe*. But this rhyme is very probably owing to the scribe. For *depe* we ought to read *wide*.

A single consonant rhymes with a double consonant. The only certain instance occurs in l. 311, *tyde : chidde*. For in ll. 312, 317, *dele : welle*, we might read *wele*, as this word is frequently spelt in the poem; cf. ll. 385, 2618, 1173, 1651, &c. For *dedde* in l. 2980 (*rede : dedde*) we may substitute *dede*, which occurs in l. 2510. The rhyme *glad : hadde*, 2687, becomes perfect if we read *gladde*, which is the usual spelling of the word in the poem; cf. ll. 439, 570, 918, &c. Besides, I believe *hadde* to be monosyllabic. *Ferre : nere* l. 1575; in l. 117 we find *fere*.

The rhyme, l. 2654, *sloughe : drowe* can easily be restored in reading *slowe*, which occurs frequently, as in ll. 2401, 2683, 304, 2208, &c. The rhyme *ane : shafe*, 555, seems to be due to some clerical error.

(4) Rhymes imperfect as concerns the vowels.

a : e—2803, *gate : lete*; perhaps we are justified in reading *late*, [xliiv](#) cf. *Havelock*, 328; l. 2752, *made : dede*. The rhymes *thare : were*, 1383; *bare : there*, 671; *Agremare : there*, 33, are really perfect ones, as we know the poet to have used *thare*, *there*, and *thore* indiscriminately; cf. ll. 208, 2604, 430, 1805, 1003; l. 1436, *ladde : nede*; 2365, *ladde : bedde*, the author probably pronounced *ledde*. For *lefte*, l. 2335 : *craft*, we may read *lafte*, as is shown by l. 424, *lafte : crafte*. In ll. 1781, 544, *tene : than*, the rhyme will be improved by reading *then*.

a : o (cf. p. xxxv)—504, *thane : gone*; 1143, 1079, *Rolande : honde*; 133, *sowdone : Lavan* (where we might read *sowdan*, as in l. 1491); 627, *sowdane : towne*; 2527, 1684, *Roulande : londe*.

i(y) : e. This rhyme also occurs in *Chaucer*; cf. Ellis, *Pron.* i. 272; see also *Guy*, p. xiv.—l. 21419, *him : hem*; 1299, *dynte : lente*; 523, *strike : breke*; 1643, *mylde : shelde*; 1263, *togedere : thidere*; 1277, *wepenless : iwis*; 344, *shitte : mette*; 2538, *hende : wynde* (read *wende*), &c.; l. 82,

vilane : remedye (read *vilanye*, as in ll. 179, 2577); but 1015, *vilane : me*, cf. *Guy*, xi, v—813, *sle : curtesye*; 895, *we : lye*; cf. Ellis, *Pron.*, i. 271.

The monophthong *y* is rhymed with a diphthong, the second part of which is *y*:—l. 441, *Sarsynes : Romaynes*; 2761, *Apolyne : agayne*; 2105 : *slayne*; 2175 : *eyne*; 2280, *dye : waye* (cf. 1582); 589, *fyne : Bourgoyne*.

o : ou (ow).—l. 1023, *wrothe : southe* (which is written *sothe* in ll. 2014, 2024, 2246, 2719); 779, *fonde : grounde*; 260, *clarione : soune*; 879, *lione : crowne*; 2780, *malison : towne*, &c. Cf. also 1264, *endured : covered*.

o : e.—463, *oost : best*. The rhyme is restored in reading *rest* instead of *oost*.

o : i.—l. 966, *sonne : begynne*.

ue : ewe.—l. 2312, *vertue : fewe*. But this rhyme cannot be objected to, as “final French *u* (as in *due*) was diphthongized into *eu* in Chaucerian English.”⁷⁸

Other irregularities are:—l. 112, *douzte : rowte*; 1987, *use : house*; 1131, *thou : lough*; 1200, *moost : goist*; 1730, *dethe : sleith*; [xlv](#) 2136, *pas : grace*; 1611, *was : mace* (in which cases *e* is silent); 931, 1144, *peris : fiers*.

A line or verse generally contains four accented syllables, separated from each other by one or by two unaccented syllables, so that there are some instances of trisyllabic feet, as in ll. 817, 834, 2035, 2301, 2791, 3020, 3073, 2313, &c. In ll. 692, 695, two accented syllables are put close together without being separated by an unaccented one, which is altogether wanting. In some passages we find lines of three accented syllables alternating with those of four accents, as in ll. 575–582, 763–770, 839–846, 871–878, 2287–2290, &c. But in most cases lines with four accents follow each other in an unbroken succession, as in ll. 1–372, 995–1010, 1026–1029, 1067–1107, 1147–1154, 1731–1734, &c.

A few instances of verses with more than four accented syllables are also to be met with in the *Sowdan*. They are either due to the author and therefore intended, as in l. 37, where the poet almost literally imitates his

original,⁷⁹ or they may be considered as due to some clerical error, in which case the metre generally can be restored by a slight emendation.

A verse has generally an iambic effect, that is to say, the first foot begins with an unaccented syllable, which is followed by an accented one. Frequently, however, the first accented syllable is preceded by two unaccented ones, as in ll. 41, 75, 127, 151, 367, 849, 1060, 1815, 1819, 2289, 2758, &c. There are some instances of the first foot consisting of a single (accented) syllable only, the unaccented one being altogether wanting, as in ll. 2120, 2288, 2374, 2394, &c.

DATE OF THE POEM AND NAME OF THE AUTHOR. [◇](#)

GEORGE Ellis attributes the present poem to the end of the fourteenth or beginning of the fifteenth century. “I think,” he says in his *Specimens of Early English Metrical Romances*, ed. Halliwell, p. 380, “it would not be difficult to prove from internal evidence, that the present translation⁸⁰ cannot be earlier than the end of the fourteenth or beginning of the fifteenth century.” [xlvii](#)

Having seen from the summary of grammatical peculiarities that there is a great similarity between the language of Chaucer and that of the composer of this romance, we might be inclined to consider the latter as a contemporary of Chaucer. From some passages of the *Sowdan*, which seem to contain allusions to Chaucerian poetry, we may conclude that the poet must have known the *Canterbury Tales*. Thus ll. 42–46:—

“Whan kynde corage begynneth to pryke,
Whan ffrith and felde wexen gaye,
And every wight desirith his like,
Whan lovers slepen with opyn y3e,
As Nightingales on grene tre” . . .

appear to be imitated from the *Prologue of the Canterbury Tales*, ll. 10–12:—

“And smale fowles maken melodie,
That slepen al the night with open eye,
So priketh hem nature in her corages.”

Further on we remark in ll. 939–40:—

“O thow, rede Marȝ Armypotente,
That in the trende baye hase made þy trone.”

some traces of resemblance with the *Knight's Tale*, ll. 1123–26:—

“And downward on a hill under a bent,
There stood the tempul of Marȝ armypotent,
Wrought al of burned steel, of which thentre
Was long and streyt, and gastly for to see,”

which may still be compared with the first lines of the *Prologue of Queen Anelida and False Arcite*:—

“Thou ferse God of armes, Mars the rede,
That in thy frosty contre called Trace,
Within thy grisly temples ful of drede,
Honoured art as patroun of that place.”⁸¹

Now the *Prologue of the Canterbury Tales* and the *Knight's Tale*, being written in couplets, or lines arranged in pairs, were certainly composed after 1385,⁸² or rather after 1389.⁸³ From the treatment of <xlvi> the final e's, which, contrary to Chaucer's usage, seem to have been silent in a great number of cases in the poet's speech, we may further conclude that the *Sowdan* must be somewhat later than the *Canterbury Tales*. Therefore the poet of the *Sowdan* cannot have been merely a later contemporary of Chaucer; I rather think it to be more probable that he must have lived some time after him. This would bring us to the beginning of the fifteenth century as the date of the romance.

As to the name and profession of the poet nothing is known, and we have no clue whatever from the poem.

MS. OF THE SOWDAN.

The present edition of the *Sowdan* is printed from the unique MS. of the late Sir Thomas Phillips, at Middle Hill, Worcestershire, which is now in the possession of the Rev. John E. A. Fenwick, Thurlestone House, Cheltenham. Sir Thomas Phillips purchased the MS. at Mr. Heber's sale.⁸⁴ The oldest possessor's name which we find noted, is on the reverse of the last leaf of the Manuscript, where is written, “This is John Eteyes (or Ebeye's) boke, witnes by John Staff”—in a hand *circa temp.* Eliz. or Jac. I. By some notes made by former possessors on the first fly-leaf of the MS.,

and by the autograph names which we find there, we learn that Geo. Steevens bought the MS. “at Dr. Farmer’s Sale, Friday June 15, 1798, for 1: 10. 0.” On May 20th, 1800, it was “bought at the Sale of Geo. Stevens, for 3. 4. 6.” by “O. Grah^m Gilchrist.”

A transcript of the MS. made by Geo. Stevens had been presented by him to Mr. Douce. This copy was re-transcribed by Geo. Ellis, who, in 1811, published some extracts with an analysis of the romance in the *Specimens of Early English Metrical Romances*.⁸⁵ The same copy has been followed by Halliwell, who in his *Dictionary of Arch. and Prov. W.*, has several quotations⁸⁶ from the present romance, which he styles as “MS. Douce, 175.” [<xlviij>](#)

The poem of the *Sowdan* was first printed by the Roxburghe Club in 1854.⁸⁷ The text of the present edition differs from that of the *editio princeps* in so far as punctuation is introduced, which is altogether disregarded by the MS. and the Roxburghe Club edition. In some passages words which have been written as one in the MS. are separated in the text; thus *a laye*, l. 2694; *a ras*, l. 645, are printed instead of *alaye*, *aras*. Sometimes also words written separately in the MS. are united by a hyphen, as *be-falle*, 14; *i-wiss*, 71; *i-sought*, 725; *with-oute*, 841; *a-bide*, 818; *a-ferde*, 1337, &c. These slight deviations from the MS., which are always indicated in the footnotes, seemed advisable on account of the great help they afford the reader in understanding the text. More important emendations and corrections of evident scribal blunders and other mistakes are given in the foot-notes, and will be found explained in the Notes.

The Index of Names will be useful to those who wish to compare the *Sowdan* with any other version of the romance.

The Glossarial Index contains besides the obsolete terms all those words the spelling or the signification of which essentially differs from that now accepted. Words which show only slight orthographical variations from their modern form have not been included, as the reader will have no difficulty in identifying them.

In conclusion I have the pleasant duty of acknowledging the invaluable assistance which Professor Zupitza at all times readily and freely gave me. My best thanks are also due to Mr. Furnivall and to Mr. Napier for their kind advice and suggestions, and to Mr. Herrtage for collating a transcript of the poem with the MS.

EMIL HAUSKNECHT.

Berlin, January, 1881.

FOOTNOTES. [↗](#)

1 *Histoire Poét.*, p. 133–4.

2 Gautier, *Epopées*, ii. 308.

3 Cf. the French *Fierabras*, l. 84; *Sir Ferumbras*, l. 102; *Sowdone*, l. 1067.

4 Thus in *Scarron*, *Gigant*, iii.

5 *Pantagruel*, ii. chap. 1.

6 See the most interesting account of this piece and its curious manner of representation in *Histoire Littéraire de la France*, xvii. 720–21.

7 Gautier, *Epopées*, ii. p. 308; and *Histoire Poétique*, p. 99.

8 See *Huon de Bourdeaux*, edd. Guessard and Grandmaison, p. xxxviii.

9 See G. Nottebohm, *Thematisches Verzeichniss der im Druck erschienenen Werke von Franz Schubert*. Wien, 1874.—Op. 76.

10 Cf. besides, *Histoire Poétique*, pp. 97, 143, 155, 214, 251; *Epopées françaises*, ii. pp. 307–9; and the *Préface* of the French edition of *Fierabras*.

11 See also Mone, *Uebersicht der niederländischen Volksliteratur älterer Zeit*. Tübingen, 1836. p. 56.

12 Cf. Warton, *Hist. of Eng. Poetry*, 1824, vol. i. pp. 147–8.

13 It is worthy of notice that the account of the *Fierabras* romance as given by Barbour, may be considered, on the whole, as identical with the subject of the French *Fierabras* or the English *Syr Ferumbras*, but not with the *Sowdan*, as there is no mention made of the combat before Rome, nor any trace of what makes up the first part of the *Sowdan*. But the spelling *Lawyn* for *Balan* agrees with the spelling of the same name in the *Sowdan*. As to the relics mentioned in the passage above, they differ from all other versions.

14 In the *Sowdan* the Bridgeward is called *Alagolofre*; cf. Index of Names.

15 This MS. consisting of 71 parchment leaves in 4to, with coloured initials at the beginning of each rhyme-strophe, had formerly been in the possession “Majoris Monasterii congregationis Sancti Mauri,” at Paris. Having passed through many hands during the French Revolution, it finally came to the Library of Wallerstein.

16 *Der Roman von Ferabras, provenzalisch*. Berlin, 1829.

17 British Museum, MS. Reg. 15. E. vi.

18 Cf. also the *Préface* of the French *Fierabras*, p. iv.

19 See *Leben und Werke der Troubadours*, by Friedrich Diez, Zwickau, 1829, p. 613 note, and *Berliner Jahrbücher für wissenschaftliche Kritik*, 1831.

20 In a footnote to his *Histoire de la Poésie scandinave*, p. 183, where he says:—“Le roman de Ferabras, publié à Berlin par M. Bekker, est . . . évidemment traduit du français, et en a conservé trop de formes et d’expressions pour avoir la moindre valeur grammaticale.”

21 *Fierabras chanson de geste*, edd. Kræber and Servois, in the collection of the *Anciens Poètes de la France*.

22 For a more detailed analysis, see *Histoire Poét.*, p. 251, and cf. the account given of the old *Fierabras* or *Balan* romance by Philippe Mousket, ed. Reiffenberg, Bruxelles, vol. I. v. ll. 4664–4716, which runs as follows:—

4664 Puis fu Roume par force prise
et la gent destruite et ocise
et li apostoile ocis
Castiaus-Mireors ars et pris
4668 et toute la cité bruie.
li dus Garins et sa mesnie
entrèrent en Castiel-Croisant,
quar Sarrasin, Turc et Persant
4672 amenerent trop grant compagne
et devers Surie et d’Espagne;
si furent crestien dolant,
et manderent tot maintenant
4676 secours al bon roi Charlemainne
ki sa fieste en France demainne,
et li rois en cele besogne
lor tramist Guion de Bourgogne,
4680 ki nouviaux chevaliers estoit
et des jovenes enfans avoit
devant çou la couronne prise.
et soucoururent sans faintise
4684 lor bon roi en la tiere estrange
u il n’orent ni lin ni lange.
en France estoient revenu
et soujourné et bien péu,
4688 mais à cel secours le tramist
li rois, ki moult s’entremist,—
et si tramist de Normendie
Ricart à la ciere hardie,
4692 si reprirent li Mireour:
et dus Garins vint à l’estour,
ki tint Pavie en quité
s’ot bien Castil-Croisant gardé,
4696 et Karles ot sa gent mandée,
si vinrent de mainte contrée,

quar il lor faisoit tant de biens,
 qu 'à ses amis ne faloit riens.
 4700 si trest vers Rome li bons rois
 et fist as paiens moult d'anois.
 dont se combati Oliviers
 a Fierabras ki tant fu fiers;
 4704 d'armes l'outra, si reconquist
 les .ii. barius qu'à Rome prist,
 si les gieta enmi le Toivre
 por çou que plus n'en péust boivre;
 4708 quar c'est baumes ki fu remés
 dont Ihesu Cris fu embausmés.
 puis furent mort tot li paien
 et mis en Roume crestien,
 4712 si ot autre apostoile fait
 et Karles s'en revint à hait,
 si gratia Dieu et St. Piere,
 que recouvrée ot sa kaiere,
 4716 soujourner vint dont à Parise . . .

23 *Romania*, ii. 1873, pp. 1–48.

24 Cf. *Jahrbuch für romanische und englische Sprache und Literatur*, edd. Lemcke, vol. xiii. p. 111.

25 Printed in *Verhandlungen der 28sten Versammlung deutscher Philologen und Schulmänner in Leipzig*. Leipzig, 1873, p. 209 *et seq.*

26 Corresponding to ll. 1410 *et seq.* of the Ashmole *Ferumbras*.

27 Cf. *Sir Ferumbras*, ll. 8192–3.

28 Cf. also l. 2784 and *Sir Ferumbras*, ll. 1860 and 2059.

29 See above, p. xi, footnote, and *Histoire Poétique*, p. 251.

30 Cf. Græber, *Verhandlungen*, pp. 217–18.

31 The following differences between the *Destruction* and the narration of Philippe Mousket are worthy of note:—

(i) the combat around Château-Miroir is described in a different manner in the two poems.

(ii) the scene of action, which at the end of the *Destruction* is transferred to Spain, remains, according to Philippe Mousket, in the neighbourhood of Rome for the whole time.

(iii) Guy of Burgundy and Richard of Normandy play a most important active part before Rome, according to Ph. Mousket, whereas in the *Destruction* this is not the case.

Now, as to the last two items, they must have been in the original such as they are related by Ph. Mousket. For only thus some obscure passages of *Fierabras*, of which even the *Destruction* affords no explanation, are cleared up. Thus, *Fierabras*, l. 1049,

“Près fu du far de Rome, ses a dedens jetés”—

which is in contradiction to the *Destruction*, is explained by ll. 4705–6 of Mousket's account (see above). Only Mousket relates that Floripas has seen Guy before Rome (*Fierabras*, l. 2240; Ashmole *Ferumbras*, l. 1413), and that Richard took part at the combat there. Therefore the

account as given by Ph. Mousket, agreeing with what must have been the contents of the old original, is based on a version older than the *Destruction*, which exhibits significant differences.

These differences between Mousket and the *Destruction*, as well as the fact that several references to preceding events contained in *Fierabras* remain unexplained by the *Destruction*, were some of the reasons which led me in my *Dissertation*, pp. 41–49, to consider the *Destruction* as a poem written by another author than that of the *Fierabras*. In order to clear up the allusions to preceding events contained in the *Fierabras*, the very beginning of which necessarily requires some explanatory account—a circumstance which also gave rise to the ‘episode’ of the Provençal version—the *Destruction* was composed as a kind of Introduction to the *Fierabras*, whereby it happened that some allusions remained unexplained.

32 For a description of this magnificent MS., see *Sir Ferumbras*, p. vi, footnote.

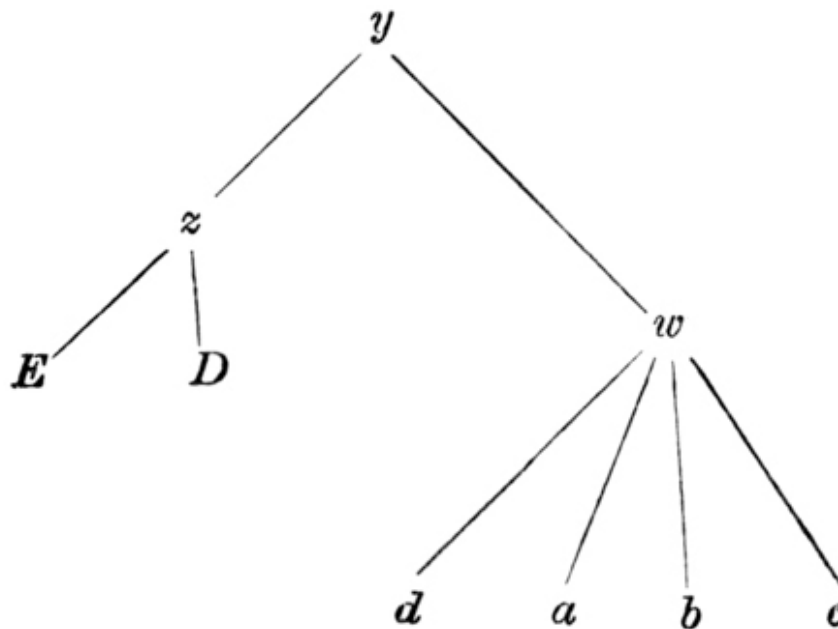
33 Cf. Warton, *Hist. of Eng. Poetry*, ii. 197–8.

34 Edited for the E. E. T. S. in 1879, by S. J. Herrtage, B.A.

35 Cf. Gautier, *Epopées Françaises*, i. 221.—“Rien n’est plus fréquent, dans la Chanson de Roland et dans nos poèmes les plus anciens, que la répétition double, triple et même quelquefois quadruple, de certains couplets. Cette répétition n’a pas lieu dans les mêmes termes, ni surtout avec les mêmes rimes. Tout au contraire, la même idée est reproduite en vers différents, munis d’assonances ou de rimes différentes.”

36 The variations of this MS. are printed in the *Jahrbuch der roman. and engl. Sprachen*, vol. ix. pp. 43 ss.

37 This edition, although printed from the MS. *a*, may be said to represent a group (*w*) of four MSS., called *a b c d* (see above xv). Another group (*z*) is formed by the MSS. *E* and *D*. Both groups belong to the same type *y*. Cf. Græber, *Die handschriftlichen Gestaltungen der chanson de geste Fierabras*, Leipzig, 1869, p. 27, where we find the following stemma:



38 *Epopées Françaises*, ii. 307, and *Cat. rais. des livr. de la bibl. d’Ambr. F. Didot*, I, 361.

39 Grøeber, *Handschriftl. Gestaltungen*, p. 6.

40 *Jahrbuch*, xiii. p. 111, and *Zeitschrift für romanische Philologie*, iv. p. 164.

41 “Die Vergleichung weniger aus allen Hss. bekannten Versen macht gewiss, dass *H* mit *D* und *E* aus der nämlichen Quelle z geflossen ist.” *Jahrbuch*, xiii. 113.

42 *Handschriftl. Gestalt.*, p. 10.

43 See the note to l. 5763 of *Sir Ferumbras*, and cf. *Fierabras*, 5955.

44 The number of instances where *A* varies from *C*’s version might easily be increased. Thus we find *A* 340 differing from *C* 52/111 and from *F* 357; *A* 814 differing from *C* 79/3 and from *F* 1548; *A* 1616 differing from *C* 102/10 and from *F* 2424; *A* 1238 differing from *C* 92/5 and from *F* 2083; *A* 4652 differing from *C* 171/26 and from *F* 4900, &c.

45 *Specimens of Early English Metrical Romances*, ed. Halliwell, p. 379 *et seq.*

46 *Histoire Poétique*, p. 251; cf. also *Revue critique d’Histoire et de Littérature*, ii. 1869, p. 121 *et seq.*

47 Cf. Mr. Shelley’s Paper in Warton, *Hist. of Eng. Poetry*, ii. 197–8.

48 pp. 17 *et seq.*

49 *Dissertation*, p. 18.

50 *Introduction to Sir Ferumbras*, p. xiv.

51 The French text will be found in the *Notes*, which see.

52 For these names, the *Index of Names* may be referred to.

53 In some passages the *Destruction* shows also the spelling *Balan*, but *Laban* is more common.

54 See note to l. 1000.

55 See note to l. 2842.

56 *Dissertation*, p. 20.

57 See note to l. 1663.

58 Cf. note to l. 1723.

59 Mr. Herrtage, in his note to the Ashmol. MS., l. 259, reproduces—from the Roxburghe Club edition, *Introd.* p. vi.—the list of the twelve peers in the French version of the Grenville copy, 10531, which he erroneously takes for that of the *Sowdan*.

60 But there is one “Alorys þe erld of Brye,” mentioned in the Ashm. MS., ll. 935, 2842, 4076, &c.

61 There is one *Templer* mentioned in the Ashm. MS., l. 2673. But he is not identical with *Tamper* of the *Sowdan*, ll. 2641, 2667.

62 Greek σινδων. Cf. *Dissertation*, pp. 45–46.

63 See note to l. 2535.

64 There being only a small fragment printed of the Didot MS. (*Epopées Fr.* ii. 307), a comparison of the *Sowdan* with this version is impossible at present. But as the Didot MS. belongs to the same group as *E*, what results from a comparison of *S* with *E* may be assumed for the Didot MS.

65 See *Zeitschrift für romanische Philologie*, iv. pp. 164, 170.

66 *Jahrbuch für romanische und englische Sprache und Literatur*, xiii. p. 111.

67 This example is not very striking, as the spelling *Ferumbras* may simply have been retained from the first part of the poem; see above, p. xxxi.

68 *Syr Ferumbras, Introduction*, p. xiv, footnote.

69 See *Handschriftliche Gestaltungen*, p. 14, and *Dissert.*, p. 29.

70 *Histoire Poétique*, p. 157.

71 And to which only a few very insignificant additions were made by the author; see *Hist. Poét.*, p. 99, bottom.

72 See Morris's Preface to *Genesis and Exodus*, Skeat's Introduction to *Havelock the Dane*, and Mall's edition of *Harrowing of Hell* (Breslau, 1871).

73 See Sweet, *Anglia*, iii. 152.

74 Cf. Mall, *Harrowing of Hell*, p. 18.

75 Cf. Schipper, *Alexiuslegenden*, 98/121.

76 See note to l. 939.

77 "This elision of a final *d* in such words as *hond*, *lond*, *sheld*, *held*, &c., is by no means uncommon in ancient poetry, and arises simply from pronunciation."—Morris, *Specimens of Early English*, 320/261.

78 Cf. Mr. Nicol's *Paper in the Academy* of June 23, 1877, vol. xi. p. 564, col. 1, and *Seventh Annual Address of the President to the Philol. Soc.*, p. 2.

79 See the note.

80 Although l. 25 says that the story of the *Sowdan* "is written in Romance," this cannot induce us to consider our poem as a mere translation. It is, on the contrary, a free reproduction of a French original.

81 Cf. also Lindsay's *History of Squyer Meldrum*, l. 390:
"Like Mars the God Armypotent."

82 Cf. *Prioress's Tale*, ed. Skeat (Clarendon Press Series), p. xx; and Furnivall's *Trial Forewords*, p. 111.

83 Cf. *Chaucer*, ed. Morris, i. 205, footnote.

84 *Bibliotheca Heberiana*, Part xi. p. 162. MSS. Lot 1533.

85 Ed. Halliwell, p. 379 *et seq.*

86 For instances, see the following words:—*Atame*, *alayned*, *ameved*, *assorte*, *avente*, *forcer*, &c.

87 London. Printed by William Nicol, Shakspeare Press, MDCCCLIV.

ADDITIONS. [◇](#)

SINCE the *Introduction* was written, I have had an opportunity of seeing the Hanover MS. of the French *Fierabras*. The kind offices of Professor Koner exerted on my behalf secured me the consent of the Administration of the Royal Hanoverian Library to have the MS. sent to Berlin, and their most generous permission to consult it freely in the Reading Room of the University Library.

Having now compared the *Sowdan* more closely with the Hanover MS., I must state that the final result arrived at in my investigation concerning the original of the *Sowdan* (cf. p. xxxii) is in no way altered.

As already stated above (p. xxxii), and as the subsequent examination and the passages of *H* quoted below will serve to confirm, the Hanover version is, generally speaking, the same as the printed version of the *Fierabras*, differing only in slight variations of readings.

The names in which *S* differs from *F*, but agrees with *H*, are already spoken of on p. xxxi. But there are several others in the spelling of which *H* agrees with *F*, but differs from *S*. Thus we find *Balans* or *Balant* in *H* for *Laban* in *S*; *Guarin*, *H*, leaf 80, back, *F* 438 = *Generyse*, *S* 1135; *Agolafres*, *H*, leaf 81 = *Alagolofer*, *S* 2135; *Amiotte*, *H* leaf 83, back = *Barrokk*, *S* 2939, etc.

As to the subject-matter, there are no instances where *S*, differing from *F*, agrees with *H*. In all points in which *S* differs from *F* we find it also differing from *H*.

Thus the game of blowing a burning coal, in the description of [♠](#) which *S* slightly differs from *F*, is related in *H* with nearly the same words as in *F*. As, besides the small fragment printed by Græber in the *Jahrbuch*, xiii, and some few remarks in the *Zeitschrift für rom. Phil.*, nothing is known of the Hanover MS., the following passages printed here may serve to show how

little *H* differs from *F*. The game of the coal (*S* 1996–2016, *F* 2907–2934) is thus described in *H*, leaf 58:—

“Veillard, dist Lucafer, *vous* ni savez juer,
Vous ne savez en France le *grant* charboun soffler.
Certes, ceo dist li dus, mais n’en oie soffler.
Et respont li payen: Mais te feray mostrer.
Ly payen vait le duc au *grant* fowel mener.
Quant Rollant l’ad veu, a Berard l’ad mostre
Ore porres boue jeu ver *et* esgarder.
Dahait qui ne laira ly *et* Naimes juer.
Lucafer se beysa pur un tison combrer,
Trestote le plus ardant quil i poet trover,
Par tiel air soffla le fu qil li fist voler.
Puis ad dist a Names ‘Ore *vous* covent soffler.’
Names prist le tison qui bien se sout aider,
Vers le payen s’en va pur le tison soffler,
Pur ceo le fist ly dus qa ly se volt meller,
Si suffla le tison qe le fist allumer,
Le barbe *et* le menton fist au payen bruler,
Tres *parmy* le visaie en fist la flame virer,
Qe par un sule petite qe nel fist souuiler.
Quant le voit ly payen, le sanc quida deueher.
Il jette a .ij. ses maines, qi le quide frapper,
Mais ly dus le ferry tres *parmy* le costes,
Qe les oilz de la teste ly fist en fu voler.
Puis l’ad pris par le flank, s’il voit en le fu ruer.
Lichiers, dist dus Names, Dex te poet mal doner,
Tu me quidoies ore come fole cy trover.”

The distribution of the relics, in which *S* (cf. note to l. 3238) differs from *F* 6195 *et seq.* is related as follows in *H*, leaf 100:—

“**A**U baron seint Dynis fu mult *grant* l’assemblee
Au perron au londy fu la messe chantee,
Illok fu la corone *partie et* desseveree,
L’un moite fu a saint Dynis donee
Et un clow *ansiement*, cest *verite* provee,
De la Corone fu un *partie* a Ais portee,
A Compaigne est l’ensigne en l’eglise honoree,
Et les altres .ij. clowes a Orlens fu enveiee,
Maint *presant* fist Charls de France la loie
Des saintisme reliques, Jhesu de maiestes.
En l’onur de Deu est mainte eglise fondee,
La feste de lendit fu pur iceo estoree.
Jaiaz videront cens ne taille donee. [](#)

Ne tardoit *que* .iiij. ans k'Espaigne fu gastee.
 La fu la treison de Rollant porpensee,
 Qe Ganes le vendist a la gent diffaae,
 Puys fu as chiuals sa chars destreinee,
 Pinables en fu mortz de suz Lyons en la pree,
 La le vengea Terris au trenchant del espee,
 Puys fu pendu armes par gulee paree,
 Toutz iours vegnent traitors a mal destinee
 Ou aloignee ou apres ia ni aueront duree.
 Charles voit a Orlens, la chanceon est finee
 Au deu *vous* commande, tote j'ai ma chancon fine.
 De cels romance est bone la fine *et* l'entree,
 Et en mileue *et* *partote* qi *bien* l'ad escoutee
 La beneiceon aez de Deu *et* del *vir* gine honore. Amen."

The miracle (*F* 6101–6123)⁸⁸ of the glove, in which Charles had placed fragments of the thorns, remaining suspended in the air for over an hour, the description of which is omitted in the *Sowdan* (cf. *Dissert.*, p. 29), is related as follows in *H*, leaf 99:—

“**L**’EMPERERS de France fist forement a loier
 Il a fait un table sur .ij. trestes lever.
 Et par de sur un paille *qui* fu fait outre mer.
 Illok fist Charl^m la corone apporter,
 Puis ad fait l’arcevesqe *partir et* deviser,
 Si ad fait les reliques mult *bien* enveloper,
 Dedens son mestre coffres les a fait deffermer,
 Et les altres reliques qe il voudra apporter.
 Les petites espignons qil vist esgruner,
 De la saint corone qil fist demenbrer,
 Trestote les acoillye nostre emperer ber,
 Et les mist en son gant qanqil pout trover.
 Un chivaler le tent qil vist lez ly ester,
 Mais al ne l’aperceut my qe nele oit parler.
 Charlemayn retiret sa mayne, si lesse le gant aler.
 Et dex a fait le gant enmy l’air arester
 Tant *que* d .j. leue en pout home *bien* aler;
 Kar la presse fu grant, ne l’en puis remenbrer.
 Charlemayn comande l’ewe apporter.
 De son gant ly sovengre si *quant* il dust laver,
 Mais ne seet a ky le comanda abailier,
 Par desur la gent le vist en l’air esteer,
 L’arcevesqe la monstre *et* tuit l’altre barne.
 Ceo fu mult grant mer veille, home en doit *bien* parler,
 Charls a pris son gant, s’est assis au soper.”

H, leaf 37, agrees with *F*, l. 1043, in making Oliver drink of the bottles of balm, which is not mentioned in the *Sowdan*, l. 1190 (cf. p. xxix). [dlii](#)

Similarly we find *S* 2604 differing from *H*, leaf 62, where we read *Basyns* (= *Basin*, *F* 3313) instead of *Bryer*.

Again *H*, l. 40, agreeing exactly with *F*, l. 1329 *et seq.*, differs from *S* 1279–82 (cf. p. xxix).

Instead of Floripas, *S* 1515, it is Brulans, *H*, l. 49, and *F* 1949, who advises the Soudan not to slay the prisoners.

The names of the twelve peers are the same in *H* as in *F* (cf. p. xxvii); and the whole scene of the peers being sent one after the other on a mission to Laban (cf. note to l. 1665 of the *Sowdan*) is described exactly alike in *F* 2263–2282 and in *H*, leaf 51, back, with the only difference that the names of the peers are given in a different order in both versions, Richard of Normandy, who is sent off as the sixth in *F*, being the second in *H*.

These variations of *S* from *H* clearly exemplify the impossibility of regarding the Hanover MS. as the original of the *Sowdan*. But as on the whole these differences are not of a very significant nature, and as, moreover, part of these variations may perhaps be attributed to the favourite habit of the author of going his own way in the arrangement of the subject-matter and in some minor points, whereas in the essential course of the events he strictly adhered to his source (see above p. xxxviii, and cf. note to l. 2535); and as besides there are several names, the spelling of which differs in *F*, agreeing in *S* and *H*, I think there can be no doubt that the original of the second part of the *Sowdan* was a version similar to the Hanover MS.

If now we compare the Hanover version with the Ashmole *Ferumbras* more closely than has been possible on page xx, there are some instances where *A*, whilst differing from *F*, agrees with *H*.

H.

lf. 27. Ha *Glout*, dist
 Karlemaines,
 lf. 27. Que puis *vivre* que cest
 jours fu passes
 lf. 25, Ses chiuals ad reine à un
 bk. arbre rasmee
 Et garda les leges tote
 contreval li pree

A.

163. A *glotoun*, saide þe
 Emperer
 175. Ke *lyve* he noȝt þys day to
 be evene
 91. Þarto ys stede þan tyeþe he

Nevertheless, the following passage in which *A* agrees with *F*, but differs from *H*, will at once show the impossibility of regarding *H* as the original of *A*. [ⓁⓂⓂⓂ](#)

A.

302. Þanne þer come bifore
 Charloun, Gweneloun and
 Hardree

H.

lf. 28, Atant se sunt drecie
 bk. Guinelons et *Alores*

In other instances *A* is found differing from *H* as well as from *F*. Thus the name of *Enfachoun*, *A* 4652, which is *Effraons* in *F* 4900, does not occur at all in *H*, which in the passage corresponding to *F* 4900, as well as in that corresponding to *F* 4913, reads *Affricons li Geans*.

Again, in the story of Myloun, in which *A*, l. 2008 *et seq.*, differs from *F*, we find *H* disagreeing from *F*, 2734 *et seq.*, and from *A*:—

“Volez vous queor de feme essayer *et* esprover
 Del riche duc Milon vous devez remenbrer,
 Qe tant nori Galans qe ly fist adouber,
 Puyt ly toly sa feile Gabaen au vis cler,
 L'enfes Marsilion en fist desherriter.—
 Quant l'entent Floripas, du sens quida deueer.”

—(*H*, leaf 56.)

But in most cases in which *F* differs from *A*, *H* agrees with *F*.

Thus we find Ferumbras challenging only *six* French knights in *H*, lf. 26, as in *F*, 84, 105, instead of *twelve* in *A*, l. 102.

In *A*, l. 5204, Floripas, swooning away, is upheld by Oliver, whereas in *F*, 5373, and in *H*, lf. 90, it is Guy who keeps her from falling.

For *Howel of saint Miloun*, A 5574, we read *Huon de saint Lis* in *F* 5792, and *Hugon de saint Lis* in *H*, lf. 95, bk.

As in *F* 2912 it is to Berard that Roland speaks in *H*, lf. 57, bk., and not to Olyver, as in A 2234.

That Maubyn scales the walls by means of a ladder of leather (A 2406) is not mentioned in *F* 3061, nor in *H*, lf. 59, bk.

In A 1386 Floripas gives Oliver, who is wounded, a warm draught, which heals every wound; in *F* 2209, as well as in *H*, lf. 51, it is by a bit of the mandrake plant that he is healed.

The maid-attendant mentioned in A 1238 (*chamberere*) is a man-attendant in *F* 2083 (*chamberlenc*) and in *H*, lf. 49, bk. (*chamberlayn*).

There is no trace of the additional lines of A, ll. 4867–4875, to be found in *H*, lf. 86 bk., nor in *F*, 5094.

Among the relics spoken of in A, there is nowhere a mention made of the *signe*. In *H* we find the *signe* always mentioned <div> together with the crown and the nails, just as in *F*. In the passage quoted above from *H*, lf. 100, and in the line which corresponds to *F* 6094, we find *ensigne* instead of *signe*; but *ensigne* certainly must be looked upon as a clerical blunder. In the other passages in which we find “the winding sheet, or shroud, of the Lord” mentioned in *H* it is also called *signe*:—

“Et rendrai la corone et le *signe* honore.”

H, lf. 42 = *F*, 1498; and *H*, lf. 45, bk. = *F*, 1805.

“Et les saintismes clowes et le *signe* honores.”

H, lf. 57 = *F*, 2829.

That the *signe* cannot be the “inscription of the cross” (cf. *Introduction*, p. xxx) is proved by an additional line of the Hanover MS., in which the Archbishop is said to have covered the heads of the French with the *signe*:—

“Puis a trait l’ensigne qui bien estoit ovres
Engenolant l’ad ly Rois tote oue lermes baieses,
Plus flairoit ducement que basine enbasines.
Quant Franceis l’ont veu, ele vous effraes,
De pite et de ioy fu chescous enplores.
L’ercesvesqe le prist, mult fu bien purpenses,
Et nos Franceis en a les chefs envelopes,
Puis le mist sur le paille qest a or ornes,
Od les altres reliques dont illi out asses.”

H, lf. 98, corresponding to *F*, 6094 *et seq.*

Abstaining now from citing any more passages where *H* agrees with *F*, but differs from *A*, I think the few quotations above will suffice to show the impossibility of regarding the Hanover MS. as the original of the Ashmole *Ferumbras*, notwithstanding that there are some resemblances of *A* to *H* (cf. p. xx). Therefore the result arrived at on p. xxi as to the original of the Ashmolean version is in no way altered by the detailed comparison of *A* with *H*.

FOOTNOTE. [◇](#)

88 Cf. *Sir Ferumbras*, 185/5988.

SKETCH OF THE STORY. [◇](#)

Laban, the Soudan of Babylon, who was residing at Agremore in Spain, went to the chase in a wood near the sea (p. 2). Being tired of hunting he sat down under a tree, and, perceiving a ship drawing near unto the shore, he sent one of his men to hail the vessel and to inquire for news. The interpreter of the vessel informs the soudan that the ship, freighted with a rich cargo at Babylon designed as a [div](#) present to Laban, had been driven by violent storms to the shore near Rome, where the ship had been robbed, and many of its people had been slain by the Romans. He solicits the Soudan to revenge this insult. Laban promises to make them pay dearly for it (p. 3). He convokes a war-council, and assembles a hundred thousand men and seven hundred sail. Himself goes, with Ferumbras his son and Floripas his daughter, in a dromond richly adorned (p. 4). They disembark in the haven of Rome, slay all Christians, and burn towns, abbeys, and churches. The pope of Rome assembles his council (p. 5). Duke Savaris is to meet the Saracens. With ten thousand men he draws near the Soudan's pavilion on the shore (p. 6); they slay ten thousand Saracens. The Romans, though masters of the field, cautiously retire within the walls of the city. Lukafer of Baldas, having scoured the country, brings ten thousand Christian maidens to the Soudan, who orders them to be put to death (p. 7). Lukafer demands Floripas for his wife, in return for which he promises her father to bring Charlemagne and his twelve peers to the foot of his throne. Floripas agrees to accept him when he has fulfilled his promise. The next morning Lukafer assaults the city, but the ditches being too deep (p. 8), the Saracens are obliged to retire. On the following day the assault is renewed, the ditches are, on Mavon's advice, filled with faggots. After a sharp conflict, where there were ten thousand Saracens slain by the stones of the Romans, the heathens are obliged to withdraw (p. 9). This second repulse makes the Soudan almost mad with vexation; he chides his gods. But

Lukafer told him that he had learned from a spy that Savaris would, on the following day, come out again to fight with them. He now intended, when Savaris was engaged in the battle, to unfold a banner made exactly like that of the Romans, and to attempt, by this stratagem, to be admitted within the gates. And so it turned out: the Romans mistaking him for Savaris returning from his sally, he entered the main tower, and slew all therein. Savaris, noticing the artifice of the enemy, and seeing his troop reduced to seventy-two men, turned back, but found the gate shut (p. 10). Estragot, a black giant of Ethiopia, slays him with his steel-mace. The Pope having summoned his council, a senator suggested the necessity of [dvi](#) sending messengers to Charlemagne to ask his aid. They all assented, and three messengers (p. 11) left the city by a postern at midnight; they passed the enemy's camp without being noticed by any wight. On the next morning Laban attempted a third assault; he commanded every man to throw pikes and bills over the walls to kill the Romans, and ordered the ships to go up the water with their boats bound to the mast, that they might fight in close combat. Near the tower there stood a bulwark, or "bastile," which was a strong defence to the wall. It was thrown down by stones hurled from an engine. Laban, growing proud from this event, summoned the Romans to surrender. Instead of an answer a Roman hurled a dart at his breast-plate, but his hauberk shielded him. The Soudan, more than mad, charged Ferumbras to destroy them all (p. 12), and enjoined Fortibrance and Mavon to direct their engines against the walls. The great glutton Estragot, with his heavy mace, smote on the gates and brake them in pieces. But as he was entering one of the gates, they let the portcullis fall, which crushed him to the ground, where he lay crying like a devil of hell. The Romans rejoiced, but the Saracens grieved. They withdrew to their tents, leaving behind the corpse of Estragot, whose soul went up to Mahound (p. 13). The Pope called all his people to St. Peter's and proposed to them to attempt a sally with twenty thousand men, to attack the enemy before day-break within their camp, and to leave ten thousand for the defence of the city. In the morning the Pope displayed the banner of Rome, and after a prayer for the preservation of the city, they marched out. But Ferumbras, going his rounds

(p. 14), noticed their coming, sounded the alarm, and drew up his troops. Then began a fierce struggle. Ferumbras slew Sir Bryer of Apulia (p. 15) and the worthy Hubert. Nine thousand heathens were killed and eight thousand Romans. Lukafer destroyed eighteen Romans; he also slew Gyndard, a senator of Rome, who had killed ten Saracens. Then came the Pope with a great escort and his banner before him. Ferumbras, supposing him to be the sovereign (p. 16), burst open the thick crowd and threw him down to the ground. But having opened his ventail, he saw his tonsure, and recognized the Pope. "Fie, priest," he said, "what doest thou here in the battle-field? <lviii> It would be a shame for me to slay thee. Go home and think of thy choir-service." The Pope, being glad to get off so easily, retired to Rome with five thousand men, fifteen thousand being killed. Charlemagne, having learned from the messenger the great disaster which had befallen the Romans, said he would not desist until he had chased the Soudan and Ferumbras out of Christendom (p. 17). He gave ten thousand pounds of francs to his nephew, Guy of Burgundy, and sent him off with orders to advance against the Soudan by forced marches. Himself would follow as soon as possible. In the mean time Laban reminded Lukafer of his vaunting promise to bring him Charlemagne and his twelve peers in return for his daughter Floripas. Lukafer said he would do all he had promised. With ten thousand men he attacked the city on one side, the other being assaulted by Ferumbras. The combat continued as long as daylight lasted. At night they retired to their tents (p. 18). Then treason was planned by Isres, who by inheritance possessed the guard of the chief gate of the town. He went to the Soudan and offered to betray the city on condition that his life and property should be spared. The Soudan promised it. Ferumbras with twenty thousand men went with Isres, but on entering the gate he caused the traitor's head to be struck off by the portcullis and to be carried on the point of a spear through the city. "Treason," cried the people (p. 19), when Ferumbras advanced into Rome. All the streets were soon covered with dead men. Ferumbras went to St. Peter's, seized the relics, the cross, the crown, and the nails, burned the whole city, and carried away all the treasures and the gold to Agremore in Spain, where the Soudan went back

to stay. Three months and three days they spent there in great festivities, making offerings to their gods, and burning frankincense in their honour. They drank the blood of beasts and milk, and ate honey, and snakes fried with oil (p. 20). When Sir Guy, approaching, drew near Rome, he found the whole city in flames. He grieved much that he had arrived too late, and resolved to wait there for Charlemagne, and then to tell him how Laban had burnt the city, and had sent the relics to Agremore, his principal town in Spain. Soon king Charles advanced to rescue Rome with his twelve peers and three hundred thousand soldiers (p. 21). Roland [¶viii](#) led the vanguard, Oliver the rear, and the king was with the main body. The provisions were conveyed by sea. Guy, seeing the army come, went to meet the king, and told him the mischief done by the Soudan, who, moreover, had made a vow to seek Charles in France in order to afflict him with grief. "He will find me near," said Charles, "and shall pay dearly for it. Unless he consents to be baptized (p. 22), he shall never see Babylon again." They all took ship without delay. Propitious winds drove them into the river Gase, where they landed, thirty miles from Agremore, and laid waste the country. Laban, hearing this news, was astonished at Charles's presumption (p. 23). He assembled all his barons, and charged them to bring him alive that glutton that called himself king of France, and to slay the rest of his army. Ferumbras went forth with many Saracens. He meets with Roland. They deal each other heavy strokes. Oliver cuts off a quarter of Lukafer's shield. The combat lasted the whole day. Well fought the twelve peers (p. 24). Ferumbras charges Oliver. King Charles, seeing this, rides at Ferumbras, and strikes his helm with a heavy mace. Ferumbras cannot approach him on account of the crowd. Charlemagne slew thirty Saracens with his sword Mounjoy. Lukafer of Baldas encountering Charles told him that he had promised the Soudan to bring him Charles and the twelve peers. Charles strikes him on his helmet (p. 25), but Lukafer is rescued by a great throng. Roland, drawing Durnedale, cleared a space around him, and hammered the heads of the Saracens. So did the other peers, and thirty thousand Saracens were slain. At night the pagans quit the field. Ferumbras vows never to desist until he has conquered Roland and Oliver (p. 26) and been crowned

king at Paris. Charles went to his pavilion and thanked God and St. Mary of France. He praised the elder knights for having won the victory, and exhorted the young ones to take example by them. They all make merry and go to supper. The Saracens address a prayer to the red Mars Armipotent (p. 27), to grant the Mahometans the victory over the Christians (p. 28). In order to recruit the late losses in his army, the Soudan sent for his vassals, and assembled more than three hundred thousand Saracens at Agremore. He addressed them (p. 29) in order to increase their dux ardour, ordered a solemn sacrifice to his gods, and charged Ferumbras to march with thirty thousand of his people against the Christian king (whom he wished to teach courtesy), and to slay all his men except Roland and Oliver (p. 30), if they would renounce their gods. Ferumbras led out his troops; until arriving near Charles's camp, he ordered them to halt in a wood, and advanced with only ten of his men to the camp of Charlemagne, and offered to fight at once against six of his peers. If he should conquer them, he would lead them away to his father's hall; but if he should be conquered, he would be Charles's man. The king sent for Roland and ordered him to undertake the combat. Roland refuses (p. 31), because Charles had praised the old knights: they might show their prowess now. Charles, vexed, smites Roland on the mouth, so that the blood springs from his nose, and he calls him a traitor. Roland draws his sword, but the other barons separate them and try to conciliate them. Meanwhile Oliver, who being sorely wounded kept his bed, on hearing of this dispute, had armed himself and went to Charles. He reminds the king of his long services, in reward for which he demands the battle. Charles remonstrates with him. But Oliver insists (p. 32). He rides to the forest, and finds Ferumbras alighted under a tree, to a branch of which his steed was tied. "Arise," he said, "I am come to fight with thee." Ferumbras, without moving, demands his name. "I am Generyse, a young knight lately dubbed." Ferumbras observes: "Charles is a fool to send thee; go and tell him to send me Roland and Oliver and such four other douzeperes. For little honour were it to me to fight with thee." "Spare thy words," replies Oliver, "and take thy arms" (p. 33). Ferumbras is wrath and seizes his helmet, which Oliver assists him to lace. Ferumbras thanks him,

courteously bowing to him. They mount their steeds, and rushing together like fire of thunder, they have their lances broken. They draw their swords. Ferumbras smites Oliver on his helmet so that the fire flies. Oliver strikes at the head of Ferumbras, breaks away the circle of his helmet, and the sword glancing off down his back, he cuts off two bottles of balm (p. 34), which he throws into the river. Ferumbras tells him that they were invaluable to a wounded man, and that he should atone for their loss with his life. He ~~dx~~ strikes at Oliver, who wards off the blow with his shield, but his steed is killed under him. Oliver quickly starts up and tries to kill his adversary's horse, but Ferumbras rides off and ties it to a hazel. "Yield thyself to me," says Ferumbras, "believe on Mahound, and I will make thee a duke in my country, and give thee my sister" (p. 35). "Ere I yield to thee," answered Oliver, "thou shalt feel my strokes." They fight for a considerable time; the blood runs from both their bodies. By mutual consent they stop to take breath. Ferumbras again asks Oliver his name and kin. "Thou must be one of the twelve peers, as thou fightest so well." "I am Oliver, cousin to Charlemagne." "Thou art welcome here," says Ferumbras; "thou slewest my uncle (p. 36); now thou shalt pay the penalty." The fight continued the whole day. At last Oliver, smiting Ferumbras upon the helmet, had his sword broken. He ran to the steed at the tree and seized a sword that was hanging there, but in turning on Ferumbras, he received a blow that made him kneel down (p. 37). But he returns Ferumbras a fearful stroke. Charles, seeing Oliver on his knees, prayed to Christ that he might grant the victory over the pagan. An angel announced to him that his prayer was heard. Charles thanks God (p. 38). The fight begins again. Ferumbras breaks his sword on Oliver's helmet. He runs for another and asks Oliver to surrender. But Oliver aims at him a blow which cuts his hauberk, so that his bowels are laid bare. Ferumbras implores his mercy, and consents to be christened, his gods having proved false. He requested him to take his hauberk (p. 39), to fetch his horse, and to carry him to his own tent. But the Saracens who lay concealed in the wood rush out. Oliver, being surrounded, sets down Ferumbras under an olive-tree, and defends himself with his sword, dealing the Saracens many a hard blow. Then Roland rushed into the throng of the

enemy and slew many (p. 40). His horse being killed by arrows and darts, he fights on foot, but his sword breaking, he is taken and led away. Oliver rides to rescue him, but his horse being also killed, he is overpowered and bound. Both were conducted to Lukafer of Baldas (p. 41). Charles sees them, and calls for a rescue. Many enemies were slain by the French barons, but the Saracens had fled with their prisoners, and [¶lxi](#) Charles is obliged to turn back. Under a holm tree they find Ferumbras, whom the king is going to put to death. But on his requesting to be baptized Charles took pity on him (p. 42), led him to his tent, and ordered a surgeon to attend him. He soon recovered, and bishop Turpin baptized him by the name of Floreyn. But he continued to be called Ferumbras all his life. Afterwards he was known as Floreyn of Rome on account of his holiness. Roland and Oliver being brought to the Soudan, Laban enquires their names. They confess their names (p. 43). The Soudan swears they shall both be executed the next morning before his dinner. But Floripas advises him to detain them as hostages, and to remember his son Ferumbras, for whom they might be exchanged. The Soudan, finding her counsel good, orders his gaoler Bretomayn to imprison them, but to leave them without food (p. 44). At high tide the sea filled their deep cells, so that they suffered much from the salt water, from their wounds, and from hunger. On the sixth day Floripas, who was gathering flowers in her garden, heard them lament. Moved to compassion, she asks her governess Maragound to help her in getting food for the prisoners. Maragound refuses, and reminds Floripas of her father's command. Floripas, thinking of a trick, called to her governess to come to a window (p. 45) and see the porpoises sporting beneath. As Maragound is looking out, Floripas pushes her into the flood. She then asks Bretomayn to let her see the prisoners. The gaoler threatened to complain to her father, but Floripas, having seized his key-clog, dashed out his brains. She then went to tell her father she had surprised the gaoler feeding the prisoners (p. 46) and promising to deliver them, wherefore she had slain him. The Soudan gives the prisoners into her guard. She now proceeded to the prison, asked the prisoners what they wanted, and promised to protect them from any harm (p. 47). She let down a rope, and with her maidens drew up both, and led

them to her apartments. There they ate, took a bath, and went to bed. The Soudan knew nothing of his prisoners being in Floripas's chamber. Meanwhile Charlemagne tells Guy that he must go to the Soudan to demand the surrender of Roland and Oliver, and of the relics of Rome. Naymes of Bavaria represents that a messenger to the Soudan [〈lxii〉](#) (p. 48) would certainly be slain; and that they ought to be anxious not to lose any more besides Roland and Oliver. Then said the king: "By God, thou shalt go with Guy." Ogier the Dane remonstrates, but is ordered to go too. So are Thierry of Ardane, and Folk Balian, Aleroy, and Miron of Brabant. Bishop Turpin kneels down to implore the king's mercy, but he must go too, as well as Bernard of Spruwse (p. 49) and Brier of Mountdidier. The knights take leave and start. About the same time the Soudan having assembled his council, Sortibrance and Brouland (p. 50) advise him to send twelve knights, and to bid Charles to give up Ferumbras and to withdraw from his country. The knights are despatched; near Mantrible they meet with the Christian messengers. Duke Naymes enquires whither they intend to go (p. 51). Having heard their message, the delegates of Charlemagne cut off their heads, which they take with them to present to the Soudan at Agremore. Laban was just dining when Naymes delivers his message: "God confound Laban and all his Saracens, and save Charles, who commands thee to send back his two nephews and to restore the relics" (p. 52). They then produce the heads of the Soudan's messengers. The Soudan vowed a vow that they should all ten be hanged as soon as he had finished his dinner. But Floripas recommended him to put off his resolution until a general council of his barons had determined on the best way to procure the liberation of Ferumbras. Thereupon the Soudan gives the prisoners into her guard. Floripas leads the knights into her tower (p. 53), where they were glad to find Roland and Oliver. They told each other how they had fared. After washing, they dined off venison, bread, and wine. The following day Floripas asks Naymes his name, and enquires after Guy of Burgundy, whom she had loved for a long time (p. 54), and for whom she would do all she could for their benefit, and would be baptized if he would agree to love her in return. Naymes tells Guy to take her for his wife; but Guy refuses, as he

never will take a wife unless she be given him by Charles. But Roland and Oliver persuade him, so that he at last consents. Floripas, holding a golden cup of wine (p. 55), kissed him, and requested him to drink to her after the fashion of her country; she then would drink to him in return. They all [<lxiii>](#) make merry, and prepare to assail the Soudan at supper on the following day. Meanwhile Lukafer comes to the Soudan and asks leave to see the prisoners, in order to know how Floripas guards them. Finding the door locked (p. 56), he burst it open with a blow of his fist, and told them he was come to speak to them, and to enquire after Charlemagne. Duke Naymes answers. Lukafer then asks what amusements they have after dinner. Naymes says: "Some joust, some sing, some play at chess." "I will teach you a new game," says Lukafer (p. 57). With a thread he fastened a needle on a pole and put a burning coal upon it. He blew it at Naymes's beard and burnt it. Naymes waxed wroth, and snatching a burning brand from the fire he smites at Lukafer, and throws him into the fire, where he was burnt to charcoal. Floripas applauds this, but points out their danger, and advises them to arm. At supper time she goes to her father (p. 58). As they were sitting at table, the twelve peers rushed in and slew all whom they met. Laban, pursued by Oliver, jumps out of a window on to the sea-shore and escaped without injury. They killed all in the castle, and then drew up the bridges and shut the gates. Laban vowed a vow that he would hang them all and burn his daughter. He sent to Mantrible for troops (p. 59) and engines and besieged Agremore. Floripas recommends the peers to enjoy themselves. In the morning the Soudan attacks the castle, but is repulsed (p. 60). He accuses his gods of sleepiness and shakes them to rouse them out of sleep. Brouland tells him, as the castle is strong and well stored with provisions, the peers will hold it very long; but if he would send orders to Alagolofer, the bridge-keeper at Mantrible, not to allow any one to pass without leave (p. 61), they would get no assistance from Charles and die from hunger. Espiard, the Soudan's messenger, is despatched to Mantrible, and commands the giant not to suffer any one to pass the bridge (p. 62). Alagolofer drew four and twenty chains across the bridge. Meanwhile the Soudan assaults the castle again, but the twelve peers slew three hundred

Saracens (p. 63). Laban threatens to hang them, and utters imprecations against Floripas, who returns them. He then calls for Mavon, his engineer, and orders him to direct a mangonel against the walls. Mavon knocked down a piece of the battlements. <lxiv> Roland and Oliver lament; they are comforted by Floripas (p. 64). Guy kills Marsedage, the king of Barbary, by throwing a dart at him. The Saracens stop the attack to bury Marsedage, and bewail him seven nights and seven days. Then the Soudan more closely blockades the castle (p. 65). The provisions being exhausted, Roland complains of Charles's forgetfulness; but Floripas cheers him up, saying she possessed a magic girdle, which was a talisman against hunger and thirst for those who wore it. They all successively put it on, and felt as if they had feasted (p. 66). Laban wondered at their endurance, but at last remembering the girdle, he induced Mapin to attempt to steal it at night. Mapin entered the chamber of Floripas (p. 67) through a chimney. He finds the girdle and puts it on, but Floripas perceives him and cries out. Roland hurries to her assistance, cuts off Mapin's head, and throws him out through the window into the sea without noticing the girdle. Floripas, seeing her girdle lost, is much grieved; Roland comforts her. They agree to attempt a sally to obtain food (p. 68). In the morning Naymes and Ogier remain in the castle, while the others start and surprise the Saracens sleeping in their huts. They slew three hundred, and carried off as much food as they could bear (p. 69). The Soudan is enraged and is going to burn his gods, but, appeased by his wise men, he sacrifices again, and is assoiled by the priests. Laban holds council (p. 70). A new assault begins, but so many of the assailants were slain by the showers of stones hurled down by the peers that the ditches are filled with dead bodies. The Saracens retire. But soon a second attack ensues. There being no stones, Floripas gave them her father's silver and gold to cast amongst the assailants. The Soudan in alarm for his treasure gives up the assault (p. 71). He is enraged with his gods, and smites Mahound so that he fell on his face; but the priests induce him to kneel down and ask forgiveness (p. 72). Meanwhile Roland exhorted Richard of Normandy to go on a message to Charles, that he might come to their rescue. They all would, the following morning before day-break, make an attack on the

Saracens, and meanwhile he should steal off in the darkness. In the morning they sally out. Floripas and her maidens draw up the bridges after them. Richard went off towards Mantrible (p. 73). <lxv> The others slay many Saracens; but Guy, overpowered by the Babylonians, is taken prisoner. Laban asks his name. Guy tells him. He is to be hanged. Three hundred Saracens crowding near the gate of the castle, attempted to prevent the other peers from entering. A fearful struggle begins (p. 74), in which Sir Bryer is killed. At last the Saracens take to flight. The peers retire inside the castle, taking the corpse of Bryer with them. Floripas enquires after Guy, and on hearing of his capture, begins to lament despairingly. Roland promises to rescue Guy (p. 75). On the following morning Laban orders Sir Tamper to erect a gallows before the castle, where Floripas could see it. Guy is led bound. Roland calls his companions to arms. They rush forth (p. 76). Oliver cuts down Sir Tamper, Roland kills a king of India, takes his sword and horse, and gives them to Guy, having unbound him. They slay many Saracens, and put the rest to flight. Retiring towards the castle, they see Admiral Costroye, and the Soudan's standard-bearer, escorting a great convoy, destined for the sultan, across a field near the high road (p. 77). Roland calls to them to share the provisions with them. Costroye refuses, and is slain by Roland. Oliver kills the standard-bearer, and the convoy is conveyed into the castle (p. 78). Floripas thanks Roland for bringing back Sir Guy, and proposes that he shall choose himself a mistress from amongst her maidens. But Roland refuses to take any that is not a Christian. The Soudan, on hearing such bad news, again defies his gods, and threatens to throw them into the flames (p. 79). But bishop Cramadas kneels before him and appeases him. The Soudan makes an offering of a thousand besants to his gods. When Richard arrived as far as Mantrible, he found the bridge barred by twenty-four chains, and Alagolofer standing before it. Determined not to leave his errand unperformed, he knelt down and commended himself to God. A hind appears (p. 80) and swims across the river; Richard follows her, and passing over in safety, hurries on to Charlemagne. Meanwhile Genelyn, the traitor, had advised Charles to retire to France, because the twelve peers were all slain. The king believed him, and

marched homeward, lamenting for his peers. Richard overtakes him, and is recognized by Charles, who asks him about the others. [¶lxvi](#) Richard tells the king how they are besieged within the castle of Agremore, and are waiting for his assistance. Charles, vowing vengeance on Genelyn (p. 81), turned and marched to Agremore. Richard informed him of the giant who kept the bridge, and how he had passed the river by a miracle. He proposed a plan that twelve knights, disguised as merchants, with their arms hidden under their clothes, should pay the toll, and the bridge being let down, they should blow a horn as a signal for the others to approach. They start and arrive at Mantrible (p. 82). Alagolofer asks whither they are going. Richard says they are merchants on their way to the Soudan, and they are willing to pay the toll. Alagolofer refuses to let them pass, and tells them about the ten knights, who had passed there and done so much mischief to the Soudan; therefore he will arrest them all. Sir Focard draws his sword and smites at him, Richard blows his horn, and Charles advances (p. 83). Alagolofer fights them with a great oak club. Richard seizes a bar of brass and knocks him down. Four men get hold of him and throw him into the river. They loosened the chains; but the Saracens assembling on the walls of the city, many Christians were slain. Alagolofer's wife, Barrock the giantess, comes on with her scythe and mows down all whom she meets. Charles dashes out her brains (p. 84), and with fifteen knights enters the outer gate of the town, thinking his army would follow him. But the gate was instantly closed upon him, and his men came too late. Charles was in great danger; but Genelyn, seeing him shut in, exclaimed that the king and the twelve peers were dead, and proposed to retire, as he wished to be king himself. They were going to return, but Ferumbras (p. 85) calls him a traitor; he rallies the French, and with his axe bursts open the gate. He chased the Saracens and rescued the king. Mantrible is taken with all its engines and treasures. Richard found two children of seven months old (p. 86), and four feet high. They were sons of Barrock, begotten by Astragot. Charles caused them to be baptized, and called the one Roland and the other Oliver. But they soon died for want of their mother's milk. The king appoints Richard governor of the city, and hurries on to Agremore with his army and with Ferumbras (p. 87). Laban,

being told by a spy [〈lxvii〉](#) that his city was taken and the bridge-ward killed, swears to avenge him. He calls a council, and charges his barons to take Charles alive that he might flay him. Charles approaches. Floripas first recognizes the banner of France and tells the others (p. 88). Roland and all his companions sally forth to meet Charlemagne. Laban draws up all his people in battle-order. The French make a great slaughter of the Saracens. Charles encounters the Soudan; he unhorses him, and would have cut off his head, but for Ferumbras, who requested that his father might be baptized. The Saracens, seeing Laban a prisoner, fly; but the Christians pursue them. Three hundred escaped to Belmarine. Charles leads Laban to Agremore. Floripas welcomes her father (p. 89), but he is enraged at seeing her. She then bids Charlemagne welcome, and presents the holy relics to him. Charles kisses them, and says a prayer; he then thanks Floripas for her assistance to his knights, and for having preserved the precious relics. He orders Turpin to prepare a vessel wherein to baptize the Soudan, and to wash off his sin in the water (p. 90). Turpin leads Laban to the font, but the Soudan strikes at him, spits on the vessel, utters invectives against all Christians, and curses Ferumbras. Charles commands Naymes to cut off his head. He is executed; his soul goes to hell, there to dance with devils. Floripas was baptized with all her maidens, and was wedded to Guy. Charles divided Spain between Guy and Ferumbras (p. 91), and charges Sir Bryer of Bretayne to take care of the relics, and to bring all his treasure to Paris. After taking leave of Guy and Floripas, Charles sails to Monpilier, where he thanks God for the victory (p. 92), and for the relics. He presents the cross to Paris, the crown to St. Denis, the three nails to Boulogne. Charles well remembered the treachery of Genelyn, and ordered him to be drawn and hanged at Montfaucon in Paris (p. 93).

The Romaunce of the Sowdone of Babylone and of Ferumbras his Sone who Conquerede Rome: [◇](#)

From the unique MS. of the late Sir Thos. Phillipps.

GOd in glorye of myghteste⁸⁹ moost,
That al thinge made in sapience
By vertue of woorde and holy goost,
Gyvinge to man grete excellence,
And alle, þat is in erthe, wrought

Subiecte to man and mañ to the,
That he shoulde with herte and thought
To loue and serve, and noon) but the:
For 3yfe mañ kepte thy commaundemente
In al thinge and loued the welle
And hadde synnede in his entente,
Than) shulde he fully thy grace fele;
But for the offences to God I-doon⁹⁰
Many vengeaunces haue be-falle.
Where-of I wole you) telle of oon),
It were to moch to telle of alle.
While þat Rome was in excellence
Of alle Realmes in dignite,
And howe it felle for his offence,
Listinythe a while and ye shal see,
Howe it was wonen) and brente
Of a Sowdon), that heathen) was,
And for synne howe it was shente;
As Kinge Lowes witnessith þat cas,

- [1](#) God has ordained all things wisely.
- [4](#) He has subjected the earth to man, and man to God.
- [8](#) The man who keeps His commandments and loves Him well, will feel His grace. But many
- [12](#) who offended Him have felt His vengeance. I will tell you of one; it would take too long
- [16](#) to tell of all. Listen to me, and ye shall hear how Rome, the former mistress of all
- [20](#) nations, came to fall by its sins, and was destroyed by a heathen Soudan. King Lewis has
- [24](#) borne witness to

As it is wryten in Romaunce
 And founden in bokes of Antiquyte
 At Seinte Denyse Abbey in Fraunc[e],⁹¹
 There as Cronycles remembrede be,
 Howe Laban, the kinge of hie degre,
 And syr^ʳ and Sowdon^ʳ of hie Babilon^ʳ,
 Conquered grete parte of Christiante,
 That was born in Ascalon.
 And in the Cite of Agremare⁹²
 Vppoñ the Rivere of Flagote
 At þat tyme he sojourned ther^ʳ†
 Fulle roially, wel I wote,
 With kinges xij and Admyralles xiiij,
 With many a Baroñ & Kniȝtis ful boold,
 That roialle were and semly to sene;
 Here worþynesse al may not be told.
 Hit bifelle by-twyxte March and Maye,
 Whan kynde corage begynneth to pryke,
 Whañ ffrith and felde wexen gaye,
 And every wight desirith his like,
 Whañ lovers slepeñ withe opyñ yȝe,
 As Nightyngalis on grene tre,
 And sore desire þat thai cowde flye,
 That thay myghte withe here louere be:
 This worthy Sowdoñ in this sesoñ
 Shope him to grene woode to gooñ,
 To chase the Bore or the Venesoñ,
 The Wolfe, the Bere and the Bawson.
 He roode tho vppoñ a fforeste stronde
 With grete rowte and roialte,
 The fairest, þat was in alle þat londe,

that story, which,
 written in Romance
 and found in very
 28 old chronicles at
 St Denys in France,
 relates how Laban, the
 king of Babylon, who
 32 was born at Ascalon,
 conquered a great part
 of Christendom. He was
 holding his court in
 36 the city of Agremore,
 on the river Flagot,
 with 12 kings and 14
 admirals, and many
 40 worthy barons and
 [If 1, bk] knights,
 when, in the time
 between March and May,
 44
 48 he went to the chase
 52 in a wood near the sea.

With Alauntes, Lymmeris and Racches free.
His huntis to chace he *commaunde*,
Here Bugles boldely for to blowe,
To fere the beestis in þat launde.

OF THE CAPTURE OF A SARACEN SHIP BY THE ROMANS.

The Sowdoñ woxe wery I-nowe;
He rested him vndere an holme tre
Sittyng vppoñ a grene sete
Seynge a Dromonde com seilyng in þ^e see
Anone he charged to bekyñ him *with* honde
To here of him tidinges newe.
The maister sende a man to londe,
Of diuers langages was gode and trewe,
And saide “lorde, this Dromonde⁹³
Fro Babyloyne comeñ is,
That was worþe thousande poundis,
As⁹⁴ it mete with shrewes I-wis,
Charged with perle and *pre*ciuous stones
And riche pelure and spicerye,
With oyle and bras qweynte for the nones
To presente yow, my lorde worthy.
A drift of wedir⁹ vs droffe to Rome,
The Romaines robbed vs anone;
Of vs thai slowgh ful many one.
With sorwe and care we be bygone.
Whereof, lorde, remedye
Ye ordeyne by youre Barons boolde,
To wreke the of this vilane;
Or certes oure blis is coolde.”
The Soudon hiryng this tyþinge,
With egre chere he made a vowe
To Mahounde and to Appolyne,

56

<p003>

- 60 Being weary with
hunting, he sat down
under a holm tree, and,
seeing a dromond
- 64 sailing on the sea, he
charged
one to enquire for news
concerning the ship. The
interpreter of the vessel
being
sent ashore, informed the
- 68 soudan, that this
dromond, freighted at
Babylon, with a cargo
- 72 of rich furs, spices,
oil, brass and pearls,
intended as a present
to the soudan, had been
- 76 driven by stress of
weather to Rome, where
they had been robbed by
the Romans.
- 80 [leaf 3]
Therefore he solicited
that the soudan would
take revenge on those
- 84 who had done such
villainy to him.
The soudan, hearing

That thai shulde by it dere I-nowe,
 Er that he wente fro theyme.⁹⁵
 “Where be ye, my kinges boolde,
 My Barons and my Admyral?
 Thes tidinges make myn herte coolde,
 But I be venged, dyen I shalle.
 Sire Ferumbras, my sone so dere,
 Ye muste me comforte in this case;

THE SOUDAN STARTS FROM AGREMORE

My ioye is alle in the nowe here
 And in my Doghter Dame Florypas.
 Sortybraunce, my Counselere,
 Lete clepe him forthe to counsaile me,
 And Oliborne, my Chauncelere
 And noble Clerke of hie degre,
 And Espiarde, my messangere,
 To goon to Assye and to Aufrike,
 To kinges, princes ferr’ and ner’,
 Barons, Admyralls and Dukes frike,
 Comaundinge hem vppoñ her legeaunce
 To come in al hast vnto me,
 Wel Armed with shelde and launse,
 To Egremoure poñ riche Cite.”
 In shorte tyme this message was wroghte
 An hundred thouusande on a rowte
 That robbery was righte dere boght,
 Was never none derrer withouten douzte.
 The kinge of Baldas, sir Lukafer’,
 Of Aufryke lorde and governoure,
 Spake to the Sowdoñ, that men myghte here,
 And saide “sir, for thyn honour’,
 Do sende for shippes both fer’ and nere.”

these tidings, made
 88 a vow to Mahound and
 to Apolyn, that they
 should dearly pay for
 it.
 92 ‘Ferumbras, my son,’ he
 said, ‘and my daughter
 Floripas, ye must

<p004>

be my comfort in this
 96 case.
 Order Sortibrance,
 my counsellor, to be
 called for, and my
 100 chancellor Oliborn,
 and Espiard my
 messenger, that he
 may go to Africa and
 104 to Asia and to all
 the princes, who owe
 me allegiance, and
 command them hastily to
 108 assemble with shield
 and lance at Agremore.’
 In a short time 100,000
 men had assembled.
 112 On the advice of Lukafer,
 king of Baldas,
 the soudan also
 brought together 700 sail
 116 and a dromond for
 himself,
 for Ferumbras of

Carrikes, Galeis and shippes shene,
 vij hundred were gadered al in fere
 And a Dromonde for the Sowdeñ kene.
 Sir Ferumbras of Alisaundre
 In the Dromonde with him was,
 Of Assy the kinge of Chaunder',
 And his faire doghter Floripas.
 Two maistres were in the Dromounde,
 Two goddes on hye seteñ thore
 In the maister toppe, withe macis rounde,
 To manace with the Cristeñ lore.
 The sailes were of rede Sendelle,
 Embrowdred with riche araye,

TO INVADE ROME WITH A GREAT ARMY.

With beestes and breddes every dele,
 That was right curious and gaye;
 The Armes displaied of Laban
 Of Asure and foure lions of goolde.
 Of Babiloyne the riche Sowdoñ,
 Moost myghty man he was of moolde,
 He made a vowe to Termagaunte,
 Whan Rome were distroied & hade myschaunce,
 He wolde turne ayen erraunte
 And distroye Charles the kinge of Fraunce.
 Forth thai sailed on the flode,
 Tille thai come to the haven of Rome:
 The wynde hem served, it was ful goode.
 Ther loded many a grymlye gome.
 Thai brente and slowen, þat Cristen were,
 Towñ, Abbey and holy chirche.
 The hethen hade such power there,
 That moche woo gan thai there wirch.

Alexandrie, for the
 Asiatic king of
 120 [leaf 4] Chaunder and
 for Floripas. There
 were two masters in
 that vessel, and two
 124 idols placed on the
 main top, with round
 maces, therewith to
 menace the Christians.
 128 The sails of red
 sendal-silk were

<p005>

richly embroidered
 132 with figures of
 animals and birds.
 Four golden lions, the
 arms of the soudan of
 136 Babylon, were also
 displayed thereon.
 Laban made a vow to
 Termagant, to destroy
 Rome,
 140 and after that
 Charlemagne.
 Having disembarked in
 the haven of Rome,
 they slew all
 144 Christians, and burned
 towns, abbeyes and
 churches.
 The Pope of Rome,
 148 hearing of the heathens

Tidinggis came to Rome anone
 Unto the Pope, that þ^t tyme was,
 That the heþen came to bren and slone.
 This was to hem a sory cas.
 He lete cal his counsaile to-geder
 To wete, what was beste to doñ.
 Anone as thai were come þeder⁹⁶,
 He asked of hem al ful sone:
 “Lordinges, it is vnknowne⁹⁶ to you,
 That this cursed hathen Sowdoñ
 Brennyth and stroyeth oure pepul nowe,
 Alive he leveth vnneth not one.
 Seint Petir be oure governoure
 And save this worthi Cite of Rome,
 And Seinte Poule be oure gydoure
 From this cursed hetheñ houn⁹⁷!”
 Ifre3 he bispake him thañ,

SAVARIS LEADS THE CHRISTIAN TROOPS

Of Rome he was a Senatoure,
 And saide “sendith some worthy man
 To Charles kinge of hye honoure.
 He wolde you helpe with al his myghte,
 That noble kinge of Dowse Fraunce.”
 “Certes” quod Savaris “þat weren no righte,
 It were right a foule myschaunce,
 To sende to þat worthy kinge.
 We have oure hedes yet al hole,
 Oure sheldes be not broke no-thinge,
 Hawberke, spere, ner poleyne, ner pole.
 Where-of shul we playñ to him,
 That no thinge yet have assaide?
 Mech uylanye we myght wyne,

laying waste the whole
 country,

152
 assembled his council.

156

160
 [leaf 5]

164
 Jeffrez, a senator

<p006>

of Rome, advised that
 worthy men should be
 168 sent to Charles of
 Douce France to implore
 his assistance.
 But Duke Savariz,
 172 thinking this to be
 a wretched piece
 of timidity, as they
 had not tried
 176 anything for themselves,

That for noght were so sone afrayed.
Ten thousande men delyuere me tyte
Tomorue next in-to the feelde,
And I shall prove with al my myghte
To breke there bothe spere and shelde.”
Vnto the Senatours it semed welle,
His counsaile goode and honourable.
This worthi Duke was armed in stele
In armes goode and profitable;
He bare a Chek of goulis clere,
An Egle of goolde abroad displayed.
With him many a bolde Bachelere
Tho spake Savary³ with wordes on hye
And saide “my felowes alle,
This daie prove you meñ worthy,
And faire you al shal befalle.
Thenke yat Criste is more myghty
Than here fals goddis alle;
And he shal geve vs the victorie,
And foule shal hem this day bifalle.”
Forth than rode þat faire Ooste
With right goode chere and randoñ,

AGAINST THE SARACENS AND CONQUERS THEM.

Tille than come ful nyȝe the cooste.
Of the Sowdons Pavyloñ
Ferumbras was of hem ware
And sprange out as a sparkil of glede;
Of Armes bright a sheelde he bare,
A Doughty mañ he was of dede.
xv thousande came oute there
With him at þat same tyde,
Ayen the Romaines for to were,

180

asked for 10,000 men
to be put under his
command.

184

188

192

The next morning the
duke addressed his men,

196

[200](#)

and directed them to
the soudan’s

[p007](#)

pavilion near the
shore.

204

[leaf 6] Ferumbras,
that doughty
warrior, becoming
aware of them, led

208

15,000 men against the
Romans.

With bobaunce, booste and grete pride.
 The stoure was stronge, enduryng^a longe:
 The Romaines hade there the feelde;
 The Sarysyns thai slough amonge,
 Ten thousand and mo with spere and sheelde.
 Sauariz was wise and ware
 And drowe towards þat Citee.
 His baner displaied with him he bare
 To releve with his meyne.
 The Pope with his Senatours
 Thanked god þat tyme of glorie,
 That gafe hem þat day grete honours,
 Of hethen that dai to have the victorie.
 Lukafer, kinge of Baldas,
 The countrey hade serchid and sought,
 Ten thousande maidyns faire of face
 Vnto the Sowdan hath he broghte.
 The Sowdoñ commanded hem anone,
 That thai shulde al be slayñ.
 Martires thai were euerychoñ,
 And therof were thai al ful fayne.
 He saide “my peple nowe ne shalle
 With hem noughte defouled be,
 But I wole distroie ouer all
 The sede over alle Cristiante.”
 Tho spake lukefere the kinge,
 That hetheñ hounde Baldas,

THE NEXT DAY LUKAFER ASSAULTS THE CITY,

And saide “Sir Sowdañ, *gra*unte me one thinge,
 Thi doghter Dame Floripas.
 The kinge of Fraunce I shal the bringe
 And the xij dosipers alle in fere.”

212

10,000 and more of the
 216 Saracens were slain,
 and the Romans, though
 victorious, were led
 back to Rome by the

220 cautious Savaris.
 The Pope thanked God
 for the victory.

Lukafer of Baldas
 224 having scoured the
 country,
 brought 10,000 maidens
 to the soudan, who

228 ordered them to be
 slain,
 saying, he would
 not have his people

232 polluted by them, and
 he would destroy every
 Christian seed.

Lukafer said to the

236 soudan:

«p008»

“Grant me thy daughter
 and I will bring thee
 240 Charlemagne and all his
 twelve peers.”

The Sowdan saide in þat tokenyng,
 “I *graunte* the here, that is so dere.”
 Tho sayde Floripe “sire, noon haste,
 He hath note done as he hath saide.
 I trowe, he speketh these wordes in waste,
 He wole make bute an easy brayde.
 Whan he bryngith home Charles the kinge
 And the xij dosipers alle,
 I *graunte* to be his derlynge
 What so evere therof by-falle.
 Than on the morowe the Sowdañ
 Callid to him Lukafer^ʃ of Baldas,
 To assaile the Cite anone:
 “And loke thou tary not in this cas!
 Thritty thousande of my menie,
 Of Gallopes, Ethiopes and Aufricanes,
 Take hem to the walles with the.
 Betith down wallis, towris and stones.”
 Lukafer^ʃ blewe his clarioñ
 To Assemble the Sarasyns þat tide,
 Where-of thai knewe right well the soune,
 Thai made hem redy for to ride,
 But whan thai come to the yate,
 The Dikes were so devely depe,
 Thai helde hem selfe Chek-mate;
 Ouer cowde thai nothir goo nor crepe.
 Lukafer^ʃ in al the haste
 Turned to the Sowdan agayñ
 And saide “sir, it is alle in waste,
 We laboure now alle in vayne.
 To depe and brode the Dikes bene,
 The Towres so stronge be with alle,

Laban assented; but
 Floripas said, she
 244 would only consent to
 be his darling,
 [leaf 7]
 248 when he had taken
 Charles and the
 douzepeers.
 The next morning the
 252 soudan ordered Lukafer
 to assault the City
 with 30,000 men.
 256
 260
 264 The Saracens, finding
 the ditches too deep,
 cannot pass, and are
 268 obliged to return.

[272](#)

That by Mahounde I can note seeñ,
How that we shulde wyne ther to the walle.”

Who was woode but the Sowdoñ?

276

He reneyed his goddis alle.

He clepede his Engynour sir mavone,

The soudan calls for

To counsaile he did him faste calle.

his engineer Mavon,

He tolde him the case of þat myschefe,

280

How it stode at that ilke tyde.

Mavon Gafe him counsel in breefe

who advised him to fill

To fille the Dikes þat were depe.⁹⁸

the ditch

Every man to woode shal gooñ,

284

Fagotis to hewe and faste bynde,

with fagots.

And fille the Dikes faste anooñ

With alle, that we may ther fynde.

“Gramercy, Mavoñ,” quod Laban thañ,

288

Laban thanks his wise

“Mahoundis benysone thou shalt haue,

engineer.

Of alle myn Ooste the wiseste man,

[leaf 8]

With counsaile men for to saue.”

Alle this was done the seconde daye,

292

The following day, the

Men myght go even to the walle;

ditch being filled with

On every party the ooste laye,

fagots, the city

Thai made assaite⁹⁹ then generale.

was assaulted from all

The Romaines ronñe to the toures,

296

quarters. The Romans

Thai were in ful grete dowte;

ran to the towers, and

Thai hade many sharpe shoures,

a sharp conflict

Thai were assailed sore a-bowte.

ensued.

Wifis and maidyns stones thai bare

300

Women and maidens

To the walles than ful faste,

carried stones which

Thai were in grete drede and care;

the

The men over the wallis did caste.

men threw over the

Thai slown many a Sarasyñ,

304

walls.

x *thousande*¹⁰⁰ pepul of he^m and moo.
The daie passed to the fyne,
The hethen withdrowe hem tho.
Whan these tidinges came to laban,

LUKA FER ENTERS THE MAIN TOWER OF ROME.

His goddes he gan chide.
He waxe both blake, pale and wan,
He was nyȝe woode þat same tyde.
Tho Lukafer comfortede him welle
And saide “sir, be not dismayed,
For I have aspied everydele,
Howe thai shalle alle be betrayede.
Sauariz wole to morowe with us fighte,
His baner knowe I ful welle;
I shal have an othere, I you^o plighte,
Like to this every dele.
Whan he is moste besy in bataile,
Than wole I with banere displaiede
Ride in to Rome *with*out faile,
Thus shal thai al be betrayede.”
The Sowdaⁿ was glad of this tidinge,
Hopinge it shulde be so;
And even as it was in purposynge,
Right so was it aftir I-do.
Wenynghe it hade be Sauarye,
Relevinge fro the hethen stour^o,
Wenynghe doth ofte harme *with*oute lye,
He entred to the maister Toure.
The firste warde thus thay wonne
By this fals contrevede engyne.
Thus was moche sorowe bygoⁿ,
Thai slough^h all, that were ther-Inne.

10,000 Saracens were
slain and
the heathens obliged to
withdraw.

308

⟨p010⟩

Laban chides his gods
and nearly grows mad
with vexation. But
312 Lukafer told him that,
having espied that
Savaris would, the
following day, come
316 out again to fight
with them, he would
have a banner made
exactly like his, which
320 when Savaris was much
engaged in the battle,
he would unfold and
enter Rome.

324

And so it
turned out; the Romans
328 mistaking him for
Savaris, returning from
his sally, he entered
the main tower,
332 [leaf 9]

and slew all therein.

Whaṇ Sauariz saugh this discomfitur'
 Of the Romaynes in that tyme,
 And howe harde thaṇ was here aventur',
 Of sorowe þat myghte he ryme
 Of x thousande meṇ lefte no moo
 But sixty meṇ and twelfe,
 And whan he sawe this myschief tho,
 He turned homewarde agayn him selue.
 By thaṇ he founde the gate shite

THE POPE DESPATCHES MESSENGERS TO CHARLEMAGNE.

With Sarisyns, that hade it wone;
 And Estragot with him he mette
 With bores hede, blake and donne.
 For as a bore an hede hadde
 And a grete mace stronge as stele.
 He smote Sauaryz as he were madde,
 That dede to grounde he felle.
 This Astrogot of Ethiop,
 He was a kinge of grete strength;
 Ther was none suche in Europe
 So stronge and so longe in length.
 I trowe, he were a develes sone,
 Of Belsabubbis lyne,
 For ever he was thereto I-wone,
 To do Cristeṇ men grete pyne.
 Whan tidinggis came to the [P]ope,
 That Duke Sauaryz was dede slayṇ,
 Thaṇ to woo turned alle his hope;
 He dide calle thaṇ to counsaile
 Alle the Senatouris of Rome,
 What þinge þat myght hem most availe,
 And what were beste to done.

336 Savaris becoming aware
 of the artifice of the
 enemy,

340 and seeing out of
 10,000 Romans no more
 than seventy-two left,
 turned back, but found

344 the gate shut,

<p011>

348
 and was slain by
 Estragot, a black giant
 352 of Ethiopia.

356
 360 After the death of
 Savaris, the Pope
 summoned his council
 364 again.

Tho by-spake a worthy man of counsaile,
An Erille of the Senatouris:
“The best counsaile, þat I can

Sending vnto Charles the kinge¹⁰¹
Certifiynge him by your myssangeris
The myschief þat ye are Inne,
That he come with his Dosyperys
To reskue Cristiante fro this hepen.”
All thai assentede anone therto;
The *lettres* were made in haste.
Thre messageres we ordeyñ¹⁰² therto,
That went forthe at the laste.

THE SARACENS THROW DOWN A BASTILE OF ROME.

At a posterne thai wente oute
Pryvely aboute mydnyght,
And passed through alle the route.
Of hem was war no wight.
BVt let we nowe the messangeris gooñ,
And speke we of Labañ,
Howe he dide saile the Cite anooñ,
And *commaundid*, þat every man
Shulde withe Pikeys or with bille
The Wallis over throwe,
That he myght the Romaines kille,
Playnly on a rowe,
By water he ordeynede the shippes gooñ,
The bootis bownden to the maste,
That thai myght fight with hem anooñ,
Honde of honde, þat was here caste.
To the Toure a bastile stode,
An engyne was I-throwe—

368 An earl of the
senatours suggested
the necessity of
dispatching messengers
to Charlemagne,
372 imploring him to come
to their deliverance.
[leaf 10]
They all assented.
376 Three messengers,
with letters
written in haste,

⟨p012⟩

left the city by a
380 postern at midnight,
and passed the enemy’s
camp without being
noticed by any wight.
384 Laban
commanded every
man to throw pikes and
388 bills over the walls,
to kill the Romans.
He ordered the ships
392 to go up the water,
with their boats bound
to the mast, that they
might fight in close
396 combat.

That was to the Cite ful goode—
 And brake dowⁿ towres both hie and lowe.
 Tho sorowede alle the Citesyns
 And were ful hevy thaⁿ.
 Tho wox prowde the Sarasyns,
 And than bispake sire laban
 And saide “yolde youe here to me,
 Ye may not longe endure,
 Or ellis shall ye al slayⁿ be,
 By mahounde I you ensure.”
 A Romaine drife a darte him to
 And smote him on the breste plate,
 Ne hadde his hawberke lasted tho,
 Mahounde had come to late.
 Tho was the Sowdoⁿ more þaⁿ wod,
 He cried to Ferumbras,
 “For Mahoundes loue, þat is so good,
 Destroye vp bothe man and place.

ESTRAGOT IS CRUSHED BY A PORTCULLIS.

Spare no thinge that is alyve,
 Hows, Toure ner Walle,
 Beest, ner man, Childe nere Wife,
 Brenne, slo and distroye alle.”
 Tho Ferumbras ordeynede anone
 To bende the Engynes to the towⁿ
 And bete dowⁿ both Toure and stooⁿ.
 He cleped forth Fortibraunce and Mavoⁿ
 And saide “be youre Engynes goode?
 Shewe forth here nowe your crafte
 For Mahoundis love, þat gevith man foode,
 That ther be no Toure lafte.”
 Tho the grete glotoⁿ Estagote¹⁰³

Near the tower there
 stood a bastile which
 formed a principal
 400 protection to the city.
 It was laid low by
 stones hurled from an
 engine.
 404 Laban, growing proud,
 summoned the Romans to
 surrender.
 Instead of an answer, a
 408 Roman hurled a dart at
 his breast-plate, but
 his hauberk shielded
 him.
 412 The soudan, more than
 mad, charged Ferumbras
 to destroy them all,

⌈p013⌋

416 [leaf 11]

420
 and enjoined
 Fortibrance and Mavon
 424 to direct their
 engines against the
 walls.
 The great glutton

With his myghty mace sware
 On the Gatis of Rome he smote
 And brake hem alle on thre thare.
 In he entrid at the Gate
 The Porte-Colis on him thai lete falle.
 He wende, he hade come to late,
 It smote him through herte, lyuer and galle.
 He lai cryande at the grounde
 Like a deuelle of Helle;
 Through the Cite wente the sowne,
 So lowde than gan he yelle.
 Gladde were al the Romaines,
 That he was take in the trappe,
 And sorye were al the Sarsyns
 Of þat myschevos happe.
 Sory was the Soudoñ thañ
 And Ferumbras and Lukafer'.
 Thai drowe hem tille her tentes thañ,
 Thai left him ligginge there.
 Mahounde toke his soule to him
 And broght it to his blis.
 He loued him wel and al his kyn,

THE POPE ATTEMPTS A SALLY.

Of þat myghte he not mys.
 Anone the [P]ope dide somoñ alle;
 The peple of the Cite came,
 To Seinte Petris he dide hem calle,
 And thidere came every man.
 He saide on hie "my Children dere,
 Ye wote wel, howe it is;
 Ayenst the Sarisyns, þat nowe be here,
 We mowe not longe endure I-wis.

428 Estragot, with his
 heavy mace,
 smote on the gates
 and brake them in
 432 pieces.
 But as he was
 entering one of the
 gates, they let the
 436 portcullis fall,
 which crushed him to
 the ground,
 where he lay crying
 440 like a devil.
 The Romans were glad,
 but the Saracens
 grieved.
 444 They withdrew to
 their tents, leaving
 behind the corpse of
 Estragot, whose soul
 448 went up to Mahound.

<p014>

The Pope called all
 452 his people to St.
 Peter's,
 and proposed to them
 456

Thay brekene oure walles, oure Toures alle
With caste of his Engyne.

Therefore here amonge you alle
Ye shalle here counsaile myne.

Thai bene withdrawe to here Oost,¹⁰⁴

And on-armede thay ben alle.

Therefore, me thenketh, is beste
To-morowe erly on hem to falle.

We have xxx^{ti} thousande men;

Twenty thousande shal go with me,

And in this Cite leve ten

To governe the comynalte.”

The Senatouris assentede sone

And saide, beter myghte no man seyne.

On the morowe this was it done¹⁰⁵;

God bringe hem wele home agayne.

The Pope did display than

The hie baner of Rome,

And he assoiled every mañ

Through gracious god in Dome.

He praide of helpe and socour⁹

Seinte Petir and Poule also

And oure lady, þat swete floure,

To saue the Cite of Rome from woo.

Forth thai rideñ towarde the Oost.

Ferumbras romede a-boute;

FERUMBRAS DRAWS UP THE SARACEN TROOPS.

He saw the Romaines comeñ by the Cost,¹⁰⁶

Thereof he hade grete dowte.

He blewe an horne, of bras it was;

The Sarsyns be-goñ to wake.

“Arise vp” he saide in aras,¹⁰⁷

[leaf 12]

460

464

to attempt a sally
with 20,000 men, to
attack the enemy

468

before day-break
within their camp,
and to leave 10,000
for the guard of the

472

city. The senators
assented.

In the morning
the Pope displayed

476

the banner of Rome,

and after a prayer

480

for the preservation
of the city,

they marched out.

But Ferumbras, going

484

his rounds,

<p015>

discovered their

coming,

sounded the alarm,

488

“We bene elles alle I-take,	
And Armes anone, every wight,	
To horse with spere and shelde!	492
Ye may se here a ferefuȝ sighte	
Of oure enemyes in the felde.	
Astopars, ¹⁰⁸ goo ye biforn vs,	and drew up his
For ye be men of myghte;	496 troops.
Ethiopes, Assayneȝ and Askalous,	
Go nexte afore my sighte.	
My Fadir and I with Babyloynes,	
Ho ¹⁰⁹ shal kepe the rerewarde.	500
King Lukafer' with Baldeseynes,	
To venge alle, shalle have the Fowarde.”	[leaf 13]
The Romaines aspied, þat thai were ware	
Of here comynge thaȝ,	504
And therfore hade thay moche care.	
Natheles on hem thai goȝ—	
Seinte Petir be here socoure!—	
And laiden on side, bake and boȝ.	508
There bigan a sturdy shoure	There began a hard
Sire ¹¹⁰ Ferumbras of Alisaundre ooȝ, ¹¹¹	struggle.
That bolde man was in dede,	
Vppon a steede Cassaundre gaye,	512
He roode in riche Weede.	
Sire Bryer of Poyle a Romaine to fraye	Ferumbras slew Sir
He bare through with a spere,	Bryer of Apulia
Dede to the grounde ther he laȝ	516
Might he no more hem dere!	

A GREAT MANY ARE SLAIN ON EITHER SIDE.

<p016>

That sawe Huberte, a worthy man,	
Howe Briere was I-slayȝ,	
Ferumbras to qwite thaȝ	520

To him he rode ful eveñ.
 With a spere vppone his shelde þañ
 Stifly ganne he strike;
 The shelde he brake I-myddis the feelde;
 His Hawberke wolde not breke.
 Many goode strokes were delte.
 Ferumbras was a-greved tho,
 He smote with mayne and myghte
 The nekke asonder, the ventayle also,
 That dede he sate vprighte.
 There was bataile harde and stronge;
 Many a steede wente ther a-straye,
 And leyn at the grounde I-stonge,
 That resyn never aftyr that day,
 IX thousand of the payens pride
 That day were slayñ,
 And viij thousande of the Romaines side,
 That in the feelde dede layne.
 Lukafer, þat paynym proude,
 Slough Romaines eyztene,
 Of werr' moche sorowe he coude,
 His strokes were over alle sene.
 Gyndarde, a Senatoure of Rome,
 Had slayne Sarsenys teñ,
 Tille he met with the cursed gome,
 Lukifere slough him than.
 Tho come the Pope with grete aray,
 His baner to-fore him wente.
 Ferumbras than gañ to assaye,
 If he myght that praye entente,
 Supposynge in this though[t]e,
 Ther was the souerayne;
 He spared him therfore right noght,

[524](#)

528 and the worthy Hubert.

532

9000 pagans were
536 killed,
and 8000 Romans.

Lukafer destroyed
540 eighteen Romans,
he also slew Gyndard,
a senator of Rome,
who had slain ten

544 [leaf 14] Saracens.

Then came the Pope
548 with a great guard
and his banner before
him.

Ferumbras, supposing
552 him to be the
sovereign,

But bare him down̄ ther in þ^e playn̄.
 Anooñ he sterte on him all ane
 His Ventayle for to onlace,
 And saugh his crowñ newe shafe,
 A-shamed thanne he was.
 “Fye, preest, god gyfe the sorowe!
 What doist thou armede in the feelde,
 That sholdest saie thi matyns on morwe,
 What doist thou with spere and shelde?
 I hoped, thou hadiste beñ an Emperoure,
 Or a Cheftayne of this Ooste here,
 Or some worthy conqueroure.
 Go home and kepe thy Qwer’!
 Shame it were to me certayne
 To sle the in this bataile,
 Therfore turne the home agayn!”
 The Pope was gladde þer-of certayne,¹¹²
 He wente home to Rome that nyght
 With Five thousande and no more,
 XV thousande lefte in the feelde aplight,
 Full grete sorowe was therefore.
NOwe telle we of the messenger,
 That wente to Charlemayne,
 Certyfyinge him by lettres dere,
 Howe the Romaines were slayne,
 And howe the Contrey brente was
 Vnto the Gate of Rome,
 And howe the people song ‘alas,’
 Tille socoure from him come.
 “Who” quod Charles, that worthy kinge,
 “The Sowdoñ and Ferumbras?

burst open the thick
 crowd and threw him
 556 down to the ground.
 But seeing his
 tonsure, he was
 ashamed.
 560 “Fie, priest,”
 he said, “what
 doest thou in the
 battle-field?
 564
 It would be a shame
 568 for me to slay thee.
 Go home and think of
 thy choir-service!”
 The Pope retired with
 572 5000 men,
 15,000 being killed.
 576 Charlemagne, having
 learned from the
 messenger the great
 disaster which had
 580 befallen the Romans,
 said, he would not
 584 desist until he had

I nyl lette for no thinge,
Till I him oute of Cristendome chace.
Therefore Gy of Burgoyñ,
Mynne owen nevewe so trewe,

[leaf 15] chased the
soudan and Ferumbras
out of Christendom.

588

THE SARACENS AGAIN ATTACK THE CITY.

¶p018¶

Take a thousande pounce of Frankis fyne,
To wage wyth the pepul newe.
Take this with the nowe at this tyme,
And more I wole sende the,
Loke that thou spare no hors ne shelde,
But þat he dede be;
And faste hye the thyderwarde,
For I drede thay haue grete nede,
And I shalle come aftirwarde
As faste, as I may me spede.”

SPeke we of Sir Labaṅ
And let Charles and Gy be,
Howe he ordeyned for hem thaṅ

To Distroye Rome Citee.
“Sir Lukafer’, thou madiste thi boost
To conquer’ the Romaines
And to bringe me the Ooste
Of the xij peris and Charlemayne.
Vppoṅ a condicioṅ I graunte the
My doghter, dere Dame Floripas.
Wherefore, I aske nowe of the
To holde covenante in this cas.”

“That I saide” *quod* Lucafere,
“To Mahounde I make a vowe
To done al þat I hight the ther’,
Ye and more than¹¹³ for Florip love.”
He ordeyned assaute anone in haste
With x thousande men and moo;
And Ferumbras at that oþer side faste
Assailed hem with grete woo.
The saute endured al þat daye
From morowe, tille it was nyght,

He gave 1000 pounds
of francs to his
nephew Guy of

592 Burgundy,
and sent him off with
orders to advance
against the soudan by
forced marches.

596 Himself would follow
as soon as possible.

600

Laban reminded
Lukafer of his
vaunting promise to
bring him Charlemagne
and his douzepeers,

608 in return for his
daughter Floripas.

Lukafer said, he

612 would do all he had
promised.

With 10,000 men he

616 attacked the city on
one side, the other
being assaulted by

Ferumbras. The combat

620 continues as long as

To throwe and shete by euery waye,
While that hem endured the light.
Tho wente thai home to thair⁹ tentys,

THEY ENTER ROME BY TREASON.

Tille it were on the morowe.
Isres in his fals ententes
Purposed tresoñ and sorowe.
He was chief Porter of the Towñ,
By heritage and fee so he shulde be.
He wente to the Sowdañ,
For the riche Cite betraye wolde he,
And saide “lorde, gife me grace
For my goodes and for me,
And I wole delyu^er the this place
To haue and holde for ever in fee.
The keyes of this riche Cite
I haue in my bandon.”
“That graunte I” *quod* Laban “the
To be free withoute raunsoñ.”
Ferumbras made him yare,
With xx^{ti} thousand meñ and moo,
With this Isres for to fare,
And to wyne the Cite soo.
As sone as he entred was
The chief Gate of alle,
And alle his men in aras,¹¹⁴
He lete the Portcolys falle.
He smote of the traitourus hede
And saide “god gife him care!
Shal he never more ete brede,
All traitour^s evel mot¹¹⁵ thai fare!
If he myght leve and reigne here,

daylight lasts. At
night they retired to
their tents.

<p019>

624 Isres, who possessed
by inheritance
the guard of the
[leaf 16] principal

628 gate, planned treason.
He repaired to the
soudan and offered to
betray the city on

632 condition that his
life and property
should be spared.

636 The soudan promised
it.
Ferumbras with 20,000

640 men went with Isres.

On entering the gate,

644 he caused the
traitor’s head to be
struck off by the

648 portcullis, and

He wolde betraye me;
For go he west, south or North,
Traidour shalle he never be.”
He dide lete bere his hede on a spere
Through-oute this faire Citee.
‘Treson, treson’ thai cried there,
Pite it was to here and see.

FERUMBRAS TAKES THE RELICS TO AGREMORE.

The people fled by every waye,
Thai durst no-where a-bide.
The hye wey ful of dede men laye,
And eke by every lanys side.
Ferumbras to Seinte Petris wente,
And alle the Relekes he seased anoon,
The Crosse, the Crowne, the Nails bente;
He toke hem with him everychone.
He dide dispoile al the Cite
Both of tresoure and of goolde,
And after that brente he
Alle þat ever myght be toolde.
And alle the tresoure with hem þai bare
To the Cite of Egremour’.
Laban the Sowdon sojourned there¹¹⁶
Thre monpes and thre dayes more
In myrth and loye and grete solas.
And to his goddes offrynge he made,
He and his sone Sir Ferumbras
Here goddis of golde dide fade,
Thai brente Frankensense,
That smoked vp so stronge,
The Fume in her presence,
It lasted alle alonge.

652

to be carried on the
point of a spear
through the city.
“Treason,” cried the
people within,

656

660

and all streets were
soon covered with
dead men. Ferumbras
went to St. Peter’s,
seized the relics,
the cross, the crown
and the nails,

664

668

[leaf 17] burned
the whole city, and
carried away all the

672

treasures and the
gold to Agremore,
where the soudan went
to stay. Three months

676

and three days they
spent there in great
festivities, making
offerings to their

680

gods, and burning
frankincense in their
honour.

<p020>

Thai blewe hornes of bras,
Thai dronke beestes bloode.
Milke and hony ther was,
That was roial and goode.
Serpentes in Oyle were fryed
To serve þ^e Sowdoñ with alle,
“Antrarian Antrarian” thai lowde cryed
That signyfied ‘Ioye generalle.’
Thus thai lived in Ioye and blis
Two monþes or thre.
Lete we now be alle this,

GUY AND CHARLEMAGNE APPROACH.

And of Gye nowe speke we.
Now speke we of Sir Gȳe
That toward Rome hied with his Oost.
Whañ he approched there-to so nyȝe,
That he myght se the cooste,
Alle on a flame þat Cite was,
That thre myle al abowte,
Ther durst no mañ, þat ther was,
Come nyȝe the Cite for grete dowte.
That was a sory Cite than,
Sir Gye was in grete care,
Ther was nowhere a soryer mañ,
For sorowe he sighed ful sare,
And saide “welallas”¹¹⁷ the while
“For we come ar to late,
For by some treson or some gyle
Thai entred in at some Gate.
There is no more but for to abyde,
Tille Charles come, the kinge,
In this mede Vnder grene wode side,

684 They drank the blood
of beasts and milk,
and ate honey and
snakes fried in oil.

688

692

<p021>

696

When Sir Guy drew
near Rome, finding
the whole city in

700

flames,

704

he grieved much

708

that he had arrived
too late.

712

He resolved there to
wait for Charlemagne
[leaf 18]

To telle him of this tithinge,
Howe Laban hath the Cite brente
And bore the Religes¹¹⁸ a-waye,
And howe he hath hem to Spayne sente
With Shippes of grete aray,
To Egremour' his chief Cite,
Ther to live and ende;
And manassith Charles and his baronye.
God gife hem evelle ende!"
Kinge Charles he forgate nought
To come to reskowe Rome,
Alle his Do3ypers were I-sought,
Fulle sone to him thay come.
Thre hundred thousande of Sowdeoures

CHARLES HEARS OF THE MISCHIEF DONE BY THE SARACENS.

Kinge Charles with him dide lede,
They were doughty in all stourys
And worthy men of dede.
Sir Roulande þat worthy knighte,
He ladde the Fowarde,
And Sir Olyuer', that was so wighte,
Gouerned the Rerewarde.
The Kinge himselfe and his Baronye,
With Dukes And Erilles roialle,
Gouerned alle the medil partye.
By commaundemente generall
He ordeynede grete plente
Of Flessch and Fissh, brede and wyne,
In shippes to saile by the see,
To serven him ful wel and fyne.
Sir Gye aspied his comynge,
He knewe the baner of Fraunce,

and then to tell him,
how Laban had burnt
716 the city, and had
sent the relics to
Agremore,
his principal town in
720 Spain.

King Charles advanced
724 to rescue Rome with
his douzepeers

and 300,000 soldiers.

<p022>

728

Roland led the
732 vanguard,
Oliver the rear,

the king was
736 with the main body.

The provisions
740
were conveyed by sea.

Guy seeing them come,
744 went to

He wente anooñ ayen the kinge
 And tolde him of þat myschaunce,
 Howe that the cursed Sowdañ
 Hath brent Rome and bore the Relekis awaye,
 And how he hath slayñ alle and some,
 That he hath founde of Cristeñ faye.
 And more-over he made his a-vowe,
 To seke kinge Charles in Fraunce
 And do him wo ther I-nowe.
 “God gif him moch myschaunce!”—
 “A” quod Charles “þat nedith noght,
 He shal fynde me nere.
 By god, þat dere me boght,
 He shal by it ful dere.
 I shalle him never leve I-wis
 Withinne walle ner withoute,
 I swere by god and seinte Denys,
 Tille I have sought him oute;
 And but if he will Baptised be

HE GOES OVER TO SPAIN.

And lefe his fals laye,
 Babyloyne shal he never see
 For alle his grete aray.”
 Anoon to shippe every mañ
 With vitaille and with store,
 Euen towarde the proud Sawdañ
 With-outeñ any more.
 Wynde him blewe ful fayre and goode
 Into the Ryver of Gaze,
 Even over the salte flode
 And ouer the profounde rase.
 XXX legee3 from Egremour¹

meet the king, and
 told him the mischief
 done by the soudan,

748

who moreover had made
 a vow to seek Charles
 in France in order
 to afflict him with
 grief. [leaf 19] “He

752

will find me near,”
 said Charles, “and
 shall dearly pay for
 it.

756

760

Unless he consents to
 be baptized,

<p023>

764

he never shall see
 Babylon again.” They
 all took ship without
 delay.

768

772

Propitious winds
 drove them into the
 river Gase, where
 they landed, 30 miles

By londe for south it is,
And ther withoute any more
To londe thai wente I-wis,
And brente and slougheñ al þat thai fonde,
And stroyed both Toure and towñ.
Thai lefte no thinge on grounde,
That thai ne bete it dowñ.
Tithinggis were tolde to Laban,
Howe Charles was I-come
And slough bouth childe, wyfe, man
And brente and stroyed alle and some
With thre hundred thousand of Bachelers,
That were both stoute and gaye,
And with him al his Dosyperis,
Pepul of grete araye.
“And but ye ordeyne remedy,
He wole you brenne and slooñ,
Youe and youre riche Baronye,
He wole leve a-life neuere ooñ.”
Whan Laban herde these tidyngys,
His herte woxe alle coolde
And saide “this is a wonder thinge!
Howe durste he be so boolde?
Litill kennyth he what I may doo,

A GREAT BATTLE ENSUES.

He dredith me litil nowe.
But certes he shalle, erþ he goo,
To Mahounde I make a vowe.
Sir Lucaferþ and Ferumbras
To him dide he calle
And Mavoñ and Sortebras
And his Barons alle.

776 from Agremore,

and laid waste the
780 country.

Laban, hearing this
784 news,

788

792

796
[leaf 20]
was astonished at
Charles's presumption.

800

He assembled all his
804 barons,

¶p024¶

I charge you vppoñ youre legeaunce,
That ye bringe me that gloton,
That clepeth himselfe kinge of Fraunce,
Hidere to my Paviloñ.
Kepe him a-live, the remenaunte sle
The xij Peris ychooñ!
I shalle tech him curtesye,
I swere by god Mahounde.”
Ferumbras anooñ than
Arrayed him for to ride
With proude Sarasyns many a man,
That boldely durst a-bide.
Rowlande met with Ferumbras
And gafe him such a stroke
That al astonyed þerof he was,
It made him lowe to stoupe.
Ferombras smote him agayne
With myghte and mayn, with ire
That he stenyed alle his brayne,
Him thought, his eyeñ were alle on fyre.
With Lucafer’ Oliver’ mette,
And hit him on the sheelde
A stroke, that was right wel sette;
A quarter flye in the feelde.
Thus thai hurteled to-gedere
Alle the lefe longe daye,
Nowe hider and nowe theder;
Mony an hors wente ther astraye.
The Dosyperis thay foughten wele,

CHARLES ENCOUNTERS FERUMBRAS AND LUKAFER.

Duke Neymys and Oger’,
With goode swerdes of fyne stele

808 and charged them to
bring him alive that
glutton that called
himself king of
812 France, and to slay
the remnant.

Ferumbras went forth
816 with many Saracens.

He meets with Roland.
820

They deal each other
824 heavy strokes.

Oliver cuts off a
828 quarter of Lukafer’s
shield.

The combat lasted the
832 whole day.

Well fought the
twelve peers.

836

⟨p025⟩

And so dide Gye and Syr Bryer'.
Ferumbras was euer a-bowte
To fyghte with Olyvere,
And Olyuer' with-oute dowte
Leyde on with goode chere.
Kinge Charles saugh Ferumbras,
To him fast he rode
And it on the helme with his mace,
That stroke sadlye abode.
Ferumbras was woode for woo,
He myght for prees come him to
For no worldis thinge, that myght be tho.
Kinge Charles anoon¹¹⁹ Ioye oute-drowe,
And with his owen honde
XXX^{ti} Sarseynys ther he slowe,
That laie dede vppone the sonde;
Many of hem therfore made joy Inowe.
Sir Lucafere of Baldas,
He presed to Charles sone,
And saide "Sir, with harde grace,
What hastowe here to done?
I behight Laban to bringe the to him
And the xij peris alle;
Now shaltowe come from al thy kyn
Into the Sowdans halle.
Yelde the to me" he saide,
"Thy life shalle I safe."
A stroke on him than Charles layde;
He made the Paynym to rafe.
He smote him on the helme
With mown-Ioye, his gode bronde.
Ne hadde he be reskued than,
He hade slayn him with his honde.

[leaf 21]

840 Ferumbras charges
Oliver.

844 King Charles, seeing
this, rides on to
Ferumbras,
and strikes his helm
with his heavy mace.

848 Ferumbras cannot
approach him on
account of the crowd.
Charlemagne with his

852 sword Mounjoy slew 30
Saracens.

856 Lukafer of Baldas,
encountering Charles,

860 told him that he had
promised the soudan
to bring him Charles
and the douzepeers.

864 Charles strikes him
on his helmet,

868

Than came Balde3yn3 with thronge
 To reskue there here lorde,
 And nubens with hem amonge
 And Turkes by one accorde.
 Tho Roulande Durnedale oute-drowe
 And made Romme¹²⁰ abowte.
 XL of hem ther he slowe,
 Tho were thai in grete dowte.
 Roulande as fiers as a lion
 With Durnedale¹²¹ tho dinge
 Vppon the Sarsyns crowne,
 As harde as he myght flynge.
 Duke Neymys and Sir Olyuer',
 Gy and Alloreyne of Loreyne,
 And alle the noble xij Peris,
 Oger' and Bryer' of Brytayne,
 Thai foughten as feythfully in þat fight,
 The feelde ful of dede men laye.
 XXX^{ti} thousande, I you plight,
 Of Sarsenys ther were slayñ.
 Al thinge moste haue añ ende,
 The nyghte come on ful sone,
 Every wighte retourned to wende;
 Ferumbras to his men gan gone
 And saide "oure hornes blowe we,
 This day haue we a ful ille afraye,
 To saie the south and not to lye,
 Oure goddis holpe vs not to daye,
 What deuel þat ever heñ eilith.
 This bataile was so sharpe in faye,
 That many a man it wailyth.

but Lukafer is
 872 rescued by a great
 throng. Roland,
 drawing Durendale,
 cleared a space
 876 around him and

 880 hammered the heads of
 the Saracens.
 [leaf 22]
 So do the other peers,
 884

 888 and 30,000 Saracens
 were slain.
 892 At night the Pagans
 quit the field.

 896

 900

Shalle I never in herte be glade to daye,
Till I may preve my myghte
With Roulande, that proude ladde,
Or with Olyuer', that is so lighte,

CHARLES PRAISES THE OLD KNIGHTS.

That evel hath vs ladde;
And in Paris be crowned kinge
In despite of hem alle,
I wole leve for no thinge
What so evere byfalle.”
Kinge Charles with grete honour'
Wente to his Paviloñ;
Of the treyumple he bare the flour'
In dispite of Mahounde.
Almyghty God and Seynte Denyse
He thanked ful ofte sithe
And oure lady Marie of Paris,
That made hem gladde and blith.
He recomendide the olde Knightes,
That þat daye hade the victorie,
And charged the yonge with al her myghtes
To haue hem in memorye;
For worthynesse wole not be hadde,
But it be ofte soughte,
Ner knighthode wole not ben hadde,
Tille it be dere boghte.
“Therefore ye knightes, yonge of age,
Of oolde ye may now lere,
Howe ye shalle both hurle and rage
In felde with sheelde and spere.
And take ensample of the xij Peris,
Howe thai have proved her myght,

Ferumbras vows, never
to desist

904

<p027>

unless he be crowned
king at Paris.

908

Charles went to his
pavilion and

912

thanked God

916

and St. Mary of
France.
He praised the elder
knights for having
won the victory and
exhorted the young
ones

920

924

[leaf 23]

928

to take an example by
them.

932

And howe thai were both wight and fiers
To wynnyn honourys in righte.
These hethen houndes we shal a-tame
By God in magiste,
Let us make myrth in goddis name
And to souper nowe goo we.”

O Thow, rede Marȝ Armypotente,
That in the trende baye hase made þy trone,
That god arte of bataile and regent

936 They make merry and
go to supper.
Prayer addressed
to the red Mars

940 Armipotent,

SPRING IS THE TIME OF LOVE.

<p028>

And rulist alle that alone,
To whom I profre precious present,
To the makande my moone
With herte, body and alle myn entente,
A crowñ of precious stoonēs,
And howe to the I gyfe
Withouten fraude or engyne,
Vppoñ thy day to make offerynge,
And so shal I ever, while þat I live;
By righte þat longith to my laye,
In worshiþe of thy reverence
On thyn owen Tewesdaye
With myrr', aloes and Frankensense,
Vppoñ condicioñ that thou me graunte,
The victorye of Crystyñ Dogges,
And that I may some¹²² hem adaunte
And sle hem dowñ as hogges,
That have done me distruccioñ
And grete disherytaunce
And eke slayn my men *with* wronge.
Mahounde gyfe hem myschaunce!”

944

948

952

to grant the
956 Mahometans the
victory over the
Christians.

960

IN the semely seson of the yere,
Of softenesse of the sonne,
In the prymsauns of grene vere,
Whan floures spryngyñ and bygynne,
And alle the floures in the frith
Freshly shews here kynde,
Than it is semely therwyth,
That manhode be in mynde;
For corage wole a man to kith,
If he of menske haue mynde,
And of loue to lystyñ and lithe,
And to seke honour^r for þat ende.
For he was neuere gode werryour^r,
That cowde not loue a-ryght;

THE SOUDAN RALLIES HIS TROOPS.

For loue hath made many a conquerour^r
And many a worthy knyghte.
This worthy Sowdan, though he hepen wer^r,
He was a worthy conquerour^r;
Many a contrey with shelde and spere
He conquerede wyth grete honoure.
And his worthy sone Ferumbras,
That kinge was of Alisaundr^r,
And Lucafer^r of Baldas,
That cruel kinge of Cassaundr^r,
That wroughten wonders *with* here honde
With myghte and mayne for to fyghte,
And over-ride mony a manly londe,
As men of Armes hardy and wighte.
The Sowdan seyinge this myschief,
How Charles hade him a-greved,
That grevaunce was him no thinge lese,^{[123](#)}

In the spring of the

964 year

[leaf 24]

968

man ought to show his
manhood

972

and to think of love.

For none can be a

good warrior, unless

976

he knows how to love.

[p029](#)

The soudan was a

980

great conqueror;

Ferumbras and

984

Lukafer wrought

wonders with their

988

hands.

[992](#)

He was ful sore ameved.	
He sente oute his bassatoures	The soudan sent for
To Realmes, provynces ferr' and ner',	996 his vassals,
To Townes, Citeis, Castels and Tours,	
To come to him ther' he were,	
To Inde Maior and to Assye,	
To Ascoloyne, Venys, Frige and Ethiope,	1000
To Nubye, Turkye and Barbarye,	
To Macedoine, Bulgar' and to Europe.	
Alle these people was gadred to Agremore,	and assembled more
Thre hundred thousand of Sarsyns felle,	1004 than 300,000 Saracens
Some bloo, some yolowe, some blake as more,	at Agremore.
Some horrible and stronge as devel of helle.	
He made hem drinke Wilde beestes bloode,	[leaf 25]
Of Tigre, Antilope and of Camalyoñ,	1008
As is here vse to egre here mode,	
Whan pai in werre to battayle goon.	
He saide to hem "my frendes der',	He addressed them in
As my trust is alle in you,	1012 order

THE SARACENS SACRIFICE TO THEIR GODS.

<p030>

On these Frenche dogges, that bene here,	to increase their
Ye moste avenge me nowe.	ardour,
Thai have done me vilanye,	
Mikille of my people have thay slayñ.	1016
And yet more-over thay manace me	
And drive me to my contrey agayn;	
Wherefore I wole at the bygynnyng	ordered a solemn
To Mahounde and to my goddis alle	1020 sacrifice to his gods,
Make a solempne offerynge;	
The better shall it vs byfalle.	
The laste tyme thai were wrothe,	
We hade not done oure dute.	1024

Therefore to saye the southe”

There were many hornys blowe,

The preestes sendeñ thikke I-nowe

Goolde, and silver thikke thai throwe,

With noyse and crye thai beestes slowe,

And thought to spede wel I-nowe;

And every man his vowe he made

To venge the Sowdañ of his tene.

Here goddis of golde thai wex alle fade,

The smoke so grete was hem bitwene.

Whan alle was done, the Sowdan than

Charged Ferumbras redy to be

On the morowe, ere day began,

To ride oute of þat Cite

With xxx^{ti} thousande of Assiens,

Frigys, Paens and Ascoloynes,

Turkis, Indeis and Venysyens,

Barbarens, Ethiopes and Macidoynes,

“Bringe him to me, that proude kinge;

I shal him teche curtesye,

Loke that thou leve for nothings

To sle alle his other mayne,

Safe Rouland and Olyuere,

That bene of grete renowe,

[1028](#)

1032

1036 and charged Ferumbras

to march with 30,000

1040 of his people

against the Christian

1044 King, whom he wished

to teach courtesye,

[leaf 26] and to slay

all his men except

1048 Roland and Oliver,

FERUMBRAS CHALLENGES 6 CHRISTIAN KNIGHTS TO SINGLE COMBAT.

[p031](#)

If thai wole reneye her' goddis ther'

And leven on myghty Mahounde.”

Ferumbras with grete araye

Rode forthe, Mahounde him spede,

Tille he came nyze ther' Charles lay

By syde in a grene mede.

In a woode he buskede his men

if they would

renounce their

gods. Ferumbras led

1052 out his troops;

until arriving near

Charles's camp, he

ordered them to

Prively that same tyde,
 And with his felowes noon but ten
 To kinge Charles he gan ride
 And said "sir' kinge, that Arte so kene,
 Upon trwes I come to speke with the,
 If thou be curteis, as I wene,
 Thou wolte graunte a bone to me,
 That I mighte fight vppoñ this grene,
 With Rouland, Olyvere and Gye,
 Duke Neymes and Oger' I mene,
 Ye and Duke Richarde of Normandye,
 With al sex attones to fight.
 My body I profr' here to the
 And requyre the, kinge, thou do me right,
 As thou art gentille Lord and fre;
 And if I may conquere hem in fere,
 To lede them home to my Faderis halle;
 And if thai me, I graunte the here,
 To be thy man, body and alle."
 The kinge Answered with wordis mylde
 And saide "felowe, þat nedith nought,
 I shalle fynde of myñ a Childe,
 That shal the fynde that thou hast sought."
 The kinge lete calle Sir Roulande
 And saide "thou most with this man fight,
 To take this bataile here on honde,
 Ther-to God gyfe the grace and myghte!"
 Roulande answered with woordis boolde
 And saide "Sir, have me excuseð!"

ROLAND REFUSES TO UNDERTAKE THE COMBAT.

He saide, certeynly he ne wolde;
 The bataile vttrily he refused.

1056 halt in a wood, and
 advanced with only
 ten of his men to the
 camp of Charlemagne,

1060

and offered him to
 fight at once against
 1064 Roland, Oliver, Guy,
 Duke Naymes, Ogier
 the Dane, and Richard
 of Normandy.

1068

If he should conquer
 them, he would lead
 1072 them away to his
 father's hall; if he
 should be conquered,
 he would be his man.

1076

The king sent for
 Roland and ordered
 1080 him to undertake
 the combat. Roland
 refuses,

1084

because Charles had

<p032>

“The laste day ye preised faste
 The oolde knightes of her’ worthynes.
 Let hem goon forth, I haue no haste,
 Thai may goo shewen her’ prowes.”
 For that worde the kinge was wrothe
 And smote him on the mouthe oñ hye,
 The bloode at his nose oute-goth,
 And saide “traitour, thou shalte a-bye.”
 “A-bye” quod Roulande “wole I noughte,
 And traitour was I never none,
 By þat lord, þat me dere hath bought!”
 And braide oute Durnedale þer’ anone.
 He wolde haue smyteñ the kinge ther’,
 Ne hadde the barons ronne bytwene;
 The kinge with-drowe him for fer’
 And passed home as it myght beste bene.
 The Barons made hem at one
 With grete prayer’ and instaunce,
 As every wrath moste over-gone,
 Of the more myschiefe to make voydaunce.
 Olyuere herde telle of this,
 That in his bedde laye seke sore.
 He armede him ful sone I-wisse,
 And to the kinge he wente withoute more
 And saide “Sir Kinge, a bone graunte me
 For alle the servyse, that I haue done,
 To fight with þat kinge so free
 To morue day, ere it be none.”
 Charles answered to Olyuer’:
 “Thou arte seke and woundede sore,
 And thou also my cosyñ dere,
 Therefore speke thereof no more.”—
 “Sir Kinge” he saide “I am alle hoole,

praised the old
 1088 knights. [leaf 27]
 “May they show their
 valour now.” Charles,
 vexed, smites Roland
 1092 on the mouth, so that
 the blood springs
 from his nose, and he
 calls him a traitor.
 1096
 Roland draws his
 sword, but the other
 1100 barons separate them
 and try to conciliate
 them.
 1104
 Meanwhile Oliver,
 who, being sorely
 wounded, kept his
 1108 bed, on hearing of
 this dispute, had
 armed himself and
 went to Charles. He
 1112 reminds him of his
 long services, and
 demands the battle.
 Charles remonstrates
 1116 with him.
 But Oliver insists.

I aske you this bone in goddis name.”

1120

OLIVER GOES TO FIGHT WITH FERUMBRAS.

<p033>

“Certes” he saide “I holde the a fole,
But I praye, god sheelde the fro shame.”

Forth he rideth in that Forest,

Tille he gan Ferumbras see,

Where he was light and toke his rest,

His stede renewed til a grene tre.

“Sir” he saide “reste thou wele!

Kinge Charles sente me hidur’.

If thou be curteys knighte and lele,

Rise vp and let vs fight to-geder.”

Ferumbras sate stille and lough,

Him liste not to rise oute of the place.

“My felowe” quod he “what arte thou?

Telle me thy name for goddis grace.”

“Sir” he saide “Generyse,

A yonge knighte late dobbet newe.”

“By Mahounde” quod he “thou arte not wyse,

For thy comyng shaltowe sore rewe.

I holde Charles but a foole

To sende the hider’ to me,

I shall the lerne a newe scole,

If thoue so hardy to fighte be.

I wende, he wolde haue sende Roulande,

Olyuer’ and iiij mo Dosypers,

That hade bene myghty men of honde

Bataile to a-bide stronge and fiers.

With the me liste no playe begynne,

Ride agayn and saye him soo!

Of the may I no worshype wyne,

Though I slough the and such V mo.”

Oliver rides to the

forest, and finds

1124 Ferumbras alighted

under a tree, to

a branch of which

his steed was tied.

1128 “Arise,” he said,

“I am come to fight

with thee.” [leaf 28]

Ferumbras, without

1132 moving, demands his

name.

“I am Generys,” says

1136 Oliver, “a young

knight lately dubbed.”

Ferumbras observes,

1140 “Charles is a fool to

send thee.

1144

Go and tell him to

send me Roland and

Oliver, and such four

1148 other douzepeers. For

little honour were it

to me to fight with

“Howe longe” quod Olyuer’ “wiltowe plete?
Take thyñ armes and come to me,
And prove þat thou saiest in dede,
For boost thou blowest, and þenkes¹²⁴ me.”
Whan Ferumbras herde him speke so wel,

OLIVER LAYS HOLD OF THE BOTTLES OF BALM,

He caught his helme in grete Ire,
That wroght was of goode fyne stele
With Perlis pight, Rubeis and Saphire.
Olyuer’ halpe him it to onlase;
Gilte it was alle abowte.
Ferumbras þanked him of his grace
And curteisly to him gan lowte.
Thai worthed vp oñ here stedes,
To Iuste thai made hem preest,
Of Armes to shewe her’ myghty dedis
Thai layden here speres in a-reeste,
To-geder thai ron neñ as fire of thonder’,
That both here Launces to-braste.
That they seteñ, it was grete wonder;
So harde it was, þat thay gan threste.
Tho droweñ thai oute here swordes kene
And smyten to-geder by one assente.
There thai hitteñ, it was wele sene;
To sle eche other was here entente.
Syr Ferumbras smote Olyuer’
Vppoñ the helme righte on hye
With his swerde of metel cler’,
That the fyre he made oute-flye.
Olyuer’ him hitte agayñ vpoñ the hede
¹²⁵the hede than fulle sore,
He carfe away with myght and mayne

thee.”

1152 “Spare thy words,”
says Oliver, “and
take thy arms.”

¶p034¶

1156 Ferumbras is wrath
and seizes his
helmet, which Oliver
assists him to lace.
1160 Ferumbras thanks him,
courteously bowing to
him. They mount their
steeds,

1164
rush together like
fire of thunder, and
have their lances

1168 broken. [leaf 29]
They draw their
swords.

1172

Ferumbras smites
Oliver on his
1176 helmet so that the
fire flies. Oliver
strikes at the head
of Ferumbras, breaks
1180 away the circle of
his helmet, and the

The cercle, that sate vppoñ his crowñ.
The stroke glode down by his bake,
The Arson he smot ther awaye
And the botelles of bawme withoute lake,
That uppone the grene ther thai laye,
That were trussed by-hynde him faste.
Tho Ferumbras was full woo;
Olyuer' light adowñ in haste,
The botellis he seased both two,

THROWS THEM INTO THE RIVER, BUT HAS HIS HORSE KILLED.

He threwe hem into the River than
As ferr' as he myghte throwe.
“Alas” *quod* Ferumbras “what doistowe, ¹²⁶ manne?
Thou art wode, as I trowe.
Thai were worth an C m^t ponde
To a man, þat were wounded sore.
Ther was no *preciosour* thinge vppoñ grounde,
That myghte helpe a man more.
Thou shalt abyge by Mahounde,
That is a man of myghtes moost.
I shall breke both bake and crowñ
And sle the, ther thou goist.”
Tho Olyuer' worth vp agayñ,
His swerde he hade oute I-drawe.
Ferumbras him smote with mayne
And mente to haue him slawe.
He smote as doth the dinte of pondir;
It glased down by his sheelde
And carfe his stedes neke a-sonder,
That dede he fille in the felde.
Wightly Olyuer' vp-sterter
As Bacheler, doughti of dede,

1184 sword glancing off
down his back, he
cuts off two bottles
of balm,

1188

1192 which he throws into
the river.

1196 Ferumbras tells
him that they were
invaluable to a
wounded man, and that
he

1200

1204 should atone for
their loss with his
life. He strikes at
Oliver, who wards off
the blow with his
shield, but his steed
is killed under him.

¹²⁰⁸

[leaf 30]

1212 Oliver quickly starts
up and tries to kill

With swerde in honde him for to hirte
Or Ferumbras goode stede.
That Ferumbras aspied welle,
He rode a-waye than ful faste
And tiede him to a grene hasel,
And come ayen to him in haste
And saide “nowe yelde the to me!
Thou maiste not longe endure;
And leve on Mahounde, þat is so der’, ¹²⁷
And thy life I shalle the ensure. ¹²⁸
Thou shalt be a Duke in my contr’,
And men haue at thyñ oweñ wille.
To my Sustir shaltowe wedded be,

THEY TAKE BREATH. OLIVER DECLARES HIS NAME.

It were pite the for to spille!”
“Better” quod Olyuer’ “shul we dele,
By God that is in magiste,
And of my strokes shaltow more fele,
Er I to the shalle yelde me.”
Thai smeten togeder with egre mode,
And nathir of othire dradde;
Thai persed her’ hauberkes, that were so goode,
Tille both thayr bodyes bladde.
Thay foughteñ soo longe, þat by assente
Thai drewe hem a litil bysyde,
A litil while thaym to avente,
And refresshed hem at þat tyde.
“Generis” quod Ferumbras,
“As thou arte here gentil knighte,
Telle me nowe here in this place
Of thy kyñ and what thou hight;
Me thenkith by the now evermore,

his adversary’s horse,

1216 but Ferumbras rides
off and ties it to
a hazel. “Yield
1220 thyself to me,” says
Ferumbras; “believe
on Mahound, and I
will make thee a duke
1224 in my country and
give thee my sister.”

¶p036¶

1228 “Ere I yield to
thee,” answered
Oliver, “thou shalt
feel my strokes.”
1232 They fight for a
considerable time;
the blood ran from
both their bodies. By
1236 mutual consent they
stop to take breath.

Ferumbras asks Oliver
1240 again his name and
kin.

Thou shuldist be one of the xij peris,
 That maiste fighte with me so sore,
 And arte so stronge, worthy and fiers.”
 Olyuere answered to hym agayn:
 “For fer’ I leve it not ontoolde,
 My name is Olyuere certayn,
 Cousyn to kynge Charles the boolde,
 To whome I shalle the sende
 Qwikke or dede this same daye,
 By conqueste here in this feelde,
 And make the to renye thy laye.”
 “O” quod Ferumbras than to Olyuer’,
 “Welcome thou arte in-to this place,
 I have desyrede many a yere
 To gyfe the harde grace.
 Thou slough myn uncle Sir Persagyne,
 The doughty kinge of Italye,
 The worthyeste kinge þat lyued of men,

OLIVER RECEIVES A HEAVY BLOW.

By Mahounde, thou shalt aby!”
 Tho thai dongen faste to-geder’
 While the longe day endured,
 Nowe hither’ and nowe thider’;
 Fro strokes wyth sheeldes here bodies þai couered.
 And at the laste Olyuer’ smote him so
 Vppoñ the helme, þat was of stele,
 That his swerde brake in two.
 Tho wepen had he nevere a dele.
 Who was woo but Olyuere than?
 He saugh noone other remedy.
 He saide “sir’, as thou arte gentile man,
 On me nowe here haue mercy.

1244 “Thou must be one
 of the douzepeers,
 as thou fighest so
 well.”
 1248 “I am Oliver, cousin
 to Charlemagne.”
 [leaf 31]
 1252
 1256 “Thou art welcome
 here,” says
 Ferumbras; “thou
 slewest my uncle,
 1260
 now thou shalt pay
 the penalty!” The
 1264 fight continued the
 whole day.
 At last Oliver,
 1268 smiting Ferumbras
 upon the helmet, has
 his sword broken.
 1272

p037

It were grete shame I-wis,
And honour were it noon,

1276

To sle a man wepenles;
That shame wolde never goo.

“Nay traitour, thou getiste noon.

Hade I here an hundred and moo!

[1280](#)

Knele down and yelde the here anon,

And eles here I woole the sloo.”

Olyver saugh, it wolde not be,

To truste to moch in his grace.

1284

He ranne to the stede, þat stode by the tre,

He ran to the steed

A swerde he raught in þat place,

at the tree and

That was trussed on Ferumbras stede,

seized a sword that

Of fyne stele goode and stronge.

1288

was hanging there;

He thought he quyte¹²⁹ Ferumbras his mede.

Almoost hadde he abyde to longe;

For in turnynge Ferumbras him smote,

[leaf 32]

That stroke he myghte welle fele,

1292

but in turning on

It come on hym so hevy and hooote,

Ferumbras he received

That down it made hym to knele.

a blow that made him

Tho was Olyver sore ashamede

kneel down.

And saide “thou cursed Sarasyne,

1296

CHARLES PRAYS TO GOD.

[p038](#)

Thy proude pride shall be atamed,

By God and by seinte Qwyntyne.

Thou hast stole on me that dynte,

I shall quyte the thyñ hire.”

1300

A stroke than Olyver him lente,

But Oliver returns

That hym thought his eyeñ wer on fir.

him fearful stroke.

Kinge Charles in his paviloñ was

Charles, seeing

And loked towarde þat fyghte

1304

Oliver on his knees,

And saugh, howe fiers Ferumbras

Made Olyuere knele dow̄n right.

Wo was him tho in his herte;

To Ihesu Criste he made his mone;

It was a sight of peynes smerte,

That Olyuere kneled so sone:

“O Lord, God in Trinite,

That of myghtis thou arte moost,

By vertue of thy maieste

That alle knoweste and woste,

Lete not this hethen man

Thy seruante ouercome in fyght,

That on the bileve ne kan,

Ihesu, Lorde, for thy myghte!

But graunte thy man the victorye,

And the Paynym̄ skomfited to be,

As thou arte Almyghty God of glorye!

Nowe mekely, Lorde, I pray to the.”

To Charles anoone an Aungel came

And broght him tidingges sone,

That God had herde his praier^l thañ

And graunte him his bone.

Tho Charles thanked God aboue¹³⁰

With herte and thought, worde and dede,

And saide “blessed be thou, lorde almyghty,†

That helpiste thy seruante in nede.”

These Champions to-gedir thai gone

FERUMBRAS BEING WOUNDED CRIES MERCY.

<p039>

With strokes grete and eke sure,

Eche of hem donge othir oñ,

Alle the while thai myghte endur^l.

Ferumbras brake his swerde

On Olyueris helme on hye.

1308 prayed to Christ

1312

1316

that he might grant

1320 the victory over the
Pagan.

1324 An angel announces
him, that his prayer
was heard. Charles
thanks God.

1328

[leaf 33]

1332 They begin again.

Ferumbras breaks his

1336 sword on Oliver's

Tho wexe he ful sore a-ferde;
 He ranne for an othir redyly
 And saide “Olyuere, yelde the to me
 And leve thy Cristeñ laye,
 Thou shalte have alle¹³¹ my kingdome free
 And alle aftir my daye.”
 “Fye, Saresyne” *quod* Olyuere thañ,
 “Trowest thou, that I were wode,
 To forsake him, þat made me mañ
 And boght me with his hert blode.”
 He raught a stroke to Ferumbras,
 On his helme it gan dowñ glyde,
 It brast his hawberke at þat ras
 And carfe hym throughe-oute his syde,
 His bare guttis men myght see;
 The blode faste dowñ ranne.
 “Hoo, Olyvere, I yelde me to the,
 And here I become thy man.
 I am so hurte, I may not stonde,
 I put me alle in thy grace.
 My goddis ben false by water and londe,
 I reneye hem alle here in this place,¹³²
 Baptised nowe wole I be.
 To Ihesu Crist I wole me take,
 That Charles the kinge shal sene,¹³³
 And alle my goddes for-sake.
 Take myn hawberke and do it on the,
 Thou shalte haue full grete nede.

THE SARACENS RUSH OUT OF THE WOOD.

X thousande Saresyns waiten vppoñ me,
 And therefore go take my stede.
 Lay me to-fore the, I the praye,

helmet.
 He runs for another
 and asks Oliver to
 1340 surrender.

 1344

 But Oliver aims at
 1348 Ferumbras a blow
 which cuts his
 hauberk, so
 that his bowels are
 1352 laid bare.
 Ferumbras implores
 his mercy, and

 1356
 consents to be
 christened, his gods
 having proved false.

 1360

 He requested him to
 1364 take his hauberk, to

⟨p040⟩

fetch his horse,
 and to carry him

And lede me to thy tente.
 Hye the faste forth in thy way,
 That the Saresyns the not hente.”
 A-nooñ it was done, as he ordeynede,
 And faste forth thai ryden.¹³⁴
 The Saresyns anone assembled,
 For to haue with hem foghten.
 Ferumbras saugh the feelde thore
 Of Sarsynes fully filled;
 Of Olyvere dradde he ful sore,
 That Saresyns shulde him haue killed.
 He praide, that he wolde let him dowñ
 “Vndir yonde Olyfe tree,
 For if ye cast me dowñ here, with hors shooñ¹³⁵
 Alle to-tredeñ shalle I be.”
 He priked forth and layde him thar’,†
 Out of the horses trase,
 And with his swerde by-gan him wer’,
 For amonge hem alle he was.
 A Saresyñ smote him with a spere,
 That it brake on pecis thre;
 His hauberke myght he not der’,
 So stronge and welle I-wroght was he.
 He hit þat Saresyns with his swerde
 Through the helme in-to the brayne.
 He made an other as sore aferde,
 He smote of his Arme with mayne.
 But thañ come Roulande with Durnedale
 And made way him a-bowte.
 He slowe hem dowñ in the vale,
 Of him hade thai grete dowte.
 The prees of Saresyns was so stronge

1368 to his own tent.
 [leaf 34]

1372 But the Saracens,
 who lay concealed
 in the wood, rush

1376 out. Oliver, being
 surrounded, sets

1380 down Ferumbras under
 an olive-tree, and

1384 defends himself with
 his sword,

1388

dealing the Saracens
 1392 many a hard blow.

Then Roland rushed
 into the throng of
 1396 the enemy and slew
 many;

ROLAND AND OLIVER ARE MADE CAPTIVES.

<p041>

A-boute Roulande that tyde.
 Thai slougheñ his horsys with thronge,
 And dartis throweñ on every syde.
 Whan Roulande was on his Fete,
 Thañ was he woo with-alle.
 Many of hem he felte yete
 And dede to grounde made hem falle.
 At the last his swerde brake,
 Thañ hadde he wepyñ nooñ,
 As he smote a Saresyns bake
 A-sundre dowñ to the Arsoñ.
 Tho was he caught, he myght not flee,
 His hondes thai boundeñ faste
 And lad him forth to here Cite,
 And in depe prisoñ they hem caste.
 Olyuer⁹ sawe, howe he was ladde,
 A sorye mañ thañ was he;
 Him hadde leuer to haue bene dede
 Than suffren that myschief to be.
 Smertly aftire he pursued tho,
 To reskue his dere brother.
 The prees was so grete, he myghte not so,
 It myghte be no othir,
 Be he was cowpe¹³⁶ by verr⁹ force
 With LX of Astopartes.¹³⁷
 Thai hurte him foule and slough his hors
 With gauylokes and wyth dartis.
 Yet on foote, ere he were foolde,
 He slough of hem fiftene.
 He was not slayñ, as god wolde,
 But taken and bounded¹³⁸ with tene.
 Tho were takeñ to Lucafer⁹,

1400 his horse being
 killed by arrows and
 darts,
 1404 he fights on foot,

 1408 but his sword
 breaking, [leaf 35]

 he is taken
 1412 and led away.

 1416

 Oliver rides to
 1420 rescue him,

1424 but his horse being
 also killed,

 1428 he is overpowered
 and bound. Both were
 conducted to Lukafer

The proude kinge of Baldas,
Both Roulande and Olyuer¹.

CHARLES FINDS FERUMBRAS.

Gladde was he of that cas.
Kinge Charles was in herte woo,
When he saughe his neuwes so ladde,
He cried to the Frenshmeñ tho:
“Reskue we these knyghtes at nede.”
The kyng himselfe slough many one,
So dede the Barons bolde.
It wolde not bene, thai were agoñ,
Magre who so woolde.
The Saresyns drewe hem to here Cite,
Kinge Charles turned agayne.
He saugh under an holme tre,
Where a knight him semed lay slayñ.
Thederward he rode with swerde in honde.
Tho he saugh, he was alyve;
He lay walowyng vppon the sonde
With blody woundes fyve.
“What arte thou?” *quod* Charlemayne,
“Who hath the hurte so sore?”
“I am Ferumbras” he saide certayñ,
“That am of hetheñ lore.”
“O fals Saresyñ” *quod* the kinge,
“Thou shalte have sorowe astyle;
By the I haue lost my two Cosynes,
Thyñ hede shalle I of-smyte.”
“O gentil kinge” *quod* Ferumbrase,
“Olyuere my maister me hight
To be Baptised by goddis grace,
And to dyeñ a Cristeñ knyghte.

1432 of Baldas.

[p042](#)

1436 Charles sees them,
and calls for a
rescue. Many enemies

were slain, but the

1440 Saracens had fled
with their prisoners,
and Charles is
obliged to turn back.

1444 Under a holm tree
they find Ferumbras.

1448

[leaf 36]

1452

1456 whom he is going to
put to death.

[1460](#) But on his requesting
to be baptized,

Honor^ʹ were it noon to the
A discourfite man to slo,
That is conuerted and Baptized wolde be
And thy man bycomeñ also.”
The kinge hade pite of him thañ,
He toke him to his grace
And assyned anoon a man

ROLAND AND OLIVER ARE BROUGHT TO THE SOUDAN.

To lede him to his place.
He sende to him his surgyne
To hele his woundes wyde.
He ordeyned to him such medycyn,
That sone myght he go and ryde.
The kinge commaunded bishope Turpyñ
To make a fonte redye,
To Baptise Ferumbras þer in
In the name of god Almyghtye.
He was Cristened in þat welle,
Floreyne the kinge alle him calle,
He forsoke the foule feende of helle
And his fals goddis alle.
Nought for thañ Ferumbras
Alle his life cleped was he,
And aftirwarde in some place,
Floreyne of Rome Cite.
God for him many myracles shewed,
So holy a man he by-came,
That witnessith both lerned and lewde,
The fame of him so ranne.

NOwe for to telle of Roulande
And of Olyuere, that worthy was,¹³⁹
Howe thai were brought to þ^e Sowdañ

1464

Charles took pity

1468

with him,

<p043>

led him to his tent,

and ordered a surgeon

1472

to attend him.

He soon recovered,

1476

and bishop Turpin

1480

baptised him, by the
name of Floreyne.

But he continued to
be called Ferumbras

1484

all his life.

Afterwards he was
known as Floreyne of
Rome

1488

on account of his
holiness.

Roland and Oliver

1492

being brought to
the Soudan, Laban

By the kinge of Boldas.
The Sowdañ hem sore affrayned,
What þat here names were.
Rouland saide and noght alayned:
“Syr Roulande and sire Olyuere,
Nevewes to Kinge Charles of Fraunce,
That worthy kinge and Emperoure,
That nowe are takyn by myschaunce
To be prisoneres here in thy toure.”
“A, Olyuer’, arte thou here?
That haste my sone distroyede,

enquires their names.

1496

They confess their
names.

1500

1504

ROLAND AND OLIVER ARE IMPRISONED.

<p044>

And Rouland that arte his fere,
That so ofte me hath anoyed.
To Mahounde I make a vowe here,
That to morue, ere I do ete,
Ye shulle be slayñ both qwik in fere,
And lives shalle ye bothe lete.”
Tho saide maide Florepas:
“My fader so dereworth and der’,
Ye shulle be avysed of this cas,
How and in what manere
My brothir, þat is to prisoñ take,
May be delyuered by hem nowe,
By cause of these two knightes sake,
That bene in warde here with yow.
Wherefore I counsaile yow, my fader dere,
To have mynde of Sir Ferumbras.
Pute hem in youre prisoñ here,
Tille ye haue better space.
So that ye haue my brother agayñ
For hem, þat ye haue here;

The Soudan swears
they shall both be
executed the next
morning before his
dinner.

1508

1512

But Floripas advises
him to detain them as
hostages, and

1516

1520

to remember his son
Ferumbras,

for whom they might
be exchanged.

1524

And certeyñ elles wole he be slayñ,
 That is to you so lefe and dere.”
 “A, Floripp, I-blessed thou bee,
 Thy counsaile is goode at nede,
 I wolde not leve my sone so free,
 So Mahounde moost me spede,
 For al the Realme of hethen Spayne,
 That is so brode and large.
 Sone clepe forth my gaylour Bretomayne,
 That he of hem hadde his charge,
 “Caste hem in your prisoñ depe,
 Mete and drinke gyfe hem none,
 Chayne hem faste, þat thay not slepe;
 For here goode daies bene a-gone.”
 Tho were thay cast in prison depe¹⁴⁰;

FLORIPAS COMPASSIONATES THEIR SUFFERINGS.

Every tyde the see came inne.
 Thay myght not see, so was it myrke,
 The watir wente to her chynne.
 The salte watir hem greved sore,
 Here woundis sore did smerte.
 Hungir and thurste greved heme yet more,
 It wente yet more nere here herte.
 Who maye live withoute mete?
 vj dayes hadde thay right none,
 Ner drinke that thay myght gete,
 Bute loked vppon the harde stone.
 So on a daye, as God it wolde,
 Floripas to hir garden wente,
 To geder Floures in morne colde.
 Here maydyns from hir she sente,
 For she herde grete lamentacioñ

1528 The Soudan finds her
 counsel good,

[leaf 38]

1532 and orders his gaoler
 Bretomayn to imprison
 them,

1536 but to leave them
 without food.

⟨p045⟩

1540 At high tide the sea
 filled their deep
 cells. They suffered
 much from the salt

1544 water, from their
 wounds, and from
 hunger.

1548 On the sixth day,

1552 Floripas, who was
 gathering flowers in
 her garden, heard
 them lament.

In the Prisoñ, that was ther nye;
 She supposed by ymagynacioñ,
 That it was the prisoners sory.
 She wente her' nerr' to here more,
 Thay wailed for defaute of mete.
 She rued on hem anooñ ful sore,
 She thought, how she myght hem beste it gete.
 She spake to her Maistras Maragounde,
 Howe she wolde the prisoneres fede.
 The develle of helle hir confounde,
 She wolde not assente to þat dede,
 But saide "Damesel, thou arte woode,
 Thy Fadir did vs alle defende,
 Both mete and drinke and othere goode
 That no man shulde hem thider sende."
 Floripe by-thought hir on a gyle
 And cleped Maragounde anoon right,
 To the wyndowe to come a while
 And se ther a wonder syght:
 "Loke oute" she saide "and see a ferr'

FLORIPAS KILLS THE GAOLER.

The Porpais pley as thay were wode."
 Maragounde lokede oute, Floripe come ner'
 And shofed hire oute in to the flode.
 "Go there" she saide "the devel the spede!
 My counsail shaltowe never biwry.
 Who so wole not helpe a mañ at nede,
 On evel deth mote he dye!"
 She toke with hire maidyns two,
 To Britomayne she wente hir waye
 And saide to him, she moste go
 To viseteñ the prisoneris that daye,

1556

1560 Moved to compassion,
 she asks her
 governess Maragound
 to help her in

1564 getting food for the
 prisoners. Maragound
 refuses, and reminds
 Floripas of her

1568 father's command.
 [leaf 39]

Floripas, thinking of
 1572 a trick, called to
 her governess to come
 to a window and

1576 see the porpoises
 sporting beneath.
 Maragound looking
 out, is pushed into

1580 the flood.

1584 Floripas asks
 Bretomayn to let her
 see the prisoners.

<p046>

And saide “sir, for alle loues, Lete me thy prisoneres seeñ.	1588	
I wole the gife both goolde and gloues, And counsail shalle it beeñ.”		
Brytomayne that Iaylor kene Answered to hir sone agayne	1592	
And saide “Damesel, so mote I theñ, Thañ were I worthy to be slayñ.		
Hath not youre Fader charged me, To kepe hem froñ every wyght?	1596	
And yet ye wole these traytours see? I wole goo telle him Anooñ right.”		
He gan to turne him anone for to go, To make a playnte on Floripas.	1600	The gaoler threatened to complain to her father, but Floripas, having seized his
She sued him as faste as she myghte go, For to gif him harde grace.		
With the keye cloge, þat she caught, With goode wille she maute ¹⁴¹ than,	<u>1604</u>	key-clog, dashed out his brains. She
Such a stroke she hym ther’ raught, The brayne sterte oute of his hede þañ.		then went to tell her father, she had
To hire Fader forth she goth And saide “Sire, I telle you here,	1608	surprised [leaf 40] the gaoler feeding the prisoners and
I saugh a sight, that was me loth, Howe the fals Iailour fedde your prisoner’,		

THE SOUDAN GIVES THE PRISONERS INTO HER GUARD.

<p047>

And how the covenante made was, Whan thai shulde delyuered be; Wherefore I slough him with a mace. Dere Fadir, forgif it me!”		promising to deliver
“My doghtir dere, that arte so free, ¹⁴² The warde of hem now gif I the.	1612	them; wherefore she had slain him.
Loke, here sorowe be evere newe,	1616	The Soudan gives the prisoners into her

Tille that Ferumbras delyuered be.”
 She thanked her Fadere fele sithe
 And toke her maydyns, and forth she goth,
 To the prisone she hyed hire swyth.
 The prisoñ dore vp she dothe
 And saide “sires, what be ye,
 That make here this ruly moone?
 What you lakkiþ, tellyth me;
 For we be here nowe alle alone.”
 Tho spake Roulande with hevy chere
 To Floripe, that was bothe gente and fre,
 And saide “lo, we two caytyfes here
 For defaute of mete dede moste be.
 vj dayes be comyñ and gooñ,
 Sith we were loked in prisoñ here,
 That mete nor drinke hade we nooñ
 To comforte with oure hevy cher’.
 But wolde god of myghtes moost,
 The Sowdoñ wolde let vs oute gooñ,
 We to fight with alle his Ooste,
 To be slayñ in feelde anooñ.
 To murthir meñ for defaute of mete,
 It is grete shame tille a kinge;
 For every man most nedes ete,
 Or ellis may he do no thinge.”
 Tho saide Floripe with wordes mylde,
 “I wolde fayne, ye were now here,
 From harme skath¹⁴³ I wole you shelde,

CHARLES DESPATCHES GUY TO THE SOUDAN.

And gife you mete with right gode cher’.”
 A rope to hem she lete dowñ gooñ,
 That aboveñ was teyde faste.

guard.

1620 She now proceeded to
the prison,

1624
asked the prisoners
what they wanted,

1628

1632

1636

[1640](#)

and promised to
1644 protect them from any
harm.

[p048](#)

1648 She let down a rope,
[leaf 41] and drew up

She and hir maydyns drewe þer vppoñ,
 Tille vp thay hadde hem at the last.
 She led hem into here chambir dere,
 That arrayed for hem was right wele,
 Both Roulande and Olyvere,
 And gafe he^m there a right gode mele.
 And whan thay hadde eteñ alle her fille,
 A bath for hem was redy there,
 Ther-to thay went ful fayre and stille,
 And aftyr to bedde with right gode cher'.
 Now Floripas chamber is here prisone,
 Withouteñ wetinge of the Sowdoñ;
 Thai were ful mery in that Dongeoñ,
 For of he^m wiste mañ never oone.
 Now lete we hem be and mery make,
 Tille god sende hem gode delyueraunce.
 Aftir the tyme, þat thay were take,
 What did Charles, the kinge of Fraunce,
 Ther-of wole we speke nowe,
 Howe he cleped forth Sir Gy
 And saide "on my message shaltowe,
 Therefore make the faste redy,
 To bidde the Sowdeñ sende me my Nevewes both
 And the Releques also of Rome;
 Or I shal make him so wroth,
 He sha^{ll} not wete what to done.
 And by þat god, þat hath me wroght,
 I shal him leve Towre ner Towñ.
 This bargañ shal so dere be bought
 In dispite of his god Mahouñ."

DUke Neymes of Bauer' vp stert thañ
 And saide "Sir, hastowe no mynde,
 How the cursed Sowdañ Laban

both, and led them to
 her apartments.

1652

There they ate,

1656

took a bath,

and went to bed.

1660

The Soudan knew
 nothing of his
 prisoners being in
 Floripas' chamber.

1664

1668

Meanwhile Charlemagne
 tells Guy that he
 must go to the
 Soudan to demand the

1672

surrender of Roland
 and Oliver, and of
 the relics of Rome.

1676

Naymes of Bavaria
 represents that a

1680

messenger to the
 Soudan should

Alle messengeris doth he shende?

Ye haue lost inowe, lese no mo

Onworthily Olyuer' and Roulande."

"By god, and thou shalt with him go,

For al thy grete brode londe."

T Ho Ogere Danoys, þat worthy mañ,

"Sir" he saide "be not wroth!

For he saith south."—"go thou thañ!

By Gode thou shalte, be thou never so loth."

A Sire" quod Bery Lardeneyis,

"Thou shalte hem se never more."—

"Go thou forth in this same rees,

Or it shalle the repente ful sore."

F Olk Baliane saide to the kinge,

"Liste ye youre Barons to lese?"—

"Certis, this is a wondir thinge!

Go thou also, thou shalte not chese!"

A Leroyse rose vp anone

And to the kinge þan gañ he speke

And saide "what thinke ye, sir, to done?"—

"Dresse the forth with heñ eke!"

M Iron of Brabane spake an worde

And saide "Sir, thou maiste do þy wille.

Knowist thou not that cruel lorde,

How he wole thy Barons spille?"—

"Trusse the forth eke, sir Dasaberde,

Or I shalle the sone make!

For of all thinge thou arte aferde,

Yet arte thou neyther hurte ner take."

certainly be slain;

and that they ought

1684 to be anxious not to

lose any more besides

Rouland and Oliver.

[leaf 42] Then said

1688 the king, 'By god,

thou shalt go with

Guy.' Ogier the Dane

remonstrates, but is

1692 ordered to go too. So

are Thierry of Ardane

and Folk Balian,

1696

Aleroyis

1700

and Miron of Brabant.

1704

1708

B Isshope Turpyñ kneled adowñ
And saide “lege lorde, mercy!”
The kinge him swore by seynt Symoñ:
“Thou goist eke, make the in hast redye!”

B Ernarde of Spruwse, þat worthy knyght,
Saide “sir, avyse youþ bette,
Set not of youre Barons so light,

THE SOUDAN ASSEMBLES HIS COUNCIL.

Thou maiste haue nede to heñ yette.”—
“Thou shalte gooñ eke for alle thy boost,
Haue done and make the fast yare!
Of my nede gyfe thou no coost,
Ther-of haue thou right no care!”

B Ryer’ of Mountez, þat marqwyz bolde,
Was not aferde to him to speke.
To the kinge sharply he tolde,

His witte was not worth a leke:
“Woltowe for Angre thy Barons sende
To þat Tiraunte, þat alle men sleith?
Or thou doist for þat ende,
To bringe thy xij peres to the deth.”
The kinge was wroth and swore in halle
By him, þat boght him with his blode:
“On my messange shall ye goñ alle!
Be ye never so wroth or wode.”
Thay toke here lefe and forth thay yede,
It availed not agayne him to sayne.
I pray, god gif hem gode spede!
Ful harde it was to comeñ agayñ.

Bishop Turpin kneels

1712 down to implore the
king’s mercy, but he
must go too,
as well as Bernard of
1716 Spruwse

1720

and Brier of
1724 Mountdidier.

[leaf 43]

1728

1732

The knights take
1736 leave and start.

⟨p050⟩

Nowe let hem passe in goddis name,
 And speke we of the Sowdoñ,
 Howe he complayned him of his grame,
 And what that he myght beste done.
 “Sortybraunnce and Bronlande¹⁴⁴” seyde he,
 “Of counsail ye be fulle wyse.
 How shal I do to avenge me
 Of kinge Charles, and in what wyse?
 He brennyth my Toures and my Citees,
 And Burges he levethe me never ooñ.
 He stroieth my meñ, my londe, my fees.
 Thus shalle it not longe gooñ.
 And yet me greveth most of alle,
 He hath made Ferumbras renay his laye.

1740 The Soudan assembled
his council.

Sortibrance and
1744 Brouland

1748

1752

HE DESPATCHES XII MESSENGERS TO CHARLES.

<p051>

Therefore my counselors I calle,
 To remedy this, howe thay best maye.
 For me were lever that he were slayñ,
 Thane he a Cristeñ hounde shulde be,
 Or with Wolfes be rente and slayñ,
 By Mahounde myghty of dignyte.”
 To answerde Sortybraunce and Broulande
 And saide “gode counsaile we shal you gyfeñ,
 If thoue wylte do aftyr covenante,
 It shal you profit, while you lyveñ.
 Take xij knightis of worthy dede
 And sende hem to Charles on message nowe.
 A-aye hem welle in roial wede,
 For thy honour and for thy prowē.
 Bidde Charles sende thy sone to the
 And voyde thy londe in alle haste,
 Or ellis thou shalt him honge on a tre,

1756

advise him

1760

to send 12 knights,

1764 and to bid Charles

[leaf 44]

to give up Ferumbras

1768 and to withdraw from
his country.

As hye, as any shippes maste.”

“Nowe by Mahounde” *quod* Laban,

“This counseil is both trewe and goode,

1772

I shalle him leve for no mañ

To parforme this, though he wer’ woode.”

He did his lettris write in haste,

The knightes were called to goo *per*with,

1776 The knights are
dispatched.

That thay hyze he^m to Charles faste

And charke¹⁴⁵ hy^m vppoñ life and lithe.

Forth thai ride towarde Mantrible pañ,

In a medowe, was fayre and grene,

1780 Near Mantrible
they meet with the
Christian messengers.
Duke Naymes inquires

Thai mette with Charles messengeris teñ.

Duke Neymes axed he^m, what thai wolde mene,

And saide “Lordynges, whens come ye?

And whider ye are mente, telle vs this tyde.”

1784 whither they intend
to go.

“From the worthy Sowdoñ” thañ saide he,

“To Charles on message shalle we ride,

THE PEERS KILL THE SOUDAN’S MESSENGERS.

<p052>

Euel tithyngges we shalle him telle,

Fro Laban, that is lorde of Spayne.

1788

Farewele, felowes, we may not dwelle.”

“A-byde” *quod* Gy “and turne agayne,

Having heard their
message,

We wole speke with you, er ye gooñ,

For we be messengeris of his.

1792

Ye shal aby everichone,

So God brynge me to blis.”

Anooñ here swerdes oute thay brayde

And smoteñ dowñ right al a-boute.

1796

Tille the hetheñ were dowñ layde,

Thai reseyued many a sore cloute.

Thai smyteñ of here hedes alle,

the delegates of

Eche mañ toke one in his lappe.

1800 Charles cut off their

Fal what so euer byfalle,
 To the Soudoñ wole they trappe.
 Tille thai come to Egremoure,
 Thai stynte for no worlde thinge;
 Anone thai fonde the Sawdañ thore,
 At his mete proudly sittynge,
 And þat maide fair⁹ Dame Floripas
 And xiiij princes of grete price
 And kinge Lukafer⁹ of Baldas,
 Thas was both bolde, hardy and wyse.
 Doughty Duke Neymes of Bauer⁹
 To the Sowdone his message tolde
 And saide “god, þat made heven^ñ so cler⁹,
 He saue kinge Charles so bolde
 And confounde Laba^ñ and all his me^ñ,
 That on Mahounde byleved¹⁴⁶
 And gife hem evel endinge! ame^ñ.
 To morue, longe er it be eve^ñ,
 He commaundith the vppo^ñ thy life
 His Nevewes home to him sende,
 And the Religes¹⁴⁷ of Rome withoute strife;

THE PEERS ARE IMPRISONED IN FLORIPAS' TOWER.

And ellis getist thou an evel ende!
 xij lurdeynes mette vs on the waye;
 Thai saide, thay come streight fro the.
 Thai made it both stoute and gay;
 Here hed^{is} here maistowe see.
 Thai saide, thai wolde to Charles goo^ñ,
 Evel tidingges him to telle.
 Loo here here heddis euerychone,
 Here soulis bene in helle.”
 “O” quod Lavane “what may this be,

heads, which they
 take with them to
 present to the Soudan
 at Agremore.

1804

[leaf 45] The Soudan
 was just dining.

1808

Naymes delivers
 his message: ‘God
 confound Laban and
 all his Saracens, and
 save Charles,

1816

who commands thee
 to send back his
 two nephews and to
 restore the relics.’

1820

1824

They then produce the
 heads of the Soudan’s
 messengers.

1828

⟨p053⟩

To suffr' this amonge my knightes alle?
 To be rebuked thus here of the
 At mete in myn oweñ halle!
 To Mahounde myghty I make a vowe,
 Ye shall be hanged alle ten,
 Anoon as I have eteñ I-nowe,
 In presence of alle my meñ.”
 Maide Floripas answered tho
 And saide “my derworth Fadir der’!
 By my counsaile ye shal not so,
 Tille ye haue your Barons alle in fer’,
 That thai may se what is the best,
 For to delyuer e my brother Sir Ferumbras.
 And aftirward, if þat ye liste,
 Ye may gife hem ful evel grace.”
 “Gramercy, doghter, thou saieste welle,
 Take hem alle into thy warde.
 Do feter hem faste in Ireñ and stele
 And set hem in stray3te garde.
 Thus was I neuer rebukede er nowē;
 Mahounde myghty gyfe heñ sorowe!
 Thay shalle be flayn and honged on a bowe,
 Longe ere tyme¹⁴⁸ to morowe.”
 Floriþ toke these messangeris
 And ladde hem vp in-to here tour’,

FLORIPAS ENQUIRES AFTER GUY.

There thai founde two of here feris.
 Thay thanked thereof god of honoure.
 Tho sayde Duke Neymys of Bauer’:
 “Gladde men we be nowē here,
 To fynde Roulande and Olyuer’
 In helthe of bodye and of goode cher’.”

1832 The Soudan vowed
 a vow that they
 should all ten be
 1836 hanged as soon as
 he had finished
 his dinner. But
 Floripas recommended
 1840 him to put off his
 resolution, until
 a general council
 of his barons had
 1844 determined on the
 best way of the
 liberation of
 Ferumbras. [leaf 46]
 1848 The Soudan gives them
 into her guard.
 1852
 Floripas leads the
 knights into her
 1856 tower, where
 they were glad to
 find Roland and
 Oliver.
 1860

<p054>

Thai kissed eche other with herte gladde
 And thanked god of his grace;
 And eche toolde othir, howe thay sped hadde,
 And howe thay come in-to that place
 By helpe of mayde Floriṑ hire self,
 “God kepe hir in honoure!
 For thus hath she brought vs hider alle twelfe,
 To dwelle in hir oweñ boure.”
 Tho thay wessh and wente to mete,
 And were served welle and fyne
 Of suche goode, as she myght gete,
 Of Venysoñ, brede and gode wyne.
 There thai were gladde and wel at ease;
 The Soudoñ ne wist it noght.
 Aftyr thay slepe and toke her ese,
 Of no man thañ thay ne roght.
 On the morowe Floriṑ, that mayde fre,
 To Duke Neymes spake in game:
 “Sir gentil knight,” tho saide she,
 “Telle me, what is your name.”
 “Whi axe ye, my lady dere,
 My name here to knowe alle?”
 “For he¹⁴⁹ spake with so bolde chere
 To my Fadir yestirdaye in his halle.
 Be not ye the Duke of Burgoyne, sir Gȳ,
 Nevewe unto the kinge Charles so fre?”
 “Noe, certes, lady, it is not I,
 It is yondir knight, þat ye may see.”
 “A, him have I loved many a day;

GUY CONSENTS TO TAKE HER FOR HIS WIFE.

And yet knowe I him noght.
 For his loue I do alle that I maye,

1864

They told each other
how they had fared.

1868

After washing,

1872

they dined off

1876

venison, bread and
wine, and then
went to sleep. The
following day,

1880

Floripas asks Naymes
his name,

1884

and enquires after

1888

[leaf 47] Guy of
Burgundy, whom she
had loved for a long
time, and for

⟨p055⟩

1892

whom she would do all
she could for their

To chere yow with dede and thought.	benefit, and would be
For his love wille I cristenede be	baptised,
And lefe Mahoundes laye.	1896
Spekith to him nowe for me,	
As I yow truste maye;	
And but he wole graunte me his loue,	if he would agree to
Of yow askape shalle none here.	1900 love her in return.
By him, þat is almyghty aboue,	
Ye shalle abyte it ellis ful dere.”	
Tho wente Duke Neymes to Sir Gye	
And saide “This ladye loveth the,	1904 Naymes tells Guy
For thy loue she maketh us alle merye,	
And Baptizede wole she be.	
Ye shalle hir take to your wedded wife,	to take her for his
For alle vs she may saue.”	1908 wife,
“By God” quod Gye “þat gafe me life,	But Guy refuses,
Hire wole I never haue,	
Wyle I neuer take hire ner no womaṅ,	as he never will take
But Charles the kinge hir me gife.	1912 a wife, unless she be
I hight him, as I was trewe maṅ,	
To holdeṅ it, while I lyve.”	given him by Charles.
Tho spake Roulande and Olyuer,	Rouland and Oliver
Certyfyinge him of her’ myschefe,	1916 persuaded him,
Tellinge him of the paretles, þat þay in wer’,	
For to take this lady to his wedded wife.	
“But thou’ helpe in this nede,	
We be here in grete doute.	1920
Almyghty god shalle quyte thy mede,	
Elles come we nevere hennys oute.”	
Thus thay treted him to and fro;	
At the laste he sayde, he wolde.	1924 so that he at last
Floripas thay cleped forth tho;	consented.
And brought fourth a Cuppe of golde,	Floripas, holding a

Ful of noble myghty wyne,

golden cup of wine,

LUKA FER VISITS THE PRISONERS.

p056

And saide “my loue and my lorde,
Myn herte, my body, my goode is thyñ,”
And kissed him with that worde,
And “sir” she saide “drinke to me,
As the Gyse is of my londe;
And I shalle drinke agayñ to the,
As to my worthy hosbonde.”
Thay clipped and kissed both in fere
And made grete Joye and game,
And so did alle, that were ther’,
Thai made ful mery alle in same.
Tho spake Floripas to the Barons boolde
And saide “I haue armur’ I-nowe;
Therefore I tel you, what I wolde,
And þat ye dide for your prowē.
To morue, whañ my Fadir is at his souper’,
Ye shalle come in alle attonys;
Loke ye spare for no fere,
Sle down and breke both bake and bones;
Kithe you knightis of hardynesse!
Ther is none helpe, but in this wyse,
Then moste ye sheweñ youre prowes,
And wyne this Castel in this guyse.”
Thai sayden alle, it was welle saide,
And gladde thay were of this counsaile.
Here armur’ was forth layde,
At souper the Sowdoñ to assaile.
Kinge Lucafere prayde the Sawdoñ,
That he wolde gif him lysence,
To the prisoners for to gooñ,

1928 [leaf 48]

kissed him, and

requested him to

1932 drink to her after

the fashion of her

country. She also

drinks to him. They

1936 all make merry.

1940

For the following day

1944

1948

1952

they all prepare to

assail the Soudan at

supper. Lukafer comes

1956 to the Soudan and

asks leave to see the

To see the maner of her presence.
 He gaf him lefe, and forth he wente
 Vp vnto Floripas Toure.
 To asspie the maner was his entent^t,
 He^m to accuse agayne honoure.
 Whaⁿ he come, he founde the dore fast I-stoke,

HE TEACHES THEM A NEW GAME.

He smote there-on with his fist,
 That the barr^r begaⁿ to broke.
 To make debate, wel him list.
 “Who artowe” quod Floripas¹⁵⁰
 “Pat maketh her^r such araye^t?”
 “I am kinge Lucafere of Baldas,
 The Sowdoⁿ sente me hidir in faye;
 To seeⁿ his prisoneris is my desire
 And speke with hem everychoⁿ,
 To talke with hem by the fire
 And speke of dedis of Armes amonge.”
 Tho saide Duke Neymes “welcome be ye
 To us prisoners here!
 What is your wille, nowe telle ye;
 For we be meⁿ of feble chere.”
 “I wolde wete of Charles the kinge,
 What maⁿ he is in his contre,
 And what meyne he hath, and of what thinge
 He rekyneth moost his dignyte.”
 Duke Neymes saide “an Emperoure
 And kinge he is of many a londe,
 Of Citeis, Castels, and many a Toure,
 Dukes, Erles, Barons bowynge to his honde.”
 “But saye me, felowe, what is your vse,
 To do in contr^r aftyr the none.

prisoners, in order
 to know the manner of
 their detention.

1960

Finding the door
 locked, he burst it

<p057>

1964

open with a blow of
 his fist.

1968

[leaf 49]

1972

He told them that he
 was come to speak to
 them,

1976

and to enquire after

1980

Charlemagne.

Duke Naymes answers.

1984

1988

He then asks what

And what is the custome of your hous,
 Tille meñ to souper shalle gone?”
 “Sir, *somme meñ iouste*¹⁵¹ with sper’ and shelde,
 And *somme meñ* Carol and singe gode songes,
 Some shote with dartis in the feelde,
 And *somme* play at Chesse amonge.”
 “Ye bene but foulis of gode dissporte;
 I wole youw tech a newe play.
 Sitte dowñ here by one assorté,

LUKA FER IS ROASTED TO CHARCOAL.

And better myrthe never ye saye.”
 He teyde a tredde on a pole
 With an nedil ther-on I-fest,
 And ther vppoñ a qwik’ cole.
 He bade every man blowe his blast.
 Duke Neymes hade a long berde,
 Kinge Lucafer’ blewe even to hyñ,
 That game hade he never before lered.
 He brent the her’ of Neymes berde to the skyne.
 Duke Neymes thañ gan wex wroth,
 For he hade brente his berde so white
 To the Chymneye forth he goth
 And caught a bronde him with to smyte.
 With a goode wille he him smote,
 That both his eyeñ bresteñ oute.
 He caste him in the fire al hote;
 For sothe he hadde a right gode cloute.
 And with a fyre forke he helde him doune,
 Tille he were rosted to colis ilkadele.
 His soule hade his god Mahouñ.
 Florip bade hiñ warme him wele.
 “Sires” tho saide Floripas,

amusements they have
 after dinner. Naymes
 says, ‘Some joust,
 some sing, some play
 at chess.’

1992

‘I will teach you
 a new game,’ says
 Lukafer.

1996

<p058>

2000

With a thread he
 fastened a needle
 on a pole and put a
 burning coal upon it.
 He blew it at

2004

Naymes’s beard and
 burnt it. Naymes
 waxed wroth, and
 snatching a burning

2008

[leaf 50] brand from
 the fire he smites at
 Lukafer and throws
 him into the fire,

2012

2016

where he was roasted
 to charcoal. Floripas
 applauds this,

“Entendith nowe al to me!
 This Lucafer^o of Baldas
 Was a lorde of grete mayne.
 My Fadir hade him euer yn cher^o
 I telle you for sothe everydele,
 He wolde anoon^e aftyr him enquer^o,
 And therefore loke, ye arme you weH!”
 Florip wente in, as the maner was,
 To here Fadir at souper tyme.
 No man spake worde of kinge Baldas,
 Ner no man knewe of his sharp pyne.
 The xij peris armed hem wel and fyne
 With swerdes drawe and egr^o chere.
 While thay mery¹⁵² drinkyng^o the wyne

2020

2024

but points out their
 danger, and advises
 them to arm. At

2028

supper time she goes
 to her father.

2032

THE PEERS TURN THE SARACENS OUT OF THE CASTLE.

<p059>

And sittinge alle at here souper^o.
 Thai reheted the Sowdoñ and his Barons alle
 And madeñ orders wondir fast,
 Thai slowe dowñ alle, þat were in the halle,
 And made hem wondirly sore a-gast.
 Olyvere egerly sued Labañ
 With swerd I-drawe in his honde.
 Oute at the wyndowe lepte he þañ
 Vppoñ the salte see stronde,¹⁵³
 And he skaped away froñ hime,
 But woo was he þefore,
 That he went awaye with lyñ
 To worche hem sorowe more.
 Roulande thañ came rennyng
 And axed, where was Laban.
 Olyuere answerede moornynge
 And saide, howe he was agoon^e.

2036

As they were sitting
 at table, the twelve
 peers rushed in and
 slew all whom they
 met.

2040

Laban, pursued by
 Oliver, jumps out of
 a window on to the
 sea-shore and escaped

2044

without injury.

2048

[leaf 51]

Tho thai voided the Courtes at the last
 And sloweñ tho, that wolde a-byde,
 And drewe the brigge and teyed it fast,
 And shitte the gatis, that were so wyde.
 Laban, that by the ebbe escapede,
 Of harde, er he come to londe,
 He alle astonyed and a-mapide, ¹⁵⁴
 For sorowe he wronge both his honde
 And made a vowe to Mahounde of myght,
 He wolde that Cite wyne
 And never go thens by day nor nyght,
 For foo, for frende, ner for kynne.
 “And tho traytouris will I do honge,
 On a Galowes hye with-oute the gate;
 And my Doghter, þat hore stronge,
 I-brente shal be there-ate.”
 To mauntryble he gan sende anooñ
 Aftir men and tentis goode,

THE SOUDAN BESIEGES THE CASTLE.

And Engynes to throwe with stooñ
 And goode armur^l many foolde.
 The sege he did leyn a-bowte
 On every side of that Cite.
 To wallis with Engynes thai gan rowte,
 To breke the Toures so fre.
 Tho saide Florip̄, “lordingges goode,
 Ye bene biseged in this toure,
 As ye bene wight of mayne and moode,
 Proveth here to saue youre honour^l.
 The toure is stronge, drede you^l nought,
 And vitayle we have plente.
 Charles wole not leve you^l vnsought;

They killed all in
 2052 the castle, and then
 drew up the bridges
 and shut the gates.

2056

Laban vowed a vow
 2060

2064 that he would hang
 them all and burn his
 daughter. He sent to
 Mantribe for troops
 2068 and

p060.

engines,

and besieged Agremore.

2072

Floripas recommends
 2076 the peers

2080

Truste ye welle alle to me.

Therefore go we soupe and make merye,

And takith ye alle your ease;

And xxx^{ti} maydens lo here of Assyne, [155](#)

The fayrest of hem ye chese.

Take your sporte, and kith yow knyghtes,

Whan ye shalle haue to done;

For to morowe, when the day is light,

Ye mooste to the wallis gooñ

And defende this place with caste of stooñ

And with shotte of quarelles and darte.

My maydyns and I sha^{ll} bringe goode wone,

So eueryche of us shalle bere hir parte.”

On morowe the Sowdoñ made assaute

To hem, that were with-Inne,

And certes in hem was no defaute,

For of he^m myght thay nought wyne.

Here shotte, here cast was so harde,

Thay durste not nyzhe the walle.

Thay droweñ hem bakwarde,

Thay were beten over alle.

King Labañ turnede to his tentes agayñ,

to enjoy themselves.

2084

2088

[leaf 52]

2092

2096

In the morning the

soudan attacks the
castle,

2100

but is repulsed.

He was nere wode for tene,	2104	
He cryede to Mahounde and Apolyne		He accuses his gods
And to Termagaunte, þat was so kene,		of sleepiness, and
And saide “ye goddes, ye slepe to longe,		shakes them to wake
Awake and helpe me nowe,	2108	up.
Or ellis I may singe of sorowe a songe,		
And of mournynge right I-nowe.		
Wete ye not wele, that my tresoure		
Is alle with-inne the walle?	2112	
Helpe me nowe, I saye therfore,		
Or ellis I forsake you alle.”		
He made grete lamentacioñ,		
His goddis byganne to shake.	2116	
Yet that comfortede his meditacioñ,		
Supposinge thay didde awake.		
He cleped Brenlande to aske counsaile,		
What was beste to done,	2120	
And what thinge myght hiṁ moste awayle,		
To wynne the Cite sone.		
“Thou wotist welle, þat alle my tresour		
Is there in here kepinge,	2124	
And my doughter, þat stronge hore,		
God yif her evelle endyng!”		
“Sir” he saide “ye knowe welle,		[leaf 53] Brouland
That Toure is wondir stronge.	2128	tells him, as the
While þay haue vitayle to mele,		castle is strong and
Kepeñ it thay wole fulle longe.		well stored with
Sende to Mauntreble, your cheif Cite,		provisions, the peers
That is the keye of this londe,	2132	will hold it very
That noñ passe, where it so be,		long;
With-oute youre speciall sonde,		but if he would send
To Alagolofur, þat geaunte stronge,		orders to Alagolafre,

That is wardeyne of þat pas,
That no man passe that brigge alonge,
But he have special grace.
So shalle not Charles with his meyne

ESPIARD IS DESPATCHED TO MANTRIBLE.

Reskowe thañ Agramoure.
Thañ thay shalle enfamyched be,
That shalle hem rewe ful sore.”—
“Mahoundis blessynge have thou and myne,
Sortybraunce, for thy rede.”—
“Espyarde, messenger myne,
In haste thou most the spede
To my Cite Mavntreble,
To do my message there,
To Alogolofr’, þat giaunte horrible.
Bydde him his charge wele lere,
And tel him, howe that the last daye
Ten fals traytours of Fraunce
Passed by that same waye
By his defaute with myschaunce,
Charginge him vppoñ his hede to lese,
That no man by the brigge,¹⁵⁶
Be it rayne, snowe or freze,
But he his heede dowñ ligge.”
Espiarde spedde him in his waye,
Tille he to Mauntribe came,
To seke the geaunte, ther he laye
On the banke bysyde the Dame,
And saide “the worthy Sowdoñ,
That of alle Spayñ is lorde and sir’,
Vppoñ thy life commaundeth the anooñ,
To deserue better thyn hire.

2136 the bridge-keeper at
Mantribe, not to
allow any one to pass
without leave,

<p062>

2140 they would get no
assistance from
Charles, and die from
hunger.

2144 Espiard is despatched
to Mantribe,

2148

2152

2156

2160

2164 and commands the giant

The laste day thou letist here passe
Ten trauoures of douse Fraunce. 2168

God giffe the evel grace,
And heȝ also moche myschaunce!
He charged the vppoȝ life and deth,
To kepe this place sikerlye; 2172
While in thy body lasteth the breth,
Lette nooȝ enemye passe ther-bye.”
not to suffer any one
to pass the bridge.

ALAGOLAFRE BARRICADES THE BRIDGE.

p063

Alagolofur rolled his yeȝ
And smote with his axe oȝ the stone 2176
And swore by Termagante and Apolyne,

That ther-by shulde passen never one,
But if he smote of his hede,
And brought it to his lorde Labaȝ,
He wolde never ete no brede,
Nere never loke more on maȝ.

xxiiij^{ti} Cheynes he didde ouer-drawe,
That noo man passe myght, 2184
Neyther for loue nere for awe,
No tyme by daye, nere by nyghte.

“Go, telle my lorde, I shalle it kepe;
On payne of my grete heede 2188
Shalle ther no maȝ goo ner crepe,
But he be take or dede.”

This geaunte hade a body longe
And hede, like an libarde. 2192

Ther-to he was devely stronge,
His skynne was blake and harde.
Of Ethiope he was bore,
Of the kinde of Ascopartes. 2196
He hade tuskes, like a bore,

An hede, like a liberde.
Laban nolde not forgete
The saute to renewe,¹⁵⁷
To wynne the Toure, he wolde not lete.
Here trumpes lowde thay blewe.
Every man wente to the walle,
With pikeys or with bowe.
Thai made assaute generale,
The walles downe to throwe.
But thay with-inne bare he^m soo,
Thay slowe of the Saresyns iij hundred^l.
Thay wroghteⁿ hem both care and woo,

MAVON BATTERS THE CASTLE.

Vppoⁿ her fightinge thay wondride.
Tho cryed Labaⁿ to hem on hye,
“Traytours, yelde you^l to me,
Ye shall be hongede els by and bye
Vppoⁿ an hye Galowe tree.”
Tho spake Flori^p to the Sowdoⁿ
And sayde “thou fals tyraunte,
Were Charles come, thy pride wer^l done
Nowe, cursede myscreaunte.
Alas! that thou ascapediste soo
By the wyndowe vppoⁿ the stronde.
That thy nek^l hade broke a-twoo!
God sende the shame and shonde!”—
“A! stronge hore, god gife the sorowe!
Tho[u] venemouse serpente.
Withe wilde horses¹⁵⁸ thou^l shalt be drawe to
 morowe,
And on this hille be brente,
That al men may be war^l by the,

2200 The soudan assaults
the castle again,

2204 [leaf 55]

2208 but the 12 peers slay
300 Saracens.

2212 Laban threatens to
hang them, and utters
imprecations

2216

against Floripas, who
returns them.

2220

2224

<p064>

That cursed bene of kynde.
And thy love shalle honged be,
His hondes bounde him byhynde.”
He called forth Mavoñ, his Engynour’,
And saide “I charge the,
To throwe a magnelle to yon tour’,
And breke it downe on thre.”
Mavon set vp his engyne
With a stooñ of .vj. C wight,
That wente as eveñ as eny lyne,
And smote a cornell dowñ right.
Woo was Roulande and Olyuer’,
That þat myschief was be-falle,
And so were alle the xij peres;
But Floriþ thañ comforte hem alle:
“Sires” she saide “beith of goode chere!
This Toure is stronge I-nowe.

MARSEDAGE IS KILLED AND BURIED.

He may cast twies or thries or he hit ayen þer, ¹⁵⁹
For sothe I telle it you.”
Marsedage, the roialle kinge,
Rode in riche weede,
Fro Barbary com myng,
Vppoñ a sturdy stede,
Cryinge to hem vppoñ the walle:
“Traytouris, yelde you here!
Brenne you alle ellis I shalle,
By myghty god Iubyter’.”
Gy aspied, that he came ner’,
A darte to hime he threwe ful eveñ,
He smote him throwe herte & liver in fer’.
Dame Floripe lough with loude steveñ

2228

The soudan calls for
2232 Mavon, his engineer,
and orders him to
direct a mangonel
against the walls.

2236 Mavon knocked down
a piece of the
battlements.

2240 Roland and Oliver
lament; they are
comforted by Floripas.

2244

⟨p065⟩

[leaf 56]

2248

2252

Guy kills Marsedage
2256 the king of Barbary,
by throwing a dart at
him.

And saide “Sir Gye, my loue so free,
Thou kanste welle hit the prikke. 2260

He shall make no booste in his contre;
God giffe him sorowe thikke!”

Whañ Labañ herde of this myschief,
A sory mañ was he.

He trumped, his mene to relefe;
For to cease that tyme mente he.

Mersadage, kinge of Barbarye,
He did carye to his tente,

And beryed him by right of Sarsenye
With brennynge fire and riche oynement,
And songe the Dirige of Alkaroñ,

That bibill is of here laye,

And wayled his deth everychoñ,
vij nyghtis and vij dayes.

Anooṇ the Sowdoṇ, south to say,

Sente iij hundrid of knightis,

To kepe the brigge and the waye

Oute of that Castil rightis,

FLORIPAS PRODUCES A MAGIC GIRDLE.

To feche vitayle by no waye.

He charged hem to wacche wel aH abowte,
That thay for-famelid^l myght dye.

Thus thay kepte the place vij dayes,

Tille alle hire vitaile was nyze spente.

The yates thai pas the streyte weyes.

Tho helde thai hem with-in I-shente.

Tho spake Roulande with hevy chere

Woordes lamentable,

Whaⁿ he saugh the ladies so whi³te of ler³,

Faile brede on here table,
 And saide “Charles, thou curteys kinge,
 Why forgetist thou vs so longe?
 This is to me a wondir thinge;
 Me thinkith, thou doiste vs grete wronge,
 To let vs dye for faute of mete,
 Closed thus in a dongeoñ.
 To morowe wol we asaye what we koñ gete,
 By god, that berithe the crowñ.”
 Tho saide Floripas “sires, drede noghte
 For nooñ houngr^l that may befall.
 I knowe a medycyne in my thoughte
 To comforte you with alle.
 I have a girdil in my Forcer^l,
 Who so girde he^m ther-with aboute,
 Hunger ner thirste shal him neuer dere,
 Though he were vij yere with-oute.”
 “O” quod Sir Gy “my loue so trewe,
 I-blessed mote ye be!
 I pray you, that ye wole us alle hit shewe,
 That we may haue oure saule.”
 She yede and set it forth anooñ,
 Thai proved alle the vertue,
 And diden it aboute he^m euerychoñ.
 It comforted alle both moo and fewe,
 As thai hade bene at a feste.

MAPYN ENTERS FLORIPAS’ CHAMBER.

So were thay alle wele at ease,
 Thus were thai refresshed both moost & lest
 And weren bifore in grete disese.
 Labañ wondred, how thai myght endur^l
 With-outeñ vitaile so longe.

Roland complains
 of Charles’s
 forgetfulness;
 2292
 2296
 but Floripas cheers
 him up,
 2300
 saying she possessed
 a magic girdle which
 was a talisman
 against hunger and
 thirst for those who
 wore it.
 2308
 2312 They all successively
 put it on and felt as
 if they had feasted.

2316

2320 Laban wondered at

p067

He remembred him on Floripas senctur',
 And of the vertue so stronge.
 Tho wiste he welle, that throgħ famyne
 Might he heȝ never wyne.
 He cleped to him fals Mapyne,
 For he coude many a fals gynne:
 He coude scale Castel and Toure
 And over the walles wende.
 "Mapyne" he saide "for myȝ honoure,
 Thou mooste haue this in mynde:
 That hore, my doghter, a girdil hath she,
 Froȝ hounger it savyth heȝ alle,
 That wonnen may thay never be,
 That foule mote hir bifalle!
 Kanstowe gete me that gyrdill by craft,
 A thousande ponde thaȝ shal I gefe the;
 So that it be there not lefte,¹⁶⁰
 But bringe it hithir' to me.
 Thouȝ kanste see by nyghte as welle
 As any man doth by daye.
 Whan thay bene in here beddes ful stiȝ,
 Than go forth thider right in thy waye.
 Thou shalt it in here Chamber fynde,
 Thou maist be thereofe sure."
 "Sir, there-to I wole me bynde,
 If my life may endure."
 Forth wente this fals Mapyne
 By nyght into the Tour'—
 God gife him evel endinge!—
 Euen in to Floripas bour'.

their endurance, but
 at last remembering
 the girdle, [leaf 58]

2324

he induced Mapyne

2328

2332

to attempt to steal
 it at night.

2336

2340

2344

2348

Mapyne entered the
 chamber of Floripas
 through

By a Chemney he wente inne;

Fulle stilly there he soughte it.
 He it founde and girde it aboute him,
 And aftyr ful dere he boght it;
 For by the light of a lampe ther'
 Floripas gañ him aspye,
 Alle a-frayed oute of hir slepe for fere,
 But lowde than gan she crye
 And saide "a thefe is in my boure,
 Robbe me he wole or sloo."
 Ther-with come Rouland fro his tour'
 To wete of hir woo.
 He founde Mapyne bysyde hir bedde,
 Standinge amased for drede,
 To the wyndowe he him ladde,¹⁶¹
 And there he smote of his hedde,
 And caste him oute in-to the see.
 Of the gyrdille was he not war';
 But whañ he wist, the girdel hade he,
 Tho hadde he sorowe and care.
 Floripe to the Chestre wente
 And aspyed, hire gyrdel was gooñ,
 "Alas!" she saide, "alle is it shente!
 Sir, what haue ye done?
 He hath my girdel aboute hyñ.
 Alas! þat harde while!
 A rebelle hounde doth ofte grete tene;
 Howe be we alle begilede."
 Tho spake Roulande with cher' boolde,
 "Dameselle! beyth noughte aferde!
 If any vitaille be aboute this hoolde,
 We wole hem wynne withe dinte of swerde
 To morowe wole wee oute-gooñ
 And assaye, howe it wole it be.

2352 a chimney;

 he finds the girdle
 and puts it on,
 2356 but Floripas
 perceives him
 and cries out.

2360 Roland hurries to her
 assistance, [leaf 59]

 2364
 cuts off Mapine's
 head, and throws
 2368 him out through
 the window without
 noticing the girdle.
 Floripas, seeing her
 2372 girdle lost, is much
 grieved;

 2376

 2380 Roland comforts her.

 They agree to attempt
 2384 a sally to obtain

I make a vowe to god alone,

food.

THE PEERS, SURPRISING THE SARACENS, OBTAIN PROVISIONS.

[p069](#)

Assaile hem wole we!

And if thay haue any mete,

Parte withe he^m wole we.

2388

Or elles strokes thay shal gete

By God and seynte Mary myⁿ avour'!"¹⁶²

In the morne, er the larke songe,

In the morning

Thai ordeynede hem to ride

2392

To the Saresyns, þat hade so longe

Leyen hem besyde.

Duke Neymes and Oger'

Naymes and Ogier

Were ordeynede to kepe the place.

[2396](#)

remain in the castle,

The x othir of the xij peres

the others start

Wente oute to assaye here grace.

Thay foundeⁿ hem in logges slepynge,

and surprise the

Of hem hade thay no thought.

2400

Saracens still

Thai sloweⁿ downⁿ þat came to honde,

sleeping in their

Mahounde availed hem noghte.

huts. [leaf 60]

In shorte tyme the ende was made,

Thay ten slough iij hundred ther'.

2404

They slew 300 and

Tho founde thai vitaile, thay were glad,

carried off as much

As moche as thay myghte home ber'.

food as they could

Duke Neymes and Oger', that kept the tour',

bear.

Say hem with here praye.

2408

Thai thanked god hye of honoure,

That thai spedde so þat day.

Thay aualed the brigge and lete him yn,

Flori^p and here maydyns were gladde,

2412

And so were thay, that were with-yn;

For alle grete hounger thay hadde.

Thai eteⁿ and dronken right I-nowe

And made myrth ever amonge. 2416

But of the Sowdoñ laban speke we nowe,
Howe of sorowe was his songe.

WHan tidyngges came to him,
That his meñ were slayñ, 2420
And howe thai hade stuffed heṁ also¹⁶³

THE SOUDAN IS ENRAGED WITH HIS GODS.

⟨p070⟩

With vitaile in agayne,
For sorowe he woxe nere wode.
He cleped Brenlande and Sortybraunce.
And tolde heṁ with angry mode
Of his harde myschaunce.

The soudan is enraged,

2424

“Remedye ordeyne me,
Ye be chief of my counsaile; 2428
That I of hem may vengede be,
It shalle you bouth availe.

O ye goddes, ye faile at nede,
That I have honoured so longe, 2432
I shalle you breñ, so mote¹⁶⁴ I spede,
In a fayre fyre ful stronge;
Shalle I neuer more on you bileve,
But renaye you playnly alle. 2436

and is going to burn
his gods,

Ye shalle be brente this day er eve,
That foule mote you befalle!”
The fire was made, the goddes were broght
To have be caste ther¹-inne. 2440

[leaf 61]

Tho alle his counsaile him by-sought,
He shulde of þat erreure blynne,
And saide “Sir, what wole ye done?

but, appeased by his
wise men,

Wole ye your goddis for-sake? 2444

Vengeaunce shalle thañ on you come,
With sorowe, woo and wrake!

Ye moste make offrynge for youre offence,
For drede of grete vengeaunce,
With oyle, mylke and ffrankeñcense
By youre prestis ordynaunce.”

Tho he dide bere hem in ayeñ,
And to hem made dewe offerynge.

The prestis assoyled him of þat synne,
Ful lowly for him prayinge.

Tho he cleped his counselors
Brulande and Sortybraunce,

2448

he sacrifices again,

2452

and is assoiled by
the priests.

2456

Laban holds council.

THE PEERS THROW LABAN'S GOLD AT THE ASSAILANTS.

[p071](#)

Axyng, howe he myght destroye the xij peres,
That Mahounde gife hem myschaunce.

Thay cowde no more ther-oñ,
But late saile ayeñ the toure.

With xx^{ti} thousande thai gañ goñ,
And bigonne a newe shoure

To breke dowñ the Walles,
With mattokes and with pike,

Tille iiij hundred of hem alle
Lay slayne in the dike.

So stronge was the cast of stoone.

The Saresyns drewe heñ abakke,

Tille it was at hye none;

Tho gonne thay ayeñ to shake.

Tho fayled hem cast, þat were *with*-inne;

Tho cowde thai no rede,

For stoone was ther noone to wyne.

Tho were thay in grete drede.

Than saide Florip, “beith not dismayde!

Ye shalle be holpe anooñ.

Here is syluer vessel and now,”¹⁶⁵ she sayde,

2460

A new assault begins,

2464

but the ditches
are filled with
assailants, who were
slain by the showers

[2468](#)

of stones hurled down
by the peers. The
Saracens retire. A
second attack ensues.

2472

There being no stones,

2476

Floripas gave
them her father's

“That shulle ye prove goode wooñ.”
She set it forth, thay caste oute faste
Alle that came to honde.
Off siluer and goolde vessel thay made waste
That wast¹⁶⁶ dowñ vppoñ the sonde.
Whañ thai saugh that roial sight,
Thai leften alle here dede;
And for the tresoure thay do fight,
Who so myghte it away lede.
Tho the Sowdoñ wexe nere wode,
Seinge this tresoure thus dispoyleð,
That was to him so dere and goode
Laye in the dike thus defouled.
He bade that thai shulde leue

THE SOUDAN ASKS HIS GODS' FORGIVENESS.

[p072](#)

And turne heñ agayne in haste.
He wente home tille his tente than
With grete sorowe and mournyng mode.
To-fore his goddis whañ he came,
He cryed, as he were wode:
“O fals goddis, that y^e beth,
I have trustid to longe youre mode.
We¹⁶⁷ were lever^þ to suffr^þ dede,
Thañ lif this life here lenger nowe.
I haue almoste loste the breth,
xij fals traytours me overe-lede,
And stroyen alle þat I haue.
Ye fals goddis, the devel youe spede!
Ye make me nowe for to rave;
Ye do fayle me at my nede.”
In Ire he smote Mahounde,
That was of goolde fulle rede,

silver and gold to
cast amongst the
assailants. [leaf 62]

2480

2484

The soudan in alarm
for his treasure

2488

gives up the assault.

2492

2496

He is enraged with
his gods,

2500

[2504](#)

and smites Mahound so
that he fell on his

2508

That he fille dow̄n to the groundē,
 As he hade bene dede.
 Alle here bisshopes crydēn oute
 And saide “Mahounde, thȳn ore!”
 And dow̄n to the erthe wele lowe thay loute,
 Howlynge and wepynge sore,
 And saide “Sire Sowdōn, what haue ye done?
 Vengeaunce shalle on the falle,
 But thoū repente the here anone.”
 “Ye” quod he “I shrewe yoū alle!”
 Thai made a fyre of frankencense
 And blewēn hornes of bras,
 And casten in milke hony for the offence,
 To-fore Mahoundes face.
 Thay counsailed Laban to knele a dow̄n
 And aske forgevenes in that place.
 And so he didde and hade pardōn
 Throgh prayere and specialle grace.

RICHARD STARTS ON MESSAGE TO CHARLES.

Then¹⁶⁸ this was done, þān sayde Roulande
 To his Felowes xj:
 “Here may we not longe holde londe,
 By God that is in hevēn.
 Therefore sende we to Charles, the kingē,
 That he wolde reskowe vs sone;
 And certyfye him of^t oure strayzte beinge,
 If ye thinke, it be to done.
 Richard of Normandye, ye most goōn,
 I holde yoū both wyse and hende.
 And we shalle tomorowe, as stil as stoōn,
 The Saresyns a-wake, er ye wynde.¹⁶⁹
 And while we be mooste bysy in oure werke,

face;

2512

2516

but the priests
 induce him

2520

[leaf 63]

2524

to kneel down and ask
 forgiveness.

⋄p073⋄

2528

Meanwhile Roland
 exhorted Richard of
 Normandy to go on
 message to Charles,
 that he might come
 to their rescue.

2532

They all would the
 following morning,
 before day break,

2536

make an attack on
 the Saracens, and
 meanwhile he should
 steal off in the

And medel with hem alle in fere,
 Stele ye a-waye in the derke!
 And spede you faste, ye were there!”
 On the morowe aftir¹⁷⁰ the daye
 Thay were armede ful ryghte,
 Thai rode forth stilly in here way,
 God gouerne hem, mooste of myght!
 Floripe and here maydyns kept the tour¹⁷¹
 And woonde vp the brigges on hye,
 And prayde god, to kepe here paramour¹⁷²,
 The Duke of Burgoyne, *Sir Gȳe*.
 She preyde to Rouland, er he wente,
 To take goode hede of hi^m,
 That he were neyper take nere shente,
 As he wolde her loue wyne.
 On thay set with herte stronge
 And alle he^m sore afrayed.
 Richard the whiles away he wronge,
 Thile¹⁷⁰ thai were alle dismayede.
 Towarde the Mountrible he hyed him faste,
 To passe, if that he myghte.
 Thedir he came at the laste.

GUY IS MADE PRISONER.

God kepe him for his moch myght!
 His xij¹⁷¹ felowes besyed he^m soo
 That many of he^m thay sloughe.¹⁷²
 Gye slowe the kinge of Babyloyn tho;
 The Babyloynes of his hors him drowe,
 And with force him drowe there
 And bounde his hondes ful fast.
 A newe game thai gaⁿ him lere,
 For in depe prisoⁿ thay him caste.

2540 darkness. In the morning

2544 they sally out.

Floripas and her
2548 maidens draw up the bridges after them.

2552

2556

Richard went off towards Mantrible.

2560 [leaf 64]

<p074>

The others slay many
2564 Saracens;

but Guy, overpowered
by the Babylonians,
2568 is taken prisoner.

But Labaṅ wolde him first se,
To wete what he was.
“Telle me thy name nowē” *quod* he,
“Thy songe shalle be ‘alas.’”—
“Sire” he saide “my name is Gye,
I wole it never forsake.

2572

Laban asks his name.

It were to me grete vilanye
Aṅ othir name to take.”—
“O fals traytour” *quod* Labaṅ,
“My doghtir, þat stronge hore,
Hath me for-sake and the hath taṅ,
Thow shalte be honged therfore.”

Guy tells him.

[2576](#)

Roulande made grete moone,
It wolde nooṅ other be.
Homwarde thai gaṅ gooṅ,
.iij.c Saresyns ther saye he,
That kepte the pace at the brigge-ende,
Armed wel in goode araye,
That thai sholde not in wende,
But be take or slayṅ þat daye.
Roulande to his felowes saide:
“Beth alle of right gode chere!
And we shal make hem alle afrayde,
Erʹ we go to oure soupere.”
There byganne a bykeringe bolde
Of x Bachelers that tyde,

2580

He is to be hanged.

2584

300 Saracens crowding
near the gate of the
castle, attempted to
prevent the other
peers from entering.

2588

2592

A fearful struggle
begins.

2596

BRYER IS SLAIN.

[p075](#)

Agayne iijc meṅ I-tolde,
That durste righte wel a-byde.
Tho was Durnedale set a werke,
XL of hethen he sloughe,
He spared neperʹ lewde ner clerke,

[leaf 65]

2600

And Floripas ther'-of loughe.
 The shotte, the caste was so stronge,
 Syr Bryer was slayn there
 With dartes, gauylokes and speres longe,
 xx^{ti} on hym there were.
 Roulande was woo and Olyuer',
 Thay slougheñ alle that thai mette.
 Tho fledde the Turkes alle for fer',
 Thay durste no longer lette
 And saide, thai wer' no men,
 But develis abrokeñ oute of helle,
 ".iij. hundred of vs agayñ hem teñ.
 Oure lorde Mahounde hem qwelle!
 XL of vs here be ascaped,
 And hardde we be bistadde."—
 "Who so wole of heñ more be iaped,
 I holde him worsse than madde."
 Tho Roulande and Olyuer'
 Madeñ grete woo and sorowe,
 And tokeñ the corps of Sir Bryere
 And beryed it on the morowe.
 Floripe asked Roulande anoone
 "Where is my loue Sir Gye?"—
 "Damesel" he saide "he is goon,
 And therfore woo am I."—
 "Alas" she saide "than am I dede,
 Nowe Gye my lorde is slayn,
 Shall I neuer more ete brede
 Tille that I may se hiñ agayñ."—
 "Be stille" *quod* Roulande "and haue no car',
 We shal hyñ haue ful wele.

2604 Sir Bryer is killed.

2608
At last the Saracens
take to flight.

[2612](#)

2616

The peers retire
2620 inside the castle,
taking the corpse of
Bryer with them.
Floripas enquires

2624 after Guy,

and on hearing of his
capture, begins to
2628 lament despairingly.

Roland promises to
2632 rescue Guy.

Tomorowe wele we thiderward far'	
With spere and shelde of stele.	
But we bringe him to this Tour'—	
Leeve me elles no more—	2636
With victorie and grete honour',	
Or thay shalle abyte it ful sore."	[leaf 66]
On the morowe, whan tha daye was clere,	
Laban ordeynede Gye honged to be.	2640
He cleped forth Sir Tampere	On the following
And badde him do make a Galowe tre,	morning Laban orders
"And set it even by-fore the tour',	Sir Tamper to erect
That þilke hore may him see;	a gallows before
For by lord Mahounde of honour',	2644 the castle, where
This traitour there shalle honged be.	Floripas could see it.
Take withe the .iij. hundred knightes	
Of Ethiopis, Indens and Ascopartes,	2648
That bene boolde and hardy to fight	
With Wifles, Fauchons, Gauylokes ¹⁷³ and Dartes;	
Leste þat lurdeynes come skulkyng oute,	
For ever thay haue bene shrewes.	2652
Loke eche of hem haue such a cloute,	
That thay neuer ete moo Sewes."	
Forth thay wente with Sir Gye,	Guy is led bound.
That bounde was as a thefe faste,	2656
Tille thay come the towr' ful nye;	
Thai rered the Galowes in haste.	
Roulande perceyued here doynge	
And saide "felows, let armes ¹⁷⁴ !	2660
I am ful gladde of here comynge,	Roland calls his
Hem shall not helpe her charmes."	companions to arms.
Oute thai riden a wele gode spede,	They rush forth.
Thai ix towarde hem alle.	2664
Florip with here maydyns toke gode hede,	

Biholdinge over the tour' walle.
Thai met first with Sir Tamper',

BUT IS RESCUED BY ROLAND AND OLIVER.

<p077>

God gife him evelle fyne!
Such a stroke lente hym Olyuer',
He clefe him dowñ to the skyne.
Rouland bare the kinge of Ynde
Ther with his spere frome his stede.
.iiij. fote it passed his bak byhynde,
His herte blode þer' didde he blede.
He caught the stede, he was ful goode,
And the swerde, þat the kinge hadde,
And rode to Gye, there he stode,
And onbounde hyṁ and bade him be gladde.
And girde him with that goode swerde,
And lepen vppoñ here stedes.
“Be thou” he saide “righte nought a-ferde,
But helpe vs wightly at this nede.”
An hundred of hem sone thay slowe
Of the beste of hem alle;
The remenaunte a-way fast thay flowe,
That foule motte hem byfalle!
Rouland and his Felowes were glad
That Gye was safe in dede.
Thay thanked god, that thay¹⁷⁵ him hadde
Gyfen thaye† such grace to spede.
As thay wente towarde the Tour',
A litil bysyde the hye waye,
Thai saugh comynge with grete vigour'
An hundred vppoñ a laye.¹⁷⁶
Costroye ther was, the AdmyraH,
With vitaile grete plente,

2668

Oliver cuts down Sir
Tamper; Roland kills
a king of India,

2672

2676

takes his sword and
horse, [leaf 67] and
gives them to Guy,
having unbound him.

2680

They slay many
Saracens, and put the
rest to flight.

2684

2688

Retiring towards the

2692

castle,
they see admiral
Costroye and
the soudan's

2696

standard-bearer

And the stondarte of the Sowdoñ Roial.
Towarde Mauntribe rideñ he,
.iiij. Chariotes I-charged with flessch and brede,
And two other' with wyne,
Of divers colouris, yolowe, white and rede,
And iiij Somers of spicery fyne.

escorting a great
convoy, destined for
the sultan, across a
2700 field near the high
road.

THE PEERS LAY HOLD OF A CONVOY.

<p078>

Tho saide Roulande to Olyuer':
"With these meyne moste we shifte,
To haue parte of here vitales her',
For therof us nedith by my thrifte."—
"Howe, sires" he saide "god you see!
We pray youe for youre curtesye,
Parte of your Vitaile graunte me,
For we may nother borowe ner bye."
Tho spake Cosdroye, that Admyral,
"Ye gete none here for noght.
Yf ye oght challenge in speciaH,
It most be dere I-boght."—
"O gentil knightes" quod Olyuere,
"He is no felowe, þat wole haue alle."
"Go forth" quod the stondart, "thow getist noon
here,
Thy parte shalle be fulle smalle."—
"Forsoth" quod Roulande "and shift we wole,
Gete the better, who gete maye!
To parte with the nedy it is gode skille,
And so shalle ye by my faye."
He rode to the Admyral with his swerde
And gafe him suche a cloute,
No wonder thogh he were aferde,
Both his eyzeñ braste oute.

2704

2708

2712

2716

2720

2724

Roland calls to them

to share the
provisions with them.

Costroye refuses,

[leaf 68]

and is slain by

Roland.

Olyuere met withe the proude stonde,
He smote him through the herte.
That hade he for his rewarde;
That wounde gañ sore smerte.
Thai were slayñ, that wolde fight
Er durste bikure abyde.
Thai forsoke her parte anooñ right,
It lefte alle oñ that oñ side.
Forth thai dreweñ þat vitaile
Streight in-to the Toure.
There was no mañ durst hem assayle
For drede of here vigour’.

THE SOUDAN DEFIES HIS GODS.

Floripe hem resceyved *with* honour’
And thanked Roulande fele sythe,
That she saugh Gye hir paramour’,
That wolde she him qwrite and kithe.
Thai eteñ and dronken and made hem gladde,
Hem neded ther aftyr fulle sore
Of suche, as god hem sente hade,
I-nowe for iiij moonþes and more.
Florip saide to Roulande than,
“Ye moste chese you a love¹⁷⁷
Of alle my maydyns, white as swañ.”—
Quod Rouland “þat were myscheve;
Oure lay wole not, þat we *with* youe dele,
Tille that ye Cristyñ be made;
Ner of your play we wole not fele,
For thañ were we cursed in dede.”

NOwe shall ye here of Labañ.
Whan tidyngges to him wer’ comeñ,
Tho was he a fulle sory mañ.

2728 Oliver kills the
standard-bearer.

2732

The convoy is
2736 conveyed into the
castle.

<p079>

2740 Floripas thanks
Roland for bringing
back Sir Guy,

2744

and proposes that he
shall choose himself
2748 a mistress from
amongst her maidens.
But Roland refuses to
take any that is no
2752 Christian.

The soudan, on
2756 hearing such bad news,

Whan he herde, howe his vitaile were nomeñ,
 And howe his men were slayne,
 And Gye was go safe heñ froo,
 He defyed Mahounde and Apolyne,
 Iubiter, Ascarot and Alcaroñ also.
 He commaundede a fire to be dight
 With picche and Brymstoñ to breñ.
 He made a vowe with alle his myght,
 “Thai shal be caste ther-Inne!”
 The prestes of her^l lawe ther-oñ,
 Thai crideñ oute for drede
 And saide “alas, what wole ye done?
 The worse than moste ye spede!”
 The Sowdoñ made a grete othe
 And swore by his hye trone,
 That though hem were never so loth,

2760 [leaf 69]
again defies his gods,

and threatens to
2764 throw them into the
flames.

2768

2772

RICHARD ARRIVES AT MANTRIBLE.

⟨p080⟩

Thai sholde be brente Ichoñ.
 Tho came the bisshope Cramadas
 And kneled bifore the Sowdoñ,
 And charged him by the hye name Sathanas,
 To saven his goddes ychoñ:
 “For if ye brenne youre goddes her^l,
 Ye wynnyñ her malisoñ,
 Than wole no man do you^l cher^l,
 In feelde, Cite, ner^l in towñ.”
 The Sowdoñ was astonyed þan
 And gan him sore repente
 Of the foly, that he bygañ,
 And els hade he be shente.
 A thousande of Besautes he offred þaym to,
 By counsail of sir Cramadas,

But bishop Cramadas
2776 kneels before him and
appeases him.

2780

2784

The soudan makes an
2788 offering of 1000

To please with his goddys tho,
For fere of harde grace.
The Sowdone *commaunded* euery daye
To assaile the tour' with caste.
But thay with-in gafe not an Eye,
For thai wroghte in wast.

NOwe speke we of Richarde of Normandy,
That on message was sente,
Howe he spede and his meyne.

Whan he to Mauntribe wente,
He founde the brigge Ichayned sore;
xxiiij^{ti} were ouere-drawnē.
Alagolofure stode there byfore,
That many a man hade slawene.
Whan Richard saugh, ther was no gate,
But by flagot the flode,
His message wolde he not lete;
His hors was both bigge and goode.
He kneled, bisechinge god of his grace,
To save him fro myschiefe.
A white hende he saugh anoon in þat place,

RICHARD CROSSES THE RIVER AND OVERTAKES CHARLES.

That swaṁ over' the cliffe.
He blessed him in godis name
And folowed the same waye
The gentil hende, þat was so tame,
That oñ þat othir side gan playe.
He thanked god fele sythe,
That him hade sente comforte.
He hied him in his message swiþe,
To speke with Charles his lorde.
But I shalle youʒ telle of a traytour,

besants to his gods.

[2792](#)

When Richard arrived
as far as Mantribe,
2796 he found the bridge
barred by 24 chains,
and Alagolafre
standing before it.

2800 [leaf 70]

Determined not to
2804 leave his errand
unperformed, he knelt
down and commended
himself to God. A

2808 hind appears

[p081](#)

and swims across.
Richard follows her,
2812 and, passing over in
safety,

2816 hurries on to
Charlemagne.

That his name was called Genelyne,
 He counseiled Charles for his honour'
 To turne homewarde ageyñ.
 He saide "the xij peres bene alle dede,
 And ye spende your goode in vayne,
 And therfore doth nowe by my rede,
 Ye shalle see hem no more certeyñ."
 The kinge bileved þat he saide,
 And homwarde gan he fare.
 He of his xij Dosiperes was sore dismayed,
 His herte woxe right fulle of car'.
 Rycharde of Normandy came prikande
 And hertly to ride begane.
 Kinge Charles aspyed him comande;
 He *commaunded* to abide euery mañ.
 "What tidingges?" *quod* the kinge to Richarde,
 "Howe fare my felowes alle?"
 "My lorde" he saide "god wote, ful harde,
 For thai be bysegged with-in ston-walle,
 Abydyngge youre helpe and your' socour',
 As men þat haue grete nede.
 For Ihesues loue, kinge of honour',
 Thiderward ye yow spede!"
 "O Genelyne" *quod* the kinge,
 "Nowe knowe I thy tresoñ,
 I shalle the qwrite, be seynte Fremounde,

2820 Meanwhile Genelyn,
 the traitor, had
 advised Charles to
 2824 retire to France,
 because the 12 peers
 were all slain. The
 king believed him,
 2828 and marched homeward,
 lamenting for his
 peers. Richard
 overtakes him, and is
 2832 recognised by Charles,
 who asks him about
 the others. Richard
 2836 tells the king, how
 they are besieged
 within the castle,
 and are waiting for
 2840 his assistance.
 Charles, vowing
 vengeance on
 2844 [leaf 71] Genelyn,

Whaṅ this viage is doṅ.”

The kinge turned him ageyṅ,

And alle his Ooste him with,

Towarde Mountrible certeyne.

And¹⁷⁸ graunte him gree and grith!

Richarde him tolde of that place,

Howe stronge it was I-holde

With a geaunte foule of face,

The brigge hath chayned many folde;

The River was both depe and brode,

Ther myght no maṅ over-ryde.

“The last tyme that I over-rode,

By myracle I passed þat tide.

Therfore sir, I shal yow telle,

Howe ye mote governe yow here.

In yonde wode ye moste dwelle

Priuely in this maner⁹,

And xij of vs shalle vs araye

In gyse of stronge marchauntes,

And fille oure somers withe fog and haye,

To passe the brigge Currauntes.

We shalle be armed vnder the cote

With goode swerdes wele I-gyrde,

We moste paye tribute, wele I wote,

And elles over we may not sterte.

But whaṅ the chaynes be lete dowṅ

Ouer ther for to passe,

Than wole I, þat ye come oṅ,

In haste to that same place.

Whaṅ I see tyme for to come,

Thaṅ shalle I my horne blowe.

Loke, ye be redy alle and some,

turned and marched to

2848 Agremore.

Richard informed him

of the giant, who

kept the bridge,

2852

and how he had passed

the river by a

miracle.

2856

He proposed a plan,

that 12 knights

disguised as

merchants, with

2860

2864

their arms hidden

under their clothes,

should pay the toll,

and the bridge being

let down,

2868

2872

should blow a horn

as a signal for the

2876

For that shaȝ ye welle knowe.”
Forth thay wente in þat araye
To Mountribe, that Cite.

THE BRIDGEWARD OF MANTRIBLE REFUSES TO LET THEM PASS.

Alagolofur' to heȝ gan seye,
“Felawes, wheder wole ye?”
Richarde spake to the geaunte
And saide “toward the Sowdoȝ,
With dyu[e]rs chaffer' as trewe marchaunte,
We purpose for to gooȝ,
To shewen him of pellur' and Gryse,¹⁷⁹
Orfrays of Perse Imperyalle,
We wole the yefe tribute of assaye
To passe by lycence in especyaȝ.”
“Licence gete ye nooȝ of me,¹⁸⁰
I am charged that noone shaȝ passe,
For x lurdeyns of Fraunce were her';
God yefe hem evell grace!
Thay passed this way to Egramour';
Thay haue done the Sowdoȝ grete tene,
Thay have wonne his toure and his tresour',
And yet holde thai it, I wene.
Wherfor', felawes, I arest youȝ alle,
Tille I knowe, what þat ye bene.”
Sire Focarde brayde oute his swerde with-alle,
Wel sore he gan to tene
And saide “fye oȝ the Sarasyne!
For alle thy grete harde hede
Shaltow never drinke water ner wyne,
By god! thou shalte be dede.”
He smote at him with egre chere
But he gafe thereof right nought.

others to approach.
They start and arrive
at Mantribe.

2880

<p083>

Alagolafre asks
whither they are
going.

2884

Richard says, they
are merchants on
their way to the
Soudan,

2888

[leaf 72]
and they are willing
to pay the toll.

Alagolafre refuses to

2892

let them pass, and
tells them about the
10 knights, who had
passed there and done

2896

so much mischief to
the Soudan;

therefore he will

2900

arrest them all.
Sir Focard draws his
sword and

2904

smites at him.

2908

“Alas” quod Richard “thou combrest vs her’,
By god, that me der’ hath boghte.”
The cheynes yet wer’ alle faste,
The geaunte wexe nere wode,
Richard blewe his horne in haste,
That was both shrille and goode.
Kinge Charles hied him anooñ

ALAGOLAFRE AND BARROCK ARE SLAIN.

Towarde the brigge so longe;
The Geaunte faught with heṁ alone,
He was so harde and stronge.
With a Clog^ʳ of añ Oke he faught,
That was wele bound with stele.
He slough al þat ever’ he raught,
So stronge was his dinte to dele.
Richard raught him with a barr’ of bras,
That he caught at the gate.
He brake his legges, he cryed “alas”
And felle alle chek^ʳ-mate.
Loude thañ gañ he to yelle;
Thay herde him yelle through þat Cite,
Like the grete develle of helle,
And saide “Mahounde, nowe helpe me!”
iiij men him caught ther’,
So hevy he was and longe,
And cast him ouer in-to the river’.
Chese he, whither¹⁸¹ he wolde swym me or gong’!
Anooñ thay brast the Chaynes alle,
That ouer the brigge were I-drawe.
The Saresyns ronneñ to the walle,
Many Cristeñ men were ther’ I-slawe.
Than came forth Dam barrokt^ʳ, the bolde,

2912

Richard blows his
horn, and Charles
advances.

<p084>

2916

2920

Alagolafre fights
them with a great oak
club.

2924

Richard seizes a bar
of brass and knocks
him down.

2928

2932

[leaf 73]
4 men get hold of him
and throw him into
the river.
They loosened the
chains;

2936

but, the Saracens
assembling on the
walls of the city,

With a sithe large and kene,
 And mewe a-dowñ as þikke as shepe in folde,
 That came byforne hir by-dene.
 This Barrok^a was a geaunesse,
 And wife she was to Astragote,
 She did the Cristeñ grete distresse,
 She felled downe alle þat she smote.
 There durst no man hire sithe abyde,
 She grenned like a deuelle of helle.
 Kinge Charles with a quarel þat tide
 Smote hir, that she lowde gañ yelle,

CHARLES IS SHUT IN IN THE TOWN.

Euer¹⁸² the founte through-out the brayñ;
 That cursede fende fille dowñ dede.
 Many a man hade she there slayñ,
 Might she never aftyr ete more brede!
 Charles entred in the firste warde
 With xv knightis and no moo;
 Of hym his oste toke no garde,
 He wende his oste hade entred also.
 The Sarysyns ronned to the gate,
 And shet it wonder faste.
 Charles meñ come to late;
 Tho was Charles sore agaste.
 Betwene two wardes he was shit,
 Defende he him if he cañ!
 The Sarysyns with him thay mette,
 Grete parel was he in thañ.
 Tho Genelyne saie, the kinge was inne
 And the yates faste I-stoke,
 Ther myght no mañ to him wyne,
 So was he faste with-inne I-loke,

2940 many Christians were
 slain. Alagolafre's
 wife, Barrock the
 giantess, comes on

2944 with her scythe and
 mows down all whom
 she meets.

2948 Charles dashes out
 her brains,

<p085>

2952

 and with 15 knights
 enters the outer gate
 of the town,
 thinking his army
 would follow him.

2960 But the gate was
 instantly closed upon
 him, and his men came
 too late.

2964 Charles was in great
 danger;
 but Genelyn, seeing

2968 him shut in,

To his frendes he gan speke
And saide “the kinge is dede,
And alle xij peres eke.
On peyne” said he “to lese myn hede,
Let vs hye to Fraunce warde!
For I wele be crownede kinge,
I shalle you alle wele rewarde,
For I wole spare for no thinge.”
Anoon thay assented to Genelyne,
Thay saugh, ther was no better rede.
The Frenssh meñ drewe hem al ayene,
Thay wende the kinge hade bene dedde.
Tho Ferumbras with his meyne than
Came for to seke the kinge,
And saugh hem turne euery man;

CHARLES IS RESCUED BY FERUMBRAS.

Him thought, it was a wondir thing.
“Where is the kinge?” quod Ferumbras.
Quod Genelyne “with-in the walle,
Shaltowe neuer more seeñ his face!”
“God gyf the ayn yvel falle!
Turne agayne, thou traytoure!
And helpe to reskowe thy lorde.
And ye, sires, alle for your honour!”
Thay turned agayne with that worde.
Ferumbras with axe in honde,
Myghtyly brake up the gate,
Ther myght laste him noon yron bonde,
He hade ner-honde I-come to late.
The kinge hadde fought so longe with-ynne,
That onnethe myght he no more.
Many ther were abouteñ him,

2973 [leaf 74] exclaimed
that the king and
the 12 peers were
dead, and proposed to
retire, as he wished
to be king himself.

2980
They are going to
return,
but Ferumbras

2984

<p086>

2988

calls him a traitour,

2992

rallies the French,

and with his axe

2996

bursts open the gate.

3000

His meñ were wounded ful sore.
 Ferumbras came with gode spede,
 He made the Sarasyns to fle.
 He reskowed the kinge at his nede,
 XL Sarasyns sone killed he.
 Thai ronnen a-weye by every side,
 Thai durste nowher' rowte.
 In shorte tyme was falled her pride,
 Thay caught many a sore cloute.
 That Cite was wonne that same daye,
 And every tour' ther-ynne
 Of Mountreble, þat was so gaye,
 For alle her' soubtile gynne,
 Fulle of tresour' and richesse,
 Of Siluer and goolde and perr',
 And clothes of goolde, wrought of Saresyns,
 Of riche aray and roialte.
 Richarde, Duke of Normandy,
 Founde ij Children of .vij. monþes oolde, [183](#)

HE HURRIES ON TO AGREMORE.

xiiij fote longe wer' thay,
 Thay wer' Barrakes sonnes so boolde;
 Bygote thay wer' of Astragot.
 Grete joye the kinge of hem hade.
 Hetheñ thay wer' both, wele I wote,
 Therefore heñ to be cristenede he bade.
 He called þat one of hem Roulande,
 And that other he cleped Olyuer':
 "For thai shalle be myghty men of honde."
 To kepeñ hem, he was fulle chere.
 Thay myght not leve, her Dam was dede;
 Thai coude not kepe hem forth.

3004 He chased the
 Saracens and rescued
 the king.

[3008](#)

Mantrible is taken,
 3012

[leaf 75]
 with all its engines
 3016 and treasures.

Richard found 2
 children of 7 months
 3020 old and

4 feet high.
 They were sons of

Barrock, begotten by
 3024 Astragot.

Charles caused them
 to be baptized, and
 3028 called the one Roland
 and the other Oliver.

But they soon died
 3032

Thai wolde neyþer ete butter nere brede,
Ner no meñ¹⁸⁴ was to hem worthe.

Her' Dammes mylke they lakked ther',
Thay deyden for defaute of here dam.

Kinge Charles made hevy cher',
And a sory mañ was than.

The kinge lete ordeyne anooñ,
The Cite to be gouerned

Of the worthyest of heñ ychoñ,
That weren of werr' best lerned.

Duke Richarde of Normandy,
He was made chief gouernour';
And ij C with him in hys company
To kepe the brigge and tour'.

Forth he rode to labañ thañ,
With his Ooste and Sir' Ferumbras.

A spye to the Sowdoñ fast ran
And tolde him al that cas,

How Charles was come with his ost,
And Mountribe had he wonne,

“Alagolofur slayñ is for alle his bost,
This game was evel begoñ.”

Whane laban herde of his comynge,

FLORIPAS RECOGNISES THE FRENCH BANNER.

Him thought his herte gan breke.

“Shalle I never be withoute moornynge,
Tille I of him be wreke.”

He commaunded to blowe his Claryons
To assemble alle his Ooste.

His counsaile to him he lete calle

And tolde, how kinge Charles was in þat coost,
Hadde wonne Mountribe and slayñ his men

for want of their

3036 mother's milk.

3040

The king appoints

3044 Richard governor of
the city,

and hurries on

3048 to Agremore with
his army and with
Ferumbras.

3052

<p088>

3056

[leaf 76]

3060

Laban, being told by
a spy that his city

“And dishiryth to disheryte me,
 And proudly manessith me to fleeñ,
 Or drive me oute of this contre.
 Me mervaylythe moch of his pride.
 By Mahounde, moost of myght!
 Ye and my sone withe him doth ride,
 To the develle I hem bedight.
 But I be venget of hem both
 And honge heñ on a tree,
 To myghty Mahounde I make myne othe,
 Shalle I never Joyfulle be.
 Therefore I charge you in alle wyse
 That thay be taken or slayñ.
 Thane shalle I pynne heme at my gyse
 And doñ hem alle qwike be flayñ.”
 On the morowe, whan it was day,
 Kinge Charles was in the felde,
 Byfore Agremour^r in riche aray
 On stede with sper^r and sheelde.
 Floripe lay on the tour^r oñ hye
 And knewe the baner^r of Fraunce.
 To Roulande she gan faste crye
 Tidynges of goode chaunce:
 “Kinge Charles is comen and Ferumbras,
 Here baners both I do see,
 With alle her oste yonder^r in þat place;
 Welcome to vs thay alle be.”
 Roulande and Olyuere

CHARLES DISMOUNTS LABAN AND LEADS HIM TO AGREMORE.

Arayed hem for to ride;
 And here felawes alle in fer^r,
 To Charles thay goñ that tyde.

3064 was taken and the
bridge-ward killed,

3068

swears to avenge him.

3072

He calls a council,

3076

and charges his

barons to take

Charles alive that

he might flay him.

3080

Charles approaches.

Floripas first

3084

recognises the banner

of France

and tells the others.

3088

3092

Roland and all his

companions sally

forth to meet

<p089>

Laban come forth with his mayne,
 Saresyns, that were ful felle,
 Turkes, Indens, and Arabye
 Ye and of the Ethiopes like the develes of helle.
 There were stronge wardes sette
 By ordynaunce of dyuers batayle.
 Whan thay to geder were met,
 Eythir othir sore gañ assayle.
 Ther were Saresyns al to-hewe;
 Roulande sloughe many one.
 Thay lay so thikke dede on rewe,
 That onneþe myghte men ride or gooñ.
 Kinge Charles met with Labañ
 And bare him dowñ of his stede,
 He lighted dowñ and ceased him thañ,
 He thought to qwrite him his mede.
 He brayde oute Mowñjoye wyth gode wille
 And wolde have smeten of his hede,
 Ferumbras prayde him to abyde stille,
 To crysteñ him, er he wer' dede.
 The Saresyns saughe Laban take,
 Thay fleddeñ away fulle faste.
 Lenger durste thay no maistryes make,
 Thai were so sore agaste.
 The Cristeñ hem chased to and fro,
 As a grehounde doth the hare.
 .iij. c. ascaped with moche woo,
 To Belmore gan thay far'.
 Kinge Charles ladde Labañ
 In-to Agremour' Cite.
 And whañ þat he ther' came
 A ful sory man was he.
 His doghter welcomed him

Charlemagne. Laban
 3096 draws up all his
 people
 [leaf 77]
 3100 in battle-order.
 The French make a
 3104 great slaughter of
 the Saracens.
 Charles encounters
 3108 the Soudan, unhorses
 him,
 3112 and would have cut
 off his head, but
 for Ferumbras, who
 3116 requested that
 his father might
 be baptized. The
 Saracens, seeing
 3120 Laban a prisoner,
 fly; but the
 Christians pursue
 them. 300 escaped to
 3124 Belmarine. Charles
 leads Laban to
 Agremore. Floripas
 welcomes her father,

With right gode cher'.¹⁸⁵
 He loked on hir al grymme,
 As he wode wroth wer',
 And saide "fye on the, stronge hore,
 Mahounde confounde the!"
 Charles saide "here-of no more,
 But let us nowe mery be!"—
 "Sir" she saide thanne,
 "Welcome ye be into this tour'!
 Here I presente to you, as I can,
 Relikes of grete honour',
 That were at Rome I-wonneñ
 And broght into this halle.
 That game was evel bygonneñ,
 It sithen rewed us alle."
 Kinge Charles kneled adowne
 To kisse the Relikes so goode,
 And badde ther' añ orysoñ
 To that lorde, þat deyde on rode.
 And þanked Floripe with al his herte,
 That she hade saued his meyne
 And holpe hem oute of peynes smerte
 And kepte the Relekes so fre.
 Kinge Charles did calle bisshope Turpyñ
 And bade him ordeyne a grete fat,
 To baptyse the Sowdoñ yne;
 "And loke what he shalle hat.
 Unarme him faste and bringe him ner',
 I shal his godfader be.
 Fille it fulle of water' cler',
 For Baptysed shalle he be.

3128 but he is enraged at
 seeing her.
 3132
 She then bids
 3136 Charlemagne welcome,
 and presents the holy
 relics to him.
 3140
 [leaf 78]
 3144 Charles kisses them,
 and says a prayer;
 he then thanks
 Floripas for her
 3148 assistance to his
 knights, and for
 having preserved the
 precious relics. He
 3152 orders Turpin to
 prepare a vessel,
 wherein to baptize
 the Soudan
 3156

Make him naked as a Childe,
He moste plunge ther-inne.
For now most he be meke and mylde,
And I-wassh awaye his synne.”

LABAN IS SLAIN, AND FLORIPAS WEDDED TO GUY.

Turpyn toke him by the honde
And ladde him to the fonte.
He smote the bisshope with a bronde
And gaf him an evel bronte.
He spitted in the water cler'
And cryed oute on hem alle,
And defied alle þat cristen wer'.
That foule mote him by-falle!
“Ye and thou, hore serpentyne,
And that fals cursed Ferumbras,
Mahounde gyfe hem both evel endyng',
And almyghty Sathanas!
By you came all my sorowe,
And al my tresure for-lorne.
Honged be ye both er tomorowe!
In cursed tyme were ye born̄.”
Ferumbras saide to the kinge,
“Sir, ye see, it wole not be,
Lete him take his endyng,
For he loueth not Cristyante.”
“Duke Neymes” quod Charles tho,
“Loke þat execucion be don̄,
Smyte of his hedde! god gyfe him woo!
And goo we to mete anoone.”
It was done as the kinge commaunde,
His soule was fet to helle,
To daunse in þat sory lande

3160

and to wash off his
sin in the water.

<p091>

Turpin leads Laban to

3164

the font,
but the Soudan
strikes at him,
spits on the vessel,

3168

utters invectives
against all
Christians,

3172

and curses Ferumbras.

3176

3180

Charles commands

3184

Naymes to cut off his
head. [leaf 79]

He is executed; his

3188

soul goes to hell,
there to dance with

With develes, þat werʹ ful felle.
Dame Florip was Baptysed thaṅ
And here maydyns alle,
And to Sir Gye I-maryed.
The Barons honoured hir alle.
Alle the londe of Spayne
Kinge Charles gyfe heṁ two,
To departe bitwyxt hem twayne,
Ferumbras and Gȳ also.

CHARLES RETURNS TO FRANCE.

And so thay livede in ioye and game,
And bretherṅ both thay werʹ,
In pees and werrʹ both I-same,
Therʹ durste no maṅ hem derʹ.
Kinge Charles turned home agayṅ
Towarde his contre,
He charged Sir Bryerʹ of Bretayne
His tresourerʹ for to be:
To kepe the Relikes of grete pris
And his other tresourʹ,
And bringe hem safe to Parys,
There to a-bide in store.
He saide “farewell, Sir Ferumbras,
Ye and Gye, my dere frende!
And thy wyf Dame Floripas!
For to Fraunce nowe wole I wende.
Be ye togeder as breth[e]rṅ both!
No maṅ ye nedith to drede,
Be ye nevere to-gedere wroth,
But eyther helpe othir at his nede.
Vysityth me, whaṅ ye haue space;
In-to Fraunce makith your disporte,

devils.

3192 Floripas was baptized
with all her maidens,
and wedded to Guy.
Charles divided Spain
3196 between Guy and
Ferumbras,

¶p092¶

3200

3204 and charges Sir Bryer
of Bretayne to take
care of the relics,
3208 and to bring all his
treasure to Paris.

3212 After taking leave of
Guy and Floripas,

3216

3220

God wole you sende the better grace,
In age to do me comforte.”
Thai toke leve of the kinge,
With ful hevy cher’,
And turned agayn both mornynge,
With wepynge water cler’.
Kinge Charles with the victory
Sailed to Mounpeleres,
And thanked almyghty god in glorye,
That he hade saued his Dosiperes,
And fende him of the Saresynes
The hyer honde to have,
For alle here strenghe¹⁸⁶ and her’ Engynes

GENELYN IS HANGED AT PARIS.

The Relikes of Rome to saue.
At oure lady of Parys
He offred the Crosse so fre;
The Crown he offred at seynte Denyse,
At Boloyne the nayles thre.
Alle his Barons of him wer’ gladd,
Thai gafe him grete presente.
For he so wele hade I-spedde,
Thay did him grete reuerence.
The kinge hade wel in mynde
The tresone of Genelyne,
Anoon for him he dide sende
To yefe him an evel fyne:
“Thou traitour unkynde” quod the kynge,
“Remembrist thou not how ofte
Thou hast me betrayed, þou fals Genelyne?
Therefore thoue shalt be honged on lofte!—
Loke that the execucioñ be doñ,

[3224](#)

he sails to Mounpeler,

3228

[leaf 80] where he
thanks God for the
victory,

3232

[p093](#)

and for the relics.

He presents the

3236

cross to Paris, the
Crown to St. Denis,
the three nails to
Boulogne.

3240

Charles well

remembered the

3244

treachery of Genelyn,

3248

That throgħ Parys he be drawe,
And honged on hye on mount Fawcoñ,
As longeth to traytours by lawe;
That alle men shall take hede,
What deth traytourys shaʒ fele,
That assente to such falshede,
Howe the wynde here bodyes shal kele.”
Thus Charles conquered Labañ,
The Sowdoñ of Babyloyne,
That riche Rome stroyed and wañ
And alle the brode londe of Spayñ.

[187](#)[an]d of his Barons

.[hi]s pride

.eligons

.þat tyde

.on Charles soule

.s also

CONCLUSION.

.Peter and Poule

God lete hem never wete of woo!

But brynge here soules to goode reste!

That were so worthy in dede.

And gyf vs ioye of the beste,

That of here gestes rede!

Here endithe the Romaunce of the Sowdon of Babyloyne and of Ferumbras
his sone who conquerede Rome, And Kynge Charles off Fraunce withe xij.
Dosyperes toke the Sowdon in the feelde And smote of his heede.

FOOTNOTES. [↵](#)

89 *Read: myghtes*

90 *MS. dōō*

91 *leaf worn.*

3252 and ordered him to be
drawn and hanged at
Montfaucon in Paris.

3256

Thus Charles
conquered the Soudan
of Babylone.

[3260](#)

3264

3268

[p094](#)

[leaf 81]

[3272](#)

God give joy to all
who read this romance.

- 92** –† *See the note.*
- 93** *See the note.*
- 94** *or Ar*
- 95** *See the note.*
- 96** *See the note.*
- 97** *looks like hound.*
- 98** *Read ‘wide’*
- 99** *sic. ? assaute.*
- 100** *MS. M¹*
- 101** *This line in a much later hand.*
- 102** *Read: were ordeyned*
- 103** *Estragote*
- 104** *Read: reste*
- 105** *See the note.*
- 106** *MS. Oost corrected to Cost.*
- 107** *Read: a ras.*
- 108** *See the note.*
- 109** *Read: We*
- 110** *MS. Berumbras.*
- 111** *See the note.*
- 112** *Read: ‘without faile.’*
- 113** *See the note.*
- 114** *Read: ‘a ras.’*
- 115** *MS. met.*
- 116** *See the note.*
- 117** *MS. is rubbed, but it looks more like welawai.*
- 118** *Read: ‘reliques.’*
- 119** *A modern hand has written in the margin “Mount.”*
- 120** *See the note.*
- 121** *Insert: ‘gan.’*
- 122** *Read: ‘sone.’*
- 123** *Read: ‘lefe.’*
- 124** *Read: ‘as thenketh.’*
- 125** *Blank in MS. See the note.*
- 126** *MS. deistowe.*
- 127** *Read: ‘free.’*

- 128** MS. ensuce.
- 129** *See the note.*
- 130** –† *See the note.*
- 131** *Probably an error for ‘half.’*
- 132** *In the margin the Scribe adds:—‘The merci Ladi helpe.’*
- 133** *See the note.*
- 134** *Read: ‘soghten.’*
- 135** –† *See the note.*
- 136** *Read: ‘caughte.’*
- 137** *Ascopartes.*
- 138** *Miswritten for ‘bounden.’*
- 139** *‘was.’*
- 140** *Read: ‘dirke.’*
- 141** *Read: ‘mente.’*
- 142** *Read: ‘trew.’*
- 143** *Read: ‘harme & skathe.’*
- 144** *See the note.*
- 145** *Sic in MS. Query—‘charge.’*
- 146** *Read: ‘byleven.’*
- 147** *Read: ‘reliques.’*
- 148** *Read: ‘I dyne.’ See the note.*
- 149** *Sic in MS. Read: ‘ye.’*
- 150** –† *These two lines are written as one in the MS.*
- 151** MS. ^oiuste.
- 152** *Miswritten for ‘were’?*
- 153** MS. strowde.
- 154** *Read: ‘a-wapide.’*
- 155** *Read: ‘Assye.’*
- 156** *See the note.*
- 157** *These two lines are written as one in the MS.*
- 158** *See the note.*
- 159** *See the note.*
- 160** *Read: ‘lafte.’*
- 161** *See the note.*
- 162** *See the note.*
- 163** *See the note.*

- 164** MS. mete.
- 165** ? I now.
- 166** *Read:* 'went.'
- 167** ? Me.
- 168** ? 'When.'
- 169** *Read:* 'wende.'
- 170** ? 'while.'
- 171** ? xj.
- 172** *See the note.*
- 173** MS. Gamylokes.
- 174** *Read:* 'as armes.'
- 175** -† *See the note.*
- 176** MS. 'alaye.' *See the note.*
- 177** *Read:* 'leve.'
- 178** *Read:* 'God.'
- 179** *Read:* 'gray.'
- 180** *See the note.*
- 181** ? 'whether.'
- 182** *Read* 'over.'
- 183** *See the note.*
- 184** *Read:* 'mete.'
- 185** *These two lines are written as one in the MS.*
- 186** *Read:* 'strengthe'
- 187** *A corner of the leaf torn off.*

NOTES. [◇](#)

Page 1, line [1](#). *myghteste*, evidently an error of the scribe for *myghtes*, cf. ll. 1635, 1312, 3068, 2546, 1200, 2059; and *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 2719.

“Nov help hem þe heȝ kyng of hevene,
Þat art of miȝtes most.”

God in glorie occurs again in l. 3229; cf. the French expression *Damedeu de gloire*; *Fierabras* 2332.

- p. 1, l. [2](#). *made* and *wroght* in l. 5 are the 2nd person sing. preterite, which in all other instances in this poem ends in *-est*. But perhaps we might suppose a change of person here, and regard *made* and *wroght* as the third person. For examples of the change of person see *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 2719, 4393, and *Guy of Warwick*, ed. Zupitza, l. 2324.
- p. 1, l. [7](#). *shulde to love*; *to* before an infinitive, governed by an auxiliary verb, is pretty common in Middle English works. See Zupitza's note to *Guy*, 1925.
- p. 1, l. [9](#). *ȝyfe*. This is the only instance of *ȝ* being written in the present poem at the beginning of a word. *ȝife* is written *if* in all other passages of the poem, cf. ll. 550, 651, 763, and 1061, etc. As to the pronunciation of *ȝ* in the middle of a word, it is doubtful, whether it had still preserved its ancient guttural sound, or not, as the same words are written sometimes with it and sometimes without it, and are often made to rhyme with words in which *ȝ* or *gh* would be etymologically incorrect; e. g. *nye*, which is spelt *nyȝe* in l. 2284, rhymes with *Gye*, in l. 2657. We even find *whiȝte*, in l. 2289, instead of *white* (l. 2008: *smyte*). At the end of a word *ȝ* has the sound of *s*.
- p. 1, l. [13](#). *idoone*. The prefix *i-*, O.E. *ge-*, sometimes occurs in this poem, but more frequently it is not written; see *Introduction*, p. xxxviii.
- p. 1, l. [14](#). cf. l. 2516.—ll. 1–14 may be said to contain the moral of the whole poem, which we know the romance writers to be very fond of

placing at the beginning of their works. “La moralité de tout un poème,” says Léon Gautier, in his *Épopées Françaises*, I. 233, “est quelquefois exprimée dans ses premiers vers.” [p096](#)

p. 1, l. [16](#). *moch* = *much* (as in l. 754) is the usual spelling in this poem. We likewise find *meche*, l. 179, and *mikille*, l. 1016.

p. 1, l. [19](#), *his* refers to *Rome*.

p. 1, l. [22](#). Laban, the father of Ferumbras, is styled *sowdan* only in this poem, and once in the *Destruction de Rome*, l. 1436:

“Les noveles en vindrent al *soldan* diffaié.”

The French, the Provençal and the English version of *Sir Ferumbras* all agree to call him *amyral* or *amirans*.

p. 1, l. [24](#). The mention of King Louis and of the abbey of St. Denis (l. 27) seems to be an imitation of the *Destruction*, l. 7 *et seq.*:

“Le chanchon est perdue et le rime fausee,
Mais . . li *rois Louis*, dont l’alme est trespassee
—Ke li fache pardon la verge honoree—
Par lui et par Gautier est l’estoire aunee
Et le chanchon drescie, esprise et alumee
A *saint Dynis* de France premierement trovee.”

St. Denis also occurs in the beginning of the French *Fierabras*, l. 4:

“A *Saint Denis* en France fu li raules trouvés.”

Cf. besides note to l. 26. *witnessith* = attests, testifies; cf. Stratmann, p. 645. It occurs again in l. 1489.

p. 2, l. [25](#). *Romaunce*, the French or *Romance* language. We often find the authors of romances, both of translations and of imitations from the French, referring to the original; cf. *Syr Eglamour of Artoys*, sign. E i:

“His own mother there he wedde,
In *Romaunce* as we rede.”

Again, fol. ult.: “In *Romaunce* this cronycle is.”

[Quoted by Warton, *History of English Poetry*, II. 146, footnote.]

p. 2, l. [26](#). *bokes of antiquyte*. This is to be regarded as one of those frequent assertions of the authors of these poems, who in order to give more credit to their tales, thought it necessary to affirm their antiquity

and celebrity in old times. Cf. Gautier, *Epop. Fr.*, II. 87: “Il fut de bon ton d’annoncer, au commencement de chaque poème, qu’on avait trouvé la matière de ce poème dans quelque vieux manuscrit latin, dans quelque vieille chronique d’abbaye, surtout dans les manuscrits et dans les chroniques de Saint-Denis. On se donnait par là un beau vernis de véracité historique. Plus les trouvèrent ajoutaient aux chansons primitives d’affabulations ridicules, plus ils s’écriaient: ‘Nous avons trouvé tout cela dans un vieux livre.’”

p. 2, l. [27](#). *Seinte Denyse* is the genitive depending on *abbey*.

p. 2, l. [28](#). *there as* = where, or where that. See Koch, *Englische Grammatik*, II. § 511.

p. 2, l. [29](#). *Laban*. So the father of Ferumbras is called in the *Destruction de Rome*, where only in six passages (ll. 891, 899, 1116, 1194, 1174, 981) we find the form *Balan*, which is the only one used in the French *Fierabras*, in the Provençal version, and in the English [p097](#) *Syr Ferumbras*.—*of hie degre*; this kind of expletive occurs again in l. 100: *clerk of hie degre*; cf. also l. 168: *king of hie honour*.

p. 2, l. [31](#). *Cristiante* = the company of Christians, the countries inhabited by Christians, cf. ll. 235, 374. It signifies “the religion taught by Christ” in l. 3182. *Cristiante* and *Christendom* are used promiscuously in Middle English writers.

p. 2, l. [33](#). *Agremare* : *there*. The rhyme becomes perfect by reading *Agremore* : *thore*, which we find in l. 1805; cf. also l. 1003 *Agremore* : *more* (*i. e.* negro), and ll. 672, 775, 2140, 2895.

p. 2, l. [34](#). *Flagot*. See *Index of Names*, s. v. Flagot, and cf. note to l. 1723.

p. 2, l. [37](#). This line is too long, nevertheless it seems to be correct as it stands, clearly imitated from several passages of the *Destruction de Rome*.

l. 420. “Ensamble ou li issirent xv roi corone. Et xiiii amaceours . .”

l. 1155. “Bien i ad xxx rois et xiiii amaceours.”

l. 689. “xxx roi sont ou li et xiiii amaceours.”

l. 163. “Et xiiii amaceours.”

- p. 2, l. [41](#). *hit* instead of *it* is found again in l. 2309; in all the other instances *it* is spelt as in modern English.
- p. 2, l. [42](#). *pryke*, to spur a horse, to excite, to spur or to stimulate. It is O.E. *prician*, which occurs in Ælfric's Grammar, ed. Zupitza, p. 174 (*pungo* = *ic pricige*). This and the following line are imitated from Chaucer; cf. C.T. Prologue, ll. 10, 11, and see *Introduction*, p. xlv. *Kynde* = *naturalis*, *ingenuus*; *kynde wit* = common sense. *Kynde* is O.E. *cynde* (Modern English *kind*).
- p. 2, l. [73](#). *frith* means "forest," or more correctly "enclosed wood." The original sense of *forest* is "unenclosed wood" (see Diez, *Etymol. Wörterbuch*, I. 185). Stratmann, *Dict.* p. 228, s. v. *frið*, seems to be right in connecting *frith* with O.E. *frið*, *freoðo* = *pax*, *tutela*, *saeptum*. Morris, *Allit. Poems*, Glossary, derives it from the Gaelic *frith*. "*frith* is still used in Provincial English, meaning unused pasture-land, brushwood" (Halliwell).
- p. 2, l. [45](#). *yze* (O.E. *êagum*) : *flye* (O.E. *flêogan*). With regard to the power of *z*, see the note to l. 9, and cf. the spelling *eyen* in ll. 826, 1302, 2012.
- p. 2, l. [46](#). *tre* may be singular (O.E. *trêowe*) as well as plural (O.E. *trêowum*).
- p. 2, l. [49](#). The following lines (49–53) correspond with ll. 94–100 of the *Destruction*, which run as follows:

"Li admirals d'Espaigne s'est ales desporter
 As puis sur Aigremore, avec li. M. Escler;
 La fist ses ours sauvages a ses hommes berser.
 La veissies meint viautre, maint brachet descoupler,
 Payens et Ascopars as espees jouer,
 Coure par le marine et chacier maint sengler,
 Maint ostour veisies et maint falcon voler."

<p098>

- p. 2, l. [50](#). *shope*, literally "shaped:" *he shope him*, "he got himself ready, he planned, devised, intended." The phrase is of frequent occurrence in Chaucer.
- p. 2, l. [52](#). *bawson*, badger. For the use of badgers, see Skeat's note to *Specimens of English Literature*, p. 383.

- p. 2, l. [56](#). *Alaunts*, a kind of large dogs of great strength and courage, used for hunting the wolf, the bear, the boar, &c. Cf.

“Aboute his chare wente white alauntz
Twenty and mo, as grete as any stere,
To hunte at the lyoun or at the bere.”

Chaucer, ed. Morris, II. 66/1290.

According to Diez (*Etymol. Wörterb.*, I. 12, s. v. “alano”) *alaunts* means “Albanian dogs.” *Lymmeris*, “blood-hounds.” Halliwell quotes the following passage: “A dogge engendred betwene an hounde and a mastive, called a lymmer or a mongrell.” *Lymmer* is the French *limier*, O.Fr. *liemier*, which etymologically means a dog that a courser leads by a lime, *i. e.* a thong or leash. *Lime* is the same word as French *lien*, a leash; Latin *ligamen*. *Lymmer* is preserved in Modern English *limer*, a “lime-hound.”

- p. 2, l. [56](#). *Rache* and *brache* are both retained in the modern speech; *rache* seems to be particularly used in Scotland. “*Brache* is said to signify originally a bitch hound—the feminine of *rache*, a foot-scenting dog” (Morris, *Gawayne*, Gloss. p. 89). *Rache* is, according to Stratmann, O.Icel. *rakki*; *brache* is O.Fr. *braque*, M.H.Ger. *braccho*. Cf. also Halliwell’s Dict. s. v. “brach.” The French *racaille* is etymologically connected with *rache*; see Diez, *Etym. Wörterb.*, II. 407.
- p. 2, l. [57](#). *commaunde* for *commaunded* (l. 228), formed on the same analogy as *comforte* (l. 2242) for *comforted* (ll. 312, 2117), *alizt* for *alighted*; *gerde* for *girded*; *graunte* (l. 607) for *graunted*, etc.
- p. 2, l. [59](#). *fere*, O.E. *færan* (Mod. Eng. *fear*), is an active verb, meaning “to frighten, to terrify.” It is still found in this sense in Shakespeare.—*launde* : *commaunde*. The very same rhyme occurs again in l. 3189, where *launde* is spelt *lande*. The rhyme need not cause any difficulty, cf. Guy, p. xi. κ. Or must *launde* be taken here for *lande* = saltus? Cf. Morris, Gloss. to *Allit. Poems*, s. v. *launde*.
- p. 3, l. [62](#). *set*, means “seat, sedes”; O.Icel. *set*, O.H.G. *sez*, M.H.G. *sitz*. This stanza as it stands seems to be incorrect, there being no rhyme to *sete*; possibly a line has been lost after l. 63.

- p. 3, l. [67](#). The subject of the sentence is wanting. For more instances see Zupitza's note to *Guy*, l. 10. It is to be observed that for the most part the subject wanting is of the same person as the object of the preceding sentence.—*he was god and trew of divers langages* = “he well knew, understood them perfectly.”
- p. 3, l. [68](#). *dromonde* : *poundis*. Read *dromounde* (which occurs l. 125): *pounde* (see l. 2336). [p099](#)
- p. 3, l. [69](#). We find *fro* and *from* in this poem. Both belong to the Midland dialect. *Fro* is confirmed by the rhyme *fro* : *so* (l. 2760). It is derived from the Scandinavian *fra*; Mod. Eng. has retained it in “froward,” and in the phrase “to and fro.” The same word enters as a prefix into composition in O.E. compounds, as *fr-ettan*, etc. *Babyloyne*, the author pronounced *Babyloyne* as well as *Babylone* (either rhyming, cf. ll. 30, 3260).
- p. 3, l. [74](#). *qweynte*, “famous, excellent,” cf. Skeat, *Etymol. Dict.* p. 482, s. v. *quaint*. *for the nones*, “for the nonce, for the occasion.” Cf. Zupitza's note to *Guy*, 612; it is often used as a kind of expletive.
- p. 3, l. [75](#). *to presente you*. The *Destruction de Rome* has: “vous quidai presenter.”
- p. 3, l. [76](#). French: “Uns vens nous fist à Rome parmi le far sigler.” *Destr.* l. 120.
- p. 3, l. [77](#). Cf. *Destr.* ll. 115–16. See *Introduction*, p. xxiii.
- p. 3, l. [78](#). About the rhyme *Rome* : *one*, see *Introduction*, p. xliii.
- p. 3, l. [79](#). *bygone*, “afflicted, pressed hard;” literally it means, “overrun, covered.” Cf. Shakespeare, *Julius Caesar*:

“Even such a one,
So pale, so spiritless, and woe-begone.”

- p. 3, l. [82](#). *vilane* : *remedye*. Read *vilanye*, as in l. 2577, where it rhymes with *Gye*, see *Introduction*, p. xlv, and Ellis, *Pronunciation*, I. 271.
- p. 3, l. [83](#). *colde*, used here and in l. 91 in nearly the same sense as in the expressions collected by Zupitza, in his note to *Guy*, 1149.
- p. 3, l. [84](#). *tithynge*. So with *th* in ll. 1787, 714, 783; in ll. 65, 91, 149, 324, etc., we read *tidinge*. There are several instances where *d* and *th* in the

middle of a word seem to be promiscuously used in this poem; as *hithire* l. 1265, *hider* 1869 (cf. also *dogdir* 2580, and *doghter* 96, 124, etc.).

- p. 3, l. [86](#). Mahounde, Appolyn and Termagant are the principal deities (cf. ll. 2105, 2177, 2761) of the Mahometans, who were considered as pagans = *payens* (ll. 535, 1040) or *paynym* (ll. 539, 866, etc.). Other idols of the Saracens are mentioned in ll. 2761–2 of the *Sowdone*. Compare also Gautier's note to l. 8, of his *Edition critique de la Chanson de Roland*, and Skeat, *Prioress's Tale* (Clarendon P.S.), 161/2000.
- p. 3, l. [88](#). *theyme* instead of *hem* occurs only three times in the poem (ll. 88, 1237, 2787). There must be some corruption here, as there is no rhyme to *theym*. The last stanza ends at l. 87, and the next one begins at l. 89. As far as the sense is concerned we could easily do without this line; it ought perhaps to be regarded as spurious.
- p. 3, l. [93](#). *Ferumbras* is spelt differently in the different versions of the romance. In the *Sowdan* we always find *Ferumbras*, in the Ashmole MS. *Ferumbras* and *Fyrumbras*. He is called *Fierabras* in the French [p100](#) *Ferabras* in the Provençal version; the *Destruction* has *Fierabras*, but more frequently *Fierenbras*. In Caxton's *Life of Charles the Great* his name is *Fyerabras*, Skelton has *Pherumbras*, Lyndsay *Pharambras*, and in Barbour's *Bruce* we read *Ferambrace*; see *Introduction*, pp. xxv and xxxii.
- p. 4, l. [99](#). *Oliborn*. This name does not occur in any other version of this poem. The same is the case with regard to *Espiard*, l. 103. None of the French versions gives any name to the Soudan's messenger. In the Ashmole MS. l. 3823, the messenger is called *Malyngryas*.
- p. 4, l. [102](#). *Assye* = Asia. This name does not occur in the other versions of the poem; cf. note to l. 1000.
- p. 4, l. [103](#). Cf. the *Destruction*, l. 202:

“Par tote la terre sont li baron mande”

ferre and nere, cf. ll. 117, 996, and the note to l. 528 of *Syr Ferumbras*.

p. 4, l. [104](#). *frike*, “quick, bold,” O.E. *frec*. See Stratmann, *Dictionary*, p. 225.

p. 4, l. [108](#). *Don*. Compare *Introduction*, p. xxxvii.

p. 4, l. [109](#). The passage is not clear. Perhaps there is some corruption here and we ought to read: *anon rowte*, “assembled quickly, immediately”; *rowte* would then be the preterite formed on the analogy of *lighte*, *graunte*, *commaunde*, etc. See *Introduction*, p. xxxviii.

p. 4, l. [110](#). *Destruction*, l. 217:

“Par C fois M payen.”

p. 4, l. [112](#). *douzte* : *route*. See *Introduction*, p. xlv, and note to l. 9.

p. 4, l. [113](#). *Lucafer* is the name of the Saracen King in all the versions of this romance but in the French one, where with the single exception of one passage (l. 2242 *Lucafer*), he is always called *Lucifer*, cf. *Introd.* p. xx.

p. 4, l. [114](#). *lorde and governoure*. This repetition of the same idea by two synonymous words, the one of English and the other of French origin, is very common in M.E. writers. Thus we read in this poem, l. 2164 *lorde and sire*, l. 225 *serchid and sought*, ll. 3199, 1936 *joye and game*, l. 742 *wel and fine*.

p. 4, l. [118](#). A *carrik* was a kind of large ship, called *caraca* in Italian, *carraca* in Spanish and Portuguese, *carraque* in French, *kraecke* in Dutch. The etymology is not clear. See Diez, *Etymol. Wörterb.*, I. 112. Halliwell has ‘*carrack*, a Spanish galleon. Sometimes English vessels of great value and size were so called.’

p. 4, l. [119](#). *Destruction*, l. 385:

“Par vii fois sont C mil, si l’estoire ne ment.”

p. 4, l. [124](#). *his faire daughter Floripas*. Floripas is described as follows in the *Destruction*, ll. 252–262:

“Aitant es vous la bele ou il n’out qu’enseignier
 Vestue d’un diapre, onke ne vi tant chier, [p101](#),
 Ses crins sur ses epaules plus lusoient d’or mier,
 Sa char out bele et blanke plus que noifs en fevrier,
 Les oes avoit plus noirs que falcon montenier,
 Et le colour vermaile con rose de rosier,
 La bouche bien seant et douce pour baisier,
 Et les levres vermailes come flour de peskier;
 Les mameles out dures com pomme de pomnier,
 Plus sont blanches que noifs que chiet apres fevrier;
 Nuls hom ne porroit ja sa grant bealte preisier.”

Compare also the French *Fierabras*, ll. 2007, *et seq.*

p. 4, l. [128](#). This line is clearly imitated from the *Destruction*, ll. 331–2:

“En sa main .i. baston que contremont bailie,
 Et manace François pour faire les loye.”

Cf. *Introduction*, p. xxiii.

p. 5, l. [131](#). *breddes*, “birds”; *l* and *r* very often change their place in a word. Thus we find *worlde* and *wrolde*, *crafti* and *carfti*, etc.

p. 5, l. [132](#). *sowdon* and *sowdan* are used promiscuously in the rhymes.

p. 5, l. [146](#). *Destruction*, ll. 445–6:

“N’i remeigne chastels, dongeons ne fermete
 Moustiers ne abbeie que ne soit embrase.”

p. 5, l. [150](#). Compare the *Destruction*, ll. 503–4:

“L’apostoile de Rome ad la novele oie
 Ke payen sont venu els plains de Romanie.”

p. 5, l. [157](#). *unknowne* makes no sense. Perhaps we ought to read *yknowne* or *not unknowne*. In the *Destruction*, ll. 509–513—

“Seignours, ke le feromes, franke gent segnorie?
 Li admirals d’Espaigne a no terre seisie;
 Il en ont ja gastee une moult grant partie:
 Au bref terme serra ceste terre exillie;
 Qui bon consail saura vienge avant si nous die.”

p. 5, l. [160](#). *unneth*, O.E. *unêaðe*, “uneasily, scarcely.” Chaucer has *unnethë*, the final *e* being almost always sounded. See *Introduction*, p. xxxix.

p. 5, l. [163](#). *gydoure* evidently means “guide, conductor, commander.”

- p. 5, l. [164](#). *houne* = *hounde*. On the elision of final *d*, see Skeat, *Specimens of Early English*, 320/261, and *Preface to Havelok*, p. xxxvii.
- p. 5, l. [165](#). *Ifrez*. There is no person of this name in any other version. Perhaps this Ifres may be identical with Jeffroi, mentioned as a senator of Rome in the *Destruction* (ll. 1122, 1139, 1367).
- p. 6, l. [170](#). About the phrase “douce France” compare Léon Gautier’s note to l. 15 of his *Edition critique de la Chanson de Roland*.
- p. 6, l. [171](#). *Savaris*. The author has found this name in the *Destruction*, l. 540.
- p. 6, l. [173](#). *Kinge* : *thinge*. In my dissertation on the language and the sources of the *Sowdan of Babylon*, p. 4, bottom, I have shown [p102](#) that *i* or *y*, which corresponds to O.E. *y*, the *umlaut* of *u*, rhymed with original *i* in this poem, which proves that the author wrote in the East Midland dialect. But among the examples collected there (p. 5), I ought not to have cited *kinge*, because this word is not peculiar to the East Midland speech, but occurs with the same form in all dialects. See *Introduction*, p. xxxv.
- p. 6, ll. [175–6](#) are imitated from the *Destruction*, ll. 546–7. See *Introduction*, p. xxiii.
- p. 6, l. [176](#). *ner*, the common form for *nor* (267, 1633) in this poem. “*Polaynes* are knee-pieces in a suit of armour. This term for *genouilleres* is found in the household book of Edward I.” (Morris, *Glossary on Sir Gawayne*, s. v. *polaynes*).
- p. 6, l. [181](#). *tyte*, “soon, quick.” The editor of the Roxburghe Club edition of the *Sowdan* curiously confounds *tyte* with *tightly* = “adroitly,” occurring in Shakespeare, *Merry Wives*, I. 3. *Tyte* is derived from O.Icel. *tîðr*, “creber,” the neuter of which *tîtt*, used adverbially means “crebro, celeriter.” See Stratmann, p. 561, s. v. *tîd*.
- p. 6, l. [189](#). *Chek* = “cotton, linen or woollen cloths, woven or printed in checkers.” (Latham, *Dictionary*, 1876.)
- p. 6, l. [191](#). A line seems to be wanting here. There is no rhyme to *displayed*.

- p. 6, l. [201](#). *randon*, “rapidity, force.” About the etymology see Diez, *Etym. Wörterbuch*, I. 342, and Skeat, *Etym. Dict.*
- p. 7, l. [202](#). *than* seems to be an error for *thay*.
- p. 7, l. [214](#). *Sarysyns*. There are several spellings of the name of this people in the poem: *Sarsyns*, *Sarsenys*, *Sarisyns*, *Sarasyns*.
- p. 7, l. [222](#). *that day* occurs again in l. 223. The author probably only wrote it once; the repetition is most likely due to the scribe.
- p. 7, l. [224](#). The following lines are imitated from the *Destruction*, ll. 613–619; see *Introduction*, p. xxiii.
- p. 7, l. [228](#). The French text (*Destruction*, l. 624) has:

“Maintenant soient tot occis et descoupe.
Ne voil que mi serjant en soient encombre.”

- p. 8, l. [247](#). The original meaning of *brayde* is “start, blow,” but this makes no sense here, nor can it mean “a boast,” as the editor of the Roxburghe Club edition explains it. But Mid. Eng. *brayde*, as well as O.E. *brægd* or *bregd*, often signifies “deceit, craft, a cunning trick, a fraudulent contrivance, a stratagem or artifice.” See Mätzner’s *Wörterb.* and Halliwell’s *Dict.* This, I think, is also the meaning of *brayde* in l. 247. Floripas has been engaged to Lukafer who had promised the Soudan, her father, to bring the emperor Charlemagne and all his twelve peers to the foot of his throne, in return for the hand of his daughter. Floripas, not at all enamoured of the king of Baldas, but obeying the will of her father, said she would only agree to [p103](#) accept him when he had fulfilled these conditions. But she does not believe that Laban thinks of ever fulfilling them, she is persuaded that those words, those promises made by Laban, are only a *brayde*, i. e. a stratagem or artifice devised by him in the hope of winning her hand before the performance of his promise. This signification of *braide* has been retained in the Mod. Eng. adjective *braid*, “crafty, deceitful.”
- p. 8, l. [257](#). The *Ethiopes*, “Ethiopians,” are not mentioned in the other versions of this romance. On the rhyme *Aufricanes* : *stones* cf. *Introduction*, p. xxxv.
- p. 9, l. [278](#). *Destruction*, l. 908:

“Sortibrans a mande Mabon l’engineor.”

p. 9, l. [283](#). *depe* : *tyde*. The rhyme becomes perfect if we read *wide* instead of *depe*.

p. 9, l. [286](#). French text gives, l. 934:

“Si emplirons les fossés.”

p. 9, l. [289](#). Cf. *Destruction*, l. 627. “Mahon te benoie,” and l. 925, “Mahon te doint honour.”

p. 9, l. [293](#). *Men myght go even to the walle*, compare the *Destruction*, l. 918:

“K’om poet aler al mure.”

and l. 958:

“K’om pooit bien au mur et venir et aler.”

p. 9, l. [295](#). *assaile*, evidently a mistake. Read *assaute*, as in l. 2205.

p. 9, l. [298](#). *shour*, “fight, attack.” See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 9206. *sharpe shoures*, as in the *Destruction of Troy*, l. 5804, “sharp was the shoure.” Cf. also l. 950 of this poem, “bataile was sharpe.”

p. 9, l. [300](#). *stones thai bare*, etc. *Destruction*, l. 967:

“Ces dedens ou grans pieres firent grant lapide.”

p. 9, l. [303](#). French text gives (l. 975):

“Maintes pieres del mur ont contreval rue.”

p. 9, l. [306](#). In the *Destruction*, l. 977:

“L’asalt dureit cel jour jusque a la nutee.”

p. 9, l. [307](#). French: “Payen se sont retrait.” *Destruction*, l. 979.

p. 10, l. [311](#). For *tyde* : *chidde* see *Introduction*, p. xliii.

p. 10, l. [312](#).

“Lucafer li traitre traison ad pense,
 Qu’il se contrefera les armes del cite;
 Et tote si pense sont a Labam demonstre.
 ‘Sire admirail d’Espaigne,’ ceo dist li diffaiies,
 ‘La cite est moult fors, et François sont doute;
 Ils defendront le mur, ja mais n’iert entre,
 Que par une voidie que jeo ai porpense.
 Il ad dedens un conte de mult grant cruhalte,
 Savaris ad a non, est de grant parente;
 Chescon jour il s’en ist, s’est oue nous melle,
 De la gent dieffae, mainte teste a coupe.”

—*Destr.*, ll. 986–96.

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p. 10, l. [317](#). *Destruction*, l. 997.

“J’ai bien conu ses armes et les ai avise.”

p. 10, l. [331](#). *Destruction*, l. 1011:

“Tantost le mestre porte aurons moult bien ferme.”

p. 10, l. [332](#). *Destruction*, l. 1057:

“Mais tot le premier bail ont Sarrasin poeple.”

p. 10, l. [336](#). *discumfiture*, “defeat.” See below, note to l. 1320.

p. 10, l. [339](#). *ryme*, “to speak loudly, to cry.” O.E. *hrêman* or *hrÿman*. See Stratmann, p. 322.

p. 10, l. [340](#). French text (l. 1063):

“De V. M. ne remendrent que iiiC sans fausser.”

See note to l. 67.

p. 10, l. [341](#). *twelfe* : *selve*; *f* and *v* very often stand for one another, see *Introduction* on p. xliii.

p. 10, l. [344](#). *shite* : *mette*. See Ellis, *Pronunc.*, I. 272, and *Introduction*, on p. xliv. Cf. also ll. 2054, 2963, 2960. *by than* = then; see Mätzner’s *Wörterb.* p. 217(2).

p. 11, l. [346](#). *Estragot* or *Astragot*. This name is not to be found in the other versions, it only occurs in the *Sowdan* and in the *Destruction*; cf. *Destr.* l. 1090–4:

“Estragot le poursuit uns geans diffaiies
.
Teste avoit com senglers, si fu rois coronés.
El main tient .i. mace de fin ascier trempe,
Un coup a Savaris desur le chef done.”

p. 11, l. [360](#). French text reads:

“Et la novele en ont l’apostoile conté.”

—*Destr.* l. 1101.

p. 11, l. [363](#). *consaile* : *slayne*. See *Introduction*, p. xliii.

p. 11, l. [364](#). See above, l. 78.

p. 11, l. [368](#). *erille* is not derived from the Erse, as the editor of the Roxburghe Club edition supposes. It is simply another spelling for *erle*, which occurs in l. 1986. O.E. *eorl*, Mod. Eng. *earl*.

p. 11, l. [369](#). There must be a gap of some lines here; between this and the following line a space has been left of about the width of one line; l. 370 is written in a much later hand.

p. 11, l. [376](#). *lettres* translates the French “li brief” (*Destr.* l. 1121), *in haste* = French “isnelement” (*Destr.* l. 1119).

p. 11, l. [377](#). *we ordeyne* makes no sense. Read *were ordeyned*, as in l. 2396. Cf. the *Destruction*, l. 1133:

“Tot troi sont coiemment de la cite hastés.”

p. 12, l. [379](#). *at a posterne*. On the posterns compare Skeat, *Spec. of Eng. Literature*, 359, 165.

p. 12, l. [380](#). *aboute mydnyghte*. French: “Tote la nuit alerent ou la lune clarté.” *Destr.* l. 1136. [p105](#)

p. 12, l. [394](#). *honde of honde*, “hand to hand.”—In the Glossary of the Roxburghe Club ed. we read: “Cast. Wherewithal to throw.” This is the sense of *cast* in l. 2471; but it occurs with two other meanings. In l. 394 *cast* signifies “device, plot, intention,” as often elsewhere. In ll. 460, 2091, 2099, 2467, 2603, 2792, it means “the act of throwing, the throw.”

p. 12, l. [400](#). *hevy*, “afflicted, sorrowful.” So in ll. 3037, 3224.

p. 13, l. [427](#). *Estagote*, miswritten for *Estragote*, cf. ll. 346, 352, and *Destr.* l. 1090. *brake on three*, cf. ll. 2234, 1388, 1269.

p. 13, l. [441](#). *Sarsyns* : *Romaynes*. See *Introduction*, p. xliv.

- p. 14, l. [464](#). *oost* does not rhyme with *beste*. Both the sense and the rhyme will be improved if we read *rest* for *oost*.
- p. 14, l. [473](#). As it stands, the line makes no sense. *This* is written indistinctly in the MS., so that we may read either *this* or *thus*; the sense requires the latter, which I think is the true reading. Or else we may keep *this* and write *idone* instead of *it done*.
- p. 15, l. [488](#). *aras*. Read *a ras*, and see note to l. 1349.
- p. 15, l. [491](#). *and armes* makes no sense, as we are hardly entitled to take *armes* for the 2nd person plural imperative; which in this poem always ends in *-eth*. See *Introduction*, p. xxxvii. I think we must change *and* into *as*. For the explanation of the phrase “as armes,” see note on l. 2660.
- p. 15, l. [495](#). The *Ascopars* or *Ascopartes* are mentioned in the *Destruction* as the subjects of the Soudan. The name of this people is not to be found in any other version. *Astopars* is merely a clerical error for *Ascopars*, which may be easily accounted for by remembering that in the MSS. the characters *c* and *t* are very often formed almost alike. The true spelling *Ascopars* is found in ll. 2196, 2648; cf. also the *Destruction*, ll. 98, 426. Nothing is known of the origin and the home of the Ascoparts. That they must have been men of great bodily strength follows from l. 496, “for ye be men of mighte,” and l. 2645, “that bene boolde and hardy to fighte.” Compare also what is said about them by Donne, in his first satire:

“Those Askaparts, men big enough to throw
Charing-cross for a bar.”

It is worthy while to note that a giant, called Askapard, occurs in the romance of Sir Bevis of Hamptoun. See Ellis, *Metr. Romances*, ed. Halliwell, p. 263.

- p. 15, l. [500](#). *Ho* is evidently a mistake for *we*. *rere-warde*, “rear-guard;” the van is called *fowarde*, ll. 502, 732, the main body *the medyl partye*, l. 735.
- p. 15, l. [504](#). *than* : *gon*. See *Introduction*, p. xxxv.
- p. 15, l. [510](#). *oon* makes no sense. I suspect the reading of this and the following stanza is quite corrupt. If ll. 510 and 511 should belong to different stanzas, the *enjambement*, or continuation of the [p106](#) sense

from one stanza to another, would be unusually strong. I am therefore inclined to think that originally a stanza began at l. 510, and that there is a line wanting after l. 509, which contained the rhyme to *bon* (l. 508). The scribe noticing the absence of rhyme tried to restore it himself. Adding *oon* to l. 510, he made it rhyme with *bon* (l. 508). Having thus destroyed the rhyme of ll. 510 and 512 (*Alisaundre* : *Cassaundre*, as in l. 984), he added *gaye* to l. 512, which now rhymed to l. 514, where he still added *to fraye*. In order to get a rhyme to l. 518, he changed in l. 516 the original *laye* (: *Romayne*) into *lan* (“he ceased, stopped”), and wrote “to” *the grounde* instead of “on” (cf. l. 1186) or “at” (cf. ll. 533, 435) *the grounde*, connecting thus these words with l. 515, whereas originally they belonged to *there he laye*, or—as *there* also may have been added by the scribe—to *he laye*. If now we read *with mayne* instead of *ful evene*, in l. 521, we get a perfect rhyme to l. 519; l. 520 having lost its rhyming line, he made it rhyme, by adding *than* to l. 522, which originally rhymed to l. 524. Now to get a rhyme to l. 524 he composed and inserted himself l. 526. Therefore I think the original reading of these two stanzas ran as follows:

- 510 Sir Ferumbras of Alisaundre
 That bolde man was in dede,
 Uppon a steede Cassaundre
 He roode in riche weede.
- 514 Sir Bryer of Poyle a Romayne
 He bare through with a spere;
 Dede on the ground [there] he laye,
 Might he no more hem dere.
- 518 That saw Huberte, a worthy man,
 Howe Briere was islayne,
 Ferumbras to quite than
 To him he rode with mayne.
- 522 With a spere uppone his shelde
 Stiffly gan he strike;
 The shelde he brake imiddis the feelde,
 His hawberke wolde not breke.

On the rhyme *Romayne : laye* (l. 514) cf. ll. 536, 890.

- p. 15, l. [514](#). *Bryer of Poyle* does not occur in any of the other versions.
- p. 15, l. [516](#). *lan*, preterite of *lin*, “to cease;” more common in the compound *blin*, contracted from * *be-lin*.
- p. 15, l. [517](#). *might he no more hem dere*. On the order of words, cf. ll. 2954, 649, 2435.
- p. 16, l. [520](#). *qwite*, “to requite, reward, retaliate, pay off.” See below note to l. 780.
- p. 16, l. [531](#). On *stronge* (O.E. *strang*) : *istonge* (O.E. *gestungen*), see *Introduction*, p. xxxv.
- p. 16, l. [532](#). *astraye*, “out of the right way or proper place, running [p107](#) about without guidance.” O.French *estraier*, which is derived from Latin *ex strada*, see Diez, *Etym. Wörterb.* I. 402; II. 296.
- p. 16, l. [541](#). *werre*, “war,” seems to owe its origin to the French *guerre*, as it is not found in O.E. It appears for the first time in the *Saxon Chronicle*, —*he coude*, “he knew, had endured.” See Mätzner’s *Grammatik*, II. 262.
- p. 17, l. [555](#). It is evident that *all ane* must be a corruption. Perhaps the conjecture of the editor of the Roxb. Club edition, supposing *all rafe* to be the true reading, may be right. But he is certainly wrong to identify this *rafe* with the *rafe* in l. 866, which, being the infinitive mood of a verb, cannot be taken for an adjective or adverb, which the sense seems to require in l. 555. Halliwell, s. v. *Raff*, gives: “in *raff* = speedily.” There is a Danish adjective, *rap*, “brisk, quick.” Cf. Skeat, *Etym. Dict.* s. v. *raffle* and *rap*.
- p. 17, l. [570](#). *certaine* spoils the rhyme. The rhyme becomes perfect if we read *without faile*, as in l. 322.
- p. 17, l. [573](#). *apligh*, “on plight, on my word.” See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 8541. It is often used as an expletive.
- p. 17, l. [580](#). *who the sowdan*, etc. = who is the Sowdan. The verb of the sentence is wanting; cf. note to l. 2156.
- p. 17, l. [587](#). French text gives:

“Et Guion de Bourgoyne ad a lui appelé
Fils est de sa soror et de sa parenté
Cosins, vous en irrés. . .”

Destr. ll. 1179, *et seq.*

p. 18, l. [613](#). *hight* = (1) “was called,” (2) “promised,” (3) “called” (partic. past). It is the preterite tense of *haten*, *hoten*, or *hat* (l. 3154). Cf. Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 169.

p. 18, l. [614](#). *than* seems to be a corruption, and I think must be left out. *Florip* is the genitive of *Florip*, which occurs as a nominative in ll. 2075, 1527. There is another nominative *Floripas* which forms the genitive *Floripas*, ll. 1659, 2350.

p. 19, l. [625](#). *Isres*, the name of the “chief porter of the town,” who betrayed the city, only occurs in the *Sowdan*; in the *Destruction* the same treachery is committed by *Tabour*, *D.* 1203.

“Uns traître del cit que del porte out les cles.”

p. 19, l. [636](#). *bandon*, literally “proclamation,” means “power, disposal.” See Skeat, *Etym. Dict.* s. v. *abandon*.

p. 19, l. [647](#). French:

“Le chief al portier trenche,” *Destr.* l. 1236.

p. 19, l. [648](#). In the *Destr.* l. 1244–5:

“Dieux” fist il “te maldie, et que t’ont engendre,
Kar traitour au darain averont mal dehe.”

p. 19, l. [650](#). *met*, a mistake for *mot*, which we find in ll. 1582, 2334, 3170.

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p. 20, l. [663](#). Cf. the *Destr.* l. 1260:

“Al moustier de saint Piere est Fierenbras alés.”

p. 20, l. [665](#). *the crosse, the crown, the nailes bente*. The relics mentioned in the *Destruction* are the crown of thorns, the cross, the nails, and the “signe,” which, as I have shown in my *Dissertation* (pp. 45, 46), does not mean “inscription of the cross,” but is the Greek σινδων, and signifies “the shroud, or winding-sheet, of the Lord, suaire, sudatorium.” In the French *Fierabras*, as well as in *Syr Ferumbras*, no mention is made of the cross.

p. 20, l. [673](#). *thare* instead of *there* would improve the rhyme. See *Introduction*, p. xxxv.

p. 20, l. [678](#). *fade*, O.E. *fadian*, “dispose, suit.” *Stratmann*, p. 187.

p. 20, l. [679](#). *frankencense* = “pure incense.” Compare Skeat, *Etym. Dict.*

p. 20, l. [686](#). *roial*, “excellent.” Cf. “roial spicerye,” *Chaucer*, ed. Morris, III. 135/142.

p. 21, l. [699](#). *Alle on a flame that cite was*; cf. the French:

“Kant il vindrent a Rome si virent luy porte oueree
La flambe en la cite moult granment alumee.
Pour grant chalour qu’i fu n’i poyoient entrer.”
(*Destr.* ll. 1378–80.)

p. 21, l. [723](#). The *Destruction*, ll. 1384–1408, has:

“Si dirrai de Charlon, le fort roi corone.
De par totes ses terres avoit ses gens mande,
N’i remest dus ne quiens ne baron el regne,
Qu’il assemble ne soient a Paris la cite.
Quant il i furent tous venu et ajouste,
L’emperere de France en halt en ad parle:
‘Seignours, or escoutes, si vous dirrai verte,
Li admirails d’Espaigne a no pais gaste
Et oue lui CM sarrazin diffiaie.
Il ont ensegie Rome, m’admirable cite,
Tot le pais entour ont il pour voir robbe;
Si jeo ne les soccour tot l’auront il gaste.’
‘Sire,’ firent li princes, ‘a vostre volonte:
Nous ne vous failliromes tant que poons durer.’
Adonc en ad li rois grant joie demene.
Quant si gent furent prest a complir son pense,
Adonc s’en est li rois eralment aprestes
Et si firent li contes de France le regne.
Quant sont appareillie si sont enchemine:
iii C mil chevaliers ad li rois el barne
Oliviers porte sa baneer que ben leu ad guie,
Rollans fu en arriere, li vassals adures.
De soccoure Guion s’en est li rois hastes.
Tant ont il nuit et jor chivalche et erre.
Qu’il sont en Romenie, n’i ont reine tire.”

p. 22, l. [744](#). *He knewe the baner of France*. The French text has: [p109](#)

“Guis parceut le baniere le roi de saint Dine,
 Encontre lui chevalche, la novele ont conte,
 Come la forte cite li payen ont gaste:
 La corone et les clous d’iloec en sont robbe
 Et les altres reliques. . .”

p. 23, l. [766](#). *for*, “notwithstanding, in spite of.” So also in l. 2904.

p. 23, l. [771](#). *Destr.*, l. 1425:

“Li vens en fiert es voiles que les a ben guies.”

p. 23, l. [776](#). *for south*, “forsooth,” cf. ll. 2014, 897, 2024, 1025, 2246.

p. 23, l. [778](#). French: “il sont en terre entre.”

p. 23, l. [779](#). *fonde* : *grounde*. *fonde* is spelt *founde* in ll. 1857, 3020, 344, 2353, 2363.

p. 23, l. [780](#). *stroyeth* = “destroyeth.” “Compounds of Romance origin, the first part of which is a preposition, or words derived from such, often mutilate, or even entirely drop the preposition” (Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 576). Thus we have *sail*, l. 385, = “assail;” *longeth*, l. 3254, = “belongeth;” *skomfited*, l. 1320, = “diskomfited,” ll. 336, 1464; *quite*, l. 520, = “requite;” *perceived*, l. 2659, = “aperceived;” *saut*, ll. 619, 2200, = “assaut,” l. 615; *ginne*, l. 2326, = “enginne,” l. 333; *playne*, l. 177, = “complayn;” *skaped*, l. 2049, = “askaped,” l. 2218.

p. 23, l. [787](#). French: “iiiC mile François.”

p. 24, l. [812](#). *ychoon* : *Mahounde*. See *Introduction*, p. xlii.

p. 24, l. [820](#). *stroke* : *stoupe*. See *Introduction*, p. xliii.

p. 24, l. [820](#). *stenyed*, “stunned,” not from O.Fr. *estaindre*, as the editor of the Roxb. Club ed. suggests, but from O.E. *stunian*, “percellere, stupefacere.” See *Stratmann*, p. 540.

p. 24, l. [835](#). Observe the subject expressed twice; cf. ll. 723, 1031, 1682, 1814, 2331.

p. 25, l. [836](#). *Neymes*. This celebrated hero has been especially famous by the advices and counsels of which even in matters of greatest difficulty he was never at a loss. “Tel conseiller n’orent onques li Franc,” *i. e.* the French had never such a counsellor. This passage of the romance of *Aspremont* may be looked upon as containing the portrait of Neymes as we find him described in all poems. The story of his birth and youth is in

the romance of *Aubri le Bourgoing*. He was the son of Gasselin, king of Bavaria. Cassile, an usurper, is about to seize the throne and to kill the young Neymes, when Charlemagne comes to his help and re-establishes the legitimate inheritor.

p. 25, l. [836](#). *Ogier Danoy*s (cf. l. 1687) is one of the twelve peers in this poem. His life is contained in the French poem of the “*Chevalerie Ogier*” by Raimbert de Paris. According to that romance Ogier had been delivered in his youth to Charlemagne as [p110](#) a pledge to secure the discharge of the tribute which his father Geffroi, king of Denmark, was bound to pay to the emperor. The French ambassadors having once been insulted by Geffroy, Charlemagne swears to make Ogier pay with his life the offence done by his father, and Ogier is going to be executed when the emperor, following the urgent requests of messengers arrived from Rome, suddenly starts to deliver this city from the Saracens. On this expedition the French army is hard pressed by the enemy, but Ogier by his eminent prowess and valour enables Charles to enter Rome. He now is pardoned and becomes the favourite of the emperor. Several years afterwards Ogier’s son Baudouinet is slain by Charlot, the son of Charlemagne, as they were quarrelling about a party of chess. Ogier, in order to revenge his son, goes as far as to attack Charlemagne himself, but on the point of being taken a prisoner, he escapes and flees to Didier, king of Lombardy. Charles makes war on Didier, and after a long struggle Ogier is taken and imprisoned at Reims, where he is going to be starved, when a sudden invasion of the Saracens obliges Charlemagne again to have recourse to the courage and valour of the Dane. Ogier delivers France by slaying the giant Bréhus. To reward him for the service done to his country, Charles gives him the county of Hainaut, where afterwards, as the poem tells us, he died in the renown of holiness.

p. 25, l. [845](#). *it* = “hit.” Cf. note to l. 41.

p. 25, l. [847](#)–50. These four lines seem to be incorrect. As they stand, the three first lines are rhymed together, and there is no rhyme to the fourth. The diction of the whole passage, which cannot be said to be ungrammatical, is nevertheless wanting in precision and exactness.

p. 25, l. [866](#). *rafe* = rave.

p. 25, l. [868](#). *Moun-joye* is the name of Charlemagne's sword in this poem (cf. ll. 3111, 850), whereas, according to all other romances, the emperor's sword was called *Joyeuse*. *Mounjoie* or *Montjoie* was the name of the French standard; it was likewise used as the battle-cry of the French, cf. *Fierabras*, l. 1703, and *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 2285, 2652, 4577, 4727. The sword *Joyeuse* had been forged by the celebrated Weland or Galand, as we read in the French *Fierabras*, l. 635:

“Et *Galans* fist Floberge à l’acier atrempé,
Hauteclere et *Joieuse*, où moult ot dignité;
Cele tint Karlemaines longuement en certé.”

Compare Gaston Paris, *Histoire Poétique*, p. 374.

p. 26, l. [875](#). *Durnedale*. This renowned sword was forged by the famous Galand or Weland. The French *Fierabras* (l. 645) is the only romance which attributes it to Munifican. It had been given by Charlemagne to Roland as the best of his warriors. As to the exploits achieved with it, Roland enumerates them himself in that celebrated passage, where in his death-hour he tries to break [p111](#) *Durnedale* to prevent it from falling into the hands of the Saracens (*Chanson de Roland*, ll. 2316–2337). The steel blade of this sword has been highly praised for its extraordinary hardness. It had been tried by Charlemagne himself on that “perron,” or steel block before the emperor's palace in Aix-la-Chapelle (see *Histoire Poétique*, p. 370). *Durnedale* proved good as well as *Almace*, the sword of Turpin. But *Courtain*, Ogier's sword, was then shortened by half a foot. According to l. 1407 of the *Sowdan*, *Durnedale* broke; but this incident has been mentioned nowhere else. Cf. *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 997, and *Fierabras*, l. 1740.

p. 26, l. [876](#). *romme*, spelt also *rome*, *rowme*, *roum*, is Mod. E. *room*, O.E. *rûm*, “spatium.”

p. 26, l. [880](#). *dinge*; read *gan dinge*. *Dinge* is the infinitive mood, but the sense requires a preterite tense. The preterite of *dinge* is *dong*, *dongen*, which occurs in l. 1263. But as *dinge* cannot be altered here, on account

of the rhyme, the passage is easily corrected by adding *gan* = “he began to strike, he struck.”

p. 26, l. [884](#). *Alloreyne*s of *Loreyne*s and *Aleroyse* (l. 1699) are probably identical. Then *Alloreyne*s would be an error of the scribe, who having already the following *Loreyne*s in his mind wrote *Alloreyne*s instead of *Alleroys*e.

p. 26, l. [900](#). *in fay* = “truly,” *fay*= “faith, truth.” O.Fr. *fei* or *feid*, Lat. *fides*.

p. 26, l. [904](#)–5. Cf. *Chanson de Roland*, ll. 1903–4:

“Rollanz est proz e Oliviers est sages,
Ambedui unt merveillus vasselage.”

p. 27, l. [913](#). I cannot tell what *treyumple* means, or whether it be a corruption.

p. 27, l. [939](#). This kind of prayer or apostrophe addressed to the God of War is certainly taken from another English work, which I am unable to trace, but which must have been much known at the time of our author, as we find it referred to in different authors. That it has been taken from another poem is proved by some phrases of this prayer which are somewhat obscure or rather unintelligible here, and which we certainly should be able to explain if we knew the original context in which they occurred. Then the form *hase* (l. 940) is somewhat suspicious, as it is the only instance of the 2nd person singular present dropping the *t*, which it has always in this poem. The arrangement, too, of the following stanzas differs from that generally observed in the *Sowdan*. If we consider our poem as composed in eight-line stanzas (but see *Introduction*, p. xl) we mostly find the 1st and 3rd lines rhyming together, then the 2nd and 4th, the 5th and 7th, and finally the 6th and 8th, so that *four* different rhyme-endings are necessary to one stanza. If now we consider the stanza from l. 939 to 946, we only have two rhyme-endings, all the pair lines rhyming together, and all the odd ones [p112](#) together. In ll. 947 to 950 the 1st and 4th rhyme together, whilst the 2nd and 3rd are paired off together.—ll. 939–941 we find alluded to in *Chaucer*, see *Introduction*, p. xlvi, and the

Prioress's Tale, ed. Skeat (Clarendon Press), p. xvii. Compare also Lindsay, *The Historie of Squyer Meldrum*, l. 390:

“Like Mars, the God Armipotent.”

- p. 27, l. [939](#). *rede Mars*. “Boccaccio uses the same epithet in the opening of his *Teseide*: ‘O rubiconde Marte.’ *Rede* refers to the colour of the planet.” Morris, note to *Knight's Tale*, l. 889.
- p. 27, l. [940](#). *Baye* never means “sword,” as the editor of the Roxburghe Club ed. renders it, nor does this translation make any sense here at all; *baye* signifies “a wide, open room or space in a building.” See Mätzner's *Wörterbuch*, p. 164. Morris, in the Glossary to the *Alliterative Poems*, has “bay = recess. The original meaning seems to be *opening of any kind*. Cf. bay, space in a building between two main beams.” Halliwell, s. v. bay, has: “A principal compartment or division in the architectural arrangement of a building.” It appears to be etymologically the same word as Ital. *baja*, French *baie*, “bay, gulf, harbour,” the French *baie* being equally used for “opening of any kind.” The Catalan form for *baie* is *badia*, which corresponds to the verb *badar*, meaning “to open.” See Diez, *Etym. Wörterb.* I. 46. *Bay* is retained in the Mod. E. compound “*bay-window*.” Cf. also the French “*la bée d'une fenestre*,” cited by Carpentier-Ducange, s. v. beare. With regard to the signification of *trende*, the editor of the Roxb. Club ed. wrongly guessed again in explaining it as “drawn” or “trenchant, cutting.” *Trende* means “turned, bent, vaulted in the form of an arch.” See Halliwell, p. 887, and Stratmann, p. 572, s. v. trenden (= “volvere”). But I am at a loss how to explain why Mars is said to have put up his throne in an arched recess, or compartment, of a building.
- p. 28, l. [957](#). *some*, a clerical error for *sone*.
- p. 28, l. [965](#). *prymsauns of grene vere* = “the earliest days of green spring” (Glossary to the Roxb. Club ed.). This may be the sense; but what is the literal meaning of *prymsauns*? If we had *prymtauns*, or *prymtaunce*, we might be inclined to take it for a corruption of French *printemps*, as we find *pastaunce* or *pastance* corrupted from *passe-temps*. (See Skeat,

Spec. of Eng. Literature, 460/149 and 427/1096.) Cf. also the *Romaunt of the Rose*, ll. 3373–74: “At *prime temps*, Love to manace, Ful ofte I have been in this caas.” Or is *prymtauns* perhaps a clerical error for *entrauns* or *entraunce*? This would then make us think of such passages as the following one:

“Che fu ou mois de mai, à l’*entree* d’esté,
Que florissent cil bos et verdissent cil pré.”

Fierabras, ll. 5094–5.

- p. 28, l. [966](#). *sprynghyn*, the only instance of the 3rd person present plural ending in *-yn* (for the common *-en*). This perhaps is due to [p113](#) the scribe thinking already of the following *yn* in *begynne*. But it must be stated that the whole passage is rather obscure. Neither the meaning of *springyn* and *begynne* nor the connection of l. 966 with the following lines is very clear. *Floures* occurring twice looks also somewhat suspicious. Moreover, these two stanzas do not well suit the context and might easily be done without; they are evidently borrowed from some other poem. Observe besides the alliteration in *floures*, *frithe*, *freshly*.
- p. 28, l. [973](#). *lithe*, “to hear.” O.Icel. *hlýða*, “auscultare.” *Stratmann*, s. v. *hlîþen*, p. 315.
- p. 29, l. [993](#). *lese* miswritten for *lefe*, which sense and rhyme require, and which occurs in ll. 832, 1526.
- p. 29, l. [995](#). *bassatours* (?) = “vavassours, vavasors.”
- p. 29, l. [999](#). *Inde Major*. The meaning of *Major* is not clear. Cf. besides *Chanson de Roland*, ed. Gautier, *Glossarial Index*, s. v. *Major*. Compare also *Destr.* l. 690: *terre Majour*.
- p. 29, l. [1000](#). The great number of geographical names contained in these two lines is probably due to the favourite habit of mediæval romance writers, who thought that they showed their geographical knowledge by introducing long strings of names. Thus we find in *Web. Rom.* II. l. 632 *et seq.*, the names of sixteen towns mentioned in fourteen lines, all of which are said to have been visited by Richard the Lion-hearted. Again in the same poem, ll. 3679, *et seq.*, we find the names of thirteen countries occurring in ten lines. Cf. also *King Alis.*, *Web. Rom.* I. ll. 1440 and

1692. Often, too, geographical names seem to be inserted on account of the rhyme, as *Chaunder* in l. 123, and *Europe* in l. 1001.

- p. 29, l. [1008](#). *Camalyon*, “meaning, probably, the camelopardalis. The blood of aameleon would go a very little way towards satisfying a thirsty Saracen” (Ellis, *Metr. R.* 387). Perhaps also the poet did not know much of either of these two kinds of animals, and all he wished was to cite an animal with some outlandish name.
- p. 30, l. [1025](#). *southe* : *wrothe*. The spelling *sothe* occurs in ll. 2014, 2024, 2246, 2719. There must be a lacuna of one or more lines here. The rhyme-word to *dute* (l. 1024) is wanting; the context also evidently shows that ll. 1025 and 1026, as they stand together, make no sense. It is worth while to add that the next five lines, contrary to the common usage of our poem, are all rhymed together.
- p. 30, l. [1040](#). Observe *Paens*, i. e. “pagans,” used as a proper name here; cf. the *Destr.* l. 98, and *Fierabras*, l. 5673.
- p. 31, l. [1051](#). For a description of *Ferumbras*, compare *Fierabras*, ll. 578 *et seq.*, and ll. 611 *et seq.*, and *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 550.
- p. 31, l. [1060](#). *trwes* = trues, truce.
- p. 31, l. [1067](#). *sex*. So in the French *Fierabras*, l. 84:

“Ja n’en refuserai, par Mahom, jusqu’à vi.”

⟨p114⟩

In the English *Ferumbras*, l. 102, we read:

“And þoʒ þer come *twelue*, þe beste of þy fered,
I will kupe on hem my mizt, & dyngen hem al to douste.”

- p. 31, l. [1071](#). *in fere* = “together.” *fere*, literally “one who fares with one,” means “a travelling companion, a comrade, a mate; a company.” O.E. (*ge-*)*fera*.
- p. 31, l. [1074](#). *man* = “bondman, subject, vassal.” So in ll. 1354 1466.
- p. 31, l. [1077](#). *childe*, “young knight, young man.” See Skeat’s note to *Sir Thopas* (Clarendon Press), 162/2020.
- p. 31, l. [1084](#). Cf. the French text:

“Sire, ce dist Rollans, chertes, tort en aves,
 Car, par icel seigneur Ki Dix est appelés,
 Je vauroie moult miex que fuissiés desmenbrés
 Ke jou en baillasse armes ne ne fuisse adobés.
 Hier quant paien nous vindrent à l’issue des gués
 L. mile furent, à vers helmes jesmés,
 Grans caus en soustenimes sur les escus bandés;
 Oliviers mes compaigns i fu le jour navrés.
 Tout fuissons desconfit, c’est fines verités,
 Quant vous nous secourustes e vos riches barnés,
 Et paien s’en tournerent les frains abandonnés.
 Quant fumes repairié as loges et as trés,
 Puis te vantas le soir, quant tu fus enivrés,
 Que li viel chevalier c’avoies amené
 L’avoient moult miex fait que li joule d’assés,
 Assés en fui le soir laidement ramponés.”

(ll. 144–161.)

Compare also *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 144–163

p. 32, l. [1088](#). *of* = “on account of.”

p. 32, l. [1092](#). According to most of the old romances Roland was invulnerable. He never lost any blood by a wound but on the occasion when he was beaten by Charlemagne

“For trois goutes sans plus, quant Charles par irour
 Le feri de son gant que le virent plousour.”

See *Histoire Poétique*, p. 264.

The French text (ll. 166–170) runs as follows:

“Karles trait son gant destre, qui fu à or parés
 Fiert le comte Rollant en travers sur le nés;
 Après le caup en est li sans vermaus volés.
 Rollans jete le main au branc qui est letrés;
 Ja en ferist son oncle se il n’en fust ostés.”

p. 32, l. [1094](#). *abye*, “to pay for, suffer for.” In Mod. Eng. *abye* is corrupted into *abide*. See Morris, Gloss. to *Chaucer* (Clarend. Press), s. v. *aboughte*.

p. 32, l. [1096](#). Double negatives like *never none* are pretty common in mediæval writers. Cf. in the *Sowdan*, ll. 1876, 2181, 2199, 2279, 2305.

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p. 32, l. [1103](#). *at one*, “of one mind, agreement.” Cf. *King Horn*, ed. Lumby, l. 925:

“At on he was wiþ þe king.”

Hence Mod. Eng. *atone*, “to set at one, to reconcile.” See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 5308.

- p. 32, l. [1106](#). *to make voydaunce*, the same as *to voide*, l. 1768 = “to quit, to depart from, to get rid of.”
- p. 32, l. [1110](#). *withoute more* = “without delay, immediately.” *more* is O.E. *mâra*, comparative to *micel*; it is not the Latin *more*. See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 719.
- p. 33, l. [1126](#). *renewed*, “tied.” Fr. *renouer*, from *næud* = Lat. *nodius*. It is to be distinguished from *renewed* = “renovated,” which occurs in l. 2200.
- p. 32, l. [1128](#). *hidur* is spelt *hider* in ll. 810, 833, etc.
- p. 32, l. [1135](#). *Generyse*. In the other versions Olyver calls himself *Garin*. See *Introduction* on p. xxxiii.
- p. 32, l. [1141](#). *lerne*, “to teach.” See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 6352. *scole*, O.E. *scôl*, Mod. Eng. *school*, means here “style, or manner of fighting.” It must not be confounded with *schole*, O.E. *scolu*, “troop, band,” Mod. Eng. *shoal*. Cf. also *The Song of Roland*, 129/786.
- p. 33, l. [1145](#). *myghty men of honde*. So in l. 3029. The same phrase occurs in M.H.G. “ein helt ze sînen handen,” which is explained as meaning, “a hero [or one who becomes a hero] by the strength of his hands or arms.” See Jänicke’s note to *Biterolf*, 5078, and Grimm’s *Grammatik*, IV. 727 note. The expression seems to be originally French; cf. Méon, *Fabliaux*, III. 478: “chevaliers *de sa main*”; *Renard*, ed. Martin, l. 21409: “proedom *de sa main*.” Cf. also *Roman des Eles*, ed. Scheler, l. 433, where *main* is wrongly explained by the editor.
- p. 33, l. [1151](#). *plete*, “plead.” The rhyme leads us to suppose that the author pronounced *ple de*, which indeed is the more common form.
- p. 33, l. [1154](#). *and* makes no sense here. *thenkes* must also be incorrect, the 3rd person present singular always terminating in *-eth* in this poem, and not in *-es*. Read *as thenketh me*; *thenketh me* occurs in l. 465.
- p. 34, l. [1158](#). *pight*, “pitched, fixed.” The infinitive mood is *picchen*; cf. O.Dutch *picken*, O.Icel. *pikka*, “pungere, pangere.”

- p. 34, l. [1159](#). In the French *Fierabras*, l. 606 *et seq.*, Oliver also assists the Saracen to put on his gear. This point is not mentioned in the Ashmolean version, see *Introduction*, p. xxviii.
- p. 34, l. [1163](#). *worthed up*, “became up, got up, mounted.” It is the past tense of the verb *worthen*, O.E. *weorðan*, “to become.” Another past tense of this verb is *worth*, l. 1204.
- p. 34, l. [1164](#). *areest*, or *arest* = “a rest, or support for the spear when [p116](#) couched for the attack” (Morris). Originally = “stoppage, waiting, readiness.” Cf. Mätzner’s *Wörterbuch*, p. 107.
- p. 34, l. [1167](#). *as fire of thonder*, cf. *dinte of thondir* in l. 1207.
- p. 34, l. [1168](#). *to-braste*, “burst in pieces.” The prefix *to-*, answering to Germ. *zer-*, has the force of “in twain, asunder.”
- p. 34, l. [1170](#). *threste*, O.E. *þræstan*, “premere, trudere.” The author probably pronounced *thraste*, which will improve the rhyme.
- p. 34, ll. [1179](#)–80. *upon the hede* (blank in MS) *the hede*. This is evidently a mistake of the scribe; *sore*, l. 1180, too, which does not rhyme with *crowne*, is probably miswritten for *sone*. The rhyme as well as the context shows that the true reading is:

“Olyver him hitte again
Upon the hede than fulle sone
He carfe awaye with myght and mayne
The cercle that sate uppon his crowne.”

- p. 34, l. [1182](#). About the *cercle*, see Demay, *Le Costume de guerre*, p. 132. “Non seulement le cône du heaume (helme) est bordé par ce cercle, mais il est parfois renforcé dans toute sa hauteur par deux arêtes placées l’une devant, l’autre derrière, ou par quatre bandes de métal ornementées (de verroteries), venant aboutir et se croiser à son sommet.”—*crowne* means the “tonsure of the head,” then topically “the skull or head.”
- p. 34, l. [1185](#). *the botteles of bawme* are not mentioned anywhere else in the *Sowdan*; the other versions tell us that the balm contained in those vessels was the same as that with which Christ was anointed. Cf. *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 510–517; and see *Introduction*, p. vi and xxix.

p. 34, l. [1191](#). *the river*. According to the oldest version of the poem the whole combat took place on the shore of the Tiber, near Rome. See *Introduction*, pp. xi and xxxii. Cf. *Fierabras*, l. 1049:

“Pres fu du far de Rome, ses a dedes jetés,”

and *Philippe Mousket*, l. 4705–6:

“Les .ii. barius qu’à Rome prist,
Si les gieta enmi le Toivre.”

In the *Sowdan* as well as in the *Ashmole* MS. there is no mention of Oliver’s drinking of the balm before throwing it into the water, which both the Provençal and the French versions tell us he did. Cf. *Fierabras*, ll. 1031–1048, and the Provençal version, ll. 1335, *et seq.*

p. 35, l. [1210](#). *fille*, “fel.”

p. 35, ll. [1221](#). *dere* spoils the rhyme. Read “*free*.”

p. 36, l. [1250](#). *Cousyn to King Charles*, cf. l. 1117. In ll. 1499 and 1671 Oliver is said to be nephew to Charlemagne. He was the son of Renier de Gennes, who according to *Sir Ferumbras*, l. 652: “Y am Charlis emys sone”—was the uncle of Charlemagne. In the poem *Girar de Viane* we find Oliver among the enemies of the [p117](#) Emperor and fighting with Roland in close combat; they are at length stopped by divine interposition. Then began a close friendship which lasted till their death at Roncesvaux. Oliver’s sister Aude was betrothed to Roland. See, besides, *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 422, 1297, 1305, 1354.

p. 36, l. [1258](#). *harde grace*, “misfortune,” cf. l. 2790.

p. 36, l. [1259](#). *Persagyn*. This name does not occur in any other version again, except in the *Destruction*, where one Persagon appears in the list of the Saracen barons. But it is not stated there that he is uncle to Ferumbras; cf. besides *Fierabras*, ll. 2614, 2784.

p. 37, l. [1263](#). Observe the four consecutive feminine rhymes.

p. 37, l. [1277](#). The scene as related here widely differs from that described in the Ashmolean version. In the *Sowdone*, Oliver gets hold of the sword which is “trussed on Ferumbras’s stede.” In the Ashmolean poem it is not Oliver who is disarmed, but Ferumbras, and Oliver allows him to pick up

his weapon again. This in itself furnishes us an argument for conjecturing that the author of the *Sowdan* did not follow, or even know of, the Ashmolean version. In the French poem, as well as in the Provençal, it is likewise Oliver who is disarmed. If in those poems we find mentioned besides that Ferumbras offered his enemy to take up his sword again—an incident not related in the *Sowdan*—we do not consider this to disprove our supposition that the French version was the source of the *Sowdan*, as we may consider our author in this case simply to have adhered to his favourite practice of shortening his original as much as possible, so far as no essential point is concerned. Cf. the French *Fierabras*, ll. 1289–1346.

p. 37, l. [1286](#). *saught* is a misprint for *raught*.

p. 37, l. [1289](#). *He thought he quyte*. *quyte* may be explained as standing for *quyted*, or else *he* must be changed into *to*: *He thought to quyte*, the latter reading is perhaps preferable. We find in l. 3110 a passage agreeing almost exactly with this.

p. 38, l. [1298](#). *Qwyntyn*. The name of this Saint does not occur in any other version of our romance.

p. 38, l. [1308](#). There is no mention made of this prayer in the Ashmolean version, the *Sowdan* here (ll. 1308–1340) agrees again with the French *Fierabras*, ll. 1164–1244 (and with the Provençal poem, l. 1493, *et seq.*), with the only difference, that the prayer which Charlemagne addressed to God, in order to bestow the victory upon the Christian hero, is much longer in *F*; and is stuffed with so many details of the Scripture, that in some way it may be regarded as a succinct account of the whole life of the Lord.

p. 38, l. [1320](#). *skomfited* = *discomfited*, l. 1464. It is formed by the same analogy as *stroyeth* = *destroyeth*. See note to l. 780. The substantive *discumfiture*, O.Fr. *desconfiture*, occurs in l. 336; the same [p118](#) word, without prefix, is found in M.H.G., cf. *Kudrun*, ed. Martin, 646, 2:

“dô si hêten gerne die porten zuo getân
dô muosten si daz lernen durch *schumphentiuren* verlân.”

The Italian noun is *sconfitta*, and the verb *sconfiggere*.

p. 38, l. [1327](#). *God aboue* does not rhyme with *lord almighty*. The rhyme is easily restored if we read *of might* (cf. l. 2059) for *aboue*, and if we change *almighty* into *almighte*, so that we have:

l. 1327. "Tho Charles thanked God of myghte."

l. 1329. "And saide, 'blessed be thou, lord almyghte.'"

The adjective *almiȝt* is of frequent occurrence in Mid. Eng. writers. So in *Allit. Poems*, l. 497: "in sothful gospel of god almyȝt;" *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 3580, "God almyȝte: siȝte;" *ibid.* l. 3815, "god almyȝt: wyȝt."

p. 39, l. [1349](#). *cas* is an erratum for *ras*.—"Ras, shave." "Rees 1693, evening." These explanations given by the editor of the Roxb. Club ed. are wrong. *Ras* and *rees* being both derived from O.E. *ræ̆s*, "impetus cursus," are indiscriminately used in three meanings: (1) "onset, assault;" (2) "course, run, rush, haste, hurry;" (3) "space, time, occasion." The last signification is well shewn by the following passages:

"Hit lasteþ but a lutel rees."

(*Cl. Maydenhod*, l. 26.)

"Þat ys to seye upon a rees,
Stynkyng Saxone, be on pees."

(*Arthur*, ed. Furnivall, l. 525.)

In the *Sowdan ras* or *rees* means (1) "time, instant, occasion," ll. 1349, 1693; (2) "rush, hurry, haste," ll. 645, 489. *rase*, l. 774 = "current in the sea," the same word as the preceding *ras* and *rees*, meaning properly, "a narrow rush, or violent current of water." See Morris, *Chaucer's Prologue* (Clarendon Press), s. v. *reyse*. Cf. the French expressions, "raz de mer," "raz de courant," "raz de marée."

p. 39, l. [1361](#). *sene* : *be*. Read *se* as in ll. 1124, 658, 1826.

p. 40, l. [1372](#). *ryden*, which does not rhyme with *foghten*, is evidently a clerical error. I suppose *soghten* to be the true reading. For examples of *soght* = "came, went, moved," see Zupitza's note to *Guy*, l. 7151, and Skeat's Glossary to *Specimens*, s. v. *socht*.—There is still another corruption in this passage, as *assembled* does not rhyme with *ordeyned*.

p. 40, l. [1380](#). Note the transition from the indirect to the direct speech.

- p. 40, l. [1381](#). As it stands, the line is too long and spoils the rhythm. The words “if ye cast me downe” can be dispensed with.
- p. 40, l. [1383](#). *thare* : *were* (O.E. *werian*). The rhyme is easily restored by reading *there* instead of *thare*, cf. ll. 2604, 2404, 2245, etc. and see *Introduction*, p. xxxv. [p119](#)
- p. 41, ll. [1419](#)–22. Observe the weak rhymes alternating with the strong ones.
- p. 41, l. [1420](#). *brother* means “brother-in-law.” Oliver’s sister Aude was Roland’s intended bride. Perhaps also *brother* may be taken here in sense of “brother in arms,” as in most romances we find Roland and Oliver mentioned as a couple of true friends united by the most tender ties of comradeship. Besides, Oliver was highly indebted to Roland, who had rescued him when he had been made a prisoner after his duel with Ferragus.
- p. 41, l. [1423](#). *cowthe* miswritten for *caughte*, which we read in ll. 1411, 1603.
- p. 41, l. [1424](#). *Ascopartes* is the correct form. See note on l. 495.
- p. 51, l. [1427](#). *foolde* cannot be “earth” here, for which the editor of the Roxburghe Club ed. takes it. *Foolde* is the participle past of *fealden*, “to fold, plicare.” It means, “folded, bent down, fallen.” This seems also to be the sense of *folde* in the following passages:

Lazamon, 23983–4:

“Þa feol Frolle
folde to grunde.”

Ibid. ll. 27054–6:

“Romanisce veollen
fiftene hundred
folden to grunden.”

Ibid. ll. 20057–60:

“he þohte to quellen
þe king on his þeode
& his folc valden
volden to grunde.”

Cf. *Stratmann*, p. 194.

- p. 41, l. [1433](#). Roland and Olyver are taken prisoners. This incident is differently related in the other poems. There Roland is not taken at all, but sent afterwards among the messengers to the Soudan's court. Together with Oliver four knights are taken, viz. Gwylmer, Berard, Geoffrey and Aubry, who all are carried away by the flying Saracens in spite of the efforts of Roland and Ogier.
- p. 42, l. [1451](#). *what* = "who." See Koch, *Eng. Gr.* II. § 339, and Skeat's note to *Piers the Plowman* (Clarendon Press), 113/19. So in ll. 1133, 1623.
- p. 42, l. [1456](#). *astyte* has nothing to do with the Latin *astutus* with which the editor of the Roxb. Club ed. apparently confounds it in explaining it as "cunningly devised." *Astyte* means "at once, immediately, suddenly"; see Morris, Glossary to *Allit. Poems*. It is a compound of the simple word *tyte*, "soon, quickly," which see above, l. 181.
- p. 43, l. [1475](#). *Turpyn*. The name of the archbishop is not mentioned in the Ashmolean version. The French text, ll. 1836–40, runs as follows: [p120](#)

"Karles, nostre empereres, en est en piés levés,
Il apela Milon et Turpin l'alosés,
Deus rices arcevesques de moult grant sainteté:
Faites moi tost uns fons beneir et sacrer;
Je woel que cis rois soit baaptiziés et levés."

Cf. also the Provençal poem, l. 1899, *et seq.*

- p. 43, l. [1483](#). *nought for thane* = "nevertheless," cf. Koch, *Eng. Gr.* II. p. 473.
- p. 43, l. [1486](#). *Rome* is a corruption of *Roye*, as follows from the French *Fierabras*, l. 1851:

"C'est sains Florans de Roie, ce dist l'auctorités."

Cf. the Ashmole *Ferumbras*, l. 1087, and Græber, *Zeitschrift für romanische Philologie*, IV. p. 167.

- p. 43, l. [1495](#). *affrayned*, which must not be confounded with *affrayed*, as the editor of the Roxburghe Club ed. does, means "asked, inquired." It is the compound of *freynen* or *fraynen*, O.E. *frignan*, "to ask." Goth. *fraihnan*. Germ. *fragen*.

- p. 43, l. [1497](#). *allayned*, “concealed.” The simple verb *layne* (from Icel. *leyna*, cf. Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 2994) is still retained in the Scottish dialect, with the sense of “to hide.” Cf. also Morris, *Allit. Poems*, Gloss. s. v. *layned*.
- p. 43, l. [1498](#). In the other poems the prisoners do not tell their true names; see *Introduction*, pp. xxvii and xxix; and cf. *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 1167.
- p. 43, l. [1499](#). Roland is nephew to Charlemagne on his mother’s side. See note to l. 1888, and cf. the Ashmole *Ferumbras*, l. 2066. For Oliver, see above, note to l. 1250.
- p. 44, l. [1515](#). In the *Sowdan Floripas* herself advises Laban not to slay his captives, but to imprison them. In the other versions it is one of the barons who gives the same advice. See *Introduction*, p. xxviii.
- p. 44, l. [1539](#). *depe* : *myrke*. The rhyme will be restored by reading *dirke* or *derke* instead of *depe*. *derke* occurs in l. 2541.
- p. 45, l. [1604](#). *maute*. “In Old French *mauté* is malice.” Gloss. to Roxburghe Club ed. I do not know whether *mauté* exists in O.Fr., but even if it did, it would make no sense here. I feel sure *maute* is a corruption of *mynte* or *mente* (cf. l. 1784), the preterite of *minten* or *menten* = “to aim a blow, to strike,” from O.E. *myntan*, “to intend, to purpose.” See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 6579, and Morris, *Allit. Poems*, s. v. *mynte*. Cf. also *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 5587:

“Þan Charlis a strok till hym gan mynte;
Ac hym faylede of ys dynte,
for þat swerd hym glente . . .”

- p. 47, l. [1615](#). *trew* instead of *free* will restore the rhyme. The same rhyme *trew* : *newe* occurs in ll. 67, 588.
- p. 47, l. [1619](#). *fele sithe*, “many a time, often.” So in ll. 2740, 2815. Cf. *ofte sithe*, l. 916. [sp121](#)
- p. 47, l. [1624](#). *ruly*, O.E. *hrêowlîc* = “rueful, sorrowful, mournful, piteous.”
- p. 47, l. [1645](#). *harme skathe* makes no sense. Read *harme* & *skathe*, which occurs in *Gen. and Exod.* l. 2314:

“ðis sonde hem overtakeð raðe
And bicalleð of harme and scaðe.”

p. 48, l. [1665](#). In the French *Fierabras* (as well as in the Ashmolean version) it is Roland whom Charlemagne addresses first (see above, note to l. 1433); he tells him that he must go on a mission to demand the surrender of Oliver and his companions. Upon which Naymes and the other twelve peers remonstrate, but are all sent to Laban one after the other, just as in the *Sowdan*. In the Provençal poem it is only Guy who protests. Cf. ll. 2263–2282 of the French *Fierabras*:

“Rollant regarda tost, si l’a araisonné:
Biaus nés, ce dist li rois, trop sui por vous irés;
Vous movrés le matin, à Aigremore irés;
Si dirés l’amirant, gardés ne li celés,
Rende moi la courone dont Dix fu couronés
Et les autres reliques dont je sui moult penés;
Et en après demant mes chevalier menbrés;
Et se il ne le fait si que deviserés,
Dites jel ferai pendre par la goule à un trefs,
En destre le menrai com .i. larron prové,
Ne troverai putel où il ne soit passé.” etc.

p. 48, l. [1668](#). Cf. *Fierabras*, ll. 2309–2321, and *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 1486–1493.

p. 49, l. [1683](#). *lese*, “lose.” So in l. 2655 and 1696, where it rhymes with *chese*, which occurs again in ll. 2748, 2934.

p. 49, l. [1687](#). French text gives (ll. 2297, *et seq.*):

“Ogiers li boins Danois s’en est levés en piés:
Sire drois emperere, pour amour Dieu, oiés:
Bien sai se il i vont ja n’en revenra piés.
Avoec irés, dist Karles, par les ex de mon cief:
Or i serés vous .v. qui porterés mes briés.”

p. 49, l. [1691](#). *Bery* must be miswritten for *Terry*, as we find Terris d’Ardane in the French *Fierabras*, l. 2290, and Terry of Ardane in *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 1469. According to l. 3187 of *Sir Ferumbras*, Thierry is the father of Berard (Bryer) of Mountdidier. Cf. the French text, ll. 2290–96 and *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 1468–1473.

p. 49, l. [1693](#). *rees*, “time, occasion.” See note to l. 1349.

p. 49, l. [1695](#). Folk Balian is not mentioned in any other poem of our romance. See *Introduction*, p. xxvii.

- p. 49, l. [1698](#). *chese*, O.E. *cêosan*, Mod. E. *choose*. It here means “to be free to choose”:—“You shall not be free to choose,” “you shall have no choice,” “you shall do what you are ordered.” See Mätzner’s remark [in his *Wörterb.*, p. 562, s. v. *cheosen*] to Halliwell, *Dict.* p. 250. [p122](#)
- p. 49, l. [1699](#). *Aleroyse*. See note to l. 884.
- p. 49, l. [1711](#). *Turpyn*. There was a real bishop of this name, who, according to the *Gallia Christiana*, held the see of Reims from A.D. 753 to 794. As we find him described in the romances, Turpin was the very type of a knight-bishop. In the poem of *Aspremont*, he bears before the Christian army the wood of the true cross which in his hands beams with brightness like the sun. In the romance of the *Enfances Ogier* it was he, into whose custody Ogier was given, when he had been made a prisoner after his revolt, in company with the king of Lombardy, against Charlemagne (see above, note to l. 856), and who, notwithstanding the order of Charles to have Ogier starved to death, kept the Dane alive, who afterwards, when the Saracens invaded France, proved a great help to the Christian arms. As we read in the *Chanson de Roland*, ll. 2242ss, Turpin met his death at Roncesvaux, but according to the *Chronicle of Turpin*, he survived the disaster of Roncesvaux, and was saying mass for the dead, when he saw the angels carrying the soul of Roland up to heaven. But from Gaston Paris’s Essay *De Pseudo-Turpino* we know this chronicle to be an apocryphical book written by two monks of the eleventh and twelfth century.
- p. 49, l. [1717](#). *set not of youre barons so light* = “do not count, consider them so little.” Cf. “to take one so lighte,” in *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 114, 156.
- p. 50, l. [1721](#). *gyfe no coost* has the same meaning as *give no tale* = “make no account, do not mind.” See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, 8143. Cf. also *Sowdan*, l. 2793, and *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 5847, 101, 4975; and also ll. 173, 1578.
- p. 50, l. [1723](#). Bryer of Mountez or Berard de Montdidier was celebrated for his gallantries and attentions to the ladies:

“D’ardimen vail Rotlan et Olivier
E de domnei Berart de Mondesdier.”

i. e.—“In prowess I am equal to Rolland and to Oliver, in matters of love to Berart of M.” says the troubadour Peire Vidal in his poem *Dragoman seiner*; cf. also *Fierabras*, ll. 2125–7:

“Je ne sai cui vous estes, car ne vous puis viser,
Mais je cuit c’as pucieles sivés moult bien juer,
En cambre sous cortine baisier et acoler.”

See, besides, *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 422, 1297, 1305, 1354. This Bryer of Mountes must be the same as the one slain in a sally of the twelve peers, ll. 2604, 2622, because, according to l. 1723, it was he who was among the peers sent on a mission to the Soudan. There is one Bryer of Brytaine occurring in l. 886, whom one might be inclined to think identical with Bryer of Mountes, as in l. 886 he is cited together with the other peers. But since we find him again as the treasurer of Charlemagne (l. 3205), this is impossible, unless we suppose the mention of Bryer in l. 3205 to be owing to the [p123](#) absent-mindedness of the author, who may be accused of a similar inadvertency with regard to Rychard of Normandy; cf. note to l. 2797, and Index of Names, s. v. Flagot.

- p. 50, l. [1743](#). *Bronland*. The true reading is *Brouland*, as shewn by *Fierabras*, ll. 1549, 5174, &c.; *Destruction*, ll. 1240–159, 441, and *Sowdan*, ll. 1759, 2456. The Ashmole MS. has *Bruyllant*.
- p. 51, l. [1751](#). *thane* = “thane that.” See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, 992, p. 363.
- p. 51, l. [1778](#). *charke* hardly makes sense here. It is perhaps a clerical error for *charge*, “to command, to order.” The sense would then be, “and to tell him the Soudan’s strict orders which by peril of death (= *upon life and lithe*) Laban recommended him to obey.”
- p. 51, l. [1779](#). *pen* instead of *pan* would improve the rhyme.
- p. 52, l. [1788](#). *lorde of Spayne*. Cf. the French expression, “amirans d’Espagne,” which we find so often used in the *Destruction*.
- p. 52, l. [1802](#). *trappe* is Mod. Eng. *trape*, which is used in the sense of “to traipse, to walk sluttishly.” Halliwell has “trapes = to wander about.”
- p. 52, l. [1816](#). *byleved*. Rhyme and sense will be improved by reading *byleven*.

p. 53, l. [1854](#). *tyme* makes no sense here. Perhaps we ought to read *I dyne*; cf. ll. 1508, 1114, 1837, and *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 5621:

“Oþer elles þoo shalt þyn hefd forgon,
To morwen, or y wil dyne.”

Fierabras, l. 1914:

“Ja mais ne mengerai si sera desmembrés.”

See also *Guy*, l. 3695.

p. 54, l. [1888](#). *Syr Gy, newew unto the king Charles*. Cf. *Fierabras*, ll. 3406–8:

“On m’apele Guion, de Borgoigne fui nés,
Et fils d’une des filles au duc Millon d’Aingler,
Cousin germain Rollant, qui tant fait à douter.”

Duke Milon d’Anglers was brother-in-law to Charlemagne, whose sister Berte was Milon’s wife and mother to Roland. Cf. Philippe Mousket, l. 2706–8:

“S’ot Charles une autre sereur,
Bertain: cele prist à seigneur
Milon d’Anglers, s’en ot Rollant.”

If, therefore, in the passage quoted above from *Fierabras*, Guy is said to be the grandson of Milon, he must have been the grand-nephew of Charlemagne, and nephew to Rollant. As we learn from the French poem of *Guy de Bourgoyne*, Guy’s father was Samson of Burgundy. Cf. besides, *Histoire Poétique*, p. 407, and *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 1922, 2091, 1410, etc.

p. 55, l. [1892](#). *And yet knowe I him noght*. Floripas has already once [p124](#) seen Guy when he was defeating Lukafer before Rome; cf. *Fierabras*, ll. 2237–2245:

“.i. chevalier de France ai lontans enamé
Guis a nom de Borgoigne, moult i a bel armé;
Parens est Karlemaine et Rollant l’aduré.
Dès que je fui à Romme, m’a tout mon cuer emblé;
Quant l’amirans mes peres fist gaster la cité,
Lucafer de Baudas abati ens ou pré,
Et lui et le ceval, d’un fort espiel quarré.
Se cis n’est mes maris, je n’arai homme né;
Pour lui voel je croire ou roi de sainte maïsté.”

See also *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 2073–2087. Our line does not necessarily imply a contradiction to the French text, as on the former occasion she probably saw the duel from a great distance, when the latter's features were hidden by his helmet. That she really did not recognize him follows from the following passage of *Fierabras*, l. 2800, *et seq.*

“Je aim en douce France .i. leger baceler.”
—“Dame, comment a nom?” ce dist Rollans li her
Et respont la puciele: “ja le m’orrés nommer;
Guis a nom de Borgoigne, moult i a bel armé.”
—“Par mon cief” dist Rollans “à vos ex le véés
N’a pas entre vous deus iiii piés mesurés.”

Besides there are numerous instances to be met with in mediæval poetry of persons enamoured of some one they had never seen:

“Ans no la vi et am la fort”

says Guilhelm de Poitiers in speaking of his lady (Mahn, *Werke der Troubadours*, p. 3). Cf. also *Rits. Rom.* II. 19, and *Web. Rom.* II. 131.

p. 55, l. [1927](#). *myghty* seems to mean “excellent, delicious,” rather than “heavy.”

p. 57, l. [1974](#). *amonge*, “every now and then, from time to time, occasionally.” See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, 2301. It is often used as a kind of expletive.

p. 57, l. [1995](#). *foulis*, “fools, foolish.” Cf. the French text:

“Par Mahoun, dist li rois, trestout sont *fol* prové.”

p. 57, l. [1996](#). There is no mention made of this game in the Provençal poem. It is described here even more explicitly than in the French *Fierabras*, ll. 2907–2932. Cf. also *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 2230–2251.

p. 57, l. [1997](#). *assorte* = “assembly, company;” by one *assorte* = “in one company” (Halliwell). It seems to be connected with *sort* = “set, assemblage,” see Skeat, *Specimens of E. E.*, 425/999

p. 58, l. [2000](#). *i-fest* : *blast*. Perhaps we ought to read *i-fast*.

p. 59, l. [2036](#). *maden orders*. I do not know the exact meaning of this expression. Perhaps it may be taken with the same sense as the Mod. H. Germ. phrase = “ordnung schaffen,” which literally means [p125](#) “to set in

order, to put matters straight,” but is often used in the sense of “to clear away,” or, “to remove or despatch.”

- p. 59, l. [2045](#). *that he wente awaye with lym* = “that he had escaped with (his limbs, or having) his limbs safe and sound.” *lyme*, O.E. *lim*, Mod. Eng. *limb*.
- p. 59, l. [2052](#). *tho* = O.E. *þā*, “those, them,” it is used as a definite article in l. 2063.
- p. 59, l. [2057](#). *amapide*, miswritten for *awapide* (Herrtage), “astounded, bewildered.” Cf. Stratmann, p. 10.—Mätzner, *Wörterbuch*, p. 150, connects it with Goth. *afhvapjan*, “to suffocate.” We find *m* written for *w* several times in our poem; thus we read *gamylokes* for *gawylokes* in l. 2650, and *romme* for *rowme* in l. 876.
- p. 60, l. [2085](#). *Assyne*. The rhyme shows that *Assye* is the true reading. *Assye* occurs in ll. 102, 123.
- p. 60, l. [2093](#). *wone*, “heap, plenty.” O.Icel. *wân*. See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, p. 444.
- p. 61, l. [2119](#). *Brenlande*. It ought to be *Breuland* or *Brouland*; see above note to l. 1743.
- p. 61, l. [2120](#). The first foot in the line consists of the single word *what*. Thus in ll. 2288, 2374, 2394, etc.
- p. 62, l. [2145](#). *Espyarde*. This name only occurs in this poem. In *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 3824, the messenger sent to the bridge-keeper is called *Malyngryas*. There is no name mentioned in the French *Fierabras*, l. 4265.
- p. 62, l. [2156](#). *That no man by the brigge*. There is no verb in the sentence. Perhaps we ought to read *that no man passe by the brigge*, or, *that no man passe the brigge*.
- p. 63, l. [2191](#). Cf. the description of the giant in *Fierabras*, ll. 4740–4755, and *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 4435–4441.
- p. 63, l. [2199](#). *nolde not*. See note to l. 1096.
- p. 64, l. [2225](#). The line is too long. *Wilde* can be dispensed with, and instead of *horses* we may read *hors*; cf. Skeat, *Gloss. to Prioress’s Tale* (Clarendon Press), s. v. *hors*.

- p. 64, l. [2233](#). *a magnelle*, “a mangonel,” an ancient military engine used for battering down walls (Halliwell). *Magnelle* is the O.Fr. *Mangonel*, or *Mangoneau*, the Italian *manganello* (= “arbalist, cross-bow”). The latter is the diminutive form of *mangano*, “a sling;” Greek, *μαγγανον*. See Diez, *Etym. Wörterb.*, I. 261.
- p. 64, l. [2238](#). *Cornel* or *carnel*, Fr. *carnel*, Mod.Fr. *créneau*, “battlement, pinnacle.” Literally it means, “a piece carved out,” *i. e.* of the wall on the top of a building; the French verb *carneler* or *creneler* signifying, “to carve out, to jag, to notch.” *Carnel* is derived from Latin *crena* (See Diez, *Gramm.*, I. 14), which means “a notch, a cut, an incision” (Diez, *Etym. Wörterb.*, II. 266). Thus *carnel* came to denote a battlement or indented parapet; or more [p126](#) exactly it was applied to those parts of the wall projecting upwards between the openings or embrasures. It was one of these projecting portions that was here knocked down. Cf. also Syr *Ferumbras*, l. 3314.
- p. 65, l. [2245](#). The line is too long. Perhaps *or he hit* may be dispensed with.
- p. 65, l. [2247](#). The episode of Marsedag being slain by Guy is not found in any other poem of this romance.
- p. 65, l. [2271](#). *Alkaron*, “the Koran,” *al* is the Arabic article. There is a god named Alcaron occurring in l. 2762.
- p. 66, l. [2282](#). *dye* : *waye*. See l. 441. *forfamelid* = “famished, starved to death.” I am not aware of any other instance of this word. Halliwell has “famele = to be famished.” The prefix *for-* has intensive or augmentative power; it is particularly used in past participles. See Mätzner’s *Grammatik*, I². 542.
- p. 66, l. [2290](#). *faile* is the infinitive mood = “to be wanting, to become deficient.” “Roland seeing the ladies white and pale (with hunger) and (seeing) the bread wanting on their table spoke some words of lamentation,” etc.
- p. 66, l. [2303](#). *forcere*, “chest, coffer.” For the etymology see Diez, *Wörterb.*, II. 31, s. v. *forziere*.

- p. 66, l. [2309](#). As it stands the line is too long. As *you* and *that* may be dispensed with, we ought perhaps to read, *I pray ye wole us alle it shewe*.
- p. 66, l. [2310](#). *saule*, “fill, hunger satisfied to repletion.” The rhyme shows that the last syllable is accentuated. Therefore it cannot be derived from the French *soûl* (Gloss. to Roxb. Club ed.), but from *soûlée*.
- p. 66, l. [2311](#). *yede* = “went.” Not from O.E. *eode*, but from *ge-eode*. See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 60, and Skeat, *Piers the Plowman* (Clarendon Press), 94/40.
- p. 66, l. [2312](#). *vertue* : *fewe*; the rhyme is perfect, see the Abstract of Mr. Nicol’s paper in the *Academy* of June 23, 1877 (vol. xi. p. 564, col. 1).
- p. 66, l. [2313](#). We must scan this line thus:

And dīden it aboúte hem éverychón.
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-en in *diden* is mute; see *Introduction*, p. xxxix.

p. 67, l. [2326](#). *ginne* = “engin, contrivance, trick.” See note to l. 780.

p. 67, l. [2337](#). *lefte*. The rhyme shows that the author pronounced *lafte*, which we find in l. 426.

p. 68, l. [2351](#). Cf. *Fierabras*, ll. 3046–3097. In the Provençal poem Maubyn or Malpi, as he is called in Provençal, enters the room by means of a charm which makes the door open itself: [p127](#)

“Vengutz es al fossat, pres de la tor cayrada.  
Tantost intret dedins cuendamens a celada,  
Venc a l’us de la cambra: si la trobet tancada.  
Et a dit son conjur: tota s’es desfermada.”

ll. 2757–60.

p. 68, l. [2365](#). The rhyme is restored if we read *ledde* instead of *ladde*. See l. 1651.

p. 69, l. [2390](#). *By God and seynte Mary, myn avour*. I think the words *myn avoure* are due to the scribe, not to the author, as they spoil the rhythm. So we get *Mary : we*. This rhyme, although not perfect, is of no rare occurrence in Mid. Eng. works, see *Introduction*, p. xlv. As to the spelling of *avour* I am not aware of any other instance of this form of the word. There is a form *avyowre* cited by Halliwell. Besides, *avoury* and *avowery*, which he quotes under different heads, are perhaps only different spellings of the same word.

p. 69, l. [2399](#). *slepinge* must be altered into *slepande* in order to restore the rhyme. The author employed -*and* and -*yng*e as terminations of the present participle. See *Introduction*, p. xxxviii.

p. 69, l. [2421](#). *also* belongs to l. 2422.

p. 70, l. [2433](#). *so mete I spede*, “as I may succeed.” See Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 615.

p. 71, l. [2477](#). *and now* is perhaps miswritten for *inow*; cf. the French text, l. 3803:

“Tant y a plates d’or, nus nes porroit nombrer.”

p. 71, l. [2482](#). *wast* gives no sense. Perhaps we ought to read *went*.

- p. 72, ll. [2491](#)–2502. The arrangement of the stanzas seems, as regards the rhymes, to be incorrect.
- p. 72, l. [2507](#). In the Ashmole *Ferumbras* this episode of the Soudan breaking the image of Mahound is omitted. In the French text he only threatens to make him cry, as soon as he gets hold of him, but he is rebuked by Sorbrance telling him that Mahomet being over-tired with guarding the treasure has only fallen asleep. Cf. *Fierabras*, ll. 3820–3829.
- p. 72, l. [2512](#). *ore*, O.E. *âr*, “mercy, favour.” *Thyn ore* = “grant us thy favour,” “have mercy upon us,” or, “with thy favour.”
- p. 73, l. [2535](#). Richard of Normandy appearing here as in the French *Fierabras*, among the twelve peers besieged by the Soudan, without having been mentioned before in the number of the knights sent on a mission by Charles, furnishes us with an argument in support of our supposition that the French *Fierabras* was the source of our poem. See *Introduction*, p. xxx, and of *Fierabras*, ll. 3957–3994, and *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 4921.
- p. 73, l. [2538](#). *wynde* : *hende*; *wende* which occurs in l. 2328 would improve the rhyme. [p128](#)
- p. 73, l. [2549](#). *paramour* = “object of chivalrous affection and devotion.”
- p. 73, l. [2557](#). *wronge*, preterite of *wringe*, “to press well out, force one’s way.”
- p. 73, l. [2558](#). Does *thile* stand for *while*, as *then*, l. 2527, seems to be miswritten for *when*? Or is *thile* = the while?
- p. 74, l. [2564](#). *sloughe* : *drowe*. Read *slowe*, as in ll. 2401, 2683, 304, 2208, etc.
- p. 75, l. [2597](#). *itolde*, “in number,” see Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, 1770.
- p. 75, l. [2614](#). *quell* = “kill,” which occurs in l. 3006.
- p. 75, l. [2616](#). *bistadde*, “hard bestead, greatly imperilled.”
- p. 75, l. [2617](#). *japed*, “mocked, tricked, laughed at.” Connected with Icel. *gabba*, “to mock.”
- p. 76, l. [2639](#). *tha*. See *Introduction*, p. xxxvii.

p. 76, l. [2651](#). *lurdeyn*, Mod. Eng. *lurdan*, which is said to be the Fr. *lourdin* (diminutive of *lourd*). Regarding it as a corruption of “lord Dane” is a mere joke:

“In every house lord Dane did then rule all,  
Whence laysie lozels lurdanes now we call.”

*Mirroure for Magistrates*, p. 588.

p. 76, l. [2654](#). *sewes*. See Skeat, *Prioress’s Tale*, p. 286.

p. 76, l. [2660](#). *let armes* makes no sense. Read *as armes*—*As armes* = Fr. *aux armes*, “to arms,” is of pretty frequent occurrence in Mid. Eng. poems; see Mätzner’s *Wörterb.*, p. 112. Cf. also *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 2933:

“As armes,” þanne cride Rolond,  
“As armes everychone!”

Cf. *ibidem*, l. 4125. So we read in the *Destruction*, l. 1460.

“Ore as armes, seignours, franc chevalier membré.”

Perhaps we ought to read *as armes* also in l. 491, where the reading *and armes* is somewhat suspicious, since *armes*, if we regard *and armes* to be the true reading, would be the only instance of the imperative plural ending in *-es* (instead of *-eth*) in the *Sowdan*.

p. 77, l. [2689](#). *Thay thanked God that thay him hadde Gyfe thaye suche grace to spede*. These lines are corrupt. I propose to read:

“Thay thanked God that hem hadde  
Gyfen suche grace to spede.”

p. 77, l. [2694](#). *alaye*, written as one word in the MS., must be divided into two, *a* being the indefinite article, and *laye* meaning “unploughed ground, field, pasture, meadow.” Mod. Eng. *ley*, *lea*, *lay*. See *Stratmann*, s. v. *leze*, p. 356.

p. 77, l. [2698](#). *he*, “they.” This is the only instance of *he* instead of the common *thay*. But *he*, which is further confirmed by the rhyme, must certainly be attributed to the author; *thay* occurs only once [p129](#) (l. 3021) as a rhyme, but the rhyme is not a good one, and there also it would be preferable to read *he*.

p. 78, l. [2706](#). *by my thрифte*, the same as “so mote y thryve,” or, “so mote y spede” = “as (verily as) I may thrive,” “in truth.”

- p. 78, l. [2707](#). *see*; cf. Zupitza's note to *Guy*, 163.
- p. 78, l. [2719](#). *wole* : *skille*. The rhyme shows that *wole* cannot be due to the author; we must read *wille* (or *welle* which occurs l. 2633).
- p. 78, l. [2732](#). *bikure* or *bykeringe*, l. 2559 = "fight, battle, skirmish." *Er durste bikure abide*. The subject is wanting, see note to l. 67. Or is there any corruption in this line? Perhaps we ought to read: "Lenger durste [thay] no bikure abyde." Cf. ll. 3117, 2610, 2947.
- p. 79, l. [2748](#). *love*. The rhyme requires *leef* or *leeve*. *leef*, O.E. *leof*, means "dear, beloved." For examples of *leef* being used as a substantive, see Stratmann, p. 359.
- p. 80, l. [2793](#). *eye*, "egg." See Koch, *Eng. Gr.* II. § 582, and compare the French phrase "valoir un œuf pelé."
- p. 80, l. [2797](#). *and his meyne*. This must be a mistake of the author himself. According to l. 2557, Richard had ventured alone on a mission to Charlemagne. There is no mention whatever made afterwards that he was joined by any one; the other poems likewise state that Richard was without any companion.
- p. 80, l. [2805](#). *lete* : *gate*. The rhyme requires *late*.
- p. 81, l. [2810](#). *cliffe*. Here the author of the *Sowdan* goes so far in shortening his original as to be wholly unintelligible. Indeed, any reader, not comparing these lines with corresponding passages in the French poem, will be left without any clue to what *cliff* is here intended to mean. From the French *Fierabras* we know that the water of the river was very deep and broad, and that the banks were exceedingly steep and almost inaccessible. Cf. *Fierabras*, ll. 4349:

"Et voit l'augue bruiant, le flot parfont et lé."

l. 4358: "La rive en est moult haute, bien fait à redouter." Cf. also the Provençal poem, ll. 3733, *et seq.* :

"Richart regarda l'aygua, que fe mot a duptar,  
E fo grans e preonda, que no y auza intrar,  
E la riba fou *auta de C pes* ses gaber."

Now it was by means of a twofold miracle that the Christian knight was enabled to cross the river:

(1) The waters suddenly increased and rose so as to reach the very top of the banks; cf. *Fierabras*, ll. 4365–69:

“Or oiés quel vertu Diex i vaut demonstrier  
Por le roi Karlemaine, qui tant fait à douter.  
Ançois que on eüst une liuée alé,  
Veïssiés si Flagot engroissier et enfler,  
Que par *desous la rive commence à seronder*.”

Provençal, ll. 3741–45: [p130](#)

“Ara podetz auzir, si m voletz escoutar:  
Tan bela maravilha li volc dieus demostrar  
Per lo bon rey de Fransa que el volc tant amar;  
Ans un trag de balesta pogues lunhs hom anar,  
Pogratz vezer Flagot *sus la riba montar*.”

(2) A deer appears and shows Richard the way across the river to the top of the opposite bank.

“Atant es vous .i. cerf, que Diex i fist aler,  
Et fu blans comme nois, biaux fu à resgarder.  
Devant le ber Richart se prent à demonstrer,  
Devant lui est tantost ens en Flagot entrés.  
Li dus voit Sarrazins après lui aroutés,  
S’il ot paour de mort ne fait à demander.  
Après le blance bisse commencha à errer  
Tout ainsi com ele vait, lait le ceval aler;  
Et li ciers vait devant, qui bien s’i sot garder,  
D’autre part à la rive se prent à ariver.”

Cf. also the Provençal version, ll. 3751–54:

“Après la blanca bestia laycha ’l destrier anar.  
E lo cer vay denan, que l saup mot ben guizar,  
De l’autra part de l’aygua l’a fayt ben aribar,  
*E dieus a fayt Flagot en son estat tornar*.”

This bank which formerly was steep and inaccessible, but is now covered with water, is called *cliff* by our poet. In the Ashmolean poem the first miracle is not mentioned; cf. *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 3943, *et seq.*

p. 81, l. [2811](#). *he blessed him in Godis name*. The phrase occurs also in *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 3961, but is not to be found in the French text. Mr. John Shelley (in his paper printed in the *Annual Report and Transactions* of the Plymouth Institution, IV. i. 71) took this phrase as a proof that the original of the *Sowdan* could not have been the French poem. But it must

be stated that as in the *Sowdan*, l. 2807, so in the French version Richard is said to have addressed a prayer to God:

“Escortrement commence Jhesu à reclaimer:  
Glorieus sire pere, qui te laissas pener  
En la crois beneoite pour ton pule sauver,  
Garisiés hui mon cors de mort et d’afoler,  
Que je puisse Karlon mon message conter.”

*Fierabras*, ll. 4360–64.

If now we consider that some lines back (l. 4093) the French poem expressively states that Richard seeing himself hard pressed by the Saracens, signed himself with the sign of the cross—

“Lors a levé sa main, de Jhesu s’est signiés”

an incident which at that moment is omitted in the *Sowdan*—we think ourselves entitled to regard this proof as not very convincing.

p. 81, l. [2820](#). *Ganelon*, one of Charlemagne’s officers, who by his treachery was the cause of the defeat of Roncesvaux, the death of Roland, etc., for which he was torn to death by horses. For [p131](#) several centuries his name was a synonymous word with traitor. *Ganelo* = Germ. *Wenhilo*.

p. 81, l. [2845](#). *Fremounde* cannot be the true reading, as it does not rhyme with *kinge*. Besides *Fremounde* does not occur again in the poem. Perhaps we ought to read *Qwyntyne*, as in l. 1298. In the corresponding passage of the French *Fierabras* (l. 4625) it is to St. Denis that Charles swears; cf. also *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 4289.

p. 82, l. [2850](#). *And* makes no sense. Read “*God*.”

p. 83, l. [2887](#). *gryse* : *assaye*. We get a perfect rhyme if we read *gray* instead of *gryse*. Halliwell, s. v. “gray,” has: “the skin or fur of a badger.”

p. 83, l. [2891](#). As it stands, the line does not rhyme with l. 2893. The rhyme will be restored if we read:

“*Lycence gete ye noone nere*,” or perhaps  
“*Lycence gete ye of me nere*,”

*nere* meaning *ne’er*, *never*, as in *Guy*, 10550 and 10716.

p. 84, l. [2939](#). The name of the giantess is *Amiette* or *Amiote* in the other poems.

- p. 84, l. [2941](#). This line is too long; *as pikke* may be omitted.
- p. 84, l. [2942](#). *bydene*, “immediately, all at once.” On the etymology see Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, 2408.
- p. 85, l. [2981](#). *ayene* means “back.” So in *Genesis and Exodus*, l. 1097:

“And bodem hem and tagten wel  
ðat here non wente agen.”

Again, l. 3267:

“ðo quoðen he ‘wende agen,  
An israel folc lete we ben.’”

- p. 86, l. [3020](#). As it stands, this line does not scan well. Perhaps we may read *month* instead of *monthes*, and *childre* instead of *children*, and scan the line thus:

Foúnd two chîldre of séven month oólde.

- p. 87, l. [3021](#). *thay* : *Normandy*. The rhyme, though imperfect, cannot be objected to; but as the rhyme *e* : *y* (*i*) is frequently employed by our author (see *Introduction*, p. xlv), and was of rather common use about that period (see Ellis, *Pronunciation*, I. 271), we might incline to the supposition that *he* is the true reading. Cf. besides l. 2698.
- p. 87, l. [3034](#). *mene* makes no sense. Perhaps we ought to read: *mete*, “food.”
- p. 87, l. [3044](#). In the French poem, l. 5108, Hoel and Riol are appointed governors of Mantribe, whereas Richard goes on with Charles and commands one of the divisions of his army (l. 5577). Cf. *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 5643.
- p. 88, l. [3062](#). *coost*, “country, region.” See Mätzner’s *Wörterb.*, 487.
- p. 88, l. [3084](#). In the *Fierabras*, l. 5374, it is Naymes who first recognizes the banner of France; cf. *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 5209. [p132](#).
- p. 89, l. [3098](#). *of the Ethiopes* = “some of the Ethiopians.” This may be regarded as an example of the partitive use of *of*. Cf. Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, 1961.
- p. 89, l. [3103](#). *alto hewe* must be more correctly written *al to-hewe*;—*to-*, as a mere prefix (signifying “in twain, asunder, apart” = Germ. *zer*)

belongs essentially to the verb; the intensive adverb *al* (= “utterly, omnino,”) used before verbs beginning not only with *to-*, but also before other prefixes, still further strengthens, and belongs to, the whole expression. So *al to-treden*, l. 1382, *to-braste*, l. 1168.

p. 89, l. [3122](#). *Belmore*. Perhaps identical with Belmarine.

p. 90, l. [3130](#). *wode-wroth*, “madly angry.” Cf. Skeat, *Specimens of Early Eng. Lit.*, 80/37.

p. 90, l. [3141](#). *game*, “sport, joke, affair.”

p. 90, l. [3154](#). *hat*, “be called.” See note, l. 613.

p. 91, l. [3164](#). *bronde*, “sword.” In the next line *bronte* means “blow, stroke.”

p. 91, l. [3189](#). *lande : commaunde*. See note, l. 59.

p. 91, l. [3191](#). The rhyme is spoiled. Perhaps *than* must be transposed so that we get the rhyme *baptysed : imaryed*.

p. 92, l. [3210](#). *there to abide in store* = “to be kept in store”; cf. Skelton, ed. Dyce, l. 162, 221.

p. 92, l. [3227](#). *victory* = “booty, spoils of victory, trophy.”

p. 92, l. [3232](#). *the hyer honde to have* = “to have conquered or vanquished.” The same phrase is found in M. H. G.; cf. Hartmann’s *Iwein*, ed. Lachmann, l. 1537–8:

“Vrou Minne nam die obern hant,  
daz sî in vienc unde bant.”

p. 93, l. [3236](#). In the French *Fierabras*, l. 6082, *et seq.*, and in the Provençal poem, l. 5067, *et seq.*, the relics are distributed as follows: Part of the crown and one nail to St. Denis, and “*li signes*,” the winding-sheet of the Lord, to Compiègne. There is no mention made of the cross in the French poem (see note to l. 665); cf. Introd. pp. l and liv.

p. 93, l. [3253](#). According to the *Chanson de Roland*, Ganelon has been drawn and quartered in a field near Aix-la-Chapelle.

p. 94, l. [3254](#). *By lawe*, cf. *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 307: “As for traytours 3af þe lawe.” On this law compare Léon Gautier’s note to l. 3736 of the *Chanson de Roland*.

p. 95, l. [3274](#). The French poem ends with the assertion of the poet (or the scribe) that whoever has well listened to this romance will find every part of it good and excellent, the opening, the middle, and the end:

“De cest roumant est boine et la fin et l’entree,  
Et enmi et partout, qui bien l’a escoutée.”

## GLOSSARY. [◇](#)

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O.E. = Old English or Anglo Saxon.

O.Fr. = Old French.

32/1094 = page 32, line 1094.

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- Abye, 32/[1094](#), *vb.* to pay for, expiate. O.E. *abycgan*.
- adaunte, 28/[957](#), *vb.* to subdue. Fr. *danter, donter, dompter*.
- aferde, 39/[1337](#), *pp.* afraid. O.E. *âfærde*.
- affrayned, 43/[1495](#), *pt. s.* asked. O.E. *frignan*.
- afraye, 26/[896](#), *sb.* disturbance, fight.
- agreved, 29/[992](#), *pp.* aggrieved. Fr. *aggrever*.
- alayned, 43/[1497](#), *pt. s.* concealed, dissembled. Icel. *leyna*.
- alle and some, 22/[749](#), altogether, every one.
- almiht, 38/[1329](#), *adj.* *See note*.
- ameved, 29/[994](#), *pp.* moved.
- amonge, 57/[1994](#), *adv.* in the mean time, now and then, sometimes. *See note to l. 1974*.
- aplight, 17/[573](#), *adv.* certainly, indeed. *See note*.
- areeste, 34/[1166](#), *sb.* rest, support. O.Fr. *arrest*.
- arson, 41/[1410](#), *sb.* pommel. Fr. *arçon*.
- aspied, 10/[314](#), *pp.* espied. Fr. *espier*.
- assaye, 83/[2889](#), *sb.* value. Fr. *essai*.
- assorte, 57/[1997](#), *sb.* assembly, company. *See note*.
- assoyled, 70/[2455](#), *pt. pl.* absolved.
- astraye, 16/[532](#), *adv.* out of the right way, roving about without guidance.
- astyte, 42/[1456](#), *adv.* immediately.
- asure, 5/[134](#), *sb.* azure.
- atame, 27/[935](#), *vb.* to tame, subdue. O.E. *âtamian*.
- atone, 32/[1103](#), agree.

attones, 31/[1067](#), at once.  
 avente, 36/[1237](#), vb. to take breath. Fr. venter.  
 avoure, 69/[2390](#), sb. protection, protectress.  
 avyse, 49/[1716](#), vb. to consider, advise with one's self. Fr. aviser.  
 awapide, 59/[2057](#), pp. astounded, bewildered. *See note*.  
 ayene, 85/[2981](#), adv. back.  
  
 Bandon, 19/[636](#), sb. disposal.  
 bassatours (?), 29/[995](#), sb. vavassors.  
 bawson, 2/[52](#), sb. badger.  
 baye, 27/[940](#), sb. recess, niche. *See note*.  
 beckyn, 3/[64](#), vb. beckon. O.E. bêacnian.  
 bedight, 88/[3070](#), vb. to dispose, to surrender, to send forth.  
 behight, 25/[859](#), pt. s. promised. O.E. heht.  
 bende, 13/[420](#), vb. to direct.  
 bente, 20/[665](#), adj. bent, crooked. [p134](#)  
 benysone, 9/[289](#), sb. blessing. Fr. benoison.  
 bette, 49/[1716](#), adv. better.  
 bikure, 78/[2732](#), sb. skirmish.  
 bispake, 5/[165](#), pt. s. spoke with.  
 bistadde, 75/[2616](#), pp. placed in peril, hardly bestead. Cf. O.E. stæððan.  
     Dan. bestede.  
 biwry, 46/[1580](#), vb. betray. O.E. biwrêgan.  
 bloo, 29/[1005](#), adj. blue. Icel. blâr.  
 blynne, 70/[2442](#), vb. to cease, stop. O.E. belinnan.  
 bobaunce, 7/[211](#), sb. boasting.  
 boure, 54/[1870](#), sb. a lady's apartment, boudoir. O.E. bûr.  
 bowe, 53/[1853](#), sb. bough, branch. O.E. bôg.  
 braide, 32/[1098](#), pt. s. drew. O.E. brægd.  
 brayde, 8/[247](#), sb. craft, deceit, artifice. *See note*.  
 breddes, 5/[131](#), sb. birds. O.E. bridas.

broke, 57/[1965](#), *vb.* to break.

bronte, 91/[3166](#), *sb.* blow.

buskede, 31/[1055](#), *pt. s.* prepared, arrayed. Icel. *bûask*.

by, 3/[87](#), *vb.* buy, pay. O.E. *bycgan*.

bydene, 84/[2942](#), immediately. *Originally* mid ene. *See note*.

bygone, 3/[79](#), *pp.* afflicted. *See note*.

bykeringe, 74/[2595](#), *sb.* skirmish.

by than, 10/[344](#). *See note*.

Camalyon, 29/[1008](#), *sb.* camel-leopard. *See note*.

carrikes, 4/[118](#), a kind of large ship. *See note*.

caste, 12/[394](#), *sb.* plan, stratagem; 60/[2091](#), the throwing; 71/[2471](#), missile. *See note* to l. 394.

ceased, 89/[3109](#), *pt. s.* seized.

chaffer, 83/[2885](#), *sb.* merchandise. O.E. *cêap*, *faru*.

charke, 51/[1778](#), *vb.* to creak, crack. *See note*.

chek, 8/[189](#), *sb.* a checkered cloth.

chere, 6/[201](#), *sb.* demeanour, behaviour, humour.

chere, 80/[2781](#), *sb.* friendliness, willingness.

chere, 87/[3030](#), *adj.* pleased, merry.

chese, 49/[1698](#), *vb.* to be free to choose. O.E. *cêosan*.

clepeth, 24/[809](#), *pr. s.* calls.

clipped, 56/[1935](#), *pt. pl.* embraced, hugged. O.E. *clyppan*.

clog, 46/[1603](#), *sb.* “truncus,” block.

cloute, 58/[2014](#), *sb.* blow.

combrest, 83/[2909](#), *pr. s.* encumberest. Fr. *combrer*.

coost, 50/[1721](#), *sb.* regard, account. *See note*.

cornell, 64/[2238](#), *sb.* shaft of a pinnacle or battlement. O.Fr. *carnell*. *See note* to l. 2238, and compare Du Cange, s. v. *quarnellus*: “pinna muri per quam milites jaculantur.”

coude, 16/[541](#), *pt. s.* knew.

counsail, 46/[1590](#), secret.

Defouled, 7/[233](#), *pp.* polluted. Cf. O.E. fȳlan, fūlian.

delte, 16/[526](#), *pp.* dealt.

dere, 92/[3202](#), *vb.* to harm, injure. O.E. derian.

derke, 73/[2541](#), *adj.* dark.

dewe, 70/[2452](#), *adj.* due.

dight, 79/[2763](#), *pp.* dressed, prepared. O.E. dihtan.

dinge, 26/[880](#), *vb.* to dash, beat. Cf. Icel. dengja.

dirke, 44/[1539](#). *See note.*

dobbet, 33/[1136](#), *pp.* dubbed. O.E. dubban. Fr. dober.

dome, 14/[478](#), *sb.* glory.

don, 88/[3078](#), *vb.* cause, order O.E. dōn.

donne, 11/[347](#), *adj.* dun.

dowte, 9/[297](#), *sb.* fear.

dradde, 36/[1232](#), *pt. s.* feared. Cf. O.E. on-drædan. [p135](#)

dresse, 49/[1702](#), *vb.* to direct one's self, go, start. Fr. dresser.

dromonde, 3/[63](#), *sb.* vessel of war.

dute, 30/[1024](#), *sb.* duty. Deriv. of due, dewe. Fr. deu.

Egre, 29/[1009](#), *vb.* to excite, to urge.

eke, 20/[662](#), *adv.* also. O.E. êac.

engyn, 28/[948](#), *sb.* a skilful contrivance. Fr. engin.

ensample, 27/[931](#), *sb.* example.

entente, 16/[550](#), *vb.* to turn one's attention to, to try to get, to attempt.

entente, 28/[945](#), *sb.* meaning, will, mind.

erille, 11/[368](#), *sb.* earl.

erraunte, 5/[139](#), quick, immediately.

eye, 80/[2793](#), *sb.* egg. O.E. æg.

Fade, 20/[678](#), *vb.* to dispose, to arrange, to set up (?).

fade, 30/[1033](#), *adj.* weak, faint.

faste, 32/[1086](#), *adv.* much, greatly.  
fat, 90/[3152](#), *sb.* Vat, tub. O.E. fæt.  
fauchon, 76/[2650](#), *sb.* a sword or falchion.  
faye, 26/[900](#), *vb.* truth, faith.  
fele, 47/[1619](#), *adj.* many.  
felle, 29/[1004](#), *adj.* fierce, furious.  
felte, 41/[1405](#), *pt. s.* made fall, killed.  
fende, 92/[3231](#), *pp.* defended, protected, granted.  
fere, 36/[1248](#), *sb.* fear. O.E. fæ̆r.  
fere, 44/[1505](#), *sb.* companion. In fere, 31/[1071](#), together.  
fere, 2/[59](#), *vb.* to terrify.  
ferre, 4/[103](#), *adv.* far.  
fet, 91/[3188](#), *pp.* fetched.  
fille, 35/[1210](#), *pt. s.* fell.  
fleen, 88/[3065](#), to flay. O.E. flêan.  
folde, 71/[1427](#), *pp.* felled, knocked down.  
forcere, 66/[2303](#), *sb.* chest, coffer. O.Fr. forcier.  
for-famelid, 66/[2282](#), *pp.* entirely famished.  
foule, 77/[2686](#), *vb.* foul luck, mischance.  
fowarde, 15/[502](#), 22/[732](#), *sb.* vanguard.  
frankensense, 20/[679](#), *sb.* an odorous resin, pure incense.  
fraye, 15/[514](#), *vb.* to frighten, attack.  
frike, 4/[104](#), *adj.* quick, bold, active.  
frith, 2/[43](#), *sb.* enclosed wood.  
froo, 79/[760](#), *prep.* from.  
fyne, 9/[306](#), *sb.* end.  
  
Game, 90/[3141](#), *sb.* affair; 92/[3199](#), pleasure. O.E. gamen.  
gan, 16/[549](#), *pt. s.* began.  
gavylok, 41/[1426](#), *sb.* a spear or javelin. O.E. gafoluc.  
geaunesse, 84/[2943](#) (?), *sb.* giantess.

geder, 45/[1553](#), *vb.* to gather. O.E. gædrian.  
 glased, 35/[1208](#), *pt. s.* glided. O.Fr. glacier. See Zupitza's note to *Guy*, l. 5067.  
 glede, 7/[205](#), *sb.* a glowing coal, ember. O.E. glêd.  
 god, 3/[67](#), *adj.* versed in, master of.  
 gome, 5/[144](#), *sb.* man. O.E. guma.  
 gonge, 84/[2934](#), *vb.* to go. O.E. gongan.  
 goulis, 6/[189](#), *sb.* gules, a red colour. Fr. geules.  
 gray, 83/[2887](#), *sb.* the fur of a gray, or badger. O.E. græg.  
 gree, 82/[2850](#), *sb.* grace, favour. Fr. gré. Lat. gratum.  
 grenned, 84/[2948](#), *pt. s.* grinned, roared. O.E. grennian.  
 grevaunce, 29/[993](#), *sb.* grievance.  
 greved, 45/[1543](#), *pt. s.* grieved, molested, troubled.  
 grith, 82/[2850](#), *sb.* peace, agreement. O.E. grið.  
 gryse, 83/[2887](#), *sb.* a kind of fur. Fr. gris. [p136](#)  
 guttis, 39/[1351](#), *sb.* guts. O.E. gut.  
 gydoure, 5/[163](#), *sb.* leader, guide.  
 gynne, 67/[2326](#), *sb.* enginne, contrivance.  
  
 Harde, 59/[2056](#), *pt. s.* heard.  
 hat, 90/[3154](#), *vb.* to be called. O.E. hâtan.  
 he, 77/[2698](#), *pron. nominat.* thay. O.E. hî.  
 heede, 62/[2158](#), *sb.* head. O.E. hêafod.  
 hende, 73/[2536](#), *adj.* gentle, polite. O.E. hendig.  
 hennys, 55/[1922](#), *adv.* hence. O.E. heonan.  
 hente, 40/[1370](#), *vb.* hold, take. O.E. hentan.  
 hie, 14/[455](#), *sb.* haste.  
 hight, 18/[613](#), *pt. s.* promised; 36/[1242](#), *art* called. O.E. heht.  
 honde of honde, 12/[394](#), *in* close fight.  
 hoole, 32/[1119](#), *adj.* whole, sound. O.E. hâl.  
 hurle, 27/[929](#), *vb.* to jostle, to strike. A contraction of *hurtle*.

hurteled, 24/[831](#), *pt. pl.* clashed against, jostled. Frequentative of *hurt*.

Fr. hurter, heurter.

hye, 32/[1092](#), *sb.* haste.

I-fast, 58/[2000](#), fixed.

ilkadele, 58/[2016](#), every part. O.E. *ælc, dælc*.

ilke, 9/[281](#), *adj.* same. O.E. *ylca*.

inowe, 25/[854](#), *adv.* enough. O.E. *genôh*.

ishente, 66/[2286](#), *pp.* destroyed. O.E. *ge-scended*.

istoke, 56/[1963](#), *pp.* shut up, fastened. From *steken*. O.L.G. *stecan*.

istonge, 16/[533](#), *pp.* stung, pierced. O.E. *stungen*.

it, 25/[845](#), *vb.* to hit. Icel. *hitta*.

iwis, 3/[71](#), *adv.* certainly, indeed. O.E. *gewiss*.

iwone, 11/[358](#), *adj.* accustomed.

Japed, 75/[2617](#), *pp.* mocked, laughed at. O.Icel. *gabba*.

jouste, 57/[1991](#), *vb.* to joust, fight. Fr. *jouster*.

Kele, 93/[3258](#), *vb.* to keel, cool. O.E. *cêlan*.

kind, 63/[2196](#), *sb.* race, family.

kithe, 28/[971](#), *vb.* to show, manifest. O.E. *cýðan*.

kon, 66/[2297](#), *prs. pl.* can.

kynde, 28/[968](#), *sb.* nature, temper.

kynde, 2/[42](#), *adj.* natural, inborn.

Lan, 15/[516](#), *pt. s.* ceased, stopped. O.E. *lan*.

late, 71/[2460](#), *pt. pl.* let, caused, ordered. O.E. *lêt, læton*.

launde, 2/[59](#), *sb.* park, lawn.

laye, 77/[2694](#), *sb.* lea, field. O.E. *lêah*. Cf. *Water-loo*.

laye, 28/[951](#), *sb.* law. O.E. *lagu*.

layne, 16/[538](#), *pt. pl.* lay. O.E. *lægon*.

lefe, 23/[763](#), *vb.* leave, abandon, forsake. O.E. *læfan*.

lefe-long, 24/[832](#), *adj.* long, tedious.

legee3, 23/[775](#), leagues. Fr. lieue. O.Fr. legue. Lat. leuca.  
 leke, 50/[1726](#), *sb.* leek. O.E. lēac.  
 lele, 33/[1129](#), *adj.* leal, loyal. Fr. leal.  
 lenger, 72/[2500](#), *compar.* longer.  
 lere, 66/[2289](#), *sb.* countenance, complexion. O.E. hlēor.  
 lere, 74/[2569](#), *vb.* to teach.  
 lered, 58/[2005](#), *pp.* learned.  
 lerne, 33/[1141](#), *vb.* to teach.  
 lese, 49/[1683](#), *vb.* to loose. O.E. lēosan.  
 lette, 17/[585](#), *vb.* leave off; 74/[2610](#), to put a stop to, hinder, tarry. O.E. lettan.  
 leve, 23/[794](#), *vb.* leave. O.E. lāfan; 30/[1045](#), omit, neglect.  
 leve, 19/[651](#), *vb.* live, remain. O.E. gelȳfan.  
 leven, 31/[1050](#), *vb.* believe. O.E. lēfan. [p137](#)  
 lewde, 75/[2601](#), *sb.* laymen, unlearned. O.E. lāwed.  
 light, 26/[905](#), *adj.* active, nimble.  
 light, 33/[1125](#), *pp.* alighted. O.E. līhtan.  
 lithe, 81/[1778](#), *sb.* limb, member. O.E. lið.  
 logges, 69/[2399](#), *sb.* huts. Fr. loge.  
 longith, 28/[951](#), *prs. s.* belongeth, becomes.  
 loute, 72/[2513](#), *vb.* to stoop, bow down. O.E. lūtan.  
 lowly, 70/[2454](#), *adv.* low, not loud.  
 lurdeynes, 76/[2651](#), *sb.* lurdan, lout. Fr. lourdin.  
 lym, 59/[2045](#), *sb.* limb.  
 lyued, 66/[1261](#), *pt. pl.* lived.  
 Magre, 42/[1442](#), *prep.* in spite of.  
 maistryes, 89/[3117](#), *sb. pl.* mastery, proof of skill, combat.  
 manly, 29/[989](#), *adj.* brave.  
 mayne, 16/[528](#), *sb.* main, strength.  
 me, 9/[287](#), *sb.* men, people, one.

meche, 6/[179](#), *adj.* much. O.E. mycel.  
mede, 31/[1054](#), *sb.* meadow. O.E. mæd.  
mede, 37/[1289](#), *sb.* meed, pay. O.E. mêd.  
medel, 73/[2540](#), *vb.* meddle. O.Fr. mesler, mestler.  
men, 4/[115](#), *sb.* men, people, one.  
menske, 28/[972](#), *sb.* manliness, honour. O.E. mennisc.  
mente, 51/[1784](#), *vb.* to aim at, to intend to go. O.E. myntan. *See note to l.*  
1604.  
mervaylyth, 88/[3066](#), *prs. s.* marvels, wonders. Cf. Fr. merveille.  
mete, 47/[1633](#), *sb.* food, repast.  
meyne, 7/[219](#), *sb.* host, company, retinue. O.Fr. maisniee.  
mikille, 30/[1016](#), *adj.* many. O.E. mycel.  
moche, 15/[505](#), *adj.* much.  
mode, 29/[1009](#), *sb.* mind, temper, courage. O.E. môd.  
moolde, 5/[136](#), *sb.* earth, worth. O.E. molde.  
moone, 28/[944](#), *sb.* moan, complaint. Cf. O.E. mænnan.  
more, 23/[777](#), delay. *See note to l.* 1110.  
more, 29/[1005](#), *sb.* moor, Maurian.  
mot, 19/[650](#), *vb.* may.  
myghty, 56/[1927](#), *adj.* *See the note.*  
myrke, 45/[1541](#), *adj.* dark. O.E. myrce.  
  
Natheless, 15/[506](#), *adv.* nevertheless.  
nather, 36/[1232](#), *adj.* nother.  
ner, 13/[416](#), *conj.* nor.  
nere, 22/[756](#), *adv.* near.  
nerehond, 86/[2998](#), *adv.* almost.  
noght, 43/[1497](#), *adv.* not.  
noght, 78/[2712](#), *sb.* nothing.  
none, 32/[1114](#), *sb.* noon.  
nones, 3/[74](#), *sb.* nonce, occasion.

nothinge, 6/[175](#), not at all.  
 nothir, 8/[267](#), *conj.* neither.  
 nought for than, 43/[1483](#), nevertheless.  
 nyl, 17/[585](#), *prs. s.* will not. O.E. nyle.  
  
 Of, 32/[1088](#), *prp.* on account of.  
 oght, 78/[2713](#), *sb.* aught.  
 onarmede, 14/[464](#), unarmed.  
 onneþe, 89/[3105](#), *adv.* scarcely.  
 onworthily, 49/[1634](#), *adv.* unusefully.  
 orders, 59/[2036](#). *See the note.*  
 ore, 72/[2512](#), *sb.* mercy, favour. O.E. âr.  
 orfrays, 83/[2888](#), *sb.* gold embroidery. Lat. Aurifrisum.  
 overlede, 72/[2502](#), *vb.* to domineer over, to oppress.  
  
 Parelles, 55/[1917](#), *sb. pl.* perils. Fr. péril.  
 paynym, 16/[539](#), *sb.* pagan.  
 pellure, 83/[2887](#), *sb.* fur. O.Fr. pelure. [p138](#)  
 pight, 34/[1158](#), *pp.* pitched, fixed.  
 pinne, 88/[3077](#), *vb.* to torment. O.E. pînan.  
 playn, 6/[177](#), *vb.* to complain.  
 plete, 33/[1151](#), *vb.* plead, prattle. From Fr. plet, plaid.  
 plight, 26/[889](#), *prs. s.* promise, assure.  
 poleyne, 6/[176](#), *sb.* pulley-pieces, knee-armour.  
 praye, 16/[550](#), *sb.* press, crowd.  
 prees, 40/[1399](#), *sb.* crowd, struggle. Fr. presse.  
 preest, 34/[1169](#), *adj.* ready. Fr. prest.  
 prik, 81/[2831](#), *vb.* to spur a horse, to ride.  
 prikke, 65/[2260](#), *sb.* a piece of wood in the centre of the target. See Halliwell's *Diction.* s. v. preke.  
 prove, 6/[183](#), *vb.* to try.  
 prowe, 51/[1766](#), *sb.* profit, advantage, honour. Fr. prou.

prymsauns, 28/[965](#) (?). *See the note.*

Quod, 32/[1095](#), *prt. s.* quoth.

qwelle, 75/[2614](#), *vb.* to kill. O.E. cwellan.

qwere, 17/[566](#), *sb.* quire, choir-service.

qweynte, 3/[74](#), *adj.* excellent, elegant. O.Fr. coint. Lat. cognitus.

qwiike, 58/[2001](#), *adj.* alive, burning. O.E. cwic.

qwhite, 16/[520](#), *vb.* to requite, to reward.

Racches, 2/[56](#), *sb.* setting dogs, pointers.

rafe, 25/[866](#), *vb.* to rave. O.Fr. raver. Span. rabiar. Lat. rabiare.

ras, 39/[1349](#), *sb.* instant, occasion. *See the note.* 19/[645](#), hurry, haste.

rased, 23/[774](#), *sb.* rush, channel of the sea.

raught, 46/[1605](#), *prt. s.* reached, aimed at, struck. O.E. ræhte.

rede, 85/[2980](#), *sb.* counsel, advice. O.E. ræd.

rees, 49/[1693](#), *sb.* time, occasion.

rehete, 59/[2035](#), *vb.* to cheer.

rekyneth, 57/[1982](#), *prs. s.* reckons, deduces.

releve, 7/[219](#), *vb.* to rally.

renew, 33/[1126](#), *vb.* to tie. Fr. renouer.

renew, 63/[2200](#), *vb.* to renovate, to recommence. Renew.

resyn, 16/[534](#), *prs. pl.* rise.

rew, 89/[3105](#), *sb.* row, order. O.E. ræw.

roght, 54/[1878](#), *pt. pl.* recked, cared. O.E. rôhton.

roial, 20/[686](#), 51/[1765](#), *adj.* exquisite, distinguished; 71/[2483](#), delightful.

Cf. l. 2247.

rome, 14/[484](#), *vb.* to walk about. *See* Stratmann, s. v. rāmen, p. 452.

romme, 26/[876](#), *sb.* room, space. O.E. rûm.

rowte, 2/[54](#), *sb.* company, host.

rowte, 60/[2073](#), *vb.* to assemble in a company, to throng, to rally.

ruly, 47/[1624](#), *adj.* rueful. O.E. hrêowlîc.

ryme, 10/[339](#), *vb.* to cry out, to moan.

Saile, 12/[385](#), *vb.* to assail.  
same, all in s., 56/[1938](#), altogether.  
sare, 21/[706](#), *adv.* sorely, sadly.  
saule, 66/[2310](#). *See the note.*  
saute, 18/[619](#), *sb.* assault.  
saye, 58/[1998](#), *pt. pl.* saw. O.E. sægon.  
scole, 33/[1141](#), *vb.* style, manner.  
sede, 7/[235](#), *sb.* seed.  
seke, 32/[1116](#), *adj.* sick.  
semely, 2/[39](#), *adj.* seemly, comely, beautiful.  
sendelle, 4/[129](#), *sb.* a kind of rich thin silk. [p139](#)  
set, 49/[1717](#), *vb.* to consider, estimate.  
sete, 3/[62](#), *sb.* a seat.  
sewes, 76/[2654](#), *sb.* juices, delicacies. O.E. seaw.  
seyne, 14/[472](#), *vb.* to speak.  
shente, 1/[23](#), *pp.* destroyed.  
shifte, 78/[2704](#), *vb.* to divide, to share. O.E. sciftan.  
shonde, 64/[2222](#), *sb.* disgrace, ignominy. O.E. sceand.  
shoon, 40/[1381](#), *sb.* shoes. O.E. scêon, scêos.  
shope him, 2/[50](#), *pt. s.* got himself ready to, arrayed himself.  
shoure, 15/[509](#), *sb.* fight.  
shrew, 72/[2518](#), *vb.* to curse.  
shrewes, 76/[2652](#), *sb.* wicked beings.  
sikerlye, 62/[2172](#), *adv.* surely.  
sith, 47/[1632](#), *conj.* since.  
sithe, 47/[1619](#), *sb. pl.* times. O.E. sîð.  
skaped, 59/[2043](#), *pt. s.* escaped.  
skath, 47/[1645](#), *sb.* loss, damage, ruin. Cf. O.E. sceaðan.  
skomfited, 38/[1320](#), *pp.* discomfited. O.Fr. desconfire.  
skulkyng, 76/[2651](#), *prs. p.* lurking, breaking forth from a hiding place.

smerte, 38/[1309](#), *adj.* smart, pungent.  
 smertly, 41/[1419](#), *adv.* smartly, at once.  
 socoure, 15/[507](#), *sb.* succour, assistant.  
 soghten, 40/[1372](#), *pt. pl.* moved on, rode. *See the note.*  
 solas, 20/[675](#), *sb.* relief, recreation, pleasure. O.Fr. solaz. Lat. solatium.  
 somer, 77/[2702](#), *sb.* a sumpter horse. Fr. sommier. Cf. Diez, *Etym. Dict.* I., p. 364, s. v. salma.  
 sonde, 61/[2134](#), *sb.* message, order.  
 sore, 2/[47](#), *adv.* very much, eagerly.  
 sore, 33/[1138](#), *adv.* sadly.  
 sowdeoures, 21/[727](#), *sb.* soldiers, hirelings. Lat. solidarius. Cf. Fr. soudard, soudoyé.  
 spede, 70/[2433](#), *vb.* thrive.  
 spille, 36/[1226](#), *vb.* to destroy. O.E. spillan.  
 stenyed, 24/[825](#), *pt. s.* shook, astounded.  
 steven, 65/[2258](#), *sb.* voice. O.E. stefn.  
 stondart, 78/[2717](#), *sb.* standard-bearer. Fr. étendard.  
 store, 23/[768](#), *sb.* provision.  
 store, 92/[3210](#), *sb.* stock, preservation, keeping.  
 stoure, 7/[212](#), *sb.* battle, tumult.  
 stoute, 53/[1825](#), *adj.* proud, boasting.  
 stronde, 2/[53](#), *sb.* strand, shore.  
 stroyeth, 5/[159](#), *prs. s.* destroyeth.  
 stynte, 52/[1804](#), *pt. pl.* stopped.  
 sue, 46/[1601](#), *vb.* to follow. Fr. suivre.  
 sware, 13/[428](#), *adj.* heavy.  
 swyth, 47/[1621](#), *adv.* quick, fast. O.E. swîðe.  
 Tan, 74/[2581](#), *pp.* taken.  
 tene, 30/[1032](#), *sb.* grief, anger, insult, injury. O.E. tēona.  
 tene, 83/[2902](#), *vb.* to vex, to wax wroth. O.E. tȳnan.

teyde, 48/[1648](#), *pp.* tied.  
tha, 76/[2639](#). *See the note.*  
thane, 51/[1756](#), than that.  
then, 46/[1593](#), *vb.* to prosper. O.E. þêon.  
thikke, 30/[1027](#), *adj.* numerous, plentiful, plenty.  
threste, 34/[1170](#), *vb.* to thrust, shake, totter.  
thrift, 78/[2706](#), *sb.* thriving, prosperity, success. O.Icel. Þrift.  
tho, 59/[2052](#), *pron.* those, them.  
tho, 59/[2063](#), *art.* the, those.  
tho, 2/[53](#), *adv.* then. O.E. ðâ.  
throng, 41/[1401](#), *sb.* thrusts, throwing of arrows. [p140](#)  
tobaste, 34/[1168](#), *pt. pl.* burst, or broke in pieces. O.E. (tôbærst)  
tôburston.  
toheve, 89/[3103](#), *pp.* hewn to pieces. O.E. tô-hêawen.  
tokenyng, 8/[242](#), *sb.* news, intelligence.  
totreden, 40/[1382](#), *pp.* crushed, trodden down.  
trappe, 52/[1802](#), *vb.* to go. Cf. Ger. trippeln, E. trip, O.Fr. treper.  
tredde, 58/[1999](#), *sb.* thread. O.E. Þræð.  
trende, 27/[940](#), *pp.* turned, vaulted.  
treated, 55/[1923](#), *pt. pl.* treated, pressed. Fr. traier.  
trew, 3/[67](#), *adj.* a thorough master of, a trustworthy interpreter of.  
treymple, 27/[913](#) (?)  
trowe, 8/[246](#), *vb.* to believe.  
trusse, 49/[1707](#), *vb.* to pack off, to be off.  
trwes, 31/[1060](#), *sb.* truce.  
tyte, 6/[181](#), *adj.* soon, quickly, fast.  
Unneth, 5/[160](#), *adv.* scarcely.  
Vere, 28/[965](#), *sb.* spring.  
vertue, 66/[2312](#), *sb.* magic, power.  
viage, 82/[2846](#), *sb.* voyage, journey.

victory, 92/[3227](#), *sb.* booty.  
voydance, 32/[1106](#), *sb.* relinquishment, deliverance.  
voyde, 51/[1768](#), *vb.* to give up, abandon, leave.  
  
Wage, 18/[590](#), *vb.* to hire, pay.  
ware, 7/[204](#), *adj.* aware.  
waste, 8/[246](#), *in* = in vain.  
wende, 92/[3214](#), *vb.* to turn, go. O.E. wendan.  
wende, 85/[2958](#), *pt. s.* thought, O.E. wênde.  
wene, 31/[1061](#), *vb.* to think.  
were, 7/[210](#), *vb.* to defend, to protect, to fight. O.E. werian.  
werre, 16/[541](#), *sb.* war.  
wery, 3/[60](#), *adj.* weary, fatigued.  
wessh, 54/[1871](#), *pt. pl.* washed.  
wete, 94/[3270](#), *vb.* to know.  
what, 47/[1623](#), *pron.* = who.  
wifle, 76/[2650](#), *sb.* a kind of axe. O.E. wífel, “bipennis.”  
wight, 27/[933](#), *adj.* nimble, active. Sw. *vig*, active.  
wirch, 5/[148](#), *vb.* to work, to do. O.E. wyrcan.  
wiste, 48/[1662](#), *pt. s.* knew.  
wode, 9/[276](#), *adj.* mad, furious.  
wode-wroth, 90/[3130](#), *adj.* madly angry. O.E. wôd and wrâð.  
wone, 60/[2093](#), *sb.* lot, quantity. Icel. wân.  
worche, 59/[2046](#), *vb.* to work, to do. O.E. wyrcan.  
worthed up, 34/[1163](#), *pt. s.* got up, mounted.  
wote, 2/[36](#), *prs. s.* know. O.E. wât.  
wotist, 61/[2123](#), *prs. s.* knowest. O.E. wâst.  
wrake, 70/[2446](#), *sb.* persecution, mischief, destruction. O.E. wracu.  
wreke, 88/[3058](#), *pp.* wreaked, revenged.  
wrong, 73/[2557](#), *pt. s.* pressed, forced his way, hurried off. O.E. wringan.  
wyne, 9/[275](#), *vb.* get, attain. O.E. winnan.

Yare, 19/[639](#), *adj.* ready. O.E. gearu.  
yates, 66/[2285](#), *sb.* gates. O.E. gatu.  
yede, 66/[2311](#), *pt. s.* went. O.E. ge-eode.  
yolde, 12/[403](#), *vb.* yield. O.E. gioldan, *pp.* golden.  
yolowe, 29/[1005](#), *adj.* yellow. O.E. geolo.  
  
Pilke, 76/[2644](#), *pron.* such, yon. O.E. þylc.  
þon, 4/[108](#), *art.* the. O.E. þone.

## INDEX OF NAMES. [◇](#)

AGREMARE, Agremour or Egremour, a town in Spain situated on the river Flagot. The soudan is holding his court there (l. [33](#)), when he hears of the injuries done to his subjects by the Romans. Having destroyed Rome, he returns to Agremor (l. [672](#)) [not to Morimonde, as in the *Destruction*, l. 1351, and in *Fierabras*, l. 27]. At Agremor the twelve peers are imprisoned and besieged. *Syr Ferumbras* reads *Egremoygne*, *Egremoun*, *Agremoun*.

ALAGOLOFUR, a Saracen giant, warden of the bridge of Mantriblé; ll. [2135](#), [2881](#), [2149](#), [2175](#), [2801](#), [3053](#). In *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 3831, etc., he is called Agolafre. In the French poem of *Fierabras* we find Agolafre and Golafre.

ALCARON, l. [2762](#), a Saracen deity; cf. note to l. [2271](#).

ALEROYSE, l. [1699](#), one of the twelve peers; cf. note to l. [884](#).

ALISAUNDRE. Ferumbras is called King of Alisaundre, ll. [510](#), [984](#). Cf. *Destr.* 71, 1237, 1315. *Fierabras*, 50, 66, 538, etc. Ashmole *Ferumbras*, 53, 88, etc.

APPOLYN, one of the Mahometan deities. See note to l. [86](#).

ARABYE, l. [3097](#). Cf. *Destr.* 75; *Fierabras*, 3160, 4096.

ASCALON. Laban's birthplace, l. [100](#), and subject to him. This name does not occur in any other version.

ASCAROT, l. [2762](#), a Mahometan god. Occurring in none of the other versions.

ASCOPARS, see note to l. [495](#).

ASKALOUS, l. [497](#).

ASSAYNES, l. [497](#).

ASSIENS, ll. [1039](#), [2085](#). In this poem only the last three nations are mentioned as being included among Laban's subjects.

ASSYE, l. [102](#), [123](#), [1000](#). See note to l. [1000](#).

ASTRAGOT, or ESTRAGOT, a Saracen giant who kills Sabaris, ll. [346](#), [352](#). He is slain by the portcullis let down by the Romans, l. [432](#). He was husband to Barrock, the giantess of the bridge of Mantrible, ll. [2944](#), [3022](#). Cf. *Destr.* 1090. Not in *Fierabras* nor in the Ashmolean version. See note to l. [346](#).

AUFRIKE, ll. [102](#), [114](#). Aufricanes, l. [257](#), part of the soudan's dominions. Cf. *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 5465, *Destr.* 76, *Fierabras*, 4913.

BABILON, see note to l. [69](#); cf. *Destr.* 78, 204, 85; *Fierabras*, 51; *Syr Fer.* 53.

BALDESEYNES, 501, 871. Occurring in no other version; cf. besides Martin's note to Kudrun, 161, 2, and perhaps *Fierabras*, 2873, 4721 Balegué = Balaguer (Ballegarium, Valaguaria) near Lerida in Spain.

BARBARYE, l. [1001](#), mentioned only in this poem.

BARROK, ll. [2939](#), [2950](#), [3022](#), a giantess, wife to Astragot, slain by Charles. See note to l. [2939](#).

BELMORE, does not occur in the other versions; see note to l. [3122](#).

BELSABUB, l. [357](#), occurs only in this poem.

BERNARD OF SPRUWSE (? Prussia); 1715, one of the twelve knights. See *Introduction*, p. xxvii.

BOLOYNE, 3238. Charles presents [p142](#) the nails to that place. See note to l. [3236](#), and cf. *Fierabras*, l. 6199.

BRETOMAYN, Laban's gaoler at Agremor, ll. [1533](#), [1591](#), slain by Floripas, l. [1606](#). This name is spelt 'Brutamont' in *Fierabras*, 'Brytamoun' in *Syr Ferumbras*. It is not to be met with in the *Destruction*.

BROULAND, chief counsellor to Laban. See note on l. [1743](#).

BRYER OF BRYTAYN,—of Mountez; see note to l. [1723](#).

BRYER OF POYLE, a Roman knight, slain by Ferumbras; see note to l. [514](#).

BULGARE, l. [1002](#). Occurring in no other poem.

CASSAUNDRE, ll. [986](#), [512](#), town belonging to Lukafer. This name is not found in the other versions.

CHARLES, Charlemayne, the French king.

CHAUNDER, l. [123](#), a town in Asia; only mentioned here. See note to l. [1000](#).

COSDROYE escorts a convoy destined for the soudan; he is slain by Roland; cf. note to l. [2695](#).

CRAMADAS, a Saracen bishop, ll. [2775](#), [2788](#). Not found in the other versions.

CURRAUNTES, the bridge near Mantribe, l. [2866](#). This name occurs only in this poem.

DASABERDE, l. [1707](#), (?) mentioned only here.

DENYS, ll. [27](#), [61](#), etc. Occurring in all versions.

DURNEDALE, Roland's sword; see note to l. [875](#).

ESPIARD, l. [111](#), Laban's messenger; cf. note to l. [2145](#).

ETHIOPE, subject to Laban. See note to l. [257](#).

EUROPE, l. [1002](#). Mentioned only in this poem.

FERUMBRAS, see note to l. [93](#).

FLAGOT, the river on which the city of Mantribe with its famous bridge is situated, cf. ll. [2559](#), [2798](#), [2855](#), etc., and *Fierabras*, ll. 7348, 4886, etc. When the twelve peers besieged in Agremer send Richard of Normandy to Charlemagne to ask his aid, Richard is said to have started in the direction of Mantribe, l. [2559](#); but finding the bridge blocked up and guarded, l. [2799](#), he is obliged to swim across the water, 'Flagot the flode,' l. [2804](#). Charlemagne being informed of the distress of his peers, starts towards Mantribe, l. [2849](#), and having first taken it and left Richard there with two hundred knights, l. [3044](#), he continues his march against the soudan at Agremer, l. [3047](#). Whence it is clear that Agremer cannot be situated on the river Flagot, as is stated in l. [34](#); a mistake evidently owing to an oversight on the part of the poet. Cf. besides, note to l. [1723](#).

FLOREYN OF ROME, name given to Ferumbras after his baptism; see note to l. [1486](#).

FLORIP, Florypas; see note to l. [614](#). In the Ashmolean versions we find *Floryppe*, a spelling which does not occur in any of the French poems. But once we find *Floripes* in *Fierabras*, l. 2035.

FOCARD, l. [2900](#), one of the Christian knights who struck at the bridge-keeper of Mantrible when he refused to let them pass. The name occurs only in this poem.

FOLK BALIANT, l. [1695](#), one of the twelve peers. Only found in this poem.

FORTIBRAUNCE, l. [422](#), one of the soudan's engineers. Only occurring in this poem.

FRAUNCE. Charles is called king of dowse Fraunce, cf. *Fierabras*, 2103; *Syr Ferumbras*, 1269. This phrase does not occur in the *Destruction*.  
[‹p143›](#)

FREMOUNDE, a saint; see note to l. [2845](#).

FRIGE, l. [1000](#); Frigys, l. 1040. Part of the soudan's dominions, not mentioned in the other versions.

GALLOPES, l. [251](#), mentioned only in this poem.

GAZE, a town in Spain, where Charlemagne lands his troops. The name is found only in this poem (in rhyme), l. [772](#).

GENELYN, a French knight, notorious for his treachery. He advised Charles to leave Spain and to return home, urging that the twelve peers must be dead at Agremor, since no news arrived from them, l. [2820](#). When in assaulting Mantrible he saw Charles shut in in the city, he treacherously proclaimed the king to be dead, and ordered the French to return to France, where he hoped to be crowned king. But he was rebuked by Ferumbras (ll. [2970](#)–2991). For his treason he is hanged and drawn at Montfaucon in Paris (ll. [3244](#)–3254).

GENERYSE, ll. [1139](#), [1239](#), is the name Oliver gives himself when asked by Ferumbras. The French *Fierabras* and the Ashmole *Ferumbras* have Garin instead.

GY OF BOURGOYNE, see note to ll. [1888](#), [1892](#).

GYNDARD, l. [543](#), a Roman senator who kills ten Saracens. He is slain by Lukafer. Occurring only in this poem.

HUBERT, l. [518](#), a Roman knight, slain by Ferumbras. Not mentioned in the other versions.

IFFREZ, a Roman senator who advises to send to Charles for help. See note to l. [165](#).

INDE, l. [999](#). Not mentioned in the other poems. Cf. note to l. [999](#).

ISRES, 625, 641, the chief porter of Rome, who treacherously delivers the keys to the Saracens. See note to l. [625](#).

JUBYTER, ll. [2254](#), [2762](#), a Saracen god, mentioned only in this poem.

LABAN, see note to l. [29](#).

LOWES, occurring in the *Sowdan* and the *Destruction*, but not mentioned in the other versions. See note to l. [24](#).

LUKA FER OF BALDAS, see note to l. [113](#). Once, l. [236](#), this name is spelt Lukefere.

MACEDOYNE, l. [1002](#). Occurring only in this poem.

MAHOUND, see note to l. [86](#).

MAPYN, l. [2326](#), introduces himself into the bed-chamber of Floripas to steal the fatal girdle. In the French poem, l. 3046, he is called Maubrun d'Agremolée; in the Ashmolean version Maubyn of Egremolee, l. 2385. Cf. *Introduction*, pp. xx, xxx, xxxi.

MARAGONDE, the name of Floripas's governess, l. [1563](#). Spelt Morabunde in the French poem. See *Introduction*, pp. xxx, xxxi.

MARIE, ll. [917](#), [2390](#); cf. *Destr.* ll. 374, 564; *Fierabras*, ll. 285, 815; *Syr Ferumbras*, ll. 5177, 5451.

MARSEDAG, king of Barbarye, occurs only in this poem. See note to l. [2247](#).

MAUNTRIBLE, a town in Spain on the river Flagot (see above) with a bridge; cf. also *Destr.* 211, and *Fierabras*, 1867, etc.

MAVON, ll. [278](#), [422](#), [2230](#), Laban's engineer; spelt Mabon in the *Destr.* ll. 908, 941, and in *Fierabras*, l. 3735. The name does not occur in the Ashmole MS.

MIRON OF BRABANE, one of the twelve peers, occurring only in this poem, l. [1703](#).

MONTFAWCON, l. [3253](#). Not found in the other versions. [p144](#)

MOUNPELERS, after having conquered the soudan, Charlemagne sails from Spain to Mounpeler, l. [3228](#). The name does not occur in the *Fierabras*, where the king returns to France in an eight days' journey (ll. 6164–6187). Cf. *Destr.* ll. 250, 286.

MOWNJOYE, see note to l. [868](#), and cf. the *Song of Roland*, 128/[746](#).

NEYMES OF BAVERE, one of the twelve peers, see note to l. [836](#).

NUBENS, l. [873](#), NUBYE, l. [1001](#), a people subject to the soudan.

OGER DANOYS, one of the twelve peers, see note to l. [836](#).

OLIBORN, l. [99](#), the soudan's chancellor; only found in this poem.

OLYVER, one of the twelve peers; see note to l. [1250](#).

PARIS, l. [917](#); see note to l. [3254](#).

PERSAGYN, a king of Italy, and uncle to Ferumbras, slain by Oliver, l. [1259](#). In the *Destr.* l. 162, we find one Parsagon mentioned among the peers of the soudan's empire. See note to l. [1259](#).

PERSE, l. [2888](#), cf. *Destr.* ll. 77, 421. *Fierabras*, 1640, 1713.

SEINT PETER, ll. [161](#), [480](#), etc., the saint; cf. *Fierabras*, l. 1261; *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 3756; *Destr.* l. 501.

CEINT PETER, l. [453](#), the cathedral; cf. *Fierabras*, l. 57; *Destr.* l. 1109.

SEINT POUL, ll. [163](#), [3269](#), the saint; cf. *Syr Ferumbras*, l. 3756; not mentioned in the other poems.

POYLE, l. [514](#),? Apulia; found only in this poem; cf. note to l. [1000](#).

QWYNTYN, l. [1298](#), a saint by whom Ferumbras swears; see note to l. [2845](#).

RICHARD OF NORMANDY, see notes to ll. [2535](#), [2795](#), [3044](#).

ROMAYNE, l. [77](#), inhabitant of Rome.

ROME, l. [17](#).

ROULAND, see note to ll. [1499](#), [1888](#).

SATHANAS, l. [2777](#), a Saracen god.

SAVARIS, l. [171](#), a duke of Rome who leads the Roman troops against the Saracens. He is slain by Estragot (l. [346](#)). He also occurs in the *Destr. de Rome*. In the French *Fierabras* appears a French knight Savaris, l. 1699.

SORTYBRAUNCE, the chief councillor of the soudan.

SPAYN, l. [717](#), belonging to the soudan's dominions. It is the scene of the principal action narrated in this poem, as indeed the only part where the scene is laid elsewhere is that describing the destruction of Rome.

SYMON, a saint by whom Charles swears, l. [1713](#).

TAMPER, a name peculiar to this poem. He erects a gallows before Agremore castle to hang Guy, l. [2641](#).

TERMAGANT, l. [137](#), a Saracen deity; cf. note to l. [86](#). Spelt Ternagant in *Syr Ferumbras*, Tervagant in the French *Fierabras*.

TERY LARDENEYS, one of the twelve peers; see note to l. [1691](#).

TURKES, l. [874](#), cf. *Fierabras*, 128, 1641, 3767. *Syr Ferumbras*, 5433, 5677.

TURPYN, the French bishop who baptizes Ferumbras, l. [1475](#). This name does not occur in the Ashmole MS.

VENYS, subject to Laban; see note to l. [1000](#). Mentioned only in this poem.

#### TRANSCRIBER'S ENDNOTE

Original printed spelling and grammar has been retained, with some exceptions noted below. The middle English characters “ȝ”, “þ”, “ð”, and “ȝ” were originally printed always upright, not italic, but in this edition have been rendered as italic wherever that seems appropriate, as in this sentence from page [xxxvii](#): “*That or þat, who, whome* are used as relative pronouns”. The transcriber created the cover image and hereby assigns it to the public domain.

No widely supported unicode characters are available for the following, which have therefore been rendered herein as images: æ, ð, en, f, g, k, l, H, m, n, p, r, t, u, and y.

The poem *The Romounce of the Sowdone*, beginning on page 1, has sidenotes which contain a running synopsis of the play in modern English. In the printed book, these notes were broken into segments which were positioned so as to correspond more or less accurately to the lines of the play. For this edition, the synopsis notes have been rewrapped to fit within an allotted space, but are still aligned more or less accurately with the lines of the play. The sidenotes also contain page references to the original manuscript from which the play was transcribed, for example “[leaf 3]”. These have been kept aligned with the correct line of the poem, in this case, line [80](#).

Page [vi](#): *Pantragruel* was changed to *Pantagruel*.

Page [xxv](#): “346, 4902, the name of the giant” is changed to “346, 2944, 3022, the name of the giant”. This error occurs also in the Index of Names, see below.

Page [xlvi](#): A new heading has been inserted—“MS. OF THE SOWDAN”—to match the table of contents. The original text showed only a horizontal rule here.

Page [2](#): “amirals” changed to “admirals”, in the sidenote.

Page 9, l. [289](#): the left quotation mark has no mate in the printed book. A right double quotation mark has been inserted at the end of l. [291](#).

Page 10, l. [313](#): the left quotation mark has no mate in the printed book. A right double quotation mark has been inserted at the end of l. [323](#).

Page 11, ll. [369](#), 370: In the original book, there was a blank line shown between lines 369 and 370. This has been marked herein with a border to distinguish it from other lines which may appear blank in this ebook due to variable user hardware, software, and settings.

Page 23, l. [755](#): the left quotation mark has no mate in the printed book. A right double quotation mark has been inserted at the end of l. [766](#).

Page 27, l. [895](#): the left quotation mark has no mate in the printed book. A right double quotation mark has been inserted at the end of l. [910](#).

Page 31, l. [1059](#): the left quotation mark has no mate in the printed book. A right double quotation mark has been inserted at the end of l. [1074](#).

Page [36](#): In sidenote “They fight for a considerable time the blood”, added semicolon between *time* and *blood*.

Page [46](#): In the sidenotes, full stop was added after “dashed out his brains”, and “feeding he prisoners” was changed to “feeding the prisoners”.

Page [47](#): The first footnote had no label number; a number has been inserted to correspond to the footnote anchor on line [1615](#).

Page 59, l. [2063](#): the left quotation mark was unmatched. A new right double quotation mark is inserted at the end of l. [2066](#), after ‘there-ate.’.

Page 64, l. [2243](#): the left quotation mark before ‘beith’ was unmatched; a new right quotation mark is inserted at the end of line 2246.

Page 66, l. [2307](#): the left quotation mark ahead of ‘my loue’ was unmatched. A new right quotation mark is inserted at the end of l. [2310](#).

Page 68, l. [2380](#): the left quotation mark seems to be unmatched in the printed text. A new matching right quotation mark is inserted at the end of line 2390.

Page [69](#): There were two footnote anchors, but only one footnote. Very likely, although the footnote anchors are independent, the footnote text “See the note.” applies equally to both. In this edition, a second footnote has been inserted to correspond to the second footnote anchor.

Page 87, l. [3021](#): Poem says “xiiij”; sidenote says “4”; both retained.

Page [96](#), under “p. 2, l. 26. *bokes of antiquyte*.” The printed text provides a reference to Gautier, *Epop. Fr.*, II. 87, which is retained herein. However, a member of the Distributed Proofreaders team has pointed out that the reference should have been to *Les épopées françaises. Étude sur les origines et l’histoire de la littérature nationale*, I. 87 (1865). This book is available from archive.org, filename “lespopesfran01gautuoft”.

Page [99](#): in “p. 8, l. 84. *tithynge*.”, changed “8,” to “3,”.

Page [113](#): “p. 35, l. 1060” changed to “p. 31, l. 1060”.

Page [120](#): “p. 44, l. 1538” changed to “p. 44, l. 1539”.

Page [121](#): In the line “Sire drois emperere, pour amour Dieu. oiés”, the full stop after Dieu was changed to comma, in agreement with the text available at archive.org filed under “fierabraschanso00servgoog”.

Page [123](#): The range of line numbers in “*Destruction*, ll. 1240–159” does not seem to make sense, but is retained. The line “Ja mais ne mengerai si sera desmembrés.” was changed to “Ja mais ne mengerai si sera desmembrés.”.

Page [125](#): In “p. 59, l. 2045. *that he wente awaye with lym* = “that he had escaped with (his limbs, or having) his limbs safe and sound. *lyme*, O.E. *lim.*, Mod. Eng. *limb.*”, a right double quotation mark was inserted after ‘sound.’, and “*lim.*” was changed to “*lim*,”.

Glossary, “nather, 36/1232”. Line 1232 spells it “nathir”; both forms are retained.

Glossary, “then, 46/1593”. Line 1593 spells it “theñ”; both forms are retained.

Index of Names, “Astrogot, or Estragot”. The printed references “ll. 3944, 4902” are changed to “ll. 2944, 3022”.

Hyperlinks to Pages and Lines.

The following index of links to pages and *Sowdone of Babylone* poem lines is provided for convenience. Clicking on any page number in the book will bring the user here.

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